

ספר לשם שבו ואחלמה

LESHEM SHVO V'ACHLAMA

*Introductions and Gates · An Annotated English
Translation*

Volume One · Gates One Through Four

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The Hebrew source text of *Leshem Shvo v'Achlama* by Rabbi Shlomo Elyashiv (1841–1926) is a historical work. This edition's English translation, commentary, and annotations are original to this publication.

Volume One of 3 · Gates One Through Four

First edition.

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About This Work

ספר לשם שבו ואחלמה

Leshem Shvo v'Achlama

Introductions and Gates · An Annotated English Translation



The Author

Rabbi Shlomo Elyashiv (1841–1926), known as the **Baal haLeshem**, was one of the foremost Kabbalists of the modern era. Born in Lithuania, he devoted his life to the systematic study and exposition of the *Lurianic Kabbalah* — the mystical tradition as taught by Rabbi Isaac Luria (the Arizal, 1534–1572) and transcribed by his chief disciple, Rabbi Chaim Vital.

His magnum opus, *Leshem Shvo v'Achlama* — named after three of the twelve precious stones on the High Priest's breastplate — is widely regarded as the most comprehensive and rigorous presentation of Kabbalistic metaphysics ever written.

The Work

The book is structured as a series of **Shaarim** (Gates), each probing a foundational question in Kabbalistic cosmology: the nature of the Divine Names, the *tzimtzum* (Divine contraction), the structure of the spiritual worlds, and the relationship between the infinite and the finite.

How to read each chapter

- **Hebrew paragraph** — the Baal haLeshem's original text
- **English translation in bold** — a close, faithful rendering
- *Commentary in italic* — explanatory notes for readers new to Kabbalistic terminology
- Footnotes at the bottom of each chapter link to primary sources (Zohar, Etz Chaim, Talmud, etc.)

Contents

Shaar 1 — The Names *Havaye* and *Ad-nai*

- Chapter 1: What the Names *Havaye* and *Ad-nai* Signify
- Chapter 2: The Revelation of the Name *Havaye* in *Atzilut* and in *BiYA*

Further chapters and Gates will be added as the translation progresses.

[Begin Reading →](#)

G A T E

Shaar 1 — The Names Havaye and Ad-nai

Chapter 1: What the Names Havaye and Ad-nai Signify

Leshem Shvo v'Achlamah

ספר לשם שבו ואחלמה – הקדמות ושערים

שער א פרק א

Leshem Shevo v'Achlama — Introductions and Gates

Shaar 1 Chapter 1

What the Names *Havaye* and *Ad-nai* Signify

יסוד החכמה ושרש הקבלה.

§ 1:1

The foundation of wisdom and the root of Kabbalah

Rabbi Shlomo Elyashiv (1785–1866) is better known as the Baal haLeshem, after his magnum opus, *Leshem Shvo v'Achlama*, and we will refer to him this way henceforth. He begins his magnum opus explaining Rabbi Isaac Luria's system of Kabbalah with a phrase the initial letters of which spell the Ineffable Divine Name יהוה (often referred to as *Havaye* in English). This is a common practice, especially among Kabbalists.¹

אשר דבר נר יהוה. אר"י [=אדונינו רבי יצחק] לוריא הקדוש ידיד
מבטן אל התלמיד ישר נאמן ותיק

§ 1:2

that 'the candle of God' – the holy [Rabbi Isaac] Luria, beloved from the womb, imparted to his upright, faithful and veteran student,

Interestingly, the Baal haLeshem continues the above theme of spelling the Name of G-d by emphasizing the initial letters of the next four words as well, spelling א-ד-נ-י the Divine Name

associated with G-d as Master (*Adon*) of the Worlds Who oversees and orchestrates everything. The Talmud² and the Zohar³ note that the Ineffable Divine Name is spelled יהוה but is pronounced א-ד-נ (A-d-o-n-a-i). The Baal haLeshem continues with the same theme with the next five words as well, spelling א-ד-נ-ה-י — G-d as the Divine Judge and Creator, followed by the words spelling "our G-d" א-ד-נ-ה-י-נ-ו — the G-d of Israel. He completes the theme with the next three words, as we will see below.

Rabbi Isaac Luria, known to many as the Arizal (1534–1572), is regarded as the father of modern Kabbalah. Rabbi Elyashiv reverently refers to him as "the candle of G-d," based on the verse in Proverbs 20:27,⁴ perhaps because Rabbi Luria revealed the inner light of the Torah.⁵ Furthermore, he refers to him as "beloved from the womb" which usually refers to the Patriarch Isaac,⁶ the Arizal's namesake. This may be because Rabbi Isaac Luria is regarded as one of the founding patriarchs of Kabbalah.

אִישׁ חַיִּים דּוֹדֵינוּ. זָכָר שְׁנֵיהֶם לְבָרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא.

§ 1:3

Our beloved 'man of life' [Rabbi Chaim Vital], may both be blessed with the life of the World to Come

As mentioned above, the Baal haLeshem completes his theme by spelling out the word א-ד-נ — [is] One, thus rendering the first sentence of this work as an acrostic of the foundational principle of Judaism which he intends to expound on in this chapter, and also throughout the entire work — the Oneness of G-d. His entire explanation is based on the teachings of the Arizal which he alludes to by including his name and the name of his chief redactor, Rabbi Chaim Vital, in stating his theme of G-d's unity. The word דּוֹדֵינוּ, besides meaning 'beloved,' may also mean 'our uncle.' Perhaps there was some family connection, although I was not able to find one.

Rabbi Chaim Vital (1543–1620) was among Rabbi Luria's foremost disciples (according to many, his chief disciple) and the

one who committed his master's teachings to writing and taught them extensively.

לִידַע וּלְהוֹדִיעַ כִּי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ אֱלֹהֵי אַבְרָהָם אֱלֹהֵי יִצְחָק וְאֱלֹהֵי
יַעֲקֹב אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל.

§ 1:4

of knowing and informing us that God Almighty, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob, the God of Israel,

Rabbi Chaim was charged with the task of conveying this knowledge to us — that the God of the patriarchs is the singular Divine presence the Baal haLeshem now proceeds to describe.

הַיָּחִיד הוּא לְבַדּוֹ בְּרָצוֹנוֹ הַטּוֹב. הַמְצִיא כָּל הַנִּמְצָאִים וּבָרָא כָּל
הַנִּבְרָאִים

§ 1:5

He alone, out of His good will, brought forth all those in existence and created all the creations

Here Rabbi Elyashiv alludes to the higher 'worlds' — spiritual planes of existence — that he will speak about at length shortly. 'Those in existence' refers to transcendent planes of existence, including the World of *Atzilut* which exists on a plane beyond actual creation; 'created all the creations' refers to the World of *Beriah* — a finite created world called the World of Creation. This is the plane of reality where limited existence comes into being, but it is as yet inchoate, formless, until the World of *Yetzirah*.

(Author's hand-written note: 'Created all the creations' — here I did not write 'creates' in the present tense since the word for creation — בְּרִיאָה — implies *ex nihilo* as Ramban states,⁷ and that is not applicable in the present.) Creation *ex nihilo* occurred once only, at the beginning of Creation. Now regarding the fact that a number of the blessings use the word בּוֹרֵא — creates, in the present tense — our Sages state (*Berachot* 52b) that בּוֹרֵא 'creates', present tense, should be understood as 'created' in the past. But when בּוֹרֵא in the present tense occurs after the expression בָּרַךְ

past tense, it is clearly meant to indicate the past. In fact, the present tense is not even relevant since the creation was exclusively *ex nihilo*, and that occurred only on the first day of creation.

וַיֵּצֶר וַיּוֹצֵר כָּל הַיְצוּרִים וַעֲשָׂה וְעוֹשֶׂה כָּל הַמַּעֲשִׂים מִהוּהוּ הַכֹּל בְּכָל
עֵת

§ 1:6

He formed and fashions all formed entities, and made and makes all made entities. He brings everything into being at every moment.

"Formed and fashions" refers to the World of *Yetzirah*, the World of Formation, where finite existence now acquires form and dimension. "Made and makes all made entities" refers to the World of *Asiyah* where they become material entities. The meaning of "He brings everything into being all the time" will be explained shortly.

[Meaning to say that all of existence in its entirety — from the time that He brought it forth, and the entire duration of its continued existence — its constant coming into being is only from Him, for He continuously maintains it in existence in all of its fullness].

All being is continuously being kept in existence by the Divine force that created, formed and made it.

וּמִשְׁגִּיחַ בְּכָל בְּלִי הַפֶּסֶק וּמְנַהִיג אֶת הַכֹּל תָּמִיד רַק הוּא לְבָדוֹ וְאֵין
שׁוּם דָּבָר בִּלְעֵדוֹ מֵאוּמָה כָּלָל.

§ 1:7

And He watches over all beings without pause, and He guides all things constantly; He alone and none other at all.

Here the Baal haLeshem alludes to the doctrine of Divine Providence which he will discuss in a later section.

שְׁמוֹ נִכְתָּב בְּשֵׁם י-ה-ו-ה וְנִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם אֲדֹנָי.

§ 1:8

His Ineffable Name is written Yud-Hai-Vav-Hai but is pronounced Adonai.

On the verse (Exodus 3:15) **זֶה שְׁמִי לְעֹלָם** — "This is My Name forever..." our Sages⁸ note that the word *l'olam* (**לְעֹלָם**) is written without the letter *vav* and therefore alludes to the word for concealment — *he'elem*. Meaning: the eternal Name *Havaye* should not be read as written, but rather as *Adon-ai*. In order to distinguish the former Name from the latter, Kabbalists often used the term *Havaye* for the former.

**וְהִנֵּה הוֹרָאת הַעֲקָרִי דְּהַשֵּׁם הַיָּהּ הוּא נִמְצָא קָיָים, וְר"ל
שֶׁמִּצִּיאוֹתָיו הוּא בְּהוֹה תָּמִיד וְאֵין בְּמִצִּיאוֹתָיו עֶבֶר וְעֵתִיד**

§ 1:9

The Name *Havaye* signifies primarily 'continuous presence,' meaning that His existence is always in the present, not the past or future

One cannot say that God's existence is in the past, since the past is no longer. Nor is it in the future, since that does not yet exist. His existence is therefore always in the present. Or as the *Zohar* puts it: "Past, present and future all at once" (*Zohar III* p. 257b, *Raya Mehemna*).

**וְכֵן יֵשׁ בּוֹ גַּם כֵּן הוֹרָאת מְהוּה עַל שֵׁם שְׁכָל הַהִתְהוּוּת הוּא רַק
מִמֶּנּוּ וְתִלּוּי לְעוֹלָם רַק בּוֹ.**

§ 1:10

The Name *Havaye* also signifies 'bringing into being,' since all existence is exclusively from Him, and is always dependent upon Him.

שֶׁהוּא נוֹשֵׂא אוֹתָם בְּכָל מְלוֹאֵם כְּנִזְכָּר

§ 1:11

For He maintains [literally, 'carries'] them — all the worlds and everything in them — as mentioned.

וְהָיָה עַל שֵׁם הַהִתְהוּוּת שֶׁהֵיא בְּזִמְנוֹ וְנִבְחַן בְּעֶבֶר וְהָיָה וְעָתִיד הֵנָּה
נִקְרָא הוּא יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ גַּם כֵּן בְּשֵׁם תֹּאֵר הָיָה וְהָיָה וְיִהְיֶה שֶׁהֵם
אוֹתִיּוֹת ג' הַיּוֹת.

§ 1:12

Now it is in terms of this 'bringing into being' — which takes place in time and can be differentiated into past, present and future — that He, may His Name Havaye be blessed, can be described as past, present and future, the letters of which are the three states of being — in the past, the present and the future.

The Name הָיָה can be explained as an amalgamation of הָיָה, הָיָה, הָיָה (was, is, will be — all three states of being throughout time). But this is only when the Name *Havaye* is interpreted as signifying 'bringing into being.'

אֲמַנָּם עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ הוּא בְּאַמֶּת תָּמִיד בְּהָיָה וְהוּא הוֹרָאת
הַעֲקָרִי דָשֵׁם הָיָה בְּרוּךְ הוּא.

§ 1:13

But His essence (blessed be His Name) is truly always in the present, and this is the primary significance of the Name Havaye, blessed be He.

וְהוֹרָאת דָּשֵׁם אֲדָנִי הוּא אֲדוֹן הַכֹּל שֶׁהוּא מְשַׁגֵּיחַ בְּכֹל וּמְנַהִיג אֶת
הַכֹּל

§ 1:14

The import of the Name Adon-ai is that He is Adon [Master] of everything and that He oversees everything and conducts all matters.

וְהוּא בּוֹחַן וְדוֹן אֶת כָּל הַמַּעֲשִׂים כָּל מָה שֶׁנֶּצְרָךְ לַהֲעֲשׂוֹת בְּכֹל
הַנִּמְצָאִים כָּלֵם בְּקִיּוּמָם וְהַנְהַגָתָם שֶׁבְּכֹל עֵת.

§ 1:15

And He assesses and judges all deeds and everything that needs to be done with all things in existence, in preserving them and guiding them at all times.

The Name *Adon-ai* thus signifies the Almighty's relationship with the created worlds — as their Master, overseer, preserver and guide.

Footnotes

1. This is not exclusive to Kabbalists, however. See e.g. Rambam's *Mishneh Torah*, *Yesodei HaTorah* 1:1. [↩](#)
2. *Pesachim* 50a, cited below fn. 8. [↩](#)
3. *Zohar III* 230a; *Tikunei Zohar* 101a. [↩](#)
4. משלי כ, כז: נִרְיָהוּהָ נִשְׁמַת אָדָם חִפֵּשׁ כָּל חַדְרֵי בֶטֶן [↩](#)
5. See *Chagiga* 12a; *Zohar I* 47a, 264a; *Zohar II* 148b ff. [↩](#)
6. See *Talmud Shabbat* 137b; *Rashi*. [↩](#)
7. In his commentary to Genesis 1:1. [↩](#)
8. *Talmud Pesachim* 50a, *Rashi*. [↩](#)

Chapter 2: The Revelation of the Name Havaye in Atzilut and in BiYA

שער א פרק ב

Sha'ar 1 Chapter 2

The Revelation of the Name *Havaye* in *Atzilut* and in *Biy" A*

וְהִנֵּה כָּל הַגְּלוּיִם הִלְלוּ אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה אֵלֵינוּ בְּכָל זֶה הִנֵּה הוּא רַק עַל
יְדֵי שְׁהַמְצִיא אֶת כָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת

§ 2:1

Now all of these revelations mentioned above that were radiated to us are nevertheless only because He brought forth all of existence.

It is by way of His bringing the worlds into existence that we have any grasp at all of Godliness. Indeed, according to the *Zohar*¹ and the Arizal,² this was in fact the purpose of creation.

אֲבָל זֹלַת הַמְצִיאוֹת הִנֵּה הוּא פָּשׁוּט בְּאַחַדוֹת פְּשׁוּטָה בְּתַכְלִית
הַפְּשִׁיטוֹת

§ 2:2

In Himself, other than in terms of this existence that He brought into being, He is 'simple' with the simple unity of absolute simplicity.

The term 'simple' here requires explanation. The closest conceptual equivalents may be 'essential', 'primordial', 'elemental' or perhaps even 'uncompounded' — in the sense of an absolute infinite oneness not comprised of disparate, limited parts.

וְאֵין לוֹ שׁוּם גְּלוּי בְּשׁוּם שֵׁם וְתֹאֵר כָּלֹל וְאֵין בּוֹ שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה כָּלֹל
בְּשׁוּם דְּבוּר וְשֵׁם וּמְלָה וּבְשׁוּם אוֹת וּנְקֻדָּה

§ 2:3

He in His essence is not revealed in any Divine Name or description and He cannot be described at all in speech or name or

word, and not in any letter or vowel point.

כִּי הֵרִי כוֹלָם הֵם בְּהוֹרָאת גְּבוּלֵי עַל כָּל פָּנִים וּבִאֲחֻדוֹתוֹ הַפְּשׁוּטָה
הֵנָּה הוּא מְשַׁלֵּל מִזֶּה בְּתַכְלִית הַשְּׁלִילָה

§ 2:4

For they — words, names, descriptors — are all indicative of limitation in some sense, and in His uncompounded Oneness all descriptors are completely negated in regard to Him.

Any descriptor must have some limitation in order to describe the object of the description. Since He is in Himself infinite, and an indivisible unity, it is not possible to describe Him as He is in Himself. All descriptive terms are thus completely negated.

וְהֵרִי הוּא אֲמַתַּת פְּשִׁיטוֹתוֹ נֶעְלָם בְּתַכְלִית הַהֶעְלָם וְאִי אֶפְשָׁר לְדַבֵּר
וּלְהִרְהֵר בְּעֵנֵינוּ אֲמַתַּתוֹ וּשְׁלֵמוֹתוֹ אֲשֶׁר זֹלַת הַמְצִיאוֹת

§ 2:5

Thus His true essential being is completely concealed and it is impossible to speak and think about the truth and completeness of His being which is devoid of existence in the regular sense of 'existence.'

As the Baal haLeshem just explained, our categories of thought and speech are inadequate to the task of positive descriptions of the Being whose existence transcends all limitations. However, as we will see, we can *negate* or repudiate any descriptions which are part of common parlance, and in this way come to a certain level of understanding, albeit negative understanding — i.e. what He isn't (but not what He is).³

אֵלָּא רַק בְּדֶרֶךְ שְׁלִילָה לְבַד הֵיינוּ לְשַׁלֵּל מֵאֲמַתַּת עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ וּפְשִׁיטוֹתוֹ
כָּל עֵנֵינוּ גְּבוּל וְתִמוּנָה וְדִמְיוֹן

§ 2:6

But we can make use of the method of negation exclusively — that is to say, negate or repudiate any concept of limitation, representation or likeness from His true and simple essence.

וְרוּצָה לומר כי הנה כל גלוייו הנה הם בערך פשיטותו אשר
למעלה מהם בבחינת כח גבולי והתר לתאר בהם כל תארי
דשעורי קומה

§ 2:7

Meaning to say, all revelations that emerge from Him, when compared with the simplicity of His essence that transcends them, are to be regarded as finite powers which it is permissible to describe using any of the descriptive terms that apply to the *shiur koma*.

The term *shiur koma* refers to those finite spiritual worlds that can in be in some sense described or 'computed,' as explained in Rabbi Yishmael's *Pirkei Heichalot*. Since these are all 'revelations that emerge from Him,' in the words of the Baal haLeshem, and are not His essence, it is permissible to use descriptive terms, and even anthropomorphisms to describe them, as the Baal haLeshem will show. Kabbalah often uses anthropomorphic terms when describing the worlds 'outside of' His essence.⁴

וְכִמוֹ שֶׁנִּמְצָא בַּתּוֹרָה כְּמָה תּוֹאֲרִים בְּזֶה כִּמוֹ וְתַחַת רַגְלָיו, כְּתוּבִים
בְּאַצְבַּע אֱלֹהִים וְכְדוּמָה הַרְבֵּה וּבִפְרָט בְּשִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים וּבְדַבְרֵי חֻכְמֵי
הָאֱמֶת

§ 2:8

As we find in the Torah itself a number of such descriptive terms, such as 'Underneath His feet...'[^13]; 'Written by the finger of God'[^14] and many similar expressions, particularly in The Song of Songs (*Shir HaShirim*) and in the writings of the 'Sages of Truth' — the Kabbalists.

הַגִּם שֶׁעָקְרָם הֵם בְּאֵמֶת וְכֵן עַל שֵׁם הַמְּצִיאוֹת שֶׁנִּצָּא מֵהֶם עַל כָּל
פְּנִיִּם הָרִי הִתֵּר לְתֹאֵר אוֹתָם גַּם בְּגִלּוּיֵי עֲצָמוֹן גַּם כֵּן מְשׁוּם שֶׁהֵם
הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ לְהַמְצִיאוֹת

§ 2:9

Even though primarily these descriptive terms truly only apply to the limited existence that emerges from them, nevertheless it is permissible to use these descriptions for the revelations themselves

as well, since they are (at the very least) the origin of limited existence.

מִשָּׂא כֹן בַּפְּשִׁיטוֹתוֹ הָאֲמִתִּית אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה מִגְּלוּיֵיוֹ הִנֵּה שֵׁם אֲסוּר
בְּכָל חֶמֶר הָאֲסוּר הַיּוֹתֵר אֶפְשָׁרִי לְתַאֵר שֵׁם חֹסֵס וְשָׁלוֹם שׁוֹם בְּחִינָה
הַמּוֹרָה עַל אֵיזָה כַּח גְּבוּלֵי וְתַמּוּנָה וְדַמְיוֹן

§ 2:10

But this is not the case regarding His true simple — i.e. essential — being that transcends all the revelations

וּמִשְׁלַל שֵׁם מִכָּל זֶה בְּתַכְלִית הַשְּׁלִילָה וְאִי אֶפְשָׁר לְהַתְּבוּנָן שֵׁם כָּלֵל
אֶלָּא רַק בְּדֶרֶךְ שְׁלִילָה לְבַד

§ 2:11

— from which all descriptive terms are absolutely and totally negated. It is impossible to even ponder that level other than exclusively by way of negation —

It is possible to contemplate the transcendent Essence only in a negative sense — by repudiating any and all descriptive terms, in the manner that the Baal haLeshem will describe shortly.

לְשַׁלֵּל מִשֵּׁם כָּל עֲנִין הַמּוֹרָה אֵיזָה חֶסְרוֹן לְשִׁלְמוֹת הָאֲמִתִּית וְכָל
עֲנִין הַשְּׁגָה וְתַפְיָסָה מְזוּלָתוֹ

§ 2:12

— by negating there in His essence all concepts that indicate any deficiency in His true completeness, sometimes rendered as the 'Divine plenum.'

כִּי אֵין בִּלְעֲדוֹ יוֹדֵעַ מֵאֲמִתּוֹתָיו מֵאוֹמָה וְכָל מָה שֶׁאֵנּוּ מְדַבְּרִים מִמֶּנּוּ
יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ הִנֵּה הוּא רַק עַל יְדֵי מָה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה אֵלֵינוּ עַל יְדֵי
הַמְצִיאוֹת

§ 2:13

For no one besides Him knows anything of His true being; everything we discuss about Him is merely what is revealed to us by way of the limited existence that He brings into being.

Furthermore, this limited existence is all post-*tzimtzum*, where descriptive terms apply, as the Baal haLeshem will explain shortly.

וְכֵן גַּם הַגְּלוּי דְּהַשֵּׁם הָיָה בְּרוּךְ הוּא הֵגֵם שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁהוֹרָאָתוֹ הוּא
עַל מְצִיאוֹתוֹ הָאֲמֵתִית שֶׁהוּא בִּהְיוֹת תָּמִיד וּבִלְתִּי זָמַן

§ 2:14

So too, the revelation of the blessed Name Havaye, even though we stated that it is indicative of His true infinite and ineffable existence — in that He is always in the present and beyond time —

הֵינָה גַּם הַגְּלוּי הַזֶּה נִתְגַּלָּה אֵלֵינוּ בּוֹ גַּם כֵּן רַק עַל יְדֵי הַמְּצִיאוֹת
דְּהָעוֹלָמוֹת

§ 2:15

even this revelation is disclosed to us via the existence of the worlds.

כִּי כָל בְּחִינָה נִמְצָא וְהוּא אֲשֶׁר בְּהוֹרָאָת דְּשֵׁם הָיָה בְּרוּךְ הוּא הֵינָה
הוּא גַּם כֵּן רַק אַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה בְּהַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּהָעוֹלָמוֹת כּוֹלָם

§ 2:16

Because every aspect indicated by the blessed Name Havaye also is to be found (*nimtza*) and exists only after it has been revealed within the limited, finite existence of all the worlds.

כִּי כָל לְשׁוֹן נִמְצָא הוּא מוֹרָה עַל גְּלוּי בְּחִדוּשׁ שֶׁנִּתְחַדֵּשׁ וְנִתְגַּלָּה
וְנִמְצָא

§ 2:17

Indeed, every instance of the word *nimtza* — 'is to be found' — is indicative of a radiance or revelation that is generated anew and becomes revealed and is then 'to be found.'

וְכֵן הוּא מוֹרָה עַל גְּלוּי לְזוּלָתוֹ כִּי כֵן הוּא לְשׁוֹן נִמְצָא שֶׁנִּמְצָא לְזוּלָתוֹ

§ 2:18

In addition, the word *nimtza* also denotes a revelation to something or someone other than Himself; this is actually the semantic

definition of 'nimtza' — 'to be found by another' i.e. those who are not Him.

וְעָקַר לְשׁוֹן נִמְצָא הוּא מִגְזֵרֵת יֵצֵא שֶׁיֵּצֵא מִהַעֲלָמְתּוֹ וְהָרִי הוּא מוֹרָה
עַל חֲדוּשׁ עַל כָּל פָּנִים

§ 2:19

Indeed, the primary derivation of the word 'nimtza' is from 'yatza' — 'emerged,' 'exited' — it emerged from its prior state of concealment, which anyway indicates that it is generated anew.

וְרוּצָה לומר שְׁנִתְחַדֵּשׁ גִּלּוּיוֹ מִהַעֲלָמְתּוֹ שֶׁבִּתְחִלָּה כִּי בִּתְחִלָּה הָיָה
נִעְלָם וְעַכְשֵׁיו נִתְגַּלָּה וְזֶהוּ לְשׁוֹן נִמְצָא

§ 2:20

Meaning to say that this radiance is a new revelation from its prior state of concealment; initially it was concealed and now it is revealed. That is the meaning of 'nimtza.'

וְהָרִי הָיָה גִּלּוּיוֹ בְּחֲדוּשׁ וְהֵינּוּ מַעַת הַצִּמְצוּם וּלְהֵלָאָה שָׂאֵז יֵצֵא
מִהַעֲלָמְתּוֹ דְּבַחֲיִנַּת אֵין סוּף וְנִתְּן אַפְשָׁרִית לְגִלּוּיוֹ

§ 2:21

Thus the radiance is a new phenomenon — from the moment of the tzimtzum and on — for this is when it emerged from its state of concealment where it was the aspect of Ein Sof, infinite and therefore ineffable. It was the tzimtzum that gave the possibility for it to emerge as a revelation.

The *tzimtzum* is a major subject that requires some explanation.⁵

As the Baal haLeshem will explain later, this very first radiance or revelation after the *tzimtzum* is called the *kav*⁶ — the ray of light (so to speak) that after a series of further reductions and descents becomes the first plane of existence known in Kabbalah as the meta-world *Adam Kadmon*, the highest and most exalted of the five worlds. *Adam* means "in the likeness of" or "in the image of," from the Hebrew word *domeh*. *Kadmon* means "primordial" or "primary," from the Hebrew root *kadam*. So, *Adam Kadmon* is the primordial, transcendent world which is "in the likeness of" the

Infinite Light which preceded it and which became concealed in the process of creation. This means that even though *Adam Kadmon* is a world that comes into being through the concealment of the Infinite Light, it is such an elevated plane of reality that it remains transcendent — "in the likeness of" the Infinite Light. Thus, the world of *Adam Kadmon* could be called a meta-world, a level so sublime, pure and transcendent that it is almost imperceptible. It cleaves to and mirrors the original Infinite Light.

וְכֹן נִתְגַּלָּה אַחֵר כֶּךָ בְּגִלּוֹי מִמֶּשׁ עַל יְדֵי הָאֲצִילוֹת

§ 2:22

And afterwards this radiance becomes revealed in actuality by way of the plane of reality called Atzilut, the world of Emanation.

וּמֵאִז וְהִלָּאָה הוּא נִתְגַּלָּה וְנִמְצָא שֶׁהוּא הוֹה תָּמִיד וְהוּא הוֹרָאָה
דָּשֶׁם הִיְוָה בָּרוּךְ הוּא נִמְצָא קִיָּם כֵּן"ל פָּרָק א'

§ 2:23

And from then on this Divine radiance is in a state of revelation and 'is to be found,' for He always is in the present. This then is what the blessed Name Havaye connotes: 'is to be found' existing, as explained above chap. 1.

אֲמָנָם גַּם הוֹרָאָה לְשׁוֹן הוֹה הוּא מוֹרָה גַּם כֵּן רַק עַל גִּלּוֹי לְזוּלָתוֹ כִּי
כָּל שֵׁם וּמִלָּה הִנֵּה הוּא לְעוֹלָם רַק כְּדִי לְהִשְׁתַּמֵּשׁ עַל יְדֵיהֶ לְזוּלָתוֹ

§ 2:24

However, even the word hoveh^[17] — the aspect of the Divine Name that denotes His always being in the present — also only implies 'revelation to another,' i.e. to those who are not Him, since every name and word is always and only so that another can use it.

וְהוּא מָה שֶׁאֲמָרוּ בַּמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה פָּרִשְׁת חֻקַּת סִימָן ג' אֲנִי ה' הוּא שְׁמִי
הוּא שְׁמִי שֶׁקָּרָא לִי אָדָם הָרָאוּ שׁוֹן הוּא שְׁמִי שֶׁהִתְנִיתִי בֵּינִי לְבִין
עֲצָמִי

§ 2:25

This is the significance of the statement in Midrash Bamidbar Rabba (Chukat 19:3) on the verse 'I am Havaye that is My

Name'^18] (Isaiah 42:8): 'This is the Name that Adam called me; this is My Name regarding which I made stipulations with Myself' regarding revelation of Myself therein.

[Meaning to say, this is the Name with which He emerged from concealment to revelation, and His Essence was revealed in this Name. And when it says 'with Myself' this refers to the radiance in Atzilut that was revealed there from the concealed True Being above].

Note that the square brackets are in the original. The meaning of 'stipulations with Myself' will be explained shortly.

The World of *Atzilut* (emanation) is the first of the immanent worlds. The word *Atzilut* in Hebrew derives from the word *etzel*, meaning "close to" or "near."⁷ The world of *Atzilut* is "close to" its source, even though it is not united and identified with it to the same degree as the world of *Adam Kadmon*. Nevertheless it is a lofty and rarefied plane of reality which is merely emanated, not yet created. But the word *Atzilut* also means "to set aside," "separated from," as in the verse "And I will set aside from (v'*atzalti*) the spirit that is upon you and place it upon them"⁸ (Numbers 11:17), for the world of *Atzilut* is, so to speak, 'set aside from' God's essence, as the Baal haLeshem goes on to explain.

הוא שמי שהתניתי ביני לבין בריותי ורוצה לומר שנתגלה על ידו
לזולתו והוא בעולמות בריאה יצירה ועשייה

§ 2:26

'And this is the Name with which I made stipulations between Myself and My creations,' meaning to say that there was revelation to others — i.e. to those who are not Him — by way of the Name. This alludes to the worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*.

Beriah, the world of Creation, is the second immanent world. It is a tremendous step down from the world of *Atzilut*, as it is the beginning of created being. ברא — the root of the word *Beriah* ('creation'), is always used in Hebrew to signify *yesh mi-ayin* —

creation *ex nihilo*.² This implies the coming into being of limited, restricted, finite existence.

Yetzirah is the third of the four immanent spiritual worlds, the realm of spiritual existence in which the limited nature of the created beings takes on form and definition, and *Asiyah*, the fourth and lowest immanent world, is the dimension where Godliness is most concealed. It is the final stage in the creative process and the lowest aspect of it includes the physical universe. The Baal haLeshem will explain all of these in their proper place (in *Shaar* 2).

וְהָרִי לָנוּ שְׂכָל הַגְּלוּי דְּהַשֵּׁם הַנִּהְיָ בְּרוּךְ הוּא רַק מֵעַת הָאֲצִילוֹת
וְלִהְלֵאָה וְרַק מָה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה בּוֹ לְזוֹלָתוֹ

§ 2:27

Thus we have it that all revelations to us of the blessed Name Havaye are exclusively from the moment the world of Atzilut was emanated and on, and only that which was revealed therein to those who are not Him.

וְמָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר שֶׁהִתְנִיתִי לְשׁוֹן תְּנָאִי הוּא בְּמָה שֶׁגִּזְרָה רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ
לְהִתְגַּלּוֹת רַק בְּגְלוּי הַזֶּה דּוֹקָא וְלֹא בְּאַפִּן אַחֵר בְּשׁוּם פָּנִים וְכֵן לֹא
לְמַטָּה מִמֶּנּוּ וְלֹא לְמַעְלָה מִמֶּנּוּ

§ 2:28

And the phrase 'with which I made stipulations' expresses a condition to be met — signifying that it depends upon what His blessed will decrees — to reveal only in this specific manner of revelation and in no other way at all; and no lower nor loftier than decreed.

וְהוּא בְּמָה שֶׁנּוֹדַע שֶׁהִתְחַלַּת הַגְּלוּי דְּהַשֵּׁם הַנִּהְיָ בְּרוּךְ הוּא הוּא רַק
בְּכָל הַנֶּאֱצָלִים אֲשֶׁר מֵהַצְמָצוּם וְלְמַטָּה אֲבָל לֹא מֵהַצְמָצוּם
וְלְמַעְלָה

§ 2:29

Specifically, the decree is, as is known, that the initial revelation of the blessed Name Havaye shall only be in that which is emanated after the tzimtzum and below, but not prior to the tzimtzum.

וְכֵן גְלוּיּוֹ לְזוּלָתוֹ הַנִּמְשָׁךְ מִמֶּנּוּ לְהַעֲלֹמוֹת בְּרִיָּאָה יְצִירָה וְעִשְׂיָה
הִנֵּה הוּא בְּעוֹלָם הָאֲצִילוֹת וְרַק בְּזַעִיר אֲנָפִין וּמַלְכוּת וְלֹא יֵצֵא
בְּעוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיָּאָה בְּגִלּוּיּוֹ אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַל מִהַזַּעִיר אֲנָפִין וּמַלְכוּת

§ 2:30

In addition, the revelation to 'something other' — i.e. to those levels below Atzilut that are regarded as 'other' — that is drawn down from the world of Atzilut to the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah (abbreviated as BiYA), is only drawn from the aspects of *zeir anpin* and *malchut*. Thus, the radiance that is drawn into the worlds of BiYA is no higher than *zeir anpin* and *malchut*.

Ze'ir anpin is a cluster of *sefirot* that includes *chesed*, *gevurah*, *tiferet*, *netzach*, *hod* and *yesod*. Its composition and function will be discussed later on. *Malchut* is the final *sefirah* and is also referred to as *Shechinah*. These will be explained at length in *shaar* 7.

אֲלֵא רַק בְּאוֹר דְּזַעִיר אֲנָפִין וּמַלְכוּת לְבַד שֶׁהֵם הַשְּׁמוֹת דְּהוּיָה אֲדָנִי.
§ 2:31

This radiance is only from the light of *z'a* (*ze'ir anpin*) and *malchut*, which are the Names *Havaye* and *Ad-nai*.

וְכַנּוּדָע שֶׁעֶקֶר הַגְּלוּי דְּהַשֵּׁם הוּיָה בְּרוּךְ הוּא הוּא נִשְׁלָם בְּזַעִיר אֲנָפִין
וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהַמְלָכוֹת וְשֵׁם נִתְגַּלָּה בְּהַשֵּׁם אֲדָנִי

§ 2:32

As is known, the primary revelation of the blessed Name *Havaye* is manifested completely in *z'a*, which is then clothed in *malchut*, where it is revealed as the Name *Ad-nai*.

וַיֵּצֵא עַל יְדֵי זֶה בְּהַעֲלֹמוֹת בְּרִיָּאָה וְלֹא הַמְּשִׁיךְ גְּלוּיּוֹ דְּעִצְמוֹת אוֹר
הַשֵּׁם הוּיָה בְּרוּךְ הוּא יוֹתֵר לְמַטָּה שֶׁהוּא בְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה

§ 2:33

By way of this process it descends into the worlds of BiYA. However, the radiance of the essence of the blessed Name *Havaye* is not drawn down to the World of Beriah

וְכִנּוּדָּע שֶׁעָקַר עֲצָמוֹת אֱלֹהוֹת נִתְצַמָּצֵם לְהִסְתֵּיִם בְּסוֹף הַמַּלְכוּת
 דְּאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהֵיָא הֵה"א אַחֲרוֹנָה דְּהֵשֵׁם וְהֵיָא הַמִּתְגַּלָּה בְּשֵׁם אֲדֹנָי
 § 2:34

As is known, the primary essence of Godliness — i.e. divine revelation — is curtailed and terminates at the lowest level of malchut of Atzilut, corresponding to the final letter hai of the Name Havaye, and is revealed as the Name Ad-nai.

וְנִתְצַמָּצֵם וּמִסְתֵּיִם עֲצָמוֹת אֱלֹהוֹת בְּסוֹף הַמַּלְכוּת דְּאֲצִילוֹת וּמִשָּׁם
 וְלִמְטָה הֵם נִבְרָאִים נוֹצְרִים נַעֲשִׂים שְׂאִינָם אֱלֹהוֹת כָּלֵל
 § 2:35

As mentioned, the essence of Godliness is curtailed and terminates at the lowest level of malchut of Atzilut. From there on below are the created, formed and made beings in the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah respectively, that are not Godliness at all.

וְכָל אוֹרוֹ הַנִּמְשָׁךְ בָּהֶם הוּא רַק עַל יְדֵי מְסָכִים
 § 2:36

All the light drawn into them is only via 'screens.' Light on the other side of a screen is called 'ohr shel toldah' — second-generation or derivative light, not original first-generation light.
 [^22]

וְלֹא נִמְשָׁךְ בָּהֶם אֵלָּא רַק תּוֹלְדוֹת הָאֶרֶץ לְבַד וּבִזְהָ בְּרָא וְיוֹצֵר וְעֹשֶׂה
 כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּבִרְיָ"ע
 § 2:37

There is not drawn into them — the worlds of BiYA — anything other than a mere radiance, and it was from this that He created, formed and made the worlds of BiYA as they exist.

[All of this is explained in Etz Chaim, in Seder Atzilut in chap. 1 summary; ibid. Drushei ABiYA chap 13; Seder ABiYA chap. 1 (end); ibid Kisei Hakavod chap. 1 (end). See also Seder ABiYA chap. 6; Kisei Hakavod chap. 5. As is known to those who have tasted from the Etz Chaim — The Tree of Life i.e. the Kabbalah of the Arizal].

The brackets appear in the original. This is a parenthetical statement offering some sources for further study.

וְהוּא שְׁאֵמְרוּ הַתְּנִיתִי לְשׁוֹן תְּנֵאִי לֹמֵר שֶׁלֹּא נִתְגַּלָּה אֶלָּא בְּגִלּוֹי הַזֶּה
דְּוָקָא וְלֹא נִתְּן רְשׁוּת לְקִרְוֹתוֹ וְלַעֲבֹדוֹ אֶלָּא רַק בְּאוֹתוֹ הַגִּלּוֹי דְּוָקָא.
§ 2:38

To return to our earlier theme: this is why the Sages said that the word הַתְּנִיתִי (I stipulated) expresses a condition to be met — for He would not be revealed other than in this manner, and permission was not given to call out to Him and serve Him other than via this exact revelation.

Footnotes

1. The term 'revelations/s' — גִּלּוּיִם in Hebrew — refers to Hashem revealing Himself as Himself and not through any individual. It is not meant to convey any sense of revelation as in prophecy etc. [↩](#)
2. *Zohar II*, 42a: ... בתר דעבד האי דיוקנא דמרכבה דאדם. עלאה, נחית תמן ואתקרי בההוא דיוקנא יהו"ה, בגין דישתמודעון ליה במדות דיליה בכל מדה ומדה. וקרא אל אלהים שדי צבאות אהי"ה, בגין דישתמודעון ליה בכל מדה ומדה ... דאי לא יתפשט נהוריה על כל בריין איך ישתמודעון [↩](#) ליה, ואיך יתקיים (ישעיה ו ג) מלא כל הארץ כבודו
3. See Rambam's *Moreh Nevuchin* part 1, chap. 58. [↩](#)
4. See *Etz Chaim, Shaar* 42:2. [↩](#)
5. See *Etz Chaim, Shaar* 1:2. [↩](#)
6. See *Etz Chaim, Shaar* 1:2. [↩](#)
7. *Pardes, shaar* 16:1. See also *Zohar Chadash, Terumah* 29. [↩](#)
8. *Pardes, shaar* 16:1. [↩](#)

9. Ramban, Genesis 1:1 — "ואין אצלנו בלשון הקדש בהוצאת" [↩](#)
"היש מאין אלא לשון ברא

Chapter 3: Derivative Names and Titles

שער א פרק ג

Shaar 1 Chapter 3

Derivative Names and Titles

וְנַחֲזֹר עַל הַדְּבָרִים כִּי הִנֵּה נִתְבָּאֵר לָנוּ שְׁגָם הַגְּלוּי דְּהַשֵּׁם הוּיָהּ ב"ה
אֲשֶׁר הוּא עֲצָמוֹ נִקְרָא בּוֹ

§ 3:1

Let us recap: It was explained that even the revelation of the blessed Name Havaye by which He Himself is called

ר"ל שְׁאֻמַּתַּת עֲצָמוֹתוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה נִתְגַּלָּה לְהִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם זֶה הִנֵּה גְלוּי
אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בְּזֶה הוּא רַק ע"י הַמְּצִיאוֹת

§ 3:2

– meaning to say, when His true hidden essence becomes revealed and can be called by this Name – this revelation in which He is revealed is only by way of finite existence.

וְהֵיינוּ ע"י הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּכָל הַנֶּאֱצָלִים אֲשֶׁר מֵהַעֲמָצוֹם וּלְמַטָּה שֶׁעַל
יָדָם נִתְגַּלָּה לְהִקְרָא הוּא עֲצָמוֹ בְּשֵׁם הוּיָהּ ב"ה

§ 3:3

I.e. His Name is revealed via the existence of the emanated worlds post-*tzimtzum* and on. It is through them that He becomes revealed so that He Himself can be called Havaye, may He be blessed.

אֲמָנָם הַגְּלוּי הַזֶּה הוּא גְּלוּי כָּלְלִי וּמִסְתַּעַף לַפְּרָטִים רַבִּים שֶׁהֵם כָּל
הַשְּׁמוֹת וְכִנּוּיִם כָּלֵם הַנִּמְסָר לָנוּ בַּתּוֹה"ק שֶׁבִּכְתָּב וּשְׁבַע"פ כָּכָל
הַמְּבֹאֵר בְּדַבְרֵי חֻכְמֵי הָאֱמֶת

§ 3:4

However, this revelation is a general revelation that branches out into many details, which are all the holy Names and designations

that have been conveyed to us in the holy Torah, both Written and Oral. As all this is explained in the words of the Sages of Truth – a term reserved for the sages of the Kabbalah.

There are seven holy names appearing in the Written Torah (i.e. Scripture), often referred to as 'the seven names which it is forbidden to erase'.¹

וְכָל־הֵם מִסְתַּעְפִּים מֵהֶשֶׁם הוּיָהּ ב' ה' כִּי כָל־הֵם לְפִי הוֹרָאָה
גְלוּיָיו הַפְּרָטִים אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בְּהַמְצִיאוֹת

§ 3:5

But all of them branch out from the blessed Name Havaye, because all of them are according to the specific revelations revealed within finite existence.

הוּן בְּפָרְטֵי מְצִיאוֹתָם גּוֹפָה וְהוּן בְּפָרְטֵי תַּהֲלוּכוֹת עֲנִינֵי הַנְּהֻגָתָם

§ 3:6

This is the case with regard to the details of their existence itself, and with regard to their specific manner of conduct

וְהוּא מָה שְׁנוֹדַע מֵאַמְרָם ז"ל בְּשֵׁמוֹר פ"ג סִימָן ו' לְפִי מַעֲשֵׂי אֲנִי
נִקְרָא

§ 3:7

– as is known from the statement of our Sages in *Shemot Rabba* 3:6: 'According to My deeds I am called...'

The Midrash explains that after God gave Moses the mission to liberate the Israelites from Egypt, Moses asked: "When I come to the Israelites to tell them, 'the God of your forefathers sent me to you' they will say to me, 'What is His name?' What should I then answer them?" (Exodus 3:13). The Midrash goes on to give God's response, the latter part of which the Baal HaLeshem quotes here: "My [ineffable] Name you wish to know? *According to My deeds I am called.*"² We will refer to the latter as names and 'titles' or 'designations' – i.e. the names and titles (such as 'the Merciful One, the Almighty etc.) used in reference to God. When 'Name' is capitalized it refers to the ineffable Name (יה-וה or *Havaya*).

וְנִמְצָא וְנַעֲשֶׂה כָּל שֵׁם וְשֵׁם לְפִי גִלּוּיוֹ שֶׁבְּכָל פֶּרֶט כִּי הַשֵּׁם וְהַגִּלּוּי
אֶחָד הוּא שֶׁהַשֵּׁם עֲצָמוֹ הוּא הַגִּלּוּי

§ 3:8

So it turns out that each name is fashioned according to its specific revelation in every detail, because the name and the revelation are one and the same. For the name itself **is** the revelation.

The above applies only to the other names, not to the ineffable Name, as will be clarified shortly.

וְכָל אֱלוֹ הַשְּׁמוֹת וְהַגִּלּוּיִם הַפְּרָטִיִּים הֵם כֻּלָּם מִסְתַּעְפִּים וְיוֹצְאִים
מִשְׁמוֹ וְגִלּוּיוֹ הַכָּלְלִי שֶׁהוּא הַשֵּׁם הוּיָה ב"ה כִּי הֵם רַק פְּרָטִי גִלּוּי
עֲצָמוֹ כֵּנִז

§ 3:9

All of these names and individual revelations – the ones that are according to His deeds – all of them branch out and emerge from His Name and overarching revelation,^[4] the Name Havaye. For they are merely the specific revelations of the ineffable Name itself, as mentioned.

וְהִנֵּה נִתְגַּלָּה בַּכ"ז ע"י הַמְצִיאוֹת דְּכָל הַנִּצָּצִים אֲשֶׁר מֵהַצְמָצוֹם
וּלְמַטָּה

§ 3:10

Yet nevertheless they are revealed through the limited existence of all the emanated worlds and levels from the **tzimtzum** and on.

See our explanation of the *tzimtzum* according to Rabbi Elyashiv in *shaar* 1, chap. 2.

כִּי ע"ז נִתְגַּלָּה לְהַקְרָא בְּשֵׁם הוּיָה ב"ה וְכֵן בְּכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת וְכִנּוּיִם
הַמִּסְתַּעְפִּים מִמֶּנּוּ

§ 3:11

For it is by way of this **tzimtzum** that He becomes revealed to be called Havaye (may He be blessed) and all the other names and titles that stem from it from the ineffable Name Havaye.

וְהֵם כָּל הַתּוֹאֲרִים כָּלֵם אֲשֶׁר עָלְיוֹ ית"ש שֶׁהוּא עֲצֻמוֹ נִקְרָא וּמִתְאָר
בָּהֶם ע"פ גְּלוּיָו שֶׁבְּאֲצִילוֹת

§ 3:12

These are all the descriptive terms or titles for Him, may He be blessed, by which He is called and described – according to what He reveals in the world of Atzilut.

וְהִנֵּה הָיָה כָּל אוֹתוֹן הַגְּלוּיִם בְּאֲצִילוֹת לְפִי צֶרֶךְ הַמְצִיאוֹת
דִּהְעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע כָּל מָה שֶׁנִּצְרָךְ לַמְצִיאוֹתָם וְהִנֵּהגָתָם

§ 3:13

Now all of these revelations of the various names and titles in Atzilut are according to the needs of the existential worlds – i.e. the finite worlds of *BiYA* \[Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah\], in contrast with the emanated world of Atzilut and above.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בָרַע"מ פִּנְחָס רנ"ז ב' קִדְּם דְּבִרָא עֲלֵמָא אֶתְקָרִי הוּא
בְּכָל אֵלִיו דְּרָגִיו עַל שֵׁם בְּרִיּוֹ דְּהוּ עֲתִידִין לְהַבְרָאוֹת

§ 3:14

This is what the *Zohar* III in *Raya Mehemna*^[^5] *Pinchas* 257b states: 'Before He created the world He was called all of those levels in the name of the future creation.'

The *Zohar* here addresses the question as to whether the various names and titles indicate a change in the *Ein Sof* from one state to another – e.g. from judgment to mercy, which would contradict the principles of G-d's immutability and His unity. The *Zohar* answers that even prior to Creation He is called all of these different names and titles etc., not because they actually apply to Him, but because it arose in His will to create the various worlds where these terms would apply in the future. It is only because of the future creation that these terms come into being.³

וְהוּא כָּל הַגְּלוּיִם שֶׁבְּאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם לְפִי הַסֵּדֶר שֶׁרָאָה רְצוֹנוֹ
לִיִּסֵּד בָּהֶם אֶת כָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת דְּבִי"ע

§ 3:15

These are all the revelations in Atzilut that were revealed there according to the order that He wanted in order to later on establish the existential worlds of *BiYA* – Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

וְאָמַר שֵׁם הָרַע"מ עוֹד דָּאִי לֹא בְרִיּוֹן דְּהוּ דְּעֵלְמָא אֲמַאי אֲתִקְרוּ
רְחוּם, דִּיּוֹן? אֵלָא עַל שֵׁם בְּרִיּוֹן דְּעֵתִידִין

§ 3:16

The *Raya Mehemna* ibid. states further that if not for the creations that would come to be in the world, why would He be called 'the Merciful One, or Judge?' Rather, all of the names and titles are for the sake of future creations.

דְּאִילוּלָא שְׁהַמְצִיא אֶת הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע הָרִי הָיָה כָּל גְּלוּיָיו
שְׁבַאֲצִילוֹת לְלֹא צָרָךְ וּבִגִּין דָּא כָּל שְׁמָהּ אֲנוּן כְּנוּיִין דְּלִיָּה עַל שֵׁם
עוֹבְדִין דְּלִיָּה שְׁכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת שְׁבַאֲצִילוֹת שְׁהֵם גְּלוּיָיו הֵם רַק בְּשִׁבִּיל
הַבִּי"ע ע"פ מָה שֶׁרְאוּי לָהֶם

§ 3:17

Were it not for the worlds of *BiYA* – Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah – that He brought forth, all of the revelations in Atzilut would have been unnecessary. Therefore, all the holy names, His titles so to speak, are given in reference to His deeds, since all the holy names in Atzilut, which are His revelations, are only for the sake of the worlds of *BiYA*, in the manner that is appropriate for each of them.

אֲמָנָם כָּל הַגְּלוּיִם הִלְלוּ הוּא רַק מֵעַת הַצְמָצוּם וּלְהִלָּאָה וְכֵן רַק
מִהַצְמָצוּם וּלְמַטָּה שֶׁהוּא בְּכָל הָאֲצִילוֹת כִּלּוֹ אֲבָל לֹא קִדְם
הָאֲצִילוֹת וְלֹא לְמַעַלָּה מֵאֲצִילוֹת

§ 3:18

However, all of these revelations are only from the time of the *tzimtzum* and on, and only from the *tzimtzum* and below – which is the entire emanated world of Atzilut, but not prior to the emanation of Atzilut, and not above it, on a higher level than Atzilut.

All of the holy names and titles become manifested only after the *tzimtzum*, and only in the world of Atzilut, not above it. The *Meir*

HaLeshem,⁴ one of the commentaries on this work, notes that the Baal HaLeshem seems to be making a distinction here between time ("not prior to...") and space ("not above it"), and he is puzzled as to the reason for the distinction.

However, the concept of time itself in the normal meaning of the word is not relevant in Atzilut, just the concept of space per se is not relevant. Perhaps he means what is called in Midrash *seder zemanim*.⁵

וְנִמְצָא שְׁכָל גְּלוּיָיו בְּלֶם שֶׁהֵם כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת וְכַנּוּיִם בְּלֶם הֵם רַק ע"י
הַמְצִיאוֹת דְּעוֹלָם הָאֲצִילוֹת וּע"פ מָה שֶׁרְאוּי מֵהֶם לְהַמְצִיאוֹת
דְּהָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

§ 3:19

It transpires therefore that each and every one of His revelations, which are all the names and titles discussed previously, all of them are only revealed by way of the existence of the world of Atzilut. And from them – the revelations in Atzilut – they are drawn down into the existential worlds of *BiYA*, as appropriate for them.

אִמָּנָם כָּל הַגְּלוּיִם הִלְלוּ שֶׁהֵם כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת וְהַכְּנוּיִם בְּלֶם הֵנָּה הֵם
מָה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה הוּא עֲצֻמוֹ בָּהֶם ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת וְנִקְרָא הוּא עֲצֻמוֹ בָּהֶם
בְּלֶם ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת

§ 3:20

However, all of these revelations – each and every one of the names and titles – are the way in which He Himself is revealed in them via Atzilut. And He Himself is called by all of them via the emanated world of Atzilut.

As the Baal HaLeshem indicated before (from the Midrash) "According to My deeds I am called..." – in other words, it is Me who is acting through these names etc. via their source in Atzilut, as he goes on to explain:

וְהֵנָּה הֵם בְּלֶם רַק מֵעַת שֶׁעָלָה בְּרִצּוֹנוֹ לְהַמְצִיא בְּהַמְצִיאוֹת
דְּהָאֲצִילוֹת וְלִהְיוֹת גְּלוּיָיו וְלִהְיוֹת עַל יְדֵיהֶם אֶת כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

§ 3:21

Now all of these names are only from the time that it arose in His will to be found within^[^9] the existence of Atzilut and to be revealed there, and to bring forth all the worlds of *BiYA* thereby.

Footnotes

1. See Talmud *Sh'vuot* 35b; *Shulchan Aruch*, *Yoreh De'ah* 276:9. [↩](#)
2. Note that the previous chapter in our *Midrash* (3:5), and similarly in *Midrash Tanchuma Shemot* (3:25), Moses wanted to know His *great Name* (i.e. Havaye) explicitly. [↩](#)
3. Following *Matok MiDevash*. [↩](#)
4. Footnote 25. [↩](#)
5. See *Bereishit Rabba* 3:7. [↩](#)

Chapter 4: Two Aspects of Revelation in Atzilut

שער א פרק ד

Shaar 1 Chapter 4

Two Aspects of Revelation in Atzilut

וְהִנֵּה הָיָה סֵדֶר גְּלוּיָיו אֲשֶׁר בְּאַצִּילוֹת מִשְׁעָר וּמִכּוֹן בְּכָל עֲנִיָּיָהֶם
בְּמִדָּה וּבְמִשְׁקָל לְפִי סֵדֶר תּוֹצְאוֹת הַבִּי"ע שֶׁרָצָה לְהוֹצִיא עַל יְדֵיהֶם
§ 4:1

Now, the order of His revelations in the world of Atzilut were measured and precise in all aspects, measured and weighed, so to speak, according to the order of the results that He wished to produce thereby in the worlds of *BiYA*.

כִּי הִנֵּה כָּל אוֹתוֹן הַגְּלוּיִם אֲשֶׁר בְּאַצִּילוֹת הִנֵּה הֵם עֲצָמָם הַשְּׂרָשִׁים
הָעֶקְרִיִּים דֶּהֶעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע וְכָל עֲנִיָּיָהֶם בְּכָל־לוֹת וּפְרָטוֹת
§ 4:2

Because all of those revelations in Atzilut are themselves the primary roots of the worlds of *BiYA* and all related concepts both generally and specifically.

In Talmudic dialectic when a general rule is followed by an explicit particular, the rule is limited to the specified particular. The Baal HaLeshem invokes this exegetical rule here as well, since the general revelation in Atzilut is limited to the specified particulars He desired in the lower worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*, as explained in chapters 2 & 3.

וְנוֹדַע הוּא כִּי בְּכָל שְׂרֵשׁ הִנֵּה מִסְדֵּר בּוֹ כָּל כְּחוֹתָיו וְתַכּוּנוֹתָיו רַק
לְפִי עֲנִיָּי תוֹלְדוֹת הָעֶנְף וְהַפְּרִי שֶׁנִּמְשַׁךְ וְיוֹצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ
§ 4:3

It is known that in every root of a plant all the capacities and qualities are arrayed only according to the products that will

emerge later in the branch and fruit that derive and emerge from them – from the roots.

The analogy here to a plant and its roots and fruits comes to illustrate an important principle the Baal HaLeshem outlined earlier – that the products in the lower world (ultimately the 'fruits') are the primary purpose, not the roots. The roots serve merely to nourish and support the plant and fruits that grow from them.

וְהוּא מ"ש בְּזוֹהַר קְפֻדֵי רַכ"א ע"א דְּכָל מָה דְּבָרָא קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ
הוּא בְּעָלְמָא דִּין בָּרָא לֵיהּ כְּגוֹנָא דְלַעֲיָלָא

§ 4:4

As is written in the Holy Zohar (*Zohar* II *Pekudei* 221a) that everything the Holy One, blessed be He, created in this world, He created in the likeness of the worlds above.[¹⁰]

וְכָל אֲנוּן גּוֹנִין דְלַעֲיָלָא אֲתֵקִין לוֹן לְתַתָּא לְמַהוּי עָלְמָא דָּא בְּדִיוּקָא
דְּעָלְמָא דְלַעֲיָלָא לְאַתְדַּבְּקָא וּלְאַתְקַשְׁרָא עָלְמָא בְּעָלְמָא

§ 4:5

(The Zohar continues:) All of those 'appearances' [¹²] – the clusters of *sefirot* or 'spiritual profiles' called *partzufim* [¹³] – above in the world of Atzilut, He established down below as well, in the worlds of *BiYA* [¹⁴] so that this world would be in the likeness of the world above so that one world will cleave to and be bound to the other.

וְכֵן בִּפ' תְּצַוֶּה קפ"ו ע"ב דְּלִית לָךְ מַלְה בְּעָלְמָא דְלָא אֵית לָהּ דּוּגְמָא
לַעֲיָלָא כְּגוֹנָא דְלַעֲיָלָא הָכִי אֵית לְתַתָּא

§ 4:6

Similarly in *parshat Tetzaveh* (186b) the *Zohar* states: There is nothing in the world that does not have its likeness above; as it is above, so is it below.

וְהוּא מְשׁוּם שְׁשׁוּרֶשׁ כָּל מְצִיאוֹתָם אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע בְּכָל
וּבְפֶרֶט וְכָל סֻדָּרָם וְתֵהְיוּכֹתִיָּהֶם הֵן מָה שְׁנוּגֵעַ לְעֶצְמוֹתָם הָעֶקְרִי
וְהֵן כָּל מְקוֹרֵיהֶם שְׁנַעֲשֶׂה בָּהֶם

§ 4:7

This is because the root of the existence of all entities in all of the worlds of *BiYA*, in general and specifically, and the way they are all arranged in their various groupings and the manner in which they proceed – whether relating directly to their essence or whether to tangential occurrences that involve them –

הַנִּה שָׂרֵשׁ כָּל הַדְּבָרִים הוּא הַכֹּל בְּאַצִּילוֹת וּמִשָּׁם נִמְשָׁךְ בָּהֶם וְהֵם
הֵם גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש אֲשֶׁר בְּאַצִּילוֹת שְׁבָהֶם הוּא מְהִיָּה הַכֹּל וּמְנַהִיג אֶת
הַכֹּל תָּמִיד וְהֵם הֵם שְׁמוֹתָיו ית"ש

§ 4:8

– the root of all of these things is all in Atzilut, from whence it is drawn down to them. These are His very revelations, may His Name be blessed, in the world of Atzilut, with which He brings everything into existence, and by which He directs everything constantly. And these revelations are themselves His names, may His Name be blessed.

The *Meir HaLeshem*¹ notes that the author seems to imply here that the primary emphasis in Kabbalah study should be knowledge of the holy names and the manner in which they are revealed.²

However, another authority, Rabbi Yitzchak Isaac Chaver³ (1789-1853), states that the primary goal is to understand Divine Providence (השגחה פרטית) and its workings. Nevertheless, *Meir HaLeshem* opines, there may not be a difference of opinion, since the workings of Divine Providence IS in fact via the revelation of His names.

שֶׁהֵם הַשְּׂרָשִׁים הָרִאשׁוֹנִים וְהַכּחוֹת הַפְּנִימִים שֶׁל כָּל הַבְּרִיאָה כְּלָה
וְכָל אֲצָאִיָּה בְּכָל מָה שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה בָּהּ בְּכָל עֵת שֶׁהַכֹּל הוּא מְמַנּוּ

§ 4:9

These revelations are the first roots and the inner capacities of the entire creation and all of its progeny – everything that is produced thereby at any time – it is all from Him.

The term 'inner capacities' or 'powers' refers to particular, immanent divine revelations that are manifested in specific, limited and definable functions (sometimes called 'vessels' – *kelim*)

indicated by the various Divine names. These are the opposite of 'encompassing' or transcendent revelations (*makifim*) that are not confined to specific, limited functions.

וְהוּא גִלּוּיּוֹ וְשִׁמוֹתָיו וְכַמּ"ש לְפִי מַעֲשֵׂי אֲנִי נִקְרָא

§ 4:10

And these are expressed as His revelations and His names, as the Sages declared, 'according to My deeds I am called,' as explained above.

אֲמַנָם הוּא כִּי הֵנָּה הַגִּם שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ שְׁכָל הַגִּילּוּיִם הִלְלוּ הֵנָּה הוּא מָה
שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה בָּהֶם ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת וְאֲמַרְנוּ כִּי הֵנָּה הֵם כָּל
הַשְּׁמוֹת הַקְּדוּשִׁים כָּלֵם אֲשֶׁר נִקְרָא ע"י הָאֲצִי הוּא עֲצֻמוֹ בָּהֶם לֹא
זוּלָתוֹ ח"ו

§ 4:11

However, although we said that all of these revelations are His essence itself, as revealed in them via the world of Atzilut, and we said that these are all the holy names by which He is called via Atzilut, He Himself and no other (God forbid) is in them

וְכַמּ"ש (ישעי' מב, ח) אֲנִי ה' הוּא שְׁמִי וְכַבֹּדִי לֹא אַחֵר לֹא אֶתֶּן

§ 4:12

as it is written, 'I am God (י-ה-ו-ה); that is My Ineffable^[18] Name, and My glory I will not give to any other' (*Isaiah* 42:8) – to idols.^[19]

וְאֲמַרְנוּ ג"כ כִּי כָּל אוֹתָן הַגִּלּוּיִם הֵם הַכַּחוֹת הָעֲקָרִיִּים הַנוֹשְׂאִים
אֶת כָּל הַהִתְהוּוֹת כְּלָה וְכָל מְקָרֶיהָ בְּכָל מְלוֹאֵיהֶם מְרֹאשִׁית עוֹלָם
הַבְּרִיאָה עַד סוֹף תַּחְתִּית הָעֲשִׂיָּה

§ 4:13

We also said that all of those revelations are the primary forces that maintain all of existence and all of the events that take place throughout existence from the highest level of the world of Beriah to the very lowest level of Asiyah.

הִנֵּה עַכְ"ז אֵין לָנוּ וְלֹא לְשׁוּם נִבְרָא שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה וְהִשָּׁגָה בְּמַהוּת
אִיזָה גְלוּי מִכָּל אוֹתוֹן הַגְּלוּיִם כָּלָם

§ 4:14

With all that being said, neither we nor any other created being has any grasp or comprehension of the essence of any of those revelations.

The Baal HaLeshem makes a clear distinction here between knowledge of the *existence* (מציאות) of divine revelations, and comprehending their *essence* (מהות) which is not possible for us. This harkens back to Shaar 1 chap 2 where he explained the difference between positive descriptions and the *negation* or repudiation of any descriptions. See also *Moreh Nevuchin* cited in chapter 2 footnote 12. *Meir HaLeshem* notes that *existence* (מציאות) refers to revelations in the worlds of *BiYA*.⁴

אֶלֶּא רַק בְּצוּרַת הָאוֹתִיּוֹת וְהַנִּקְדּוֹת בְּצִירוֹן הַתְּגִין וְהַטַּעֲמִים אֲשֶׁר
בְּכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת הַקְּדוּשִׁים כְּפִי מָה שֶׁנִּמְסַר לָנוּ בְּכֶתֶב וּבַע"פ אֶבֶל זוֹלַת
צוּרַת הַשְּׁמוֹת אֵין לָנוּ וְלֹא לְשׁוּם נִבְרָא שׁוּם הִשָּׁגָה וְתְּפִיסָה בְּמַהוּת
אִיזָה גְלוּי מִכָּל גְּלוּיּוֹ מְאוּמָּה כָּלָל

§ 4:15

We are capable of grasping only the shape of the letters and the vowel points, together with the crowns on top of the letters^[^21] and the cantillation marks of all the holy names,^[^22] as handed down to us in written and oral form. But besides the form of the names neither we, nor any created being, has any comprehension and grasp at all of the essence of any revelation among all of the revelations.

וְהוּא ג"כ מְאוּתוֹ הַטַּעֲם גּוֹפָה שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ כִּי כָל אוֹתוֹן הַגְּלוּיִם כָּלָם
הוּא מָה שֶׁהוּא עֲצָמוֹ ית"ש נִתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם וְלָכֵן מְשַׁלֵּל הוּא מִכָּל
נִבְרָא מְלֶה שִׁיג בָּהֶם מְאוּמָּה

§ 4:16

This is for the very same reason already stated: because all of those revelations are such that He Himself is revealed in them. And

therefore every created being is denied the possibility of comprehending anything of them.

וְמָה שֶׁאֵנוּ קוֹרְאִים אוֹתָן בְּשֵׁם גְּלוּיִם שֶׁהוֹרָאָתָם הוּא שֶׁמֶשֶׁג וְנִתְפָּס
הוּא בִּשְׁנֵי עֲנִינִים אֲשֶׁר שְׂרָשָׁם אֶחָד הוּא

§ 4:17

But the fact that we refer to them as 'revelations' – implying that they are comprehended and grasped intellectually – is true in terms of two concepts that have a single origin:

הֵינּוּ א' כִּי הֵנָּה הֵם נִקְרָא גְלוּיִם רַק מִצֵּד מְצִיאוֹתָם וְלֹא מִצֵּד
מֵהוּתָם כִּי מֵהוּתָם הוּא בְּאֵמֶת נֶעְלָם בְּתַכְלִית הַהֶעָלָם אֲבָל
מְצִיאוֹתָם הֵרִי נִתְגַּלָּה לָנוּ בְּדַאי מִצֵּד הַתְּהוּוֹת כָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת
וְהִנְהֲגָתוֹ אוֹתָם תָּמִיד

§ 4:18

1) They are called 'revelations' only in terms of their existence, not their essence – i.e. as revealed in *BiYA*,^[23] because their essence is indeed profoundly concealed, whereas their existence is certainly revealed to us in terms of His bringing all of existence into being and orchestrating them at all times.

וְהוּא כִּמְאֹמֶר קְדוּשַׁת ה' בְּשִׁיר הַיְּחֻד יוֹם ה' לֹא מְצֻאנוֹהוּ וְלֹא
יִדְעֵנוֹהוּ אֲךָ מִמַּעֲשָׂיו הַכִּרְנוֹהוּ

§ 4:19

This is like the statement of God's sanctity in *Shir HaYichud* for the fifth day of the week: 'God, whom we did not find and did not know, but from Whose deeds we recognize Him...'

Regarding God Himself we have no direct knowledge, but we can know His deeds, as the Baal HaLeshem explained earlier.

וְעַד שֶׁאֵמַר דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ ע"ה הַשָּׁמַיִם מְסֻפָּרִים כְּבוֹד אֵל כּו' וְכֵן
בְּמִזְמוֹר ק"ד ה' אֱלֹהֵי גְדֻלַּת מָאֵד כּו' וּבְמִזְמוֹר ק"ז הִמָּה רָאוּ מַעֲשֵׂי
ה' כּו' וְכַמוֹהוּ רַבִּים

§ 4:20

– similar to what King David said, 'the heavens declare the glory of God' (Psalms 19:2). Similarly, in Psalm 104:1 'Havaye my God, You are very great' upon which the Radak comments: 'From Your deeds \[the Creation that this Psalm lauds\] we understand that You are very great.' And in Psalm 107:24 'They have seen the deeds of God...' – His deeds, but not Him. There are numerous other examples.

וּבִפְרָט בְּהִנְהִיגָתוֹ ית"ש בְּכָל הַנִּסִּים הַנִּגְלִים וְהַנִּסְתָּרִים וּבְכָל
הַמַּאֲרָעוֹת כָּלם אֲשֶׁר מִיּוֹם בְּרֹא ה' אָדָם עַל הָאָרֶץ עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה
וּבִפְרָט בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל עִמּוֹ בִּיחּוּד בְּכָלל וּבִפְרָט

§ 4:21

This is all evident particularly in the way He orchestrates matters in terms of all the miracles, both revealed and concealed, and all the phenomena that testify to His deeds from the day God created man on earth until this very day. And this is particularly evident with Israel His people in general and also individually, in a most singular manner,

עַד שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד רוֹאֶה בְּעֵינָיו מִמֶּשׁ כִּמְאֹמֶר הַכָּתוּב (דְּבָרִים ד', לֵא)
אַתָּה הָרָאֵתָ לְדַעַת כִּי ה' הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים אֵין עוֹד מִלְּבָדוֹ

§ 4:22

to the extent that every person can see it with his very own eyes, as the verse states, 'You have been shown, in order to know, that Havaye is God; there is none beside Him!' (Deuteronomy 4:35).

וְהָרִי לָנוּ שֶׁכָּל מָה שֶׁצִּמְצַם בְּאַמְתָּתוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה הַמְשָׁלָל מִכָּל
תְּפִיסַת מַחֲשָׁבָה וִידִיעָה בּוֹ וְנִתְצַמְצַם לְמָקוֹם לְהַעֲלֹמוֹת וּלְהִיּוֹת
מִהוּהָ הַכֹּל וְהוּהָ בְּכָל שֶׁהוּא הוּ בְּכָל עֲצֻמוֹתָם וְהוּ בְּכָל מְקָרֵיהֶם

§ 4:23

Thus we have it that whatever He constricted (*tzimtzem*) of His concealed true Being, from which any perch for thought and knowledge is negated, and which was constricted in order to form a place for the worlds, so that He would bring everything into being and be within whatever there is, whether in their essential state or in the events that take place with them, as explained above.

הִנֵּה רָאוּי לְקַרֵּא אוֹתָם הֵיטִיב בְּשֵׁם גְּלוּיִם כִּי הָרִי נִתְגַּלָּה וְנִתְנַדַּע
לָנוּ בַכ"ז וּבַכ"ח אֶתְּהָ הָרֵאָתָ לְדַעַת כּו'

§ 4:24

Thus it is wholly proper to refer to them as 'revelations', since they become revealed and known to us through all these means, as the verse states 'You have been shown, in order to know...' as mentioned above.

אֲמָנָם כָּל גְּלוּיִם הוּא רַק בִּידִיעָה וְלֹא בְהִשָּׁגָה שֶׁהוּא רַק בְּמִצִּיאוֹתָם
וְלֹא בְמַהוּתָם

§ 4:25

However, all of this revelation is only in one's knowledge of them but not in comprehension, in their existence but not in their essence, as mentioned above.

אֲךָ עֲנִינוּ הַשְּׁנִי בַזֶּה הִנֵּה הוּא בְּאֶמֶת קְרוּב כִּמְעַט לומר שֶׁהֵם גְּלוּיִם
מִמֶּשׁ גַּם בְּהִשָּׁגָה וּתְפִיסָה חוּשִׁית

§ 4:26

2) But the second factor truly comes close to stating that they really are revelations, even in comprehension and in the apprehension of the senses!

In other words, they are revelations not only existentially, as was explained in the first point above, but can also be considered revelations in a much deeper sense, so that they are revealed in one's comprehension and can even be apprehended by the senses.

וְעַכ"ז הִנֵּה הֵם בְּעֶמֶק רַק מֵאוֹתוֹ עֲנִינוּ הָרֵאָשׁוֹן עֲצָמוֹ וְהֵינּוּ כִּי הִנֵּה
אֲמָרְנוּ לְעֵיל פ"ג שֶׁכָּל גְּלוּיָיו כָּלָם הִנֵּה הֵם עֲצָמָם כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת
הַקְּדוּשִׁים הַנִּמְסָר לָנוּ בִּכְתָב וּשְׁבַע"פ

§ 4:27

Nevertheless, at their very depth, they are the same concept mentioned in the first point. Meaning to say, that which we stated above in chapter 3 – that all the revelations are themselves all the holy names that have been conveyed to us in writing and orally –

וּבְאִמְרֵנוּ בַּע"ר לְכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת הַמְּבֹאָרִים בְּדִבְרֵי חֲכָמֵי הָאֱמֶת
וְהֵם יוֹצְאִים כָּל־מִצְרופֵי אוֹתִיּוֹת שְׁבִתוֹה"ק אִם מִרְאשֵׁי תְבוֹת אוֹ
מִסּוּפֵי תְבוֹת אוֹ מִחֲצֵינָן

§ 4:28

– now when we say 'orally', we mean those names that are explained in the words of the Sages of Truth the Kabbalists – these all emerge from the permutations of the letters in the Holy Torah, whether from the initial letters of consecutive words or the end letters of consecutive words, or the middle letters.

וְכֵן גַּם מִחֲלוּפֵי הָאוֹתִיּוֹת בְּכָל הָאֲלֶפֶ"י בֵּיתִין דְּרַל"א שְׁעָרִים כְּנוֹדָע
לְבָאֵי בְּסוּד ה'

§ 4:29

They are also produced by letter exchanges using all the alphabets of the 231 gates, as is known to those who are privy to God's secrets.

The *Mishna* in *Avot* 5:1 declares that God created the world with 10 utterances. The *Sefer Yetzirah* (2:4-5) describes this process and mentions that the most basic combinations of letters of the Hebrew Alphabet, i.e. two-letter combinations, form 231 pairs of letters that were used in the construction of the universe. They are called the 231 'gates'.

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן בְּפִתְיַחַת הַתּוֹרָה וְאָמַר שֶׁם כִּי כָל הַתּוֹרָה
כְּלָה שְׁמוֹתָיו שֶׁל הַקַּב"ה וְכֵן הוּא בְּזוּה"ק יִתְרוֹ צ' ע"ב וּמִשְׁפָּטִים
קכ"ד רע"א

§ 4:30

As the Ramban writes in his Introduction to the Torah in which he states that the entire Torah is names of the Holy One, blessed be He. The same point is made in the Zohar *Yitro* 90b (which will be cited shortly) and *Mishpatim* 124a.

וְכָבֵד אֶמְרֵנוּ כִּי כָל שְׁמוֹתָיו הֵנָּה הֵם הַגְּלוּיִם עֲצָמָן אֲשֶׁר הוּא עֲצָמוֹ
יִת"ש נִתְגַּלָּה בְּאוֹתָן הַשְּׁמוֹת ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת

§ 4:31

As we already said, all of His names are the revelations themselves in which He, may He be blessed, is revealed – in those very names – via Atzilut.

וכמ"ש בזה"ק יתרו פ"ו ע"א על העשר ספירות דאצילות דבהו
אתחזי מלכא קדישא ואינון שמייה והוא אינון הוא שמייה דכתיב
אני יי' הוא שמי הוא ושמייה חד הוא

§ 4:32

As it states in Zohar *Yitro* 86a regarding the ten *sefirot* of Atzilut: 'in which the Holy King appears; they are His name, and He is them. He is His name, as it is written, "I am Havaye; that is My Name" (*Isaiah* 42:8) – He and His Name are one.'

וכן בפרשת אמור צ"ג ע"ב אליו עטרי מלכא דאיהו אחד בהו,
ואינון ביה. אינון שמייה, ואיהו ושמייה, מלה חדא הוא

§ 4:33

So too in *Zohar* III *parshat Emor* 93b: 'those are the crowns of the King (the ten *sefirot* of Atzilut) with which He is unified, and they with Him. They are His name, and He and His name are one.'

The ten *sefirot* of the world of Atzilut are not distinct entities or intermediaries, which might imply duality or plurality in God. Quite the contrary – as the Baal HaLeshem states here they are nothing other than His names, through which He reveals Himself to man, as explained previously.

ובפ' יתרו צ' ע"ב דהא אורייתא שמא דקודשא בריך הוא הוי כו'
ואורייתא כלל שמא חד הוי שמא קדישא דקודשא בריך הוא ממש
כו' מאן דזכי באורייתא, זכי בשמא קדישא

§ 4:34

Similarly, in *Zohar* II *parshat Yitro* 90b: 'Indeed, the Torah is the name of the Holy One, blessed is He... and the Torah is all one name, the holy name of the Holy One, blessed is He, literally... One who, by his deep study of Torah and his righteous actions, [25] merits the Torah, merits the Holy Name.'

ר' יוסי אמר בקב"ה ממש זכי דהא הוא ושמייה חד הוא

§ 4:35

Rabbi Yose declared: not only is he worthy of the Holy Name, he is worthy of the Holy One, blessed is He Himself, literally, since He and His Name are one.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ מִכֹּחַ שְׁכַל הַשְּׁמוֹת הַקְּדוּשִׁים הִנֵּה הוּא מִה שְׁעֲצֻמוֹת
גּוֹפָה נִתְגַּלָּה בְּגִלּוּיָהֶם אַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּאַצִּילוֹת

§ 4:36

Thus, from all of this, we have it that all the holy names are such that His very essence becomes revealed in their being revealed, after being clothed in Atzilut.

וְהוּא מְשׁוּם כִּי אִמְתָּתוֹ הִנֵּעַלְמָה עֲצָמוֹ נִתְצַמְצַם וּמִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְשׁוֹכֵן
בְּאַצִּילוֹת וּמִתְיַחַד בָּהּ בִּיחּוּד עָצוֹם עַד שֶׁנַּעֲשִׂית חֵד עִמּוֹ

§ 4:37

This is because His concealed true Being itself becomes constricted (*nitzamtzem*) so that He can extend into, and dwell in, Atzilut. And He becomes unified in it with a powerful unity to the extent that it becomes one with Him,

וְכַמ־שׁ אֵלֵיהֶו זל"ט אַנְתָּ הוּא דְּאַפִּיקַת עֶשֶׂר תְּקוּנֵיוֹ, וְקָרִינוּ לוֹן עֶשֶׂר
סְפִירוֹת כו' וּבְגִין דְּאַנְתָּ מְלָגְאוּ, כָּל מָאן דְּאַפְרִישׁ חֵד מִן חֲבֵרִיה מְאַלִּין
עֶשֶׂר, אֶתְחַשִּׁיב לִיה כְּאֵלוֹ אַפְרִישׁ בְּךָ

§ 4:38

As Eliyahu the Prophet, who is remembered for the good, stated: 'You are He who brings forth the ten rectifications,[²⁶] which we call the ten *sefirot*... And because You are within them, anyone who separates one from the other of these ten *sefirot* is regarded as if he caused a separation in You.'

וְהָרִי לָנוּ שְׁעֲצֻמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה שׁוֹכֵן בְּאַצִּילוֹת וְהִנֵּה נִתְגַּלָּה שֵׁם עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ
גּוֹפָה בְּבַחֲיִנַת אֵלוֹ הַד' אוֹתִיּוֹת י-ה-ו-ה וְהוּא אֱלֹהֵינוּ כִּי הָרִי
עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה נִתְגַּלָּה ע"י הָאַצִּילוֹת בְּבַחֲי הַד' אוֹתִיּוֹת הִלְלוּ

§ 4:39

Thus we have it that His very essence rests in Atzilut, and His essence itself is revealed there in the four-letter Name י-ה-ו-ה. And He is our God – as we recite in *Shema* twice daily – since His essence itself is revealed via the world of Atzilut in these four letters.

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁמִּבְּאֵר בְּרַע"מ פ' בָּא מ"ב ב' דע"י הִתְלַבְּשׁוּ בְּאַצִּילוֹת נִתְגַּלָּה
הוא עֲצָמוֹ בְּהֶשֶׁם הוּיָה ב"ה

§ 4:40

And as is explained in *Zohar* II *Raya Mehemna parshat Bo* p. 42b: via clothing Himself in Atzilut He Himself is revealed in the blessed Name Havaye. Study the text there carefully and you will find this idea.

וְהוּא מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה ב' סִימָן ג' אָמַר ר' חֲנִינָא
בְּרֵאשׁוֹנָה כָּל מִי שֶׁהָיָה מֵרָאָה אִיקוֹנִין שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ בְּאַצְבָּע הָיָה נִהְיָ
וְהִתִּינוּקוֹת הוֹלָכִים לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ וּמֵרָאִים אֶת הָאֲזָכָרוֹת בְּאַצְבָּע
אָמַר ה' וְדָגְלוּ עָלַי אֶהְיֶה (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים ב, ד) וְגָדְלוּ עָלַי אֶהְיֶה

§ 4:41

This is what our Sages stated in *Bamidbar Rabba* 2, 3: Rabbi Chanina declared, 'At first, in earlier generations, anyone who pointed with his finger to the representation^[^30] of the king was put to death, but now even young children go to the House of Study and point with a finger to the expressions of the four-letter Name in the Torah! To which God responds, "And their encampments^[^31] of the Israelites around the Tabernacle is beloved to Me" (Song of Songs 2:4) – which Rabbi Chanina interprets as meaning: Don't read "and their encampments" but rather "and his thumb^[^32] the thumb of a young child pointing to God's Name in the Torah is beloved to Me."

וְהָיָה לָנוּ שֶׁקוֹרָא הַמִּדְרָשׁ אֶת הֶשֶׁם הוּיָה ב"ה בְּשֵׁם אִיקוֹנִין שֶׁל
מֶלֶךְ

§ 4:42

So we have it from here that the Midrash refers to the blessed Name Havaye as the 'representation' of the King!

כי אחר שנתפשט ונמשך דרך אלפי ריבואות מדרגות אין חקר
ונמשך גלוי שפאצילות דרך כל העולמות בי"ע ונחתם בכ"א
מחותם לנחתם עד שנחתמו אלינו לאלו הד' אותיות דהשם הוי"ה
ב"ה כפי מה שכתובים לפנינו בתורה

§ 4:43

Because since the Name extends forth and was drawn down tens of thousands of levels to an extent that is impossible to fathom, and the revelation in Atzilut is drawn down through all the worlds of *BiYA*, and is emblazoned into each of them, from stamp to stamped, until there is emblazoned in us these four letters of the blessed Ineffable Name Havaye, as is written in the teaching before us – this 'stamp' in us is the 'representation' of the King of kings, the blessed Holy One.[³³]

וכן עד"ז הנה נתגלה עצמותו עוד ע"י האצ"י בכל השמות כלם
המסתעפים מהשם הוי"ה ב"ה וכן בכל התורה כלה שהיא כלו
שמו של הקב"ה כנז' והם כלן איקונין שלו

§ 4:44

In the same manner, His essence is further revealed via Atzilut within all the Divine names that branch out from the blessed Name Havaye, and throughout the entire Torah, which is all the name of the Holy One, blessed be He,[³⁴] as mentioned, and they are all His 'representations'

מבחי' גלויי שנתגלה באצילות שנתצמצם שם להתגלה באותן
הגלויים להיותם שרש לכל פעלתו והנהגתו שפועל ומנהיג
בהעולמות בי"ע

§ 4:45

of the aspect of His revelations as revealed in Atzilut, where He constricted Himself to become revealed in those very revelations, to become the root of all His activities and their orchestration which He brings about and directs in the worlds of *BiYA*.

ומאחר שהם איקונין דגילוי עצמותו גופה א"כ הרי הם נודע
וגלויים לנו גם בהשגה ותפיסה חושית ממש והוא ענין השני אשר
אמרנו לעיל בטעם שנקראו בשם גלויים

§ 4:46

And since they are the resemblance of the revelation of Himself, they are known and revealed even in a conceptual sense, and in the perception of our senses. This is the second idea we mentioned above regarding the reason they are called 'revelations,'

כִּי הָרִי נִרְאָה לְכַאוֹרָה לֹמַר שֶׁהֵם בְּאַמֶּת גְּלוּיִם מִמָּשׁ גַּם בְּהַשְׁגָּה
וּתְפִיסָה וְהוּא הַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה וְכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת כָּלָם וְכֵן כָּל הַתּוֹרָה
כְּלָה

§ 4:47

because it seems we can state that they – the holy names – are truly actual revelations, revealed even in thought and intellectual apprehension. This is the blessed Name Havaye and all the derivative names, and also the entire Torah, as mentioned previously.

Footnotes

1. Notes at the back of his commentary on the *Leshem*, p. 415 note 1. [↩](#)
2. He references *Etz Chaim Shaar 1 Anaf 1* as support. [↩](#)
3. Rabbi Yitzchak Isaac was a distinguished kabbalist and one of the foremost disciples of Rabbi Menachem Mendel of Shklov, a close disciple and associate of the Vilna Gaon (1720-1797). [↩](#)
4. Fn. 30, where he refers to the GRA *Sifra diTzniuta* 37. [↩](#)

Chapter 5: The Revelation via the Name Havaye and via other Names

Shaar 1 Chapter 5

The Revelation via the Name *Havaye* and via other Names

אֲמַנָם הוּא כַּאֲשֶׁר נִתְּבוֹנָן בְּזֶה אָנוּ רוֹאִין כִּי עֲנִין הִזֶּה הַשְּׁנִי הֵנָּה
הוּא בְּהֶכְרַח ג"כ רַק מֵעֲנִין הָרִאשׁוֹן עֲצָמוֹ

§ 5:1

However, when we contemplate this matter, we see that the second point mentioned above in the previous chapter – that the revelations discussed really are revelations – is inevitably only the first point itself,^[^1] namely, that they are called 'revelations' only in terms of the fact that they actually exist, but not in terms of their essence – in terms of **metziut** but not **mehut**. This will be explained below.

וְכָל גְּלוּיָיו אֲשֶׁר גַּם בְּהִשְׁמוֹת הַקְּדוּשִׁים וּבְכָל הַתּוֹרָה כּוֹלָה הֵנָּה
הֵם מְשׁוּלָל ג"כ מִהִשָּׁגָה וּתְּפִיסָה לְשׁוֹם נִבְרָא

§ 5:2

All of His revelations, even those revealed as the holy names throughout the entire Torah, are also inaccessible to the comprehension and intellectual grasp of any created being.

וְהוּא כִּי הֵרִי כָּל הִשָּׁגָה וּתְּפִיסָה חוּשִׁית אֲשֶׁר יֵשׁ לָנוּ בְּזֶה, הֵנָּה
הוּא נִמְשָׁךְ לָנוּ רַק מִצַּד הַחוּמָּרִי וְהַגִּשְׁמִי שֶׁבָּהֶם שֶׁהֵרִי מֵה שְׁאֵנוּ
מְשִׁיגִים צוּרַת אוֹתִיּוֹת הַתּוֹרָה וְהִשְׁמוֹת הוּא רַק מִצַּד שֶׁהֵם עֲשׂוּיִם
מִקָּלָף וְדִיו וְשִׁחּוֹר עַל גִּבֵּי לָבָן

§ 5:3

And this is because any sense-based comprehension and grasp we have of this matter is bestowed upon us only by virtue of their material and physical aspects. The fact that we can grasp the shape of the letters of the Torah and the holy names is only because they are made of parchment and ink, black on white.

וגם אם נצייר איזה אות בציור המחשבה לבד הנה נמשך אלינו כל
 ציורי צורתה ותמונתה רק מכח צורת ציורי מציאותם בגשמי
 וחמרי

§ 5:4

Now even if we depict some letter in thought alone, its entire shape and image is elicited only by virtue of the shape and structure of their physical and material existence.

ומה גם שכל כח המחשבה והציור אשר אלינו היא כולה משתף
 בגשם וחמר ואי אפשר לראות שכלינו לדמות ורחני בלתי גשם
 בשום אופן אחר שכל מציאותינו בנוי רק בגשם וחמר

§ 5:5

And particularly so since our power of thought, and the ability to form a mental image, is linked with the physical and material.^[^2] It is impossible for our mind's eye to imagine in any other way something spiritual devoid of the physical, because our entire existence is built exclusively upon the physical and material.

ועכ"פ הוא כי כל צורת השמות כלם המשגים אלינו הנה הוא רק
 ע"י בנין צורתם שבנוים ועשויים מגשם וחמר שהוא מדיו ע"ג קלף
 ומצירים מתמונת אותיות ע"י כתב וסופר

§ 5:6

In any event, the form of all the divine names – all those we can comprehend – is achieved by means of constructing their form on the basis of their physical and material structure as ink on parchment. And they are fashioned in the mind's eye from the image of the letters written by a scribe on parchment.

וכ"ז הרי נודע ופשוט הוא שאור קדשתו ית"ש הוא רחוק ומושלל
 מלתפס אותו במציאות כזה בתכלית השלילה וההרחק

§ 5:7

It is known and even obvious that the light of His blessed holiness is far removed from, and cannot in any way at all be grasped – even remotely – in an empirical manner.

וְהָאוֹת עַל זֶה כִּי הָרִי גַם אַחֵר רוֹמְמוֹת מַעֲלֵת קְדוּשַׁת הָאוֹתִיּוֹת
 דְּהֵשֶׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה וְכֵן כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת כָּלָם הֵנָּה אֵין לָהֶם קְדוּשָׁה כָּלֹל
 אֲלָא רַק כְּשֶׁנִּכְתְּבוּ לְשֵׁמֶן דְּוָקָא

§ 5:8

The proof of this is that even given the lofty, holy status of the letters of the blessed Name Havaye, and all of the other names as well, they have no holiness at all unless they were written
 lishman – for their own sake.

Torah law requires that Torah scrolls, *tefillin* and *mezuzot* must be written *lishma* – for the intention of fulfilling the *mitzvah* – and not for some ulterior motive, or even without any intention. If that condition is not filled they are invalid.¹

וְאָמְרוּ בְּפֶרוֹשׁ גִּיטִין נ"ד ע"ב שֶׁכָּל סֵפֶר תּוֹרָה שֶׁאֵין אֲזָכוֹרוֹת שְׁלוֹ
 כְּתוּבוֹת לְשֵׁמֶן אֵינוֹ שָׁוֶה כָּלוּם

§ 5:9

Our sages said explicitly (*Gittin* 54b) that any Torah scroll whose holy names were not written for their own sake is not worth anything.

Note that the words "not *worth* anything" is the actual expression used in the Talmud since the discussion there is whether a scribe who wrote a *Sefer Torah*, but did not write the names *lishmo* (with the proper intention), can charge his client anything. According to Rav Ami the scroll is worthless and he loses his scribal fee. The *Shulchan Aruch, Yoreh De'ah* 274:1 and commentaries describe the scroll as *invalid (possul)* if written without proper intention.

וְכ"ז הוּא מְשׁוּם שֶׁכָּל מְצִיאוֹת צוֹרֵת הָאוֹתִיּוֹת אֲשֶׁר לִפְנֵינוּ הֵנָּה הֵם
 בְּנוּיִם וְעֲשׂוּיִם מֵחֶמֶר וְגִשָּׁם וְלָכֵן אֵין בְּמְצִיאוֹתָם גּוֹפָה קְדוּשַׁת
 אֱלֹהוֹת כָּלֹל מִצַּד עֲצָמוֹ רַק ע"י הַתַּפְשָׁטוֹת אוֹרוֹ

§ 5:10

This is all because the actual letters in the form they are before us in a Torah scroll, or *tefillin* and *mezuzot*, are made and formed from physical and material things – ink on parchment – and therefore there is no Divine holiness at all in their existence in and

of themselves; only by virtue of the extended radiance of His light to them.

שְׁמֵתִפְשֹׁט וְשְׂרוּיָה בָּהֶם כְּשֶׁהֵם נִכְתָּבִים לְשָׁמֶן וּבִשְׂאֵר כָּל הַתְּנָאִים
הַמְּפֹרָשִׁים בְּהִלְכוּתֵיהֶם וְאִזְּ הֵנָּה יֵשׁ בְּאַמֶּת בָּהֶם עֲצָמֵן אוֹר
קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש וְהֵם מְלֵאִים מְקֻדְשֵׁת אֱלֹהוֹת

§ 5:11

For His light extends to them and suffuses them when they are written for their own sake, and when all the other pre-conditions specified in *halacha* (Jewish law) are complied with. And indeed then the blessed light of His holiness is in them in the letters themselves; they are permeated with Divine holiness.

וּבִפְרָט הַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה שֶׁנִּקְרָא שֵׁם הָעֵצָם מִשּׁוֹם שְׁעֲצָמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה
נִתְגַּלָּה בְּהֵשֵׁם הַזֶּה ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת וְגִלּוּיוֹ בּוֹ הוּא בְּלִי שׁוֹם לְבוּשׁ כָּלֵל
§ 5:12

This is particularly so regarding the blessed Name Havaye, which is called 'the Essential Name' since His very Essence is revealed in this Name by way of the world of Atzilut. Moreover, His revelation within it – within the Name Havaye – is with no 'garment' at all,

A 'garment' (*levush*) in this context is something that screens and filters the revelation in order to keep it discreet. The *Zohar*² writes that the Torah itself is a prime example of this in that some of the deepest wisdom of the Torah – the Torah as it is in the world of Atzilut – is clothed in the 'garments' of stories and seemingly mundane events.

אֲמָנָם גִּלּוּיוֹ בָּהֶם הוּא רַק ע"י מַסְכִּים וּלְבוּשִׁים וְלָכֵן לֹא נִקְרָא שֵׁם
הָעֵצָם אֶלָּא רַק הַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה וְהוּא דְיוֹקְנֵנוּ שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי
הַמְּלָכִים הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא

§ 5:13

However, His revelation within them – within the other holy names – is by way of screens and garments, and therefore only the Name Havaye is called 'the Essential Name'; it is the likeness of the blessed King of kings, as explained previously in chapter 4.

אֲשֶׁר בּוֹ נִתְגַּלָּה עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת וּבּוֹ נִתְרָאָה אֱלִינוּ
לִהְיוֹת כָּל עֲבוֹדָתֵנוּ אֵלָיו

§ 5:14

In it – in the Name Havaye – His Essence itself is revealed via Atzilut, and with it He appears to us, since all of our service is to Him, as will be explained later in Shaar 7 Chapter 4 and in a number of other places at length in our works.

אִמָּנָם מֵאַחַר שְׁאִמְרָנוּ שֶׁכָּל רוּמָמוֹת מַעֲלֵת קְדוּשַׁת הַד' אוֹתִיּוֹת
הִלְלוּ אֲשֶׁר לִפְנֵינוּ הִנֵּה הוּא רַק ע"י אוֹר קְדֻשָּׁתוֹ ית"ש הַשּׁוֹרָה בָּהֶם
וּמִמֶּלֶא אוֹתָם בְּכָל מְלֻאָם

§ 5:15

However, we stated that the entire sublime holiness of these four letters before us – the four letters of the Ineffable Name – is due only to the light of His blessed holiness abiding within them and suffusing them completely.

א"כ נִמְצָא שֶׁהֵגֵם שְׁאוֹתָן הַד' אוֹתִיּוֹת עֲצָמָן הֵם מְשֻׁגָּגִים וְגִלּוּיָם
אֱלִינוּ גַם בְּהִשְׁגָּה וּתְפִיסָה חוּשִׁית וְהוּא לְרֹאוֹת עֵינֵינוּ מִמֶּשׁ

§ 5:16

Accordingly, it turns out that although those four letters themselves are comprehensible and are revealed to us even in thought and in sensory perception, and are accessible to our very eyes,

עכ"ז הִנֵּה אוֹר קְדֻשָּׁתוֹ ית"ש הַשּׁוֹרָה בָּהֶם אֲשֶׁר עַל יְדּוֹ נִתְקַדְּשׁוּ
הַד' אוֹתִיּוֹת הִלְלוּ לְהַעֲשׂוֹת לְגִלּוּי עֲצֻמוֹתוֹ וּלְתַאֲר דִּיוְקָנוּ הִנֵּה הִנֵּה
אוֹר קְדֻשָּׁתוֹ גּוֹפָה נֶעֱלָם עַדִּין אֱלִינוּ בְּתַכְלִית הַהֶעֱלָם כְּמִקְדָּם

§ 5:17

nevertheless, the light of His blessed holiness that dwells within these four letters, by virtue of which they became sanctified, and are made into a medium for the revelation of His essence and a portrayal of His likeness, the light of His holiness itself is still concealed from us, absolutely concealed, just as before.

וּא"כ נִמְצָא שֶׁגַם אַחַר שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה אֱלִינוּ בְּהֵשֶׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה וּבְכָל
הַשְּׁמוֹת כָּלָם וּבְכָל הַתּוֹרָה כּוּלָּהּ הַנִּמְשָׁךְ וּמִסְתַּעַף מֵהֵשֶׁם הוּי"ה

§ 5:18

Therefore it turns out that even after it – the light of His holiness – is revealed to us within the blessed Name Havaye and in all of the names, and throughout the Torah, which is drawn from and branches out from the blessed Name Havaye,[⁵]

עכ"ז הנה מזהות אור קדשיתו עצמו הוא לעולם רחוק ומשולל מכל השגה ותפיסה[⁶] ולא נגלה אלינו מכל גלוייו אלא רק בדיעה ולא בהשגה[⁷]

§ 5:19

nevertheless, the essence of His holy light itself is always remote from and inaccessible to comprehension and intellectual grasp. And nothing is revealed to us of all His revelations other than awareness about these matters, but without actual comprehension,

כי לא נתגלה אלינו אלא רק במציאותם אבל לא במהותם וכענין הראשון שאמרנו לעיל פרק ד'

§ 5:20

since they were revealed to us only existentially, but not essentially, as in the first concept explained above in chapter 4.

Footnotes

1. See *Mishneh Torah, Tefillin, Metzuzot v'Sefer Torah* 1:15. [↩](#)

2. *Zohar, Behaalotecha* 152a. [↩](#)

Chapter 6: His Revelation within Names and Worlds is Concealed

Shaar 1 Chapter 6

His Revelation within Names and Worlds is Concealed

וְהָרִי נִתְבָּאֵר שְׁכָל גְּלוּיָיו כָּלָם ר"ל גַּם מֵה שֶׁנִּגְלָה אֵלֵינוּ בְּהִשְׁגָּה
חוֹשִׁיית וְאָמַר לָנוּ שֶׁהוּא תֹאֵר דְּיוֹקְנוֹ עֲצָמוֹ

§ 6:1

It was explained above that all of His revelations, i.e. including that which is revealed to us through sensory perception, are a portrayal of His likeness, we are told.

This was explained in chapter 4 from the statement of the Sages of the *Midrash Bamidbar Rabbah* chap. 2: In earlier generations, anyone who pointed with his finger to the 'representation' of the king was put to death, but now even young children go to the House of Study and point with their finger to Him, i.e. to the expressions of the four-letter Name in the Torah.

וְהוּא הִד' אוֹתִיּוֹת דֵּהֶשֶׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה וְכֹן כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת הַקְּדוּשִׁים
כָּלָם וְכָל הַתּוֹרָה כּוֹלָה שֶׁהִיא כּוֹלָה שְׁמוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ וְהֵם כָּלָם דְּיוֹקְנוֹ
גְּלוּיָיו מִמֶּשׁ אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם אֲמִתּוֹת הַנִּעְלָמָה עֲצָמוֹ ע"י
הָאֲצִילוֹת

§ 6:2

This portrayal of His likeness is by way of the four letters of the blessed Name Havaye, and all of the holy names, and the entire Torah – which in its entirety is His blessed name – and they are indeed all representations of His revelations in which His hidden truth becomes revealed via the world of Atzilut.

עכ"ז הֵנָּה אוֹר קְדֻשָּׁתוֹ עֲצָמוֹ הַשּׁוֹרָה בָּהֶם אֲשֶׁר עַל יְדוֹ נַעֲשִׂים הֵם
לְדִיוֹקְנוֹ הֵנָּה נִשְׁאָר אֵלֵינוּ עַדִּין נַעֲלָם בְּתַכְלִית הַהֶעָלָם כְּמוֹ זוּלָּת
גְּלוּיָיו

§ 6:3

Nevertheless, the light of His holiness itself abiding within them – within the holy names – which fashions them into His likeness, is still absolutely hidden from us, just as if there had been no revelation.

וְכָל מַה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם אֵלֵינוּ הוּא לִפִּי הַשְׁגָּתֵנוּ רַק בְּגִזְרָה שְׁכָךְ
אָמַר לָנוּ וְכָךְ צִוָּה לָנוּ

§ 6:4

And all that is revealed within them – within the holy names – to us according to our comprehension is only by Divine decree, for that is what He told us and this is what He commanded,

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁאָמַר הוּא ית"ש זֶה שְׁמִי וְזֶה זְכָרִי וְכֵן צִוָּה לָנוּ וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁבִּפ' תְּבֹא לִירְאָה אֶת הַשֵּׁם הַנִּכְבָּד

§ 6:5

as He stated, 'This is My name... this is My remembrance'[^8] and this is what He commanded us, as it states in *parshat Tavo*[^9] '...to be in awe of this honored Name.'

וְאֵלָיו הוּא כָּל הָעֲבוּדָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר לְקֶמֶן שְׁעַר ז' פ"ו וְהוּא שֵׁם
הָעֶצֶם כִּי אִמְתָּתוֹ הַנֶּעְלָמָה עֲצָמוֹ נִתְגַּלָּה ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת בְּהַשֵּׁם
הַזֶּה

§ 6:6

And to His Name is all of our service, as will be explained further on, in Shaar 7 chapter 6. This is the Essential Name, for His hidden true Being is revealed via Atzilut in this Name.

אֲבָל כ"ז הוּא רַק בִּידִיעָה וְלֹא בְּהִשָּׁגָה כִּי הוּא נֶעְלָם בְּתַכְלִית
הַהֶעְלָם מִלְּהַשִּׁיג אֶת זֶה בְּהִשָּׁגָתֵנוּ אִיךְ שֶׁמִּתְיַחַס אִיךְ עֲצָמוֹתוֹ
לְהִתְגַּלָּה בְּהַשֵּׁם הַזֶּה וְלֹא שֶׁהוּא עֲצָמוֹ וְהוּא הוּא

§ 6:7

But again all of this is merely in our awareness – we are aware that this is so – but not in our comprehension, because it is absolutely concealed from our intellectual grasp how His essential light becomes revealed in this Name, for us to state that He Himself is it – that He is His name.

אך עכ"פ הוא כי האמת כן הוא שהוא הוא כי כן אמר לנו וכן צוה
לנו כנז' והשם הזה הוא אמתת עצמותו עצמו שנתגלה בו ע"י
האצילות והוא אלהינו אין עוד^[10^]

§ 6:8

But nevertheless, this is the truth – He is His Name, for this is what He told us and that this is what He commanded us, as mentioned earlier. This Name is His true essential being revealed in this Name via Atzilut, and He is our G-d and there is none other.

אלא שכ"ז הוא רק בידיעה ולא בהשגה וכמו שאמרנו

§ 6:9

But all of this is only in our awareness but not in comprehension, as we said.

Chapter 7: His Essence is Revealed in and until Atzilut; The Primary Revelation is through Torah

Shaar 1 Chapter 7

His Essence is Revealed in and until Atzilut; The Primary Revelation is through Torah

וְהִנֵּה סִבַּת הַדְּבָר מָה שְׁאוּר קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש הוּא נֶעְלָם מִלֵּה שִׁיג בּוֹ
מֵאוּמָּה גַם אַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה בְּכָל גְּלוּיָיו הַנִּזְכָּרִים הִנֵּה הוּא בְּסִבַּת מָה
שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל פ"ב כִּי נִתְצַמֵּצַם עֲצֻמּוֹתוֹ ית"ש וּמִסְתַּיֵּם בְּסוֹף
הָאֲצִילוֹת

§ 7:1

The reason that the light of His holiness is hidden from comprehension and cannot be grasped at all – even after being revealed in all the revelations mentioned above – the reason for this is as we stated above in chapter 2: because He constricted Himself in a way that these revelations come to an end at the lowest rungs of Atzilut.

Since even the lowest levels of Atzilut, where the light is somewhat dimmed, transcend our limited comprehension, how much more so is the light that is revealed in Atzilut beyond our comprehension.

וְכָל מָה שֶׁמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט בְּאוּרוֹ וְקִדְשָׁתוֹ לְמַטָּה הוּא רַק ע"י מַסְכִּים
וְלְבוּשִׁים וְהוּא רַק תּוֹלְדוֹת הָאוֹר וְתִמְצִית הָאָרֶז לְבַד וְכָנ"ל פ"ב
§ 7:2

Anything that suffuses His light and holiness below is only via screening and cloaking, so that what is revealed is merely a product of the light and only a diminishing or attenuation of the radiance, as explained in chapter 2.

In order for the light to descend to *BiYA* it must be dimmed and attenuated. This process is akin to covering or cloaking it in garments which obscure the light.

ואותה התמצית הארה הוא עומד בפנימיות כל העולמות בי"ע
בבחי' נשמה לנשמה והוא אור שכינתו יתברך השוכן בתוך כל
העולמות בי"ע ע"י התורה וישראל

§ 7:3

Now this diminishing of the radiance suffuses the inner core of the worlds of BiYA as the aspect of the soul of the soul,[^1] of those worlds, which is His Shechinah, may He be blessed, within the worlds of BiYA, drawn down there by Torah and the Jewish People.

ואותו האור הוא מקומו של עולם המהוה את הכל ונושא את כל
ומנהיג את הכל תמיד ע"י קשורה ואחדותה בעצם האור העקרי
אשר למעלה באצילות

§ 7:4

And that light itself is the place[^2] of the world, and brings everything into being, and sustains and leads everything always, by way of its bond and unification with the essence of the primary light that transcends Atzilut.

That abridged extract from the supernal radiance is itself the life force of the lower worlds.

ולכן אין גלוי בהשגה לכל העולמות בי"ע כלן בעצמותו ית"ש
מאומה אחרי שגם אור שכינתו ית"ש השוכן בהם הוא רק תמצית
הארה מאור של מעלה

§ 7:5

And therefore there is no revelation at all of His blessed essence that can be grasped in any of the lower worlds of BiYA, since even the light of His blessed Shechinah that resides within them is only a diminished extract of the Supernal Light.

וגם זה הוא רק בפנימית פנימיותם שהוא בבחי' נשמה לנשמה
שהוא למעלה ממדרגת הנבראים לגמרי כי במדרגת הנבראים
כלם הוא רק מהנשמה ולמטה כמו שיתבאר בע"ה בשערים
הבאים

§ 7:6

And even that diminished extract is only in their innermost being, which is the soul of their souls, transcending the level of created being altogether. This is because the level of all created beings is from the level of soul called neshama^[3] and below, as will be explained in forthcoming chapters, G-d willing.

וְלִכְּנֹגַם הַהֶאָרָה הַזֶּה הוּא נֶעְלָם מִכָּל־מַגְמְרֵי עַד שְׁגָם מִשְׁרָתֵי
שְׂרָפֵי מַעְלָה שׁוֹאֲלִים זֶה לָזֶה אֵיךְ מְקוֹם כְּבוֹדוֹ

§ 7:7

And therefore, even this mere radiance is completely hidden from all, to the extent that even His servants, the supernal seraphim – angels in the world of Beriah – ask, 'Where is His glory?'^[4]

וְכָל־עוֹנִים וְאוֹמְרִים בְּרוּךְ ה' מִמְּקוֹמוֹ מִמְּקוֹם שֶׁהוּא כִּי
מְקוֹמוֹ לֵיכָא דִּידַע לִיה

§ 7:8

And they all answer, 'Blessed is G-d's glory from its place' (Ezekiel 3:12) – from whatever place, for His place is unknown, as the Talmud states in Chagiga 13b^[5] and Zohar I, 103a.^[6]

אָמְנָם מָה שֵׁשׁ לָנוּ גִלּוּי מַמְנוּ עֲצֻמוֹ ג"כ ר"ל זולת פְּעֻלוֹתָיו גּוֹפָה
הֵנָּה הוּא בְּרָצוֹנוֹ הַמַּתְפַּשֵּׁט בַּהֲבִי"ע

§ 7:9

However, as for revelations to us of Himself – i.e. besides His actions themselves – it is all in the extension of His will into the worlds of BiYA.^[7]

His wanting those worlds to exist is their very existence. Had He not wanted their existence they simply would not be at all.

כִּי הָרִי אָנוּ רוֹאִין שְׂרוּצָה בְּהַתְהוּוֹת כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת וּבְקִיּוּמָם תָּמִיד
וְהוּא הָעֲנִין דְּפָרַק שִׁירָה

§ 7:10

For we see that He desires the coming into being of all existence and its continuation throughout time, and this is the conceptual basis of Perek Shira.^[8]

אֲשֶׁר הִפְלִיגוּ בְּשִׁבְחֵהּ הָאוֹמְרוֹ וְהַמִּתְבּוֹנֵן בּוֹ מְשׁוֹם שֶׁהֵרִי כָּל
הַתְּהוּוֹתֵם וְקִיּוּמָם הוּא רַק רְצוֹנוֹ הַמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט עַד תַּחְתִּית הָעֵשִׂיָּה
וְאַחֲרֵי שֶׁכָּל אוֹתָן הַמְּצִיאוֹת עֲצָמָם הֵנָּה רַבָּם כְּכֹלָם הֵם עֲבִים
וְחֻמְרִים בְּתַכְלִית הַחֻמְרֵי לָכֵן גָּדוֹל שִׁבְחֵהּ הָאוֹמֵר וְהַמִּתְבּוֹנֵן בְּכָל
פְּרָקֵי הַשִּׁירָה

§ 7:11

The sages effusively praise one who recites it and contemplates the ideas therein, for their entire coming into being and continued existence is by virtue of His will, which extends all the way to the lowest level of the world of Asiyah. And since all those existing things themselves are almost all coarse and materialistic to the greatest extent possible, therefore great is the praise of one who recites and contemplates all the chapters of Shira,

כִּי בִזָּה מַגִּלָּה פָּנִי הַלוֹט וְהַמִּסְכָּה הַנִּסּוּכָה עַל כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כָּלָם
וּמִתְרָאָה הָאוֹר בִּהִיר אֲשֶׁר הֵם נִשְׂוִאִים עָלָיו שֶׁהוּא רְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש

§ 7:12

for in this way one removes the veil and the mask covering the entire existence.^[^9] And the bright light – which is His blessed will that they all venerate – will become visible.

וְהֵרִי מוֹצִיא יָקָר מִזּוּלָּל [10^] שֶׁאֵין קֶץ לְמִתֵּן שְׂכָרוֹ וּבִפְרָט כִּי עִי"ז
הֵנָּה נִשְׁלָם רְצוֹנוֹ ר"ל גְּלוּיָו אֲשֶׁר רָצָה בָּהֶם כִּי לֹא נַעֲשֶׂה גְלוּיָו בָּהֶם
אֲלָא רַק לְהַמְתִּיבָנָם שֶׁהֵם כָּלָם מִרְצוֹנוֹ וְתַלּוּיָם רַק עָלָיו

§ 7:13

This will extract the valuable from the self-indulgent,^[^10] for which there is endless reward, and especially since this fulfills His will, i.e. the revelations that He wanted revealed. For His revelation is not made visible in them other than to one who contemplates that they are all His will and depend only upon Him.

וְהוּא ע"י הַפְּסוּקִים דְּפָרָק שִׁירָה שֶׁהֵם הוֹרָאת כָּל תְּכוֹנוֹתֵיהֶם אֲשֶׁר
יֵצְאוּ מִרְצוֹנוֹ בָּהֶם

§ 7:14

And this is by way of contemplating the verses of Perek Shira, which are instructions regarding all the ethical and moral qualities

that emerged from His will. Contemplate this and understand.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ כִּי בְמָה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה אֵלֵינוּ בְּפַעֲלוּתָיו הִנֵּה יֵשׁ לָנוּ גְלוּי בְּרָצוֹנוֹ
עֲצָמוֹ וְהוּא בְּאוֹתוֹ הִרְצוֹן אֲשֶׁר רָצָה בָּהֶם וְהִמְתָּבוֹנוּ בְּזֶה הָרִי הוּא
דְּבוּק בְּרָצוֹנוֹ

§ 7:15

Thus we have it that what is revealed to us via His actions is in fact the revelation of His very Will. And this is the same Will that wanted them – i.e. their existence – so that anyone contemplating this is actually cleaving to His will.

וְהוּא מ"ש הַכְּתוּב (תהלים קד, כד) מְלֵאָה הָאָרֶץ קִנְיָנְךָ וְכו'
(בראשית יד, יט) קוֹנֵה שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ לְהִתְבּוֹנוֹן עַל רָצוֹנוֹ אֲשֶׁר בְּכֻלָּם
§ 7:16

And this is what the verse (Psalms 104:24) states, 'The earth is full of Your possessions,' and (Genesis 14:19) refers to Him as 'Maker of heaven and earth' – alluding to contemplating His Will as manifested in all of them.

אִמָּנָם הִנֵּה עֵקֶר גְּלוּי רָצוֹנוֹ ית"ש אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה לָנוּ בּוֹ הִנֵּה הוּא כָּל
הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה שֶׁהוּא כָּל הָעֲבוּדָה כְּלָה אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה לָנוּ וְרוּצָה
מֵאֲתָנוּ

§ 7:17

However the primary revelation of His Will as revealed to us is in Torah and mitzvot, which is the entire service that He commanded us and wants from us.

וְכָל הָעֲבוּדָה כְּלָה הָרִי צָרִיךְ שֶׁתְּהִיָּה לְשִׁמוֹ וְלַעֲשׂוֹת נַחַת רוּחַ לְפָנָיו
שֶׁאָמַר וְנַעֲשֶׂה רָצוֹנוֹ

§ 7:18

This entire service must be fulfilled for His sake, to cause Him delight, for He declared His will and it was done.^[11]

וְהָרִי נִתְגַּלָּה לָנוּ בְּרָצוֹנוֹ ית"ש וְהוּא גְלוּי אֵלֵינוּ אֲשֶׁר מִמֶּנּוּ עֲצָמוֹ
ר"ל בְּעֲצָמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה זוּלַת גְּלוּי בְּפַעֲלוּתָיו אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל הַהִתְהוּוֹת

וְהַמְצִיאוֹת דְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע שֶׁהֵם כָּלָם בְּבַחֲיוֹ חוּץ מִמֶּנּוּ שֶׁהֲרִי
הֵם כָּלָם אֵינָם אֱלֹהוֹת כָּלָל

§ 7:19

Thus He is revealed in His Will, and its revelation to us is from Him Himself – meaning to say, from His essence itself – apart from His revelation through His actions of bringing everything into being, including the existence of the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah. For they – all the worlds – are of the aspect of 'outside of Him,' since none of them are G-dliness at all,

Although we stated before that the Almighty is revealed in the act of Creation, this is merely a secondary revelation. The primary revelation is in Torah and *mitzvot*.

אֲבָל גְּלוֹי רְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה אֵלֵינוּ בּוֹ הִנֵּה הוּא גְּלוֹי מֵאֱלֹהוּתוֹ עֲצָמוֹ
וְעַל זֶה הוּא גָּדֹל הַחַיִּיב דַּעֲסֵק הַתּוֹרָה שְׁאֵנוּ מְחַיִּבִים בָּהּ

§ 7:20

whereas the revelation of His will as revealed to us in Torah and mitzvot is the revelation of His actual G-dliness. And this is the reason behind the great duty to study Torah in which we are obligated.

כִּי נֹדַע הוּא שֶׁהַשְּׂכָל וְהַמְשָׁכִיל וְהַמְשָׁכָל אֶחָד הוּא וְכַשְּׁמִשְׁכִּיל
וְיֹדַע אֵיזָה דָּבָר מֵהַתּוֹרָה הֲרִי הוּא דְּבוּק וּמִתְאַחֵד בְּרְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש
מִמֶּשׁ כִּי נַעֲשֶׂה אוֹתוֹ הַיְדִיעָה שֶׁכָּל בּוֹ שֶׁהוּא חֵלֶק מִכְחוֹת הַנֶּפֶשׁ
שָׁבוּ וְהֲרִי מִתְאַחֵד עִם רְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש מִמֶּשׁ

§ 7:21

Now as is known, the power of thought, the thinker and the thought are all one,^[12] so that when a person comprehends and knows some matter in Torah, that person actually cleaves to and is at one with His blessed will. This is because that knowledge becomes part of his intellect, which is an element of his soul-powers. And so he becomes one with His will in actuality.

וְכַשְׁזֹּכָה לַיְדִיעָת כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהוּא רָמ"ח וּשְׁס"ה כְּבָנִין מְצִיאת כָּל
הָאָדָם וּמְקִיָּם וְעוֹשֶׂה אוֹתָם גַּם בְּגוּפוֹ מִמֶּשׁ הֲרִי נַעֲשֶׂה כָּל בְּגוּפוֹ
וְנִפְשׁוֹ דְּבוּק וּמִתְאַחֵד בְּרְצוֹנוֹ

§ 7:22

Thus, when a person merits knowledge of the entire Torah, which comprises 248 positive commandments and 365 prohibitions,[¹³] like the structure of the human body, and when a person keeps the prohibitions and fulfills the commandments with his body as well, he cleaves to and becomes one with His Will completely, body and soul.

וְלִכֹּן נֶאֱמַר וְאַתֶּם הַדְּבָקִים כו' וכו' הוּא מְשׁוּם שְׂרָצוֹנוֹ ית"ש הִנֵּה
הוּא אוֹרוֹ עֲצָמוֹ הַמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט לְמִטָּה אַחֵר אֲשֶׁר נִתְצַמָּצַם בְּאַמְתָּתוֹ
הַנֶּעֱלָמָה דא"ס וְנִתְגַּלָּה בכו' בְּאַצִּילוֹת

§ 7:23

And for this reason the verse (Deuteronomy 4:4) states, 'And you who cleave to God your Lord are all alive today,'[¹⁴] since His will is His very own light spreading below, after He contracted His hidden true infiniteness – this is the concept of tzimtzum explained above – and is nevertheless revealed in Atzilut.

כִּי שֵׁם הוּא גְלוּי עֲצָמוֹתוֹ לְכָל אוֹתוֹ הֶרְצוֹן אֲשֶׁר גָּלָה לָנוּ בְּכָל
הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוָה וְכֵן לְהֶרְצוֹן אֲשֶׁר בִּפְעֻלַּת כָּל הַנִּבְרָאִים שֶׁנִּבְרָאוּ
וְנוֹצְרוּ וְנַעֲשׂוּ ג"כ רַק מִהַתּוֹרָה עֲצָמָה

§ 7:24

There in Atzilut His essence is revealed in the entire will He revealed to us throughout Torah and the mitzvot. And similarly regarding the Will that was activated in the process of creating all beings created in the world of Beriah, formed in the world of Yetzirah, and made in the world of Asiyah – from the Torah itself, [¹⁵] since all of the worlds were made from the Torah, as the Zohar declares.

וְכֵמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּסֵפֶר יִצְרָה פ"ב עֲשָׂרִים וּשְׁתֵּים אוֹתִיּוֹת כו' וְצַר בָּהֶם
אֵת כָּל הַיְצוֹר וְאֵת כָּל הָעֵתִיד לְצַר

§ 7:25

And as the Sefer Yetzirah (2:2) declares: 'Twenty-two letters... with them He designed all that was formed, and all that would be formed.'

וּמִשּׁוֹם שֶׁכָּל רְצוֹנוֹ אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה לָנוּ בּוֹ הֵנָּה הוּא הַתְּפִשָּׁטוֹת אוֹרוֹ
עֲצָמוֹ לָכֵן הַדְּבֹק בְּרְצוֹנוֹ הוּא דְּבֹק בּוֹ גּוֹפָה זֶהוּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְאַתֶּם
הַדְּבָקִים בִּי"א כו' וְכִנְזָכָר

§ 7:26

Now since His entire will was revealed to us in it – in the Torah –
the Torah is therefore the spreading forth of His very light.
Therefore, one who cleaves to His Will, cleaves to Him Himself,
and this is what the verse states, 'And you who cleave to God your
Lord...' as mentioned.

Chapter 8: Atzilut is Unified with the Emanator; the Future Revelation

Shaar 1 Chapter 8

Atzilut is Unified with the Emanator; the Future Revelation

וְהִנֵּה כ"ז הוּא ע"פ מָה שֶׁמִּלְמַדְנוּ קְדוֹשׁ עֲלִיוֹן רַבְּנוּ הֶרֶם"ק ז"ל
בְּסֵפֶר הַפְּרָדֶס שֶׁעַר הַצְחָצְחוֹת פ"ג

§ 8:1

All of this — the above explanation — is according to what the Ramak, Rabbi Moshe Cordovero, taught us in *Pardes Rimoni, Shaar haTzachtzachot* chap. 3.

וְאָמַר זֶה לְשׁוֹנוֹ וְהֶעֱנִין כִּי לֹא מַחְשְׁבוֹתָיו מַחְשְׁבוֹתֵינוּ וְלֹא דִרְכָּיו
דִּרְכָּנוּ

§ 8:2

This is what he said, in his own words: "His thoughts are not our thoughts, and His ways are not our ways:[^1]

כִּי בְּאֲשֶׁר יִדְמָה הָאָדָם בְּשִׁכְלוֹ לְהוֹת אִיזוֹ מְצִיאוֹת שִׁיחִיָּה הִנֵּה
מַחְשְׁבָתוֹ לֹא תִפְעֵל וְאִם יִדְמָה וַיִּצִיר בְּשִׁכְלוֹ צוּרַת הַמְצִיאוֹת
אֲשֶׁר בְּרָצוֹנוֹ לְהוֹת

§ 8:3

Because when a person thinks about creating some entity, such a thought achieves nothing — even if he imagines it clearly and depicts in his mind the form of what he wishes to bring into being.

עַם כָּל זֹאת וְהָיָה כָּלָא הָיָה עַד יִפְעַל וַיִּצָּא לִפְעֹל

§ 8:4

Even so, nothing changes — it is as it always was, nothing — until he acts and brings it into reality.

וְנִמְצָא הַפּוֹעֵל שְׁלֵם מִהֶכַח כִּי הֶכַח חָסַר הַמְצִיאוֹת וְאִין לוֹ מְצִיאוֹת
וְשְׁלִימוֹת כָּלָל

§ 8:5

It turns out therefore that, in the human realm, action is more complete than potential, since what is merely in potential lacks existence; it has no actual existence and completeness at all.

וְהַפּוֹעֵל הוּא הָעֶקֶר וְהַמְצִיאוֹת זִוְלָתוֹ אֵין דָּבָר

§ 8:6

Thus the deed is the main thing^[^2] and it is what exists, and other than it there is nothing.

וְאֵין כֹּן פְּעֻלּוֹתָיו וְהוּיָתוֹ שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים הַקֵּב"ה

§ 8:7

But this is not so with the deeds and creations of the King of kings, the Holy One, blessed is He.

כִּי בְּאִשֶּׁר עָלָה בְּרָצוֹנוֹ לְהוֹוֶת וּלְהַאֲצִיל אֲצִילוֹת הַטָּהוֹר וְהַקְדוֹשׁ

§ 8:8

For when it arises in His Will to bring something into being and to emanate a pure and holy emanation,^[^3]

הִנֵּה אֵז נֶאֱצַל וְנֶצְטִיר כֻּלּוֹ בְּעֶצְמוֹתוֹ בְּלִי שֵׁנוּי בּוֹ ח"ו

§ 8:9

then it is emanated and formed within Him without any change in Him, G-d forbid.

אֵלָא מְצִיאוֹת מִתְיַחַד עִמּוֹ עַד שֶׁאֵין בֵּין הַמַּאֲצִיל וְהַמְצִיאוֹת הַהוּא
הַבְּדֵל כָּלֵל

§ 8:10

But that existence is one with Him, to the extent that there is no distinction between the Emanator and that existence at all.^[^4]

אֵלָא הוּא וְהֵם הַכֹּל דָּבָר אֶחָד וְעַצָּם אֶחָד כּו' כּו' ע"ש

§ 8:11

Rather, He and they are all one, and a single essence" etc. etc. This is the end of the quote from the *Pardes Rimmonim*. See there in *Pardes*.

וְכֵן עוֹד בְּדִבְרֵיו בְּזֶה בְּאֵילָמָה בְּעֵין שְׁמֶשׁ תָּמַר א' פ"ב וּבְעֵין הַבְּדֻלָּח
תָּמַר א' פ' ט"ז ע"ש

§ 8:12

Likewise, again in his own words, in *Eilimah Rabbati, Eyn Shemesh, Tamar* 1, chap. 2, and in *Eyn HaBedolach, Tamar* 1, chap. 16:

וְהִנֵּה כֵן הוּא עַד"ז עֲנִין רְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש הִנֵּה הוּא מְצִיאוֹת אוֹרוֹ עֲצָמוֹ
§ 8:13

"It is a similar situation regarding His blessed will — it is His very light of the *Ein Sof* Himself.

וְלָכֵן אָמַרְנוּ כִּי הַדְּבֶק בְּרְצוֹנוֹ הוּא דְּבוּק בּוֹ מִמֶּשׁ

§ 8:14

And therefore we said that one who cleaves to His Will literally cleaves to Him.

אֲמַנָם כִּבְרֵי אֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁהֵגֶם שְׁכָל הַתּוֹרָה כֻּלָּה הִנֵּה הִיא אוֹר רְצוֹנוֹ
מִמֶּשׁ וְהִיא אוֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ גּוֹפָה

§ 8:15

However, we already noted that even though the entire Torah is actually the light of His Will, and is the light of His holiness itself,

עַכ"ז הִנֵּה אֵין גְּלוּי לָנוּ מֵאוֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ שֶׁבָּה אֵלָּא רַק בִּידִיעָה וְלֹא
בְּהִשְׁגָּה

§ 8:16

nevertheless, the light of His holiness in it — in the Torah — is not revealed to us in a manner that we can comprehend it; only in terms of knowledge do we know that this is so, but not how or why.

וְאִין אָנוּ מְשִׁיגִים בָּהּ אֶלָּא רַק ע"ד הַשְׁגָּתָנוּ בְּכָל בְּחִי' רְצוֹן שֶׁהוּא
רְצוֹן וְלֹא מְצִיאוֹת

§ 8:17

And we are able to comprehend of it only in the same manner we comprehend any aspect of will — it is will in a potential state, not actual being, i.e. an entity that exists.

הַגִּם שֶׁבְּאַמֶּת הָרִי הָיָה רְצוֹנוֹ בָּהּ אוֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ עֲצָמוֹ

§ 8:18

Even though, in truth, His Will in it — in the Torah — is the light of His holiness itself.

וְכֵן אָמְרָנוּ ג"כ כִּי הֵנָּה הִיא רַק תְּמִצִּית הָאֶרֶץ לְבַד מֵאוֹר הָעֶקְרִי
אֲשֶׁר לְמַעְלָה

§ 8:19

Similarly, we also noted that it is only the distillation of the radiance of the main light above.

וְלָכֵן אָמְרוּ רַז"ל בְּ"ר פ' י"ז סס"ה ה' נוֹבֵלֶת חֻכְמָה שֶׁל מַעְלָה תוֹרָה
§ 8:20

And therefore our Sages state in *Bereishit Rabba* 17:5: 'Torah is merely the runoff from *Chochma* [Wisdom] above.'

Although Torah is G-d's wisdom, the Torah down here in this world is merely the 'runoff' or 'overflow' of G-d's wisdom, according to the sages of the Midrash.

וְכֵן בְּקֵהֶלֶת רפ"ב ופ' י"א כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהָאָדָם לָמַד בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה
הֶבֶל הוּא לִפְנֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם הַבָּא

§ 8:21

A similar statement is found in Midrash *Kohelet* chaps. 2 & 11: 'All the Torah that a person learns in this world is regarded as merely futility^[5] compared with the Torah of the World to Come,'

כִּי בְּאֶשֶׁר יִתְבַטֵּל כָּל הַזֹּהֶמָּא וַיִּזְדַּכְּכוּ כָּל הָעֲבִיּוֹת וְהַמַּסְכִּים
הַמַּפְסִיקִים אֵלֵינוּ בֵּין אֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ הָעֶקְרִי אֲשֶׁר לְמַעְלָה בְּאַצִּילוֹת
§ 8:22

because when all the contamination will be annulled and all the
coarseness will be purified, and the 'screens'[^6] separating us from
the main light of His holiness as it is above in Atzilut will be
removed —

אִז יִתְפַּשֵּׁט אֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ עֲצָמוֹ לְמַטָּה גַּם כֵּן וְנִגְלָה כְּבוֹד ה' אֶל כָּל
בָּשָׂר
§ 8:23

then the very light of His holiness will spread forth down below as
well, and the glory of G-d will be revealed to all flesh,[^7]

וְכִמוֹ שֶׁכְּתוּב (יִשְׁעְיָה ל, כ) וְלֹא יִכְנֹךְ עוֹד מוֹרִיךְ וְהָיוּ עֵינֶיךָ רֹאוֹת אֶת
מוֹרִיךְ
§ 8:24

as the verse states (*Isaiah* 30:20): "Your Teacher will no longer
be hidden behind His garment, and your eyes will behold your
Teacher."

כִּי עֲכָשׁוּ עַל יְדֵי שֶׁהָיָא רַק תַּמְצִית הָאֶרֶה לְבַד וְעַל יְדֵי הָעֲבִיּוֹת
וְהַזֹּהֶמָּא נִפְסְקָה חוֹמַת בְּרֹזֶל בֵּין יִשְׂרָאֵל לְאֲבֵיהֶם שְׁבַשְׁמִים
§ 8:25

But now, since it is only the distillation of the radiance, and
coarseness and contamination obstruct like an iron wall between
Israel and their Father in Heaven,

וְאִין אָנוּ מְשִׁיגִים מֵאֹר קִדְשָׁת רְצוֹנוֹ אֶלָּא הַשְׁגַּת הָרְצוֹן לְבַד
§ 8:26

we do not comprehend the light of His holy Will, but only the Will
itself — what it is that He wants, though His light is not revealed
to us therein.

אָבֵל לְעֵתִיד כְּשִׁיתִבְטֵל כָּל הַמַּסְכִּים אַז יִתְגַּלֶּה וְיֵרָאֶה כָּל הָרָצוֹן
בְּאוֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ שְׁבוּ מִמֶּשׁ וְהָרִי יִתְגַּלֶּה אַז הָרָצוֹן בְּבַחֲיַנַת הַמַּצִּיאוֹת
שְׁבוּ גַם כֵּן וְהוּא אֲמַתֶּת רָצוֹנוֹ כְּמוֹ שֶׁהוּא

§ 8:27

But in the future, when all the 'screens' will be nullified, then His entire Will shall be revealed, with that very light of holiness therein. For the Will shall be revealed then as it is in actuality within Him — this is His true will as it is in itself.

וְנִמְצָא שְׁכָל הַגְּלוּי אֲשֶׁר יֵשׁ לָנוּ עַתָּה בּוֹ הִנֵּה אֵין עֶרְךָ לוֹ הֵן בְּכֻמוֹת
וְהֵן בְּאִיכוֹת נֶגֶד הָרָצוֹן הָאֲמִתִּי וְהַעֲקָרִי שִׁיתְגַּלֶּה אַז

§ 8:28

So it turns out that the entire revelation that we have now is incomparable — quantitatively and qualitatively — to the true, primary Will that will be revealed then in the World to Come.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שְׁכָל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהָאָדָם לוֹמֵד בְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה הֵבֵל הוּא לִפְנֵי
תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם הַבָּא

§ 8:29

And this is the meaning of the statement that the entire Torah that a person learns in this world is merely 'futility' — i.e. inconsequential — compared with the Torah of the World to Come.

Chapter 9: The Importance of the Inner Dimensions of Torah

Shaar 1 Chapter 9

The Importance of the Inner Dimensions of Torah

אִמָּנָם הוּא כִּי הָגַם שְׁאִין לָנוּ עֵתָה מִהֲרָצוֹן הָעֶקְרִי אֲלָא רַק תְּמֻצִּית
הָאָרָה מִמָּנוּ

§ 9:1

However, although we do not currently have access to His primary will, but only to the distillation of the radiance thereof — as explained in the previous chapter —

עַם כָּל זֶה הֵנָּה הִיא תְּמֻצִּית הָאָרָה מִכָּל בְּלִי חֲסוֹר בּוֹ דָּבָר מְאוּמָּה
§ 9:2

nevertheless, it is the distillation of the radiance in its entirety, not missing one iota.

וְלֹא עוֹד אֲלָא שְׁאוֹתָהּ הַתְּמֻצִּית הָאָרָה אֲשֶׁר נִתְּפַשְׁטָה אֵלֵינוּ הֵנָּה
הוּא הִיסוֹד הַמַּעֲמִיד אֶת כָּל גְּלוּיֵי הָעֶקְרִי ית"ש אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה
בְּאַצִּילוֹת

§ 9:3

Furthermore, that distilled radiance itself which is disseminated to us is the very foundation that supports His entire primary revelation above in the world of Atzilut.

וְכַמוֹ שֶׁכְּתוּב בְּשִׁמוּאֵל רַבְתִּי פְּרָשָׁה ה' אֵלֶיךָ נִשְׁאַתִּי אֶת עֵינֵי הַיִּשְׁבִּי
בְּשָׁמַיִם (תהלים קכג, א) שְׁאֵלֹלָא אֲנִי כְּבִיכּוֹל אֵין הוּא יוֹשֵׁב
בְּשָׁמַיִם וְכֵן בְּסִפְרֵי פ' וְזֹאת הַבְּרָכָה סִי' שִׁמ"ו

§ 9:4

As is written in Midrash *Shmuel Rabbati* section 5, on the verse (Psalms 123:1) 'To You who resides in the Heavens I lifted my eyes...' — 'If not for me [the Jewish person learning Torah and doing mitzvot], He would not be sitting in heaven, so to speak!' A

similar sentiment is expressed in *Sifri, Zot HaBracha* section 346.

כִּי אֵלּוּלָא הַתּוֹרָה שְׁבַע עוֹלָם הָיָה מִתְבַּטֵּל כָּל גְּלוּיָיו אֲשֶׁר
בְּאַצִּילוֹת גַּם כֵּן וְהָיָה חוֹזֵר לְאֵין סוֹף כְּמִקְדָּם

§ 9:5

Because if not for Torah in this world, all of His revelations in Atzilut as well would return to their source in the *Ein Sof*, just as before.

וְרַק עַל יְדֵי עֶסֶק הַתּוֹרָה וְקִיּוֹם הַמִּצְוָה שְׁבַע עוֹלָם הָיָה מִעֲמִידִים כָּל
גְּלוּיָיו שְׁבַע אֲצִילוֹת

§ 9:6

It is only by virtue of striving in Torah and fulfilling mitzvot in this world that His revelations are firmly established in Atzilut.

וְהוּא עֲנִין הָעֲבוּדָה צָרָךְ גְּבוּהָ כְּנוֹדָע מִכֶּמֶה סִפְרֵי קְדוּשֵׁי עֲלִיוֹן וְכִמּוֹ
שֶׁהָאֲרִיכוּ בָּזָה הָרַב מֵאִיר גְּבֵאִי בְּסִפְרֵי עֲבוּדַת הַקֹּדֶשׁ וְהַשֵּׁל"ה
וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַחַיִּים

§ 9:7

This is called 'service for the sake of the Supreme One,' as is known from a number of holy works, as explained at length by Rabbi Meir ibn Gabai in *Avodat HaKodesh*, and by the *Shelah*^[^1] and the *Nefesh Hachaim*.^[^2]

וְהוּא כְּדֵי לְהַעֲמִיד אֶת גְּלוּיָיו לְמַעַלָּה וְעֵין זֹהֵר קֹדֶשׁ פְּרָשֶׁת בְּחֻקֵּי
קִי"ג סַע"א וְשֵׁם ע"ב

§ 9:8

This service for the sake of the Supreme One is in order to establish His revelations above. See *Zohar* II, *Bechukotai* 113a-b.^[^3]

וְכָל מָה שֶׁהָאָדָם מַקְיִים וְעוֹשֶׂה רְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש לְמַטָּה הֵנָּה הוּא מַקְיִים
וּמַעֲמִיד וּמַתְקֵן וּבוֹנֶה אֶת דְּגֻמָּתוֹ בְּשֶׁרְשׁוֹ וְאוֹרוֹ אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה
לְמַעַלָּה

§ 9:9

Whenever a person fulfills and follows His blessed Will down below, he fulfills and establishes and rectifies and builds something similar in the roots and illuminations above and beyond.

וּמִכָּל שְׁכֵן כְּשֶׁהָאָדָם עוֹסֵק לְמַטָּה בִּפְנִימִית הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהוּא בְּעֲנֵינִי
אוֹר קִדְשׁוֹ עֲצָמוֹ אֲשֶׁר בְּאַצִּילוֹת שֶׁהוּא לְמַעַלָּה מֵהַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹתוֹ אֲשֶׁר
בְּעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

§ 9:10

And all the more so when a person occupies himself down here with the inner dimensions of the Torah — i.e. with Kabbalah — in matters pertaining to the light of His holiness itself in Atzilut, that transcends the 'cloaking' that is prevalent in the worlds of *BiYA*.

As mentioned earlier, in order for the light to descend to *BiYA* it must be dimmed and attenuated. This process is akin to covering or cloaking it in garments which obscure the light.

וְהָרִי הוּא עוֹסֵק בְּאוֹר קִדְשׁוֹ עֲצָמוֹ בְּלִי הַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹת כָּלֵל וְהָרִי גָדוֹל
הַעֵסֵק בְּעֲנֵינִי הִזָּה בְּאִין עֶרֶךְ וְחֶקֶר

§ 9:11

In fact, when a person studies Kabbalah he occupies himself with the light of His holiness itself, not cloaked at all. Accordingly, the merit of striving in this matter is immeasurably and unfathomably great.

וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאֵנּוּ רוֹאִין שֵׁשׁ חֲלוּק בְּדִין בֵּין הַכּוֹתֵב אֶת הַשְּׁמוֹת
הַקְּדוּשִׁים לְשֶׁאֵר כָּל הַתּוֹרָה כִּי הַשְּׁמוֹת צָרִיךְ לְקַדְּשָׁם בְּקִדְשָׁהּ
כְּפוֹלָה נוֹסֵף עַל קִדְשָׁתָהּ שֶׁאֵר כָּל הַתּוֹרָה

§ 9:12

This is analogous to the difference we see in Jewish law between writing the holy Names and writing all the other words of the Torah: the holy Names require sanctification with double sanctity over and above the sanctity of the rest of the Torah.[^4]

For example, before a scribe writes any words of the Torah, he declares, "I am hereby writing this Torah scroll keeping in mind the sanctity of the Torah." Nevertheless, whenever he writes one of

the holy Names he must first declare, "I am hereby writing this holy Name for the sanctity of the holy Name."¹ From this we see the Names have a higher level of sanctity. In addition, while the scribe is writing one of the Names, he may not interrupt, even if a Jewish king addresses him. Furthermore, the Names may not be erased, not even a single letter.

וְהָגַם שֶׁכָּל הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָהּ הָרִי הוּא שְׁמוֹתָיו שֶׁל הַקֵּב"ה וְכָנ"ל עִם כָּל
זֶה הֵם חֲלוּקִים בְּדִין

§ 9:13

And even though the entire Torah comprises G-d's Names,[^6] as mentioned earlier, there is a difference in Jewish law between the holy Names and the rest of the Torah.

וְצִוִּיךָ בְּשִׁמּוֹת לְקֹדֶשׁ בְּקֹדֶשׁ יִתְּרָה מִשּׁוּם שֶׁשָּׂאָר כָּל הַתּוֹרָה הִיא
מְלֻבָּשׁ בְּאַיִזָּה נוֹשֵׂא מִהָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה מִשָּׂא כֹן הַשְּׁמוֹת שֶׁהֵם עָלָיו
עֲצָמוּ ית"ש לְכָךְ הֵם צְרִיכִים קֹדֶשׁ יִתְּרָה

§ 9:14

The reason we must treat the Names with a higher level of sanctity is because the rest of Torah is cloaked in some mundane subject or other, whereas the holy Names refer to Him Himself, blessed be He. And therefore they require a greater level of sanctity.

כֹּן הוּא נִקְל לְהַבִּין עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה תּוֹסֶפֶת הַמַּעֲלָה וְהַקֹּדֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר
לְעוֹסֵק בְּאוֹרוֹת הָאֲצִילוֹת עֲצָמוּ אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַל מִהָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

§ 9:15

Similarly, this analogy makes it easy to understand the additional preeminence and holiness of one who occupies himself with the illumination in Atzilut itself, which transcends the worlds of *BiYA*.

וְהִנֵּה מִתְדַבֵּק בָּזֶה בְּאוֹר קֹדְשׁוֹ עֲצָמוּ בְּלִתִּי הַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹת כָּלֵל וְנִעֲשָׂה
הוּא גּוֹפָה מְקוֹם וּמַעוֹן לְשִׁכְנִית עִזּוֹ ית"ש

§ 9:16

For he cleaves thereby to the light of His holiness itself, without it being cloaked in any way, and he himself becomes the place and

abode for His blessed indwelling power — the *Shechinah*.

וְכָמוּ שְׁאֲמָרְנוּ לְעִיל פ"ז כִּי הַשֶּׁכֶל וְהַמְשָׁכִיל וְהַמְשָׁכָל אֶחָד הוּא
§ 9:17

For as we said above in chapter 7 — the power of thought, the thinker and the thought are all one, and this is particularly so in the inner dimensions of Torah — Kabbalah.

וְכֵן בְּעֶסְקוֹ בְּזֶה הִנֵּה הוּא מְקִים וּמְתִקֵּן אֶת אוֹתוֹן הַגְּלוּיִים לְמַעַלָּה
וְכָמוּ שֶׁכְּתוּב בְּהַקְדָּמַת זֶהָר בְּרֵאשִׁית ב' ע"א וְד' ע"ב וְכֵן בְּהַקְדָּמַת
תְּקוּנִים ג' סע"ב

§ 9:18

Furthermore, when he occupies himself with this — the inner dimensions of Torah — he supports and rectifies those revelations above, as is written in *Zohar, Bereishit* 2a, 4b and in the Introduction to the *Tikunei Zohar* 3b.

וְלָכֵן הוּא גָּדֹל הַחַיּוּב לַעֲסֹק בְּחֻכְמַת הָאֱמֶת כָּל מִי שֶׁרְאוּי לָזֶה כָּמוֹ
שֶׁכְּתוּב בְּתְקוּנִים תְּקוּן ל' פ"א ע"ב

§ 9:19

Thus there is a great obligation for anyone who is suited for this to occupy himself with this True Wisdom, as is stated in *Tikunim, tikun* 30, p. 81b.

וְעֵין שָׁם בְּהִגָּר"א וְכֵן הוּא בְּכַמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת בְּזֶהָר קִדָּשׁ וְכָמוֹ שֶׁהָאֲרִיךְ
בְּזֶה הַסֵּפֶר וַיִּקְהַל מֹשֶׁה בְּהַקְדָּמָה

§ 9:20

See the commentary of the GRA — the Gaon of Vilna — to the *Tikunei Zohar*, and in a number of places in the holy Zohar, as the Introduction to *Vayakhel Moshe*^[7] states at length.

וְכֵן הָרַח"ו ז"ל בְּהַקְדָּמַת עַץ חַיִּים מְדַפּוּס וְאַרְשָׁא תֵרֵנ"א

§ 9:21

And similar statements were made by Rabbi Chaim Vital in the Introduction to *Etz Chaim*, Warsaw 5651 (1891):

וּבְאֲשֶׁר שֶׁהַזֹּהַר קִדָּשׁ אֲשֶׁר הוּא כָּלּוּ מִיִּסֵּד עַל זֶה הִנֵּה כָּל דְּבָרָיו הֵם
 סְתוּמִים וְחֲתוּמִים לְכֹן הָאִיר הַשִּׁית"ב אֶת עֵינֵינוּ וְשָׁלַח לָנוּ אֶת
 אִישׁ אֱלֹהִים קָדוֹשׁ מֶרֶן הָאַרִיז"ל

§ 9:22

"And being that the Zohar is founded entirely upon this — the illumination in Atzilut — all of it is closed and sealed to a regular person. And therefore G-d, may He be blessed, illuminated our eyes and sent us the man of G-d, our holy master, the Arizal" — Rabbi Isaac Luria.

וְהוּא פָּתַח לִפְנֵינוּ אֶת שַׁעְרֵי אוֹרָה בְּכָל דְּרוּשָׁיו אֲשֶׁר דָּרַשׁ וְגָלָה
 לְתַלְמִידוֹ נְאֻמָּן בֵּיתוֹ וְתִיק וְחֲסִיד הָרַח"ו ז"ל

§ 9:23

He opened before us the gates of light through his teachings, and revealed them to his faithful disciple, the venerable and pious Rabbi Chaim Vital.

וְהֵם כָּל סִפְרֵי הָאַרִיז"ל אֲשֶׁר כָּתְבָם הָרַח"ו ז"ל וּבִפְרֹט הַסֵּפֶר
 הַקָּדוֹשׁ וְהַנּוֹרָא עַץ חַיִּים אֲשֶׁר לִפְנֵינוּ שֶׁהוּא הָרֹאשׁ וְהָרָאשׁוֹן
 וְהַעֲקָרִי לְכָל סִפְרָיו וְהוּא פָּתַח וְשַׁעַר לְכָל דְּבָרֵי הַזֹּהַר קִדָּשׁ

§ 9:24

Rabbi Chaim Vital recorded all the works of the Arizal — and particularly the holy, awe-inspiring work *Etz Chaim*[¹⁸] in its present form before us — which is the first and foremost and the primary of all his works. It is the opening and the gateway to all the words of the holy Zohar.

וְהִנֵּה הוּא מְדַבֵּר בְּרִחְבָּה וְאַרְכָּה בְּכָל כְּלָלוֹת גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש אֲשֶׁר
 מֵרוֹם חֲבִיּוֹן עֶזוֹ שֶׁהוּא מְאֹרֵר אֵין סוֹף אֲשֶׁר מְאַמְתָּתוֹ הַנְּעֻלָּמָה עַד
 גְּלוּיֹו הָאַחֲרוֹן שֶׁבְּכָל הַנִּצְאָלִים כָּלֵם שְׁנַתְּגָלָה שֵׁם בָּאוֹר קִדָּשְׁתּוֹ
 עֲצָמוֹ

§ 9:25

It discusses extensively and at length the entirety of His revelations — from the pinnacle of His hidden strength,[¹⁹] the *Ohr Ein Sof*, His concealed truth — until the final revelation among all the

emanations that was revealed there in Atzilut as the light of His holiness itself.

לְהִיּוֹת יִסּוֹד וְשֹׁרֶשׁ לְכָל הוֹצָאוֹת הַמְּצִיאוֹת וְהַהֲנָהֲגָה דְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת
בִּי"ע

§ 9:26

This was to become the foundation and root of all the forms of existence that were brought forth, and the foundation and root of how the worlds of *BiYA* are directed.

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁיִּסֵּד הָאֲרִיזָ"ל בְּתַפְלָתוֹ לְיוֹם הַחֲמִישִׁי (בְּשַׁעֲרֵי צִיּוֹן) אֲשֶׁר
בְּהִיוֹתָ אַתָּה שֹׁרֶשׁ אֵל כָּל נִמְצָא וְיִסּוֹד כָּל נִבְרָא

§ 9:27

As we see based on the teachings of the Arizal in the prayer for the fifth day of the week (in *Shaarei Tzion*,^[^10] *sha'ar* 3): "In Your being, You are the root of all existence and the foundation^[^11] of all creations."

וְהַכּוֹנֵה הוּא עַל גְּלוּיּוֹ שֶׁבְּאַצִּילוֹת שֶׁשָּׁם נִתְגַּלָּה לְהִיּוֹת שֹׁרֶשׁ לְכָל
הַמְּצִיאוֹת כְּלוּ

§ 9:28

The objective of this stanza is to refer to His illuminations in Atzilut — revealed there in order to become the root of all existence.

וְהִנֵּה מִדְּבַר הָעֵץ חַיִּים בְּכָל סְדְרֵי גְלוּיּוֹ שֶׁבְּאַצִּילוֹת בְּאִיזָה אִפּוֹ
שֶׁנִּסְדְּרוּ וּבְאִיזָה פָּנִים שְׁמַאֲרִים שֶׁם לְהוֹצִיא פְּעֻלָּתוֹ בָּהֶם וּבִסְדֵּר
הַתְּלַבְּשׁוֹת בְּכָל פְּרָטֵי הַנֶּאֱצָלִים כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר עַל יְדֵיהֶם נִתְגַּלָּה

§ 9:29

Now the *Etz Chaim* discusses the entire process of His revelations in Atzilut — in what manner they are configured, and which aspects they illuminate — in order to bring forth His activities through them, and it discusses the process by which the light is cloaked in all the specific details of the emanated entities there, by which the light becomes revealed.

וְאִפֹּן יִחְדּוּ בְּכָל אֶחָד מֵהֶם וּבִסְדֵּר עֲמִידָתָם וְקִשּׁוּרָם זֶה בְּזֶה וְאִיךָ
שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּלְּשְׁלוּ מִמַּדְרָגָה לְמַדְרָגָה מִשְׁרָשָׁם הָרָאשׁוֹן אֲשֶׁר מֵרוֹם חֲבִיוֹן
עָזָו עַד מִצִּיאוֹתָם הָאַחֲרוֹן

§ 9:30

In addition, this work explains the manner of His unification with each of them, and their stature and connection with each other. And it reveals how they devolved^[12] from stage to stage from their original root — from the pinnacle of His hidden strength, the *Ohr Ein Sof* — until their final form of existence.

וְכֵן אִפֹּן הִתְפַּשְׁטוּתָם בְּמִצִּיאוֹת דְּהֶעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע עֲצָמָן עַד שְׁכָלָם
תְּלוּיִם וְכֵן בְּאַצִּילוֹת וּבְאֹר יִחְדּוּ אֲשֶׁר שָׁם וּמִשָּׁם הֵם נִמְצָאִים
וּמִשְׁגָּחִים וּמִתְנַהֲגִים תָּמִיד

§ 9:31

The *Etz Chaim* also delineates the manner in which they spread forth into the objective reality of the worlds of *BiYA* themselves, to the extent that all of them are dependent exclusively upon Atzilut and the light of His Oneness there. And it is from there that they emerge and are overseen and are directed continuously.

וְכָל זֶה הוּא מְבֹאֵר בְּסֵפֶר הַקְּדוֹשׁ וְהַנּוֹרָא הָעֵץ חַיִּים אֲשֶׁר לְפָנֵינוּ
וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר (דְּבָרֵי הַיָּמִים א' כ"ח) דַּע אֶת אֱלֹהֵי אָבִיךָ

§ 9:32

All of this is explained in the holy, awe-inspiring work *Etz Chaim* in its present form before us. Regarding this the verse states (I Chronicles 28:9): "Get to know the G-d of your father."

וְכֵן מֵה שְׁכָתוֹב (דְּבָרִים ד') וַיִּדְעַת הַיּוֹם וְהַשְּׁבֹתָ אֶל לִבְבְּךָ כִּי ה' הוּא
הָאֱלֹהִים בְּשָׁמַיִם מִמַּעַל וְעַל הָאָרֶץ מִתַּחַת אֵין עוֹד

§ 9:33

Similarly, another verse (Deuteronomy 4:39) urges: "Know this day and place upon your heart that G-d is the Lord in the heavens above and upon the earth below; there is no other."

וְדַע כִּי עוֹד כַּמָּה דְּבָרִים עֲקָרִיִּים הַנוֹגְעִים לְדְבָרֵינוּ הֵן"ל כְּתִבְנוּ
בְּאַרְכָּה וּבִבְאוּר יוֹתֵר בְּסֵפֶר הַדְּעָה ח"א דְּרוֹשׁ ה' סִימָן ז'

§ 9:34

Know also that there are a number of fundamental matters pertaining to what we just said above that we have written about at length and with further explanation in our book *De'ah*, part 1 (5:7).

וְכֵן יִתְבָּאֵר עוֹד לְקִמּוֹן בְּשַׁעְרֵים הַבָּאִים בְּעֶזֶר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ וַיִּתְעַלֶּה
§ 9:35

These matters will also be explained further in the sections to come, with G-d Almighty's help.

Footnotes

1. *Berachot* 32b; *Shulchan Aruch*, *Orach Chaim* chapter 104.



G A T E

*Shaar 2 — Matter, Form, and the Chain of
Worlds*

Chapter 1: From Higher World to Lower World

Shaar 2 Chapter 1

From Higher World to Lower World

וְהָיָה אַחֵר שֶׁדִּבְּרָנוּ בְּשַׁעַר א' מֵעַנִּין מְצִיאוֹת גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש אֲשֶׁר
נִתְפָּשֵׁט מֵאַמְתָּתוֹ הַנֶּעֱלָמָה וְנִתְגַּלָּה בְּאַצִּילוֹת וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הַמְצִיא
אֶת הַמְצִיאוֹת דְּעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

§ 2:1

We spoke in the first *shaar* of this work about His revelations^[^1] — how they spread forth from His hidden true being and are revealed in Atzilut, and in this way the existence of the worlds of *BiYA* is produced.

וְהָיָה הַיָּה סֵדֶר הַתְּפִשְׁטוֹת גְּלוּיָיו שֶׁבְּאַצִּילוֹת בְּדֶרֶךְ הַשְּׁתַּלְשְׁלוֹת
הַמְדֻרָּגוֹת וְיֵרֵד מִמְדֻרָּגָה לְמְדֻרָּגָה עַד שֶׁיֵּרֵד לְהַתְגַּלּוֹת בְּפַעֲלַת
מְצִיאוֹת הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע וְהִתְגַּתֵּם

§ 2:2

Now the orderly manner in which this spreading forth of His revelations in Atzilut proceeds is by way of *hishtalshelut hamadreigot* — a chain of cause and effect, descending from level to level, until it descended to where these Divine revelations became revealed in producing the existence of the worlds of *BiYA* and in the manner in which they are conducted.

וְכֵדִי לְהַבִּין קֶצֶת סֵדֶר הַתְּפִשְׁטוֹת הַמְדֻרָּגוֹת שֶׁבְּאַצִּילוֹת סֵדֶרם
וְקִשּׁוֹרָם זֶה בְּזֶה נִלְמַד מֵהַמְּאַחֵר אֶל הַקּוֹדֵם הֵינּוּ מִסֵּדֶר פְּעֻלָּתוֹ
ית"ש אֲשֶׁר אָנוּ רוֹאִין בְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה

§ 2:3

In order to understand in some small measure the order of this spreading forth of the levels in Atzilut, their sequence, and how they are connected to one another — let us learn in reverse, from later to earlier, that is, from the order of His actions we see in this world and upward.

וּמִזֶּה נוֹכַח לְהַבִּין קִצֵּת אֵיךְ שֶׁהוּא הַסֵּדֶר בְּשִׂרְשָׁם בְּקֹדֶשׁ וּבְקֹדֶשׁ
הַקִּדְּשִׁים אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה לְמַעַלָּה

§ 2:4

And from this we will be able to understand a little about the order of things in their root in the holy realms and the holy of holy realms that are above and beyond.

וְנִתְחִיל וְנֹאמַר כִּי הִנֵּה אֲנוּ רוֹאִין בְּכָל הַנִּמְצָאִים כֻּלָּם שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם
הַזֶּה הוּא בְּכָלֵל וְהוּא בְּפֶרֶט הִנֵּה מִיֵּסֶד כָּל אֶחָד עַל שְׁנֵי בַּחֲנוּת שֶׁהֵם
חֶמֶר וְצוּרָה אוֹ גוּף וְנֶפֶשׁ

§ 2:5

Let us begin by stating that all the entities we see in this world — in general and in particular, i.e. general categories and individual entities — are all based on two aspects: matter and *tzurah* (form) [^2] — or body and soul.

וְכֵמוֹ שֶׁמִּבְּאֵר כָּל זֶה בְּדִרוּשִׁים הָאֲחֵרוֹנִים שֶׁבִּסְפָּר עַץ חַיִּים וְעֵין
בִּסְפָּר הַבְּרִית בְּתַחֲלָתוֹ

§ 2:6

as explained in the last teachings in *Etz Chaim*[^3] — see also *Sefer HaBrit* in the beginning.

וְהִנֵּה אֵין חֶמֶר בְּלִי צוּרָה וְלֹא צוּרָה בְּלִי חֶמֶר כְּנוֹדָע

§ 2:7

Now in our world there is no matter without *tzurah*, and no *tzurah* without matter, as is known.

וְהִגַּם שֶׁהֵם שְׁנֵי מְצִיאווִיּוֹת אֲשֶׁר הֵם רְחוּקִים בְּמִדְרַגָּתָם זֶה מִזֶּה
הַרְבֵּה מְאֹד עִם כָּל זֶה הִנֵּה הֵם מְתִיחָדִים זֶה בָּזֶה בְּיַחְדּוֹ עֲצוּם עַד
שֶׁאֵי אֶפְשָׁר לְהַמְצִיא זֶה בְּלֹא זֶה

§ 2:8

And even though these are two distinct entities, very distant from one another in terms of their levels, they are united with one another in such a powerful unity that it is impossible to find one without the other.

וְהֶעֱנִינוּ בְּזֶה הוּא כִּי כָּל מָה שֶׁאֲנִי רֹאֶינָה שֶׁהֵם שְׁתֵּי מַדְרָגוֹת וְגִבּוּהַ
מַעֲלֵת הַצּוּרָה עַל הַחֲמֹר בְּאִין עֶרֶךְ הִנֵּה כָּל זֶה הוּא רַק בְּהַחֲמֹר
וְצוּרָה שֶׁבְּכָל הַנִּמְצָאִים שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה גּוֹפָה

§ 2:9

The concept is this: everything we see as two different levels, where *tzurah* is immeasurably superior to matter, is all exclusively as regards matter and *tzurah* as found in this world itself.

וְכֵן בְּכָל הַנִּמְצָאִים שֶׁבְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם עֲצֻמוֹ

§ 2:10

Similarly with all the entities in each of the worlds themselves — *tzurah* and matter are inseparably united.

אָבֵל מֵעוֹלָם לְעוֹלָם הִנֵּה נַעֲשֶׂה מֵהַחֲמֹר שֶׁל עוֹלָם הָעֶלְיוֹן הַצּוּרָה
שֶׁל עוֹלָם הַתַּחְתּוֹן

§ 2:11

But from world to world — from a higher plane of existence to the one below it — the matter of the higher world becomes the *tzurah* of the lower world.

וְכָלֹל בְּאוֹתָהּ הַצּוּרָה כֹּחַ הַחֲמֹר דֶּהֱתַחְתּוֹן גַּם כֵּן אֵלָּא שֶׁמִּתְחַלָּה
הִיא כְּלוּלָה שֶׁם רַק בְּכֹחַ וְאַחֵר כֵּן יוֹצֵא מִשָּׁם מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל
לְמַצִּיאוֹת גָּמוּר גַּם כֵּן

§ 2:12

And contained within that *tzurah* is also the potential for matter of the lower plane — albeit that initially it is included there only *in potentia*. This subsequently emerges from potential to actual, as actual existence as well.

וְהִרִי הֵם שְׁנֵיהֶם מִשְׁרֵשׁ אֶחָד וְלִכְךָ הֵם מִיְחָדִים זֶה בְּזֶה לְעוֹלָם כִּי
מִתְחַלָּה בִּשְׂרֵשׁ כְּלוּל הַחֲמֹר בְּצוּרָה וְאַחֵר כֵּן כְּשֶׁנִּשְׁלְמוּ לְבַחֲיִנַת
מַצִּיאוֹת הָרְאוּי לְתַחְתּוֹן מִתְלַבֶּשֶׁת הַצּוּרָה בְּהַחֲמֹר וְהֵם אֶחָד
לְעוֹלָם

§ 2:13

Thus both *tzurah* and matter are from a single source, which is why they are always united with one another — since initially, in their root, matter was included in *tzurah*. But afterwards, when it became an entity befitting that lower plane, the *tzurah* becomes vested in the matter and they are one forever.

וּבְאוֹר הַדְּבָרִים הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה כָּל עוֹלָם תַּחְתּוֹן הוּא מְשִׁתְּלָשֶׁל וְנֶעֱשֶׂה
כָּל מְצִיאֹתוֹ מִהָעוֹלָם הָעֲלִיּוֹן שֶׁעָלָיו שֶׁהוּא קוֹדֵם אֵלָיו בְּזִמְנוֹ
וּבַמַּעֲלָה

§ 2:14

The explanation is this: every lower world devolves from — and its entire existence is produced by — the world above it, by the plane of existence that precedes it in time and superiority.

וְסֹדֶר הַהִשְׁתְּלָשְׁלוֹת הוּא כִּי מִתְפַּשֵּׁט מִתַּחֲלָה אוֹרוֹ וְעֲצָמוּתוֹ הָרָאוּי
לְהִיּוֹת שְׂרֵשׁ לַמַּדְרָגַת הַתַּחְתּוֹן הִנֵּה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְיוֹרֵד בַּמָּקוֹם הָעֲתִיד
לַתַּחְתּוֹן וְעַל יְדֵי יְרִידָתוֹ וְרוּחוֹקוֹ מִמָּקוֹרוֹ הִנֵּה נִתְחַשֵּׁךְ וְנִתְעַבָּה קֶצֶת
§ 2:15

This *hishtalshelut* sequence occurs because initially the light and essence of the higher plane that was fit to become the source of the lower plane spreads out and descends to the future place of the lower plane, and by descending and becoming distant from its source it becomes dimmed and somewhat 'thicker' — i.e. coarser and less permeable to the light.

'Thicker' is not meant literally. It signifies a qualitative reduction and degrading of the light, much like physical light emerging from a semi-opaque filter — it is still light but much dimmer and weaker than it was before.

וְאוֹתָהּ הָעֲבִיּוֹת שֶׁנֶּעֱשֶׂה בּוֹ הוּא הַיְסוֹד שֶׁהוּא הָרָאשִׁית וְהַתַּחֲלָה
לְחֹמֶר דֶּהֱתַחְתּוֹן

§ 2:16

This 'thickening' that takes place is the foundation and initial introduction of matter in the lower plane.

וְהִנֵּה נֶעֱשֶׂה עַל יְדֵי הַתְּפַשְׁטוֹת הָאוֹר הַנִּזְכָּר שֶׁלֹּשׁ תּוֹעֲלִיּוֹת

§ 2:17

Now this spreading forth of the light just mentioned produced three benefits:

אֶחָד כִּי עַל יְדֵי רְחוּקוֹ מִמְקוֹרוֹ וְהִתְפַּשְּׁטוֹתוֹ וִירִידָתוֹ בְּמָקוֹם הָעֵתִיד
לְתַחְתּוֹן נַעֲשֶׂה רְאוּי לִהְיוֹת שֶׁרֶשׁ אֵלָיו

§ 2:18

1) By becoming distant from its origin, and by spreading out and descending to the place of the future lower plane, it becomes suitable as a source for that lower plane.

שְׁנִיִּים כִּי עַל יְדֵי שְׁנִיתָעֲבָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ הָרִי נַעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ הִיסוֹד לַחֲמֵר
דִּהְתַּחְתּוֹן גַּם כֵּן

§ 2:19

2) By becoming 'thicker', as we said, it also becomes the foundation for the matter of the lower plane.

וְהַשְׁלִישִׁי הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה בְּאֶשֶׁר שָׁכַל אוֹתוֹ הָאוֹר שְׁנִיתָפֶשֶׁט הִנֵּה הוּא
רַק כְּדֵי לְהַעֲשׂוֹת לְבַחֲיִנַת שֶׁרֶשׁ לְתַחְתּוֹן הִנֵּה מְקוֹמוֹ וְעָקְרוֹ הוּא רַק
לְמַעַלָּה בְּהַעֲלָם הָעֲלִיוֹן

§ 2:20

3) The light spreads forth entirely for the purpose of becoming a source for the lower plane — although its proper place and primary nature is only above, in the concealed upper plane.

The spreading forth of the light from the higher plane to the lower is for the sake of the lower plane. Yet in itself the light 'belongs' above, as the Baal HaLeshem goes on to explain.

כִּי כֵּן הוּא מְכַרַּח לְכָל עוֹלָם וּמְצִיאֹת לִהְיוֹת לוֹ שֶׁרֶשׁ בְּמָקוֹם עֲלִיוֹן
שֶׁמֶשֶׁם שׂוֹאֵב חַיּוּתוֹ תָּמִיד וְהָיָה כָּל הִתְפַּשְּׁטוֹתוֹ אֲשֶׁר נִתְפַּשֵּׁט
בְּמָקוֹם הָעֵתִיד לְתַחְתּוֹן רַק כְּדֵי לְהַצְטַמֵּם לְמַדְרָגָתוֹ לִהְיוֹת שֶׁרֶשׁ
עֲלִיוֹן אֵלָיו

§ 2:21

In the Divine plan it is necessary that every world and existing entity has its source in the plane above, from whence it draws its life force — so that the entire spreading forth of the higher level to the future place of the lower level is only so that it can become diminished in its descent, and in this way become its supernal source.

וּמְקוֹמוֹ הָעֶקְרִי הוּא רַק לַמַּעֲלָה בְּהַעֲלִים הָעֲלִיוֹן עֲצָמוֹ וּלְכַן הוּא כִּי
אֲחֵר שֶׁנִּתְפַּשֵּׁט וְנִצְטַמָּצֵם וְנַעֲשֶׂה רְאוּי לְהִיּוֹת שְׂרֵשׁ לַתַּחְתּוֹן הַנִּה
הוּא אֵינוֹ עוֹמֵד שָׁם עוֹד כָּלֹל אֶלָּא שְׁחוּזָר וְנִסְתַּלַּק וְעוֹלָה לַמַּעֲלָה
וְנִשְׁאַר שָׁם לְעוֹלָם

§ 2:22

Its primary place is only above in the concealed upper plane itself. Therefore, after it spreads forth and becomes diminished so that it is suitable as a source for the lower, it does not remain there at all. Instead it returns and is withdrawn above, where it always remains.

אִמָּנָם בְּחִינַת הָעֲבִיּוֹת שְׁאֵמְרָנוּ שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה בּוֹ עַל יְדֵי יְרִידָתוֹ הַנִּה זֶה
נִשְׁאַר לְמַטָּה וְאֵין לוֹ כֹּחַ לַעֲלוֹת לַמַּעֲלָה מֵאַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְעַבֶּה וְהַנִּה
נִפְרָד אֶז הָעֲבִיּוֹת מֵהָאוֹר וְנִשְׁאַר הִיא לְמַטָּה וְהָאוֹר חוֹזֵר וְעוֹלָה
לַמַּעֲלָה

§ 2:23

However, the aspect of 'thickening' that we mentioned — which is caused by its descent — remains below. This diminished light has no power to ascend above since it has become thickened, which separates it from the original light. And therefore it remains below while the undiminished light returns and ascends above.

The aspect of light that was diminished and thickened remains below while the undiminished light is retracted and remains above. The light that remains below is called the *reshimu*¹ or *roshem ha-ohr* — the residue of the light, as will be explained.

וְדַע עוֹד כִּי עֶקֶר בְּחִינַת הָעֲבִיּוֹת שְׁאֵמְרָנוּ שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה בְּהָאוֹר עַל יְדֵי
יְרִידָתוֹ וְרוּחוֹ מִמְּקוֹרוֹ הַנִּה הוּא נַעֲשֶׂה עַל יְדֵי כֹחַ סוֹד הַצְמָצוּם
הַמְבָּאָר בְּדִבְרֵי הָאֲרִיזָ"ל שֶׁהוּא הַמָּקוֹם לְכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם

§ 2:24

Know further that the primary thickening of the light — that comes about because of its descent and distancing from its source — is the effect of the secret of **tzimtzum** that makes place for all of the worlds, as explained by the Arizal.^[^7]

Were it not for the *tzimtzum*, none of the worlds would exist. Even if they could have been created, they would immediately be overwhelmed by the unmitigated *Ohr Ein Sof* and would disappear entirely.

ומכח סוד הצמצום הזה הנה מתעבה כל אור בהתפשטותו
ממקום למקום ומעולם לעולם

§ 2:25

The effect of this **tzimtzum**^[^8] is thus to thicken all the light that spreads forth from place to place and from world to world.

The *tzimtzum* has this effect only on the light intended for creation — that which spreads forth to the worlds. The aspect of light that is not intended for the worlds and remains above is unaffected.

וכמו שיתבאר ענין הצמצום לקמן בדברינו בשערים הבאים
ובעגלים וישר ענף ב'

§ 2:26

The concept of **tzimtzum** will be explained below in the coming chapters^[^9] and in the section titled **Igulim v'Yosher** chap. 2.
^[^10]

ונחזר לענין כי הנה האור חוזר ומסתלק ועולה למעלה והעביות
שנעשה בו נפרד אז ממנו והוא נשאר למטה

§ 2:27

Let us return to the subject. The light returns and withdraws and ascends above, and the thickening that is produced in it becomes thus separated from it and remains below.

אמנם הוא כי הנה הגם שכל האור העקרי הנה הוא חוזר ועולה
למעלה עם כל זה הנה מאחר שמציאות העביות שנעשה בירידתו

הנה הוא מהאור עצמו כנ"ל הנה נשאָר תּמציֹת האָרה ורשם אור
עם העביות גם כן לעולם

§ 2:28

It is true, however, that even though all the main aspect of the light returns and ascends above — nevertheless, since the presence of thickening in its descent is an aspect of the light itself, as noted previously — an extract of the radiance and an impression of the light with its thickening also remains forever.

ואותו הרשם אור הוא הכנה וכח לקבל בתוכו את אור נשמתו
העקרי שעתיד להתפשט בו משפעת אור העליון אשר עלה
ונסתלק

§ 2:29

And this impression of the light prepares and empowers it to receive within it the primary light of its *neshama*^[11] — that in the future will spread forth from the outpouring of the supernal light that ascended and was withdrawn.

כי אחר שנסתלק האור ועלה למעלה ונעשה שרש עליון לתחתון
הנה הוא חוזר ומשפיע בו שפע אור ונשמה הראוי למדרגת
התחתון עצמו ומתפשט ומתלבש בהעביות שנשאָר למטה לאור
ונשמה העקרי שבו

§ 2:30

Because after the light was withdrawn and ascended above it became the supernal root of the light remaining below. Then it reverts to projecting a stream of light and *neshama* upon the lower light as appropriate for the level of the lower aspect itself, and it spreads forth and clothes itself in the thickening that remains below as the primary illumination and *neshama* thereof.

וכל זה הוא על ידי רשימת אור שנשאָר בהעביות מתחלה מהאור
הראשון עצמו כי על ידי זה קשור העביות עם האור הראשון
לעולם שישפיע בו אור תמיד

§ 2:31

And this is all due to the residue of the initial light itself that remains in the thickening, because in this way the thickening is

always connected to the initial light which enables it to always stream light into the thickening.

וְהוּא הַתּוֹעֵלֶת הַשְּׁלִישִׁית שְׁאֶמְרָנוּ לְעֵיל מֵהַתְּפֻשָּׁטוֹת אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן
שֶׁבַתְחָלָה וְהוּא הָרִשֵּׁם אוֹר שְׁמִשְׁאִיר אַחֲרָיו בְּהֶעֱבִיּוֹת שֶׁהוּא הִכְנָה
וְכֵחַ וְשֶׁרֶשׁ לְאוֹר נִשְׁמָתוֹ הָעֶקְרִי בְּנִזְכָּר

§ 2:32

This is the third benefit of the spreading out of the initial light we noted above — which is that the impression of the light that it leaves behind in the thickening is a preparation for, the empowerment of, and the root of the light of the primary *neshama*, as mentioned.

To recall: the first two benefits were that 1) by becoming 'thicker' the initial light becomes a suitable source for the lower light; 2) by 'thickening' it also becomes the foundation for the matter of the lower plane.

וְהָיָה נִתְבָּאֵר בְּזֶה מָה שְׁאֶמְרָנוּ לְעֵיל בְּעֲנִין הַחֲמֹר וְצוּרָה שֶׁמַּתְחִלָּה
בְּשֶׁרֶשׁ כָּלוּל הַחֲמֹר בְּצוּרָה וְהוּא הֶעֱבִיּוֹת הַכָּלוּל בְּהָאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן
שֶׁהוּא הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ הָעֲלִיּוֹן וְכִלְיוֹתוֹ שֵׁם הוּא רַק בְּכֵחַ

§ 2:33

This explains what we said above regarding matter and *tzurah* — that initially, in its root, matter is included in *tzurah*; which is the same as saying that the thickening is included in the initial light, which is the supernal root, and its inclusion there is only in a potential state.

כִּי נַעֲשֶׂה עֵקֶר הֶעֱבִיּוֹת בּוֹ עַל יְדֵי סוּד הַצְמָצוּם כֵּן"ל וְכָלוּל בּוֹ בְּכֵחַ
וְאַחֵר כִּךְ כְּשִׁיּוּצָא מִן הַכֵּחַ אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל וְנַעֲשֶׂה לְמַצִּיאוֹת בְּפָנֵי עֲצָמוֹ
וְהוּא כְּאֲשֶׁר מִסְתַּלַּק הָאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן לְמַעְלָה בְּנִזְכָּר

§ 2:34

Since the primary thickening thereof is via the secret of *tzimtzum*, as explained above, and it is included only in a potential state — subsequently, when it emerges from potential to actuality and becomes an independent existence,^[12] this occurs when the initial light is withdrawn above, as mentioned.

אז מתלבשת הצורה בהחמר והוא אור נשמתו העקרי אשר נמשך
 בו אחר כך משפעת אור הראשון וחוזר ומתלבש בו ונעשו שניהם
 לאחד כי הם שניהם משרש אחד כנ"ל

§ 2:35

Then the *tzurah* is clothed in matter — that *tzurah* is the primary light of the *neshama* that is drawn into it afterwards from the outflow of the initial light. The light returns and becomes clothed in matter, and both aspects become a single entity, since they are both from the same root, as explained above.

והוא מה שאמר הרמב"ם ז"ל ביסודי התורה פ"ד סימן ז' וכן
 הגר"א ז"ל בספר יצירה פ"א משנה ד'

§ 2:36

This is what the Rambam states in *Yesodei Hatorah* 4:7,^[14] and so does the GR"A of Vilna in his commentary to *Sefer Yetzirah* 1:4.^[15]

אכן שני שלא היה לעולם חמר בלא צורה וצורה בלא חמר וכח
 החמר בצורה וכן כח הצורה בחמר כי הרי גם האור הראשון
 שנתפשט הנה היה התפשטותו מהחמר דהעליון שהוא הצורה
 לתחתון כנ"ל

§ 2:37

A second approach to explaining that there was never a situation where matter existed without *tzurah* or *tzurah* without matter, and that the potential for matter is in *tzurah* and the potential for *tzurah* is in matter: The initial light that spread forth emerged from the 'matter' of the upper entity, which is the *tzurah* of the lower, as we explained at the beginning of this chapter.

ומה שאמרנו שכל החמר בצורה הוא העביות דהתחתון שנעשה
 בכח דאור הראשון ומה שאמרנו שכל הצורה בחמר הוא רשימת
 אור שנשארו מיחד לעולם בהעביות והוא הכנה ושרש לאור נשמתו
 העקרי שבו כנ"ל ומזה נמשך לעולם שכל החמר בצורה וכח
 הצורה בחמר ונמשך ונארג התהוות כל מציאות מתחלתו ועד
 סופו בחמר וצורה יחד

§ 2:38

When we wrote that the potential for matter is contained in *tzurah*, this refers to the thickening of the lower level that is brought about by means of the power of the initial light. When we wrote that the potential for *tzurah* is in matter, this refers to the impression of the light that remains forever united with the thickening, which is the preparation and root of the light of the primary *neshama* therein, as explained above. And from this derives the fact that always the potential of matter is in *tzurah*, and the potential of *tzurah* is in matter — so that matter and *tzurah* are together drawn forth and blended throughout all of existence from beginning to end.

ידע כי כל הדברים הללו הנה הם כוללים כל העולמות כלם אשר
מאחר אמתתו הנעלמת ולמטה עד סוף עולם העשיה שכלם
נשתלשלו כל תחתון מהעליון בסדר זה

§ 2:39

And know that all of these matters encompass all of the worlds — from after His inscrutable true Being below, from the very first world until the end of the world of *Asiyah* — because every lower entity devolved from a higher entity according to this arrangement.

אמנם אותו הסדר עצמו הוא בכל עולם ועולם לפי הענינים
והמציאויות המתיחס אליו ובארנו כל זה בעמק וארכה בכל עולם
ועולם בפני עצמו בספר הכללים אשר כלו מיוסד על זה

§ 2:40

However, this very arrangement is in each and every world according to the concepts and realities associated with it. We explained all of this in depth and at length for each world individually in *Sefer HaKelalim*, which is based entirely upon this idea.

והרוצה לעמוד על סוד סדר מסדרי מעשה בראשית יעין שם
ומשכיל על דבר ימצא טוב

§ 2:41

Anyone who wishes to achieve clarity^[16] regarding the mysteries of the arrangements of Creation should study the matter

there. 'One who undertakes a matter intelligently will find good' —
i.e. success (*Proverbs* 16:20).

Footnotes

1. See *Etz Chaim* 6:5. [↩](#)

Chapter 2: Tzurah — Form

Shaar 2 Chapter 2

Tzurah — Form

וְהִנֵּה הַגֵּם שֶׁמִּתְבָּאֵר מִדְּבָרֵינוּ שֶׁהַחֲמֹר וְהַצּוּרָה הֵם אֶחָד מִשְׁרָשָׁם
וְכֵן הֵם מִיְחָדִים זב"ז [זֶה בָּזֶה] תָּמִיד

Now even though we explained that matter and *tzurah* (form¹) are one in their root, and they are also always unified one with the other, so that one cannot find *tzurah* without matter or matter without *tzurah*,

עכ"ז הִנֵּה יֵשׁ חֲלוּק גָּדוֹל בֵּינֵיהֶם

there is nevertheless a great difference between them,

כִּי הִנֵּה הַחֲמֹר כֹּאֲשֶׁר שֶׁנִּשְׁלֵם הִוְיָתוֹ וּמִצִּיאוֹתוֹ בְּמִקְוָמוֹ

because when the being and existence of matter is complete in its place i.e. in this world

הִנֵּה הוּא נִבְדָּל מִהָעוֹלָם הָעֲלִיוֹן לְגַמְרִי

it becomes completely disconnected from the upper world;

וְלֹא נִרְאָה בּוֹ עוֹד קֶשֶׁר וְשִׁיכוּת עִמּוֹ כָּלֵל

any connection with and relevance to it to the upper world are no longer evident

כִּי עוֹמֵד כָּל מִצִּיאוֹתוֹ רַק לְמַטָּה

since its entire existence is only below.

מִשָּׁא"כ [מָה שֶׁאֵין כּוֹן] הַצּוּרָה הִנֵּה הִיא אֵינָה יוֹרֶדֶת לְמַטָּה
לְהִתְיַחֵד בְּהַחֲמֹר

Whereas the higher aspect of *tzurah* does not descend below to become fused with matter;

אֵלָא רַק בְּהִקְצָה הַתַּחְתּוֹן שְׁלָה לְבַד כִּי שָׁם הִיא שֹׁרֶשׁ לְהַחֲמֵר אֲשֶׁר
מִמֶּנָּה לִּיקַח

only its lowest extremity descends to become fused with matter for there, in the higher worlds, as explained above, is the root of matter and from there it derives,

וּמִשָּׁם נִמְשָׁךְ לוֹ כָּל חַיּוּתוֹ וְקִיּוּמוֹ וְכָל תְּהִלּוּכוֹתָיו וְהַנְהָגָתוֹ

and from there all its life force and continued existence is drawn, as well as all of its progress and its conduct.

וְלָכֵן הִיא מִתְיַחֶדֶת בָּזֶה עִם הַחֲמֵר כָּל זְמַן קִיּוּמוֹ

And therefore it the *tzurah* is fused with matter while it exists.

אֲבָל עֲקָרָה דְּהַצִּוּרָה הִיא לְעוֹלָם קָשׁוּר וְדְבוּק בְּשִׁרְשָׁהּ שְׁלִמְעָלָה
אֲשֶׁר בְּהָעֵלָם הָעֲלִיוֹן.

Nevertheless, the primary aspect of *tzurah* is always bound up with and cleaves to its root above in the state of supernal hiddenness.

וְהוּא מְסֻבֵּת ג' טַעֲמִים אֲשֶׁר כֻּלָּם עוֹלָיִם לְמַקּוֹר אֶחָד.

And this is for three reasons, all of which arise in the same source:

There are three reasons why the *tzurah* of the lower world becomes revealed only at its lowest extremity while pouring forth outflow from above.²

טַעַם א' הוּא כִּי הֵיכָּה אֵי אֲפָשָׁר לְשׁוּם מְצִיאוֹת לְהִתְקִים אִפִּי רִגַע
אֶחָת בְּהִיּוֹתָהּ מִפְּרֵד מִשִּׁרְשׁ צוּר מְחַצְבָּתָהּ

- 1. The first reason: It is impossible for any existent entity to endure for even a moment if it is severed from the root**

from whence it was cut out

וְכִמּוֹ שִׁיתָבֵּאֵר בְּטַעַם הַב' וְהִג'

as will be explained in reasons 2 & 3.

וְלִכֵּן הַצּוּרָה אֲשֶׁר הוּא עֶקֶר חַיּוּתוֹ דֶּהֱחִמָּר וְכֵחַ הַתְּהוּוּתוֹ וְקִיּוּמוֹ

And therefore the *tzurah*, which is the primary life-force of matter and the power that brings it into existence and maintains it in existence,

הַכֹּרֵחַ לְהִשָּׂאֵר לְמַעַלָּה לִישֵׁב בְּסִתֵּר עָלִיוֹן תָּמִיד

Must remain above, 'to reside in the supernal hiddenness.'³

וְשׂוֹאֵבֶת מִשָּׁם כָּל שְׁפָעֶת כַּח קִיּוּמוֹ דֶּהֱחִמָּר כָּל מָה שֶׁנֶּצְרָךְ לוֹ

And it draws from there all the flow of energy that keeps matter in existence as long as needed,

וּמִמְשִׁיךְ בּוֹ דֶּרֶךְ קֶצֶה הַתַּחְתּוֹן שֶׁלָּהּ הַמְתַּיַּחַד עִמּוֹ

and draws down this energy via its lowest extremity – the aspect that fuses with it with matter.

וְעִי"ז מִתְקַיֵּם כָּל מְצִיאוֹתָיו דֶּהֱחִמָּר בְּעוֹלָמוֹ כָּל הַזְּמַן הַנִּגְזֵר עָלָיו

It is through this that the entire existence of matter endures in its world the World of Asiyah for as long as has been decreed from Above.

וְמָה שֶׁנִּמְשָׁךְ לְמַטָּה רַק הַקֶּצֶה הַתַּחְתּוֹן שֶׁלָּהּ

That only its the *tzurah*'s lowest extremity is drawn down below

הוּא מְשׁוּם כִּי רַק זֶה לְבַד הוּא סִבַּת דֶּהֱחִמָּר וְצוּרָתוֹ הָרְאוּי אֵלָיו

is because that the lowest level of the spiritual dimension of *tzurah* alone is the reason for matter and its proper *tzurah*.

The fact that *tzurah* and matter combine at all is an anomaly, given that they are polar opposites. And the only way they can combine is that only the extreme lower limit of the *tzurah* configures the matter below.

אבל עקרה דהצורה הוא שיך רק למעלה ושם הוא מקומה

But the primary aspect of *tzurah* is only relevant above in spiritual dimensions, for that is its place.

ומתפשטת ומתיחדת למטה ע"י הקצה התחתון שלה

And from there **it extends forth and unites with matter below, via its lowest extremity**

ושואבת למעלה ומשפעת למטה תמיד

that draws off from above and pours its outflow forth continuously below.

טעם ב' הוא כי אלו שהיה כל נמצא מפךד ממקורו הן בחמרו והן בצורתו

1. **The second reason** why the *tzurah* of the lower world becomes revealed only at its lowest extremity while pouring forth outflow from above **is that if any entity was severed completely from its source, whether** this is in terms of **its matter** or in terms of **its *tzurah*,**

והיינו שהיה מפךד כל צורה דהתחתון ג"כ ממקורו

that is to say, the entire *tzurah* of the lower aspect would be severed from its source, so that the *tzurah* would only exist below and would not be connected above,⁴

הנה היה עומד כל נמצא על מצב אחד לעולם בלי שנוי בו כלל

then every entity would remain in the same state forever, with no change at all.

כי כל שנוי הנעשה בשום נמצא הנה הוא לעולם רק ע"י סבה
המסבב אותה לזה

**Because any change in any entity is only due to some cause
impinging upon it**

ומכריח אותה על שינויה וכל מכריח הנה הוא למעלה ממנו

**'forcing' it to change in those ways. Whatever does the 'forcing'
is obviously of a higher status than that which is being forced.**

ואלו שהיה שום נמצא נפרד לגמרי מלמעלה לא היה נעשה בו
שום שנוי כלל

**And if any entity was completely severed from above, no
change would ever transpire in it,**

והיה עומד על מצב אחד לעולם.

and it would remain in the same state forever.

ולא כן היה כוננתו ית"ש בכל המציאות כלו כמו שיתבאר

**This was not His intention, blessed be His name, throughout all
of existence, as will be explained.**

ואלו שהיה נפרד כל מציאות מלמעלה הן בחמרו והן בצורתו

**And if any object in existence was severed from what is above,
whether its matter or its *tzurah*,**

הנה היה אז פעלתו ית"ש ג"כ רק על דרך פעלת התחתונים

then His actions would also be like the activities of those below

—

שאחר גמר הפעלה אין לה שיכות עוד עם הפועל כלל

**in that after an action is completed it no longer has any
relationship to the one performing the act at all,**

וְאֵינָהּ מְקַבֶּלֶת מִמֶּנּוּ לֹא תוֹסֶפֶת וְלֹא גִרְעוֹן

and the operator can no longer add to or subtract from the action⁵

וְהִיא מַצִּדּוֹ עַל מַצָּב אֶחָד תָּמִיד בְּכָל זְמַן קִיּוּמָהּ

As far as the object is concerned, it would remain in the same status always, as long as it remains in existence.

וּבְאִשֶּׁר שֶׁכּוֹנֶנֶתוֹ ית"ש בְּכָל מְצִיאוֹת הָעוֹלָמוֹת בְּכָלל וּבִפְרָט

But since His intention in all of the worlds, generally and specifically⁶

לֹא הָיָה הַכּוֹנֵנָה בָּהֶם לְהַשְׁאִירָם עַל מְצִיאוֹתָם שֶׁהֵם עֲתֵהּ

– the intention in each of them was not that they would remain as they are,

וְשִׁיחָא זֶה לְבַד תְּכַלִּית מְצִיאוֹתָם ח"ו וְכִמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְּבָאֵר בְּטַעַם ג'

and that would be the ultimate purpose of their existence, G-d forbid, as will be explained in the third reason below.

לְכַךְ סִדֵּר אֶת בְּנֵינוּ כָּל מְצִיאוֹתָם הֵן בְּכָלל וְהֵן בִּפְרָט

And therefore He arranged the structure of their existence generally and specifically

שִׁיחָא כָּל כַּח קִיּוּמוֹ וְחִיּוּתוֹ שֶׁל כ"א קָשׁוּר וְתָלוּי לְעוֹלָם רַק לְמַעַלָּה

that the ability of each individual entity to endure and its life-force is always bound to and is dependent only upon what is above.

וְכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כָּלָם הֵם כָּלָם קָשׁוּרִים וְתָלוּיִם זב"ז לְעֵלְאָ לְעֵלְאָ עַד
אֱלֹיו עֲצָמוֹ ית"ש

In addition, all of the worlds are all bound to and depend on one another to the highest levels and beyond – to Him Himself, blessed be His name.

וּמִשְׁגָּחִים כָּלָם תָּמִיד רַק מִמֶּנּוּ וּמִנְהֻגֵּים כָּלָם תָּמִיד רַק עַל יָדוֹ

And they are all watched over continuously only by Him, and they are directed always only by Him,

כִּי שׂוֹאֲבִים כָּל חַיּוֹתָם וְכָל כֹּחַ קִיּוּמָם תָּמִיד רַק מִמֶּנּוּ לְבָד

for they always draw down all their life force and the power of their existence only from Him,

וְרַק הוּא לְבָד חַי הָעוֹלָמִים כָּלָם.

and He alone is the life of all the worlds.

וְהִנֵּה הוּא פּוֹעֵל תָּמִיד בָּהֶם וְעִי"ז אֵינוֹ עוֹמֵד הַמְצִיאוֹת בְּמַצָּב אֶחָד
כָּלֵל אֶף רִגַע אַחַת

Now since He is constantly acting upon them upon the worlds their existence does not remain static for even a moment.

אֲלֹא שֶׁמִּתְחַלֶּפֶת תָּמִיד בְּשִׁינוּיִם שׁוֹנִים וְאִינֶה עוֹמֶדֶת בְּמִנוּחָה כָּלֵל

On the contrary, it is constantly changing in various ways, and does not remain in a state of inertness at all.

אֲלֹא שֶׁהִיא בִּפְעֻלָּה תָּמִיד וְהוּא מָה שֶׁכָּתוּב אֲשֶׁר בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים
לַעֲשׂוֹת

Instead, it is in a constant state of activity, as the verse (Genesis 2:3) states, "that God created to do." Not "and it was done" but "to do,"⁷ continuously.

(This portion of the verse is often translated as "that God had done.")

כִּי הוּא ית"ש עוֹשֶׂה וּפּוֹעֵל בְּהַמְצִיאוֹת תָּמִיד

For He, blessed be His name, continuously creates and acts upon existence.

שְׁכָל הַפְעָלוֹת הַנִּעֲשֶׂה בְּכָל הַבְּרִיאָה כְּלָה בְּכָל עֵת הִנֵּה הוּא רַק
מִמֶּנּוּ ית"ש

For all of the actions that take place in all of creation at all times, are only from Him,

ע"ד שֶׁהוּא בְּכָל פְּעֻלוֹת הַגּוֹף שֶׁהוּא רַק מִהֲנִשְׁמָה שָׁבוּ

in a manner similar to the activities of a person's body which are exclusively from the soul within him. Without the soul the body would simply be a corpse and would be incapable of any activity.

וְהַכֹּל הוּא מָה שֶׁהִקְב"ה עוֹשֶׂה בְּהַמְצִיאוֹת תָּמִיד וּמִנְהִיג אוֹתָהּ
לְעוֹלָם ע"פ הַכּוֹנֶנָה הַתְּכַלִּיתִית שֶׁבָּהּ.

All of them all the events and actions that take place throughout the universe **are all always the actions of the Holy One blessed be He upon existence, which He always directs according to the divine purpose with which it is imbued.**

וְע' [וְעִין] דְּבָרִים עֲמָקִים בָּזָה בְּדַבְּרֵינוּ בְּסֵפֶר הַדַּע"ה ח"ב דְּרוֹשׁ ב'
וְשֵׁם ח"א דְּרוֹשׁ א' סִימָן ג' אוֹת ו'.

See in depth our explanation in *Sefer HaDe'ah* section 2, lecture 2 and section 1 lecture 1 chapter 3, paragraph 6.

וְהִנֵּה נִעֲשֶׂה כ"ז ע"י שֶׁהִנָּפֵשׁ וְהַצּוּרָה שֶׁל כָּל מְצִיאוֹת

Now all of this is brought about by the *nefesh*⁸ and *tzurah* of all existence,

שֶׁהִיא הַכֹּחַ דְּכָל הַתְּהוּוּתָהּ וְתִכּוּנָתָהּ

which is the power of its entire coming into being and its properties.

הנה עומד עקרה רק למעלה וקשורה לעלא לעלא עד המאציל
עליון ית"ש

Now the primary aspect thereof of the *nefesh-tzurah* is located exclusively above, where it is bound above to the highest levels, until the Supernal Emanator, may His Name be blessed.

ועל ידה מתנהג כל נמצא תמיד בעולה ויורד

And it is by way of this *nefesh-tzurah* that every being is continually guided in its ascent and descent.

כי פעם נתעלה תכונתה בעלוי רב ופעם יורדת ממדרגתה ונגרע
מערכה אם מעט ואם הרבה

For at times its nature is greatly elevated and at other times it descends from its level and it loses its value, whether a little or a lot.

ועד"ז מתחלף ועובר על כל נמצא שונים רבים והיא בפעלה תמיד

And in the same manner everything in existence undergoes many changes and it is always in a state of activity.

והכל הוא מההשגחה וההנהגה העליונה

All of this comes from supernal guidance and oversight.

ומקבלת כל מה שנגזר עליה מהפעלות והשנוים ע"י צורתה

And it receives by way of its *tzurah* everything that is decreed upon it in terms of those things that act upon it and the changes it undergoes.

אשר היא כח כל התהוותה ואיכותה

That *tzurah* is the power of its coming to be and the nature of that entity

הנשאר ועומד למעלה דבוק בשרשה העליון

that remains fixed above, cleaving to its supernal root

וְקָשׁוּר לְעֵלָא לְעֵלָא עַד צֶרֶךְ כָּל הָעוֹלָמִים כֻּלָּם הַמְנַהִיג וּפּוֹעֵל אֶת כָּל

and its nature remains **bound up above and beyond**, all the way up **until He who formed all the worlds, who directs and activates everything**.

וְהוּא יִתְבָּרַךְ וַיִּתְעַלֶּה שְׁמוֹ מִחֲלִיף אוֹתָם וּמְשַׁנֶּה וּפּוֹעֵל בָּהֶם

And He, may His name be blessed and exalted, modifies them and causes change in them and acts upon them

לְפִי הַצֶּרֶךְ לְתִקּוּנָם וּלְכּוֹנֶנֶת תְּכִלִּיתָם כְּמוֹ שִׁיתְבָּאֵר בְּסִמּוּךְ.

according to the necessities of their rectification and their purpose, as will be explained below.

טעם הג' והוא קרוב לטעם הב'

1. **The third reason** which discusses the *orot makifim* (the transcendent, enveloping light) **has an affinity with the second reason** – which speaks about *orot pnimi'im* (immanent light)²:

כִּי הִנֵּה רְצוֹנוֹ ית"ש וְכוֹנֶנֶתוֹ בְּבְרִיאַת עוֹלָמוֹ

The third reason is that His will and intention in creating His universe

הָרִי הָיָה לִבְרֵא הָמוֹן בְּרוּאִים לֹאִין תְּכִלִּית וּלְהַחֲלִיף עֲלֵיהֶם כָּל
הַשְּׁנוּיִם הָרַבִּים וְהַעֲצוּמִים

was to create an unlimited number of creatures and to impose upon them the many and drastic changes

אֲשֶׁר עוֹבֵר עֲלֵיהֶם בְּכָל מִשָּׁךְ זְמוֹ מִצָּב מְדֻרְגָּתָם הַתַּחְתּוֹנָה

that they undergo throughout the duration of their situation on the lower level i.e. not on their root level, but on the level of each

individual creature.

שִׁסַּד בָּהֶם מִסֹּד הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה [וְכִמוּ שֶׁבָּאֲרָנוּ בְּדַע"ה ח"ב
וּבכ"מ מִדְּבָרֵינוּ]

This He established within them in the mystery of the Supernal Thought [as we explained in Sefer haDe'ah¹⁰ part 2 and in a number of places].

וְע"י כָּל אוֹתוֹן הַשְּׁנוּיִם הָעֲצוּמִים הַמִּתְחַלְפִּים עֲלֵיהֶם תָּמִיד בְּגִזְרַת
נוֹרָא עֲלִילוֹת

****By way of those drastic changes that they constantly undergo, due to the decree of the Awesome-in-¹¹His-deeds i.e. God**

הַשֵּׁם מַפְעֵלוֹת בְּשָׂמִים וּבְאָרֶץ וּבְכָל צְבֹאֵיהֶם (וְכִמוּ שֶׁבָּאֲרָנוּ שָׁם
כ"ז)

Who placed His works in heaven and earth¹² and among all of their hosts (as explained there).

הִנֵּה ע"ז מְזַכֵּךְ חֲמִירוֹתָם וְנִקְשָׁרִים וּמִתְאַחֲדִים כָּל פְּרָטִי
הַמְּצִיאֵת כָּלֵם זב"ז וזב"ז

– in this way the materiality of every detail of existence is refined and they become bound one to the other and united with each other.

וְכָלֵם בְּאָדָם שֶׁהוּא מְבַחֵר כָּל הַיְצוֹר

And all of them within man¹³ who is the choicest of all creations.

וְע"ז מִתְעַלִּים מִדְּרָגָה לְמִדְּרָגָה וִיתְקִנוּ כָּלֵם ע"י הָאָדָם

And in this way they are all elevated from level to level and all are rectified by man –

שְׁבוּ תְּלוּי תִּקּוּן הַכֹּל לַעֲלוֹת עִמּוֹ לְמַעַלָּה לְמַעַלָּה לְמִקְוֶה הָרָאוּן
אֲשֶׁר לְקִחוֹ מִשָּׁם

upon whom the entire rectification depends – to ascend with him to the highest levels, to their original source from whence they derive,

וְכַדִּי לְהַשְׁבִּיעֵם מְנוּעֵם זֵיו צְחָצוֹחַ הָעֲלִיוֹן

and to satiate them with the blissful radiance of the supernal purity –

אוֹר פְּנֵי מֶלֶךְ חַיִּים בְּאֵין סוֹף וְתַכְלִית

the light of the King's countenance which is infinite and never-ending life.¹⁴

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁבְּאַרְנוֹ בְּאַרוּכָּה כ"ז בְּסֵפֶר הַכְּלָלִים כָּלֵל ט"ז וי"ז

As we explained in *Sefer Hakelalim, Klal 15, 17.*

וְכָל הַתִּקּוּן וְהָעֲלִיָּה הַזֶּה הִנֵּה הוּא רַק ע"י צוּרְתָם אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁאָר עֲקָרָם
לְמַעַלָּה

All of this rectification and elevation is only by virtue of their *tzurah*, the primary aspect of which remains above,

וְהֵם קְשׁוּרִים וְתְלוּיִם זב"ז עַד לַעֲלֹא לַעֲלֹא כְּנִז'

and they are bound together and depend on one another to the highest levels, as mentioned above.

וְשֵׁם בְּמִקְוֶה הִנֵּה מִתְאַחֲדִים צוּרוֹת כָּל הַמְּצִיאִית כָּלָם בְּאַחֲדוּת
גְּמוּרָה

In their source the *tzurachs* of all things in existence are united in one complete unity

מִשׁוּם שֶׁכָּלָם נִמְשָׁכוּ מִמִּקְוֶה אֶחָד

since they all derive from a single source.

ועי"ז הם נקשרים ונתלים זב"ז גם למטה

By virtue thereof because they all derive from a single source **they are bound together and depend upon one another below as well.**

וכמו שנודע שפרטי כל המציאות כלם נצרכים זה לזה ונעזר
האחד ע"י חברו

As is known, individual entities throughout creation all need each other, and one entity is aided by another.

והם נתלים זב"ז וכלם באדם ואדם בכלם

And they are all dependent upon one another, and all of them upon man, and man upon all of them.

והם מתתקנים ומתעלים ע"י האדם

They are rectified and ascend through man.

וכ"ז הוא ע"י שמתנהגים כלם מצורתם הנשארת למעלה ואותו
הצורה מנהיגו תמיד לתכליתו

All of this is by way of being directed by their *tzurah* that remains above, and that *tzurah* directs each entity towards its purpose

ומחליף עליו כל השנוים מהפעלות והתקונים שנעשה בו

and modifies the entity with all the changes that come about from the activities and rectifications that are done with it

עד שלבסוף מחזירו אליו

until in the end it returns to it – to its original *tzurah* state, before it became invested in matter.

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָנוּ רוֹאִין ג' כ שֶׁסּוֹף כָּל דָּבָר שֶׁחוֹזֵר לִיסוּדוֹ וְחוֹזֵרִים כָּלָם
לְשֵׁרָשָׁם

**As we also see that in the end everything returns to its
elemental state¹⁵ and all things return to their root,**

עַד כִּי לָעֵת קֵץ תִּקְוֵן הָאַחֲרוֹן יַעֲלוּ כָּלָם לְתִקּוּן סוֹד הָאַחֲדוּת
הַשְּׁלִימָה

**Until in final era with the last rectification all of them will
ascend into the rectification of unity,**

שֶׁהוּא תְּכֵלִית בְּנֻתּוֹ ית"ש בְּכָל בְּרִיאַת עוֹלָמוֹ וְכְמוֹ שֶׁבִּאֲרָנוּ כ"ז
בְּסֵפֶר הַכְּלָלִים הַנִּזְ'.

**which was God's primary intention when He created His
world, as we explained in *Sefer HaKlalim*.**

וְהָרִי לָנוּ עַכ"פ מָה שֶׁאָנוּ רוֹאִין בְּסֵדֶר כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת שְׁבָה־עוֹה"ז

**So at least we can conclude that what we see throughout
existence in this world**

כִּי נִסְדֵּר כ"א מִחֲמֶר וְצוּרָה שֶׁהוּא גּוֹף וְנִשְׁמָה כְּלִי וְאוֹר חִיצוֹנִיּוֹת
וּפְנִימִיּוֹת

**is that every entity is comprised of matter and *tzurah*, body and
soul, vessel and light, outer aspect and inner aspect,**

וּמִתְנַהֵּג הַחִיצוֹנִיּוֹת ע"י הַפְּנִימִיּוֹת שָׁבוּ

and that the outer aspect is directed by its inner aspect.

וְאוֹתָהּ הַפְּנִימִיּוֹת שֶׁהוּא הָאוֹר וְנִשְׁמָה עוֹמֵד עֲקָרָה לְמַעְלָה

**And that same inner aspect, which is its light and soul exists
primarily above,**

וְרַק הַקְּצָה הַתַּחְתּוֹן שֶׁלָּהּ הוּא אֲשֶׁר מִתְפַּשֵּׁט לְמַטָּה וְיוֹרֵד וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ
בְּתוֹךְ הַגּוֹף לְנִשְׁמָה שָׁבוּ

and only its lowest extremity extends down below and descends to become clothed in the body the physical aspect of any existing entity¹⁶ as the soul within.

וְדֶרֶךְ אוֹתָהּ הַקֶּצֶה הַתַּחְתּוֹן הִנֵּה שׁוֹאֵב הַגּוֹף חַיּוּתוֹ וְכָל כֹּחַ קִיּוּמוֹ
מִלְמַעְלָה כָּל עֵת מְצִיאוֹתוֹ הַנִּגָּזר עָלָיו

It is by way of this lowest extremity of the *tzurah* that the body draws its life and the power of its continued existence¹⁷ from above, for as long as its existence is decreed.

וְאוֹתָהּ הַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁהוּא הַצּוּרָה הָעֶקְרִית דֹּכָל מְצִיאוֹת אֲשֶׁר עוֹמֵד
לְמַעְלָה

That soul, which is the primary *tzurah* of all existence, stands above

הִנֵּה הוּא פּוֹעֵל בְּהַמְצִיאוֹת תָּמִיד וְאֵינוֹ מְנִיחָה רִגַע אַחַת בְּלֹא
פְּעֻלָּה

and acts upon that existence continuously, not letting up acting upon it for a single moment.

וְכָל פְּעֻלָּתוֹ בָּהּ הוּא כְּדֵי לְתַקֵּן חֲמִרְיוֹתָהּ לְמַטָּה

And its entire effect on it on the world below is for the purpose of rectifying its corporeality below

וּלְהַחְזִירָה אֵלָיו לְבִסּוּף לְהִתְאַחַד עִמּוֹ לְנֶצַח

and then return it the corporeal element to itself the *tzurah* in the end to be united with it forever.

כִּי קֹדֶם שֶׁיִּרְדֶּה חֲמֵר דְּהַמְצִיאוֹת לְמַטָּה הָיְתָה גַם הִיא עִם
הַפְּנִימִיּוֹת לְמַעְלָה כְּלוּלָה עִמּוֹ

Because before the corporeal aspect of existence descended below, it was together with the inner aspect above and was integrated with it with the inner aspect

אֲלָא שְׁכָלִילוּתָהּ בּוֹ אֲשֶׁר מִתְחִלָּה הָיָה רַק בְּכַח לְבַד

However, that integration with it with the inner dimension, **was initially only in potential** since actual corporeality does not exist above,

וּלְכֹן הוֹרִידָה לַמַּטֶּה כְּדִי לְהוֹצִיא אֶת מְצִיאוּתָהּ וּתְכוּנָתָה מֵהַכֹּחַ
אֶל הַפּוֹעַל

and therefore He lowered it the corporeal aspect **to down below in order to bring it into actual existence and** reveal its nature **from a state of potential to actual.**

וְאַחֵר שֶׁנִּשְׁלְמָה בַּכ"ז הִנֵּה מַחְזִירָה אֵלָיו לְהִתְתַּקֵּן עִמּוֹ וּלְהַשִּׁיג אֶת
תְּכֵלֶת מְצִיאוּתָהּ

Once all this is completed, then the *tzurah* **brings it** the corporeal body **back to him** to the soul **to be rectified together with him** the soul **and to achieve the ultimate purpose of its existence**

אֲשֶׁר לָזֶה נִמְצָאת שֶׁהוּא לְהַעֲלוֹתָהּ מֵעֲלוּי לְעֲלוּי עַד אֵין סוּף
וְתְכֵלֶת

for which it the body **was brought out** into existence from higher spiritual dimensions – **which is to elevate it from one lofty level to the next without limitation or constraint.**

כִּי זְכוּת וְעֲלוּי וְתִקּוּן גָּדוֹל הוּא לְהַנְשָׂמָה בְּאֲשֶׁר מִתְתַּקֵּן¹⁸ הַגּוּף עַל
יָדוֹ

For it is a great merit, and a spiritual elevation and rectification for the soul when the body becomes rectified by it.

כִּי שְׁנֵיהֶם לֹא נִבְרְאוּ אֲלָא רַק לְתְכֵלֶת זֶה שֶׁתִּקּוּן הַגּוּף ע"י הַנְּשָׂמָה
שֶׁבּוֹ

For both of them, body and soul, were created for no other purpose than this exclusively – that the body would be rectified by the soul within it.

וְהוּא עָלוּי גָדוֹל לְהִנָּשֵׁם ג"כ בְּאֲשֶׁר שְׁמִשְׁלִים אֶת פְּעֻלָּתוֹ אֲשֶׁר
שׁוֹלַח לָזֶה

And this is a great boost for the soul as well when it completes its task for which it was sent down to become fused with the body in this world.

וְעִי"ז הֵנָּה הֵם עוֹלִים שְׁנִיָּהּ בְּעָלוּי רַב לְהִתְעַנֵּג וּלְהִתְעַדָּן בְּאוֹר
פְּנֵי עֲצָמוֹ ית"ש

It is through this *tikkun* that both of them soul and body ascend to the heights to delight in and become refined in the very light of His countenance, may His Name be blessed,

וּלְהִדְבֵּק וּלְהִתְיַחַד בְּאוֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ בְּתַכְלִית תְּקוּן הָאֲחֵרוֹן

and to cleave to and be united with the light of His holiness with the completion of the final *tikkun*

כְּכוֹנֵנָתוֹ ית"ש בְּכָל בְּרִיאַת עוֹלָמוֹ.

as was God's intention in creating His world.

וְהָרִי נִתְבָּאֵר לָנוּ עַכ"פ כִּי כָּל נִשְׁמָה וְצוּרָה עֲקָרָה הִיא לְמַעְלָה

At minimum, we have clarified for ourselves that every soul and *tzurah* resides primarily above,

וְרַק הַקְּצָה הַתַּחְתּוֹן שֶׁלָּהּ הוּא אֲשֶׁר מִתְפַּשֵּׁט לְמַטָּה בְּתוֹךְ הַגּוּף
וְהַחֲמֵר

and only their lowest extremity extends down below into a body and matter.

וְעַל יְדֵה מִתְתַּקֵּן וְנִעְשָׂה כָּל הַתְּקוּנִים כָּלָם

And by this means the soul or *tzurah* descending below to elevate the body all of the rectifications are achieved.

וְכֵן נִתְבָּאֵר מִמִּילָא מִדְּבָרֵינוּ ג"כ שְׁכָל עוֹלָם תַּחְתּוֹן לְגַבִּי עֲלִיוֹן הֵנָּה
הוּא רַק כְּמַר מִדְּלִי נִגְדוּ

In addition, from what we have said it is self-evident that every lower world, compared to the higher world, is merely like a drop in a bucket,

שֶׁהָרִי כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת דֵּה־תַּחְתּוֹן הֵנָּה הוּא רַק מָה שֶׁהִיָּה כְּלוּל
בְּתַחֲלָה בְּכֵחַ דֵּה־עֲלִיוֹן

since the existence of the lower world was initially included in potential in the upper world from which it derives.

וְכָל מְצִיאוֹתָיו וִיצִיאָתוֹ לַפֶּעַל הוּא ג"כ רַק מִשְׁפַּעַת דְּאוֹר הָעֲלִיוֹן
אֲשֶׁר מִשְׁפִּיעַ בּוֹ תָּמִיד וְכָכָל הַנֶּ"ל

And its entire existence of the lower world and its emergence into reality is also only by virtue of the outflow of light from the upper world which flows into it continuously, as was all explained above.

וּא"כ הָרִי נִמְצָא שְׁכָל תַּחְתּוֹן לְגַבִּי עֲלִיוֹן הֵנָּה הוּא רַק כֵּחַ וְהֶאֱרָה
וְשָׁפַע מִמֶּנּוּ לְבַד

Being that this is so, it turns out that every lower world compared with a higher one is merely a manifestation of the power and radiance and outflow from it from the higher world.

וְהוּא אֵינוֹ עוֹמֵד לְעַצְמוֹ כְּלָל אֶלָּא שֶׁהוּא קָשׁוּר לְמַעַלָּה וְתָלוּי בּוֹ
לְעוֹלָם:

And it does not exist independently at all; instead it is bound up above and always depends on the world above.

Footnotes

1. As noted in the previous chapter, 'form' is more than just the shape of something; a thing's 'form' is its essence or definition — what it is. Human form, for example, is what it

is to be a human being. 'Matter,' on the other hand, is simply what it is made of. We will use the term *tzurah* for 'form' throughout. [↩](#)

2. Makover. [↩](#)

3. See Palms 91:1– יֵשֵׁב בְּסִתָּר עָלָיוֹן [↩](#)

4. Makover. [↩](#)

5. A more literal translation: "it does not receive any addition or withdrawal from him." [↩](#)

6. 'Generally and specifically' refers to the worlds, as will become clear shortly. In other words, 'to the worlds in general, and to specific worlds, each according to its particular intention.' [↩](#)

7. Since Creation came about *yesh mi-ayin (ex nihilo)*, the creative force which brings it into existence must constantly recreate it in order for it to exist. If this force would be withdrawn for even a moment, creation would revert to absolute nothingness. See *Sha'ar HaYichud v'haEmunah* chap. 2. [↩](#)

8. *Nefesh* here is meant in terms of the spiritual life-force of existence. [↩](#)

9. *Meir haLeshem*. [↩](#)

10. *Sefer HaDe'ah* is an abbreviation of *Drushei Olam HaTohu*, an important section of his magnum opus titled *Leshem Sh'vo v'achlama*. [↩](#)

11. See Psalms 66:5. [↩](#)

12. See Psalms 46:9. [↩](#)

13. Cf. *Kohelet* (Ecclesiastes) 3:11 [↩](#)

14. Cf. *Mishlei* (Proverbs) 16:15 [↩](#)
15. See Rambam *Yesodei Hatorah* 4:1, 3 – All material things eventually revert to the four elements from which they are composed, fire, air, water, earth... [↩](#)
16. According to the Arizal, even inanimate objects have a 'soul' and spiritual life-force. See *Etz Chayim, Shaar* 50 (ch. 2, 10). [↩](#)
17. Alternatively: "its ability to exist." [↩](#)
18. In modern Hebrew the *hitpa'el* form is **הִתְקַדַּח** – it is rectified. [↩](#)

G A T E

*Shaar 3 — Five levels of form: nefesh,
ruakh, neshama, chaya, yehida (narnhai)*

Chapter 1 — The worlds of bia (briah, yetsirah, asiya), their nature and expression in man.

Shaar 3 Chapter 1

וּמַעֲתָה נֶאֱמַר עוֹד כִּי הִנֵּה כָּלֵל הַמְּצִיאוֹת הוּא נִחְלָק לִג' מַדְרָגוֹת

Now it can further be stated that all of existence is divided into three levels

וְהֵם נִבְרָאִים נּוֹצְרִים נַעֲשִׂים

which are: those aspects that are created; those that are formed; those that are made

וְנִקְרָאִים בְּשֵׁם ג' עוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיָּאָה יִצִּירָה עֲשִׂיָּה

and they are called three Worlds – *Beriah, Yetzirah, Asiyah*.

כִּי כ"א הוּא עוֹלָם מָלֵא מִכָּל כְּלָלִי וּפְרָטִי הַמְּצִיאוֹת כָּלֵם

For each of them is a world filled with all types of general and specific existence.

אֲלָא שְׁבִזָּה הֵם בְּבַחִי' נִבְרָאִים וְהוּא חֲדוּשׁ הָעֶצֶם דְּכָל מְצִיאוֹת

However, in this world (*Beriah*) they are *created*, meaning the initiation of the ethereal substance¹ of all existence

אֲשֶׁר שֵׁם יֵצֵאוּ וְנִבְרָאוּ יֵשׁ מֵאִין

which emerges there as created being from nothing i.e. *ex nihilo*.

וּבִזָּה הֵם בְּבַחִי' נּוֹצְרִים שֶׁשֵׁם יֵצֵא כ"א בְּצוּרָתוֹ וְצִיּוּרוֹ הַכְּמוֹת וְהַגְּבוּלִי

Whereas in this other world, the World of *Yetzirah*, they are *formed*, for it is there that each of them emerges in its form, in

a quantitative and limited configuration.

משא"כ [מָה שְׁאִין כֹּן] הַנִּבְרָאִים אֵין גְּלוּי לָהֶם לַמָּטָה צוּרָתָם
הַכְּמוּתִית² כָּלֵל

This is not the case with the merely created beings of the World of *Beriah* – they are not revealed below in a quantitative form at all;

וְנִבְחָנִים רַק עַל הָאֵיכוֹת שֶׁבָּהֶם לְבַד

they are discerned only by qualitative differences among them.

וּבִזְהָ הֵם בִּבְחִי' נֶעֱשִׂים שֵׁשׁם נִגְמַר חֲמִרְיֹתָם הֵן בְּהֶעָצֶם וְהֵן
בְּהַצִּיּוֹר

And in this next World, the World of *Asiyah*, they are *made*; their corporeal aspect is completed there in both substance and form.

משא"כ בְּהַיְצִירָה וּמַכְש"כ [וּמַכָּל שְׂכֹן] בְּהַבְרִיָּאָה לֹא יֵרָדוּ עַד־יֵן
לְהַחֲמֹר הָעֵקָרִי וְהַמְּמָשִׁי כָּלֵל

This is not the case in the World of *Yetzirah*, and all the more so in the World of *Beriah*, where they have not yet descended into base materiality and tangible substance at all.

אֲךָ עַכ"פּ הוּא כִּי כ"א לִפִּי בְּחִינָתוֹ הוּא עוֹלָם מָלֵא מְכַל כָּלְלִי וּפְרָטִי
הַמְּצִיאוֹת כָּלֵם

Nevertheless, each World according to its attributes is a complete World comprising all the general and specific aspects of existence as manifested on that plane of reality.

שֶׁכָּל מָה שֶׁיִּשְׁנֹנוּ בִּזְהָ יִשְׁנֹנוּ בִּזְהָ וְנִחָתָם כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן בְּכָל פְּרָטִי
הַמְּצִיאוֹת שֶׁבּוֹ מְהַעֲלִיּוֹן שֶׁעָלִיו

For whatever is in this lower World is also in that higher World,³ and the lower level World, in all its details, is stamped with the impression⁴ of the higher World above it.

שֶׁהַעֲלִיּוֹן עִם הַתַּחְתּוֹן הֵם כְּחוֹתֶם וְנֶחֱתֶם

For the higher and lower Worlds are as signet-ring is to seal,

שֶׁכָּל מָה שִׁישׁ בַּהֲחוֹתֶם מֵעֲתִיקוֹ בִּהְנַחֲתֶם וְכָל מָה שֶׁבִּהְנַחֲתֶם
הוא רק מהחותם

so that whatever contours there are in the signet-ring is copied onto the wax seal, and whatever there is in the wax seal is exclusively from the signet-ring.

אֲלָא שֶׁכָּל מִי שֶׁהוא יוֹתֵר עֲלִיּוֹן הֵנָּה נִתְעַלָּה כָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת שָׁבוּ
בְּמַדְרָגָה יוֹתֵר נְעֻלָּה

Albeit that the existential character of the higher level is superior to,

וְיוֹתֵר זָךְ הוּא בְּחֻמְרוֹ וְהוּא בְּצוּרָתוֹ הַרְבֵּה מְאֹד מֵאוֹתוֹ שֶׁלִּמְטָה הַיָּמִינוּ.

and is much more refined in substance and form, than the one below it.

וְהֵנָּה כָּל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם בְּכָלְלוֹ הוּא בְּתִכּוּנֵת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם

Now each of the Worlds in a general sense displays the format of human stature,⁵ called a *partzuf*,

שֶׁכָּל מָה שִׁישְׁנוּ בְּאָדָם יִשְׁנוּ בְּעוֹלָם וְכָל מָה שֶׁבִּהְעֵלָם הוּא בְּאָדָם

so that everything all the human characteristics that man has is also in the World, and everything in the World is also in man.

וְאִין בִּזְזָה אֲלָא מָה שֶׁבִּזְזָה וְכַמ"ש בְּאֲבוֹת דִּר' נָתָן פ' ל"א וְכֵן הָרַמְבַּ"ם
בְּמוֹרָה ח"א פ' ע"ב

And there is nothing in either man or the World that is not in the other, as stated in *Avot d'Rabbi Natan* chapter 31⁶ and also in Rambam's *Moreh Nevuchin* part 1, chapter 72.

וְכִנּוּדָּע שְׁלִזָּה נִקְרָא הָאָדָם עוֹלָם קָטָן וְכוּ נִקְרָא ג"כ כָּל עוֹלָם בְּשֵׁם אָדָם

As is known, it is for this reason that man is called a *microcosm*⁷ and each World is called 'man' – *Adam*.

וְהֵם אָדָם דְּבְרִיָּאָה אָדָם דִּיצִירָה אָדָם דְּעִשְׂיָה

They are: *Adam of Beriah, Adam of Yetzirah, Adam of Asiyah*.

כִּי כ"א הוּא קוּמָה שְׁלֵמָה מִתְכַּנֵּת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם שְׁלֵם מִמָּשׁ.

For each of them of the three Worlds is a complete structure in the format of a complete human *partzuf*, as will be explained.

וְהִנֵּה ע"ד שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ בְּהַמְצִיאוֹת בְּכָל־ל שֶׁהוּא נִחְלָק לִג' מַדְרָגוֹת

Now similar to what we said about existence in general – that it is divided into three levels –

שֶׁהֵם הִג' עוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיָּאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה

which are the Worlds of *Beriah, Yetzirah, Asiyah* –

הִנֵּה עַד"ז הוּא ג"כ בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְעוֹלָם בִּפְרָט.

similarly, each world individually can be subdivided into three categories.

כִּי כָל עוֹלָם הִרִי הוּא בְּתִכּוּנַת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם כְּנִז'

Because each world is in the format of a human *partzuf*, as mentioned.

וְכָל פְּרָצוּף אָדָם הִנֵּה הוּא נִחְלָק לִג' בְּחִי' שֶׁהֵם ג' מַדְרָגוֹת הוּן בְּאֶרֶךְ וְהוּן בְּעָבִי

Now the human form is divided into three aspects, which represent three levels, both vertically and horizontally:

בְּאֶרֶךְ הוּא רֹאשׁ גּוּיָה בֶטֶן

Along the vertical axis these are the head, the torso and the abdomen.

וּבְעֵבִי הוּא בָּשָׂר גִּדִּין עֲצָמוֹת

On the horizontal plane they are flesh, *gidin*,⁸ bones

וְהֵם ג' חֲלָקֵי הַגּוּף שֶׁהֵם חִיצוֹן תִּיכוֹן פְּנִימִי

corresponding to three sections of the body – outer, middle, inner.

וְהֵם ג' בְּחִי' כ"א בְּמִדְרָגָה בַּפִּנ"ע [בְּפָנֵי עֲצָמוֹן]

They are three aspects, each of which is a level on its own,

כִּי בָּהֶם שׁוֹכְנִים הַג' חֲלָקֵי צוּרָה הַיְדוּעִים שֶׁהֵם נֶפֶשׁ רוּחַ נְשָׁמָה

and in each of them resides one of the three well-known aspects of the *tzurah* – *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*.

כִּי הַנֶּפֶשׁ הִיא שְׂרוּיָה בְּהַבָּשָׂר שֶׁהוּא הַחֶלֶק הַחִיצוֹן שֶׁל הַגּוּף

***Nefesh* resides in the flesh and is the outer layer of the body.**

וְעָקֹר מִשְׁכָּנָהּ וּמְקוֹמָהּ אֲשֶׁר מִשָּׁם הִיא מֵתַפְשֶׁטֶת וּמַחֲיָה אֶת כָּל הַגּוּף הוּא בְּהַכֶּבֶד

It's primary 'seat' and location – from which it spreads out to give life to the entire body – is the liver.²

שֶׁהוּא הַתְּחִלַּת הַמַּעֲיִם וְהַבֶּטֶן חֶלֶק הַתְּחִתּוֹן דֶּה־גּוּף

The liver is located in the area from the beginning of the intestines and the abdomen, the bottom part of the body, i.e. the lower half of the torso.

ור"ל כי עקר עצמות אור הנפש הוא באמת ג"כ רק בלב אך גליון
[הוא בכבד. ע' דברינו שער טנת"א פ"ה אות ס"ג ושם פ"ו אות ב

[i.e. the primary essence of the light of the soul is truly only in
the heart, but its revelation is in the liver. See our *Shaar Tant"a*
chapter 5, subsection 63; ibid. chapter 6 subsection 2].¹⁰

והרוח הוא שרוי בהגדין שהוא החלק התיכון והאמצעי שבגוף
ועקר משכנו ומקומו הוא בלב

The level of *Ruach* resides in the *gidin*, the intermediate
(horizontally) and middle part (vertically) of the body, and its
primary residence and place is the heart,

שהוא הנקרא בספר יצירה בשם גויה משום שהוא עקר מציאת
האדם.

which is called 'torso' in *Sefer Yetzirah* as it is the primary
organ necessary for a person to exist.

והנשמה היא שרויה בעצמות ר"ל במח שבהעצמות

The level called *neshama* resides in the bones, that is, in the
marrow of the bones.¹¹

והוא מ"ש כל עצמותי תאמרנה והוא החלק הפנימי שבהגוף

And this is the significance of the verse "all my bones
declare..."¹² and this is the inner aspect of the body.

ועקר משכנה ומקומה הוא בהמוח שבראש שהוא החלק העליון
שבהגוף.

The primary residence of the *neshama* is in the brain in the
head, the topmost part of the body.

והנה אלו הג' מדרגות שהם ראש, גויה, בטן שבארץ אשר סימנם
הוא מל"ך [מח לב כבד]

The initial letters of these three – the head, the torso and the abdomen along the vertical axis – form the word *melech* meaning 'king.'

The initial letters of the central organs of the head, torso and abdomen (i.e. *mo'ach*, the brain; *lev* the heart; *caveid* the liver) are *mem*, *lamed*, *caf* – *melech* – king, for each is a 'king' in its domain.

וְכֵן פְּנִימִי תִיכוֹן חִיצוֹן שֶׁבְּעֵבְיוֹ אֲשֶׁר סִימָנָם הוּא פֶת"ח עִם הַנֶּר"נ
שֶׁבָהֶם

Similarly inner, middle, outer on the horizontal plane form the word *petach* 'opening' together with the *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neslama* within them.

The initial letters of *pnimi* (inner), *tichon* (middle), *chitzon* (outer) form the word *petach* – 'opening.' (Note that vowels in Hebrew are not signified by letters, but rather by vowel points, so they can be ignored when emphasizing the initial letters). The implication seems to be that these form the opening to a spiritual path inwards.

הִנֵּה הֵם הִג' בְּחִי דְבָרִיָּאָה יִצִּירָה עֲשֵׂיָהּ אֲשֶׁר הֵם בְּכָל פֶּרְצוּף
וּפְרָצוּף

These correspond to *Beriah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*, which are in each and every *partzuf*.

Each *partzuf* can be subdivided into these three levels *Beriah*, *Yetzirah*, *Asiyah*, corresponding to the brain, heart and liver, as will be explained.

כִּי הַנִּשְׁמָה וְהַמַּח עִם הַחֶלֶק הַפְּנִימִי שֶׁבְּהִגּוּף הוּא בְּחִי בְרִיָּאָה
שֶׁבְּכָל פֶּרְצוּף

The *neslama* and brain are part of the inner aspect of the body, corresponding to *Beriah* in each *partzuf*.

וְהוּא מ"ש רז"ל [רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זְכוֹרֵנוֹם לְבָרְכָהּ] יוֹמָא (פֶּה, א) מְהִיכֹן
הַנֶּלֶד נּוֹצֵר מֵרֹאשׁוֹ כו'

This is what our rabbis of blessed memory were referring to in the Talmud, Tractate *Yoma* (85a): "From where does a fetus develop? From its head..."¹³

אבא שאול אומר מטבורו ומשליח שרשיו אילך ואילך

One of the Talmudic Sages, Abba Shaul, said that development begins from the navel i.e. from where the embryo is attached to the placenta, which sends out its 'roots' this way and that.¹⁴

ואמרו שם עד כאן לא קאמר אבא שאול אלא לעננו יצירה כו'

The following is a discussion regarding the extent to which one is obligated to check whether a person buried under rubble is still alive, if at first glance he appears to be dead. One opinion states that one need only check his nostrils to see if he is breathing. Another opinion maintains that one must check the person's heartbeat.

Now the rabbis there opined that Abba Shaul's expressed his view only as regards the formation and development of the embryo

אבל לעננו פקוח נפש אפי' אבא שאול מודה דעקר חיותיה באפיה

But as regards a danger to life, even Abba Shaul agrees that life is discerned primarily by the breath in the nostrils.

For a complete discussion see Babylonian Talmud, Tractate *Yoma* page 85a.

וע' בתוספת שם שהקשו כי בנדה כ"ה א' אמר אבא שאול ג"כ כי תחלת בריתו מראשו ואומר רבנו תם שם כי בנדה צ"ל כרשון וכן הוא בערוך ע"ש אמן בתוספתא נדה פ"ו כתוב שם ג"כ כמו הגרסא שלפנינו אך במדרש ויקרא רבה פ' י"ד סימן ח' שם איתא¹⁵ [בגרסת ר"ת וקערוך]

אך באמת הנה אלו ואלו הם דברי א"ח [אלקים חיים]

But in truth both views are the word of the living God.

In Talmudic law, when there are two or more opinions regarding a law (*halacha*), only one opinion can be followed practically. Yet both opinions are regarded as the word of God, as long as they are both valid interpretations of Scripture. In Kabbalistic literature, two (or more) opinions can be accepted as valid, as in the following case, where one view applies in the World of *Beriah*, another in the World of *Yetzirah*, and a third in the World of *Asiyah*:

כי בבחי' הבריאה של הולד שהוא התחלת מציאותו ויציאתו אשר מאין ליש

Because in terms of the aspect of *Beriah* (corresponding to creation *ex nihilo*) of the fetus – the beginning of its existence and its emergence from nothing into existence –

הנה ראשיתו מראשו דהוא מהמח שבו כי משם הוא שרש החיות

the beginning of its development starts from the head, which is the brain, for there is the root i.e. origin of its life.

More specifically, this beginning point is *chochmah*, and it is therefore called the 'beginning' as in the verse – ראשית חכמה – 'יראת ה' (Psalms 111:10). And it emerges from nothing, as the verse in Job 28:12 states והחכמה מאין תמצא.

ושם הוא ראשית העצם ונקדתו הפנימית אשר משם נמשך ההתהוות של הולד

and there is the beginning of its essence and its inner point of existence, from which the coming into being of the fetus is drawn down.

והוא מה שאמרו כי לענין חיותיה גם אבא שאול מודה ששם הוא שרשו בעצם

As the Sages said in the excerpt from the Talmud cited above: even Abba Shaul acknowledges that there the head and brain is the essential root-source of the rest of the embryo.

אך זהו רק בבחי' האיכות שבו שהוא בחי' הבריאה שבו

However, this is only in a qualitative sense, which is its aspect of *Beriah* – creation from nothing.

אבל בבחי' היצירה של הולד שהוא מציאותו בכמות

But the aspect of *Yetzirah* of the fetus, which is its existence in quantitative terms –

הנה בזה נעשה ההתחלה מהחלק האמצעי שבגוף והוא מ"ש מטבור

in this aspect the beginning is from the middle part of the body, from the navel –

ור"ל מטבור הלב עד טבור הגוף ששם הוא החלק האמצעי שבגוף

meaning, from the 'navel of the heart' (the intention here seems to be the aorta)¹⁶ to the navel of the body, which is located in the center of the body

וכמו שאמרו שם דכל מדי ממציעתה מיתצר

as our Sages state there¹⁷ 'everything forms around its center.'

ומתחיל מציאותו אשר בבחי' יצירה

In terms of the aspect of formation in *Yetzirah* its existence begins there.

מהרום והלב שהוא החלק האמצעי שבגוף ומשלם שרשיו אילך ואילך

From the level of *ruach* and the heart, which is the middle part of the body, sending its roots out this way and that – the arteries extending from the heart branch out into all areas of the body.

As noted earlier in this chapter, the primary 'residence' of *ruach* is in the heart.

כִּי הָרוּחַ וְהַלֵּב שֶׁהוּא בְּאֶמְצַע הוּא בְּחִי' הַיְצִירָה שֶׁבְּהַפְרָצוֹף וְהוּא
הַגּוּיָה

for the *ruach* and the heart are centrally located and correspond to *Yetzirah* of the *partzuf*, which is the torso in terms of the body.

וּמִצִּיאֹתוֹ הוּא מִטְבוֹר הַלֵּב עַד טְבוֹר הַגּוֹף

And it ranges from the 'navel of the heart' – again, possibly the aorta – to the navel of the body.

וְהוּא כָּל חֵלֶק הַגּוֹף אֲשֶׁר לְפָנִים מִן הַפְּרָסָא הַמִּפְסִיק בֵּין הַלֵּב
וְהַרְיָאָה לְבִין הַכֶּבֶד וְהַמַּעֲיִם

It's that section of the body that spans the area from above the diaphragm separating the heart and lungs from the liver and intestines, ¹⁸ to the top of the chest.

וּכ"ז הוּא בְּחִי' הַיְצִירָה שֶׁבְּגוֹף.

All of this is the *Yetzirah* aspect of the body.

אֲךְ הַנֶּפֶשׁ עִם הַכֶּבֶד וְכָל חֵלֶק הַחִיצוֹן וְהַתְּחִתּוֹן שֶׁבְּגוֹף הוּא בְּחִי'
עֲשִׂיָּה שֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוֹף

However, the *nefesh* and its corresponding organ, the liver, and the entire outer layer of the lower body, is the aspect of *Asiyah* of every *partzuf*.

כִּי שֵׁם נִגְמַר תְּקוּנוֹ בְּכָל עֲבוּיָתוֹ וְחִמְרִיּוֹתוֹ הַנִּצָּרָךְ אֵלָיו לְקִיּוּמוֹ
בַּעוֹרָה"ז [בְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה].

It is there that its – the body's – construction is completed in all of the coarseness and corporeality needed for its continued survival in this physical world.

וְכֵן הִנֵּה יוֹשְׁנֵם עַד"ז [עַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה] כָּל אֱלֹהֵי הַג' בְּחִי וּמַדְרֵגוֹת בְּכָל
עוֹלָם וָעוֹלָם ג"כ

There are similar parallels to all of these aspects and levels mentioned above in all of the Worlds as well.

These comparisons apply not only to the various aspects of the human form, but also to the metaphysical Worlds themselves as well.

כִּי אֵין בְּרִיאַת וַיְצִירַת וַעֲשִׂית הָאָדָם אֶלָּא רַק מֵאוֹתוֹן הַבְּחִי אֲשֶׁר
יֹשְׁנֵם בְּהַעֲלָם

For the aspects of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* in man are only derivatives of those aspects that exist as concealed planes of reality, the Worlds,

וכמ"ש בְּאַבוֹת דֶּר' נָתָן פ' ל"א וְכַנִּז'

as is written in *Avot d'Rabbi Natan* chapter 31, as mentioned above.

וְהֵם הַג' מַדְרֵגוֹת שֶׁבְּעֶשֶׂר סְפִי אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל עוֹלָם שֶׁהֵם כח"ב חג"ת)
(נְהִי"מ כְּנוֹדַע

(And these are the three levels among the ten *sefirot* i.e. three groups of the *sefirot*, corresponding to¹⁹ *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh*, in each of the Worlds – *keter-chochmah-binah*; *chesed-gevurah-tiferet*; *netzach-hod-yesod-malchut*, as is known).

וְנִמְצָא כִּי אֱלֹהֵי הַג' מַדְרֵגוֹת דְּבְרִיאָה וַיְצִירָה וַעֲשִׂיָּה הֵנָּה הֵם יוֹשְׁנֵם הֵן
בְּפִרְטוֹת שֶׁהוּא בְּכָל אָדָם בְּפִרְט

It thus becomes apparent that these three levels – *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* – are manifested in specific instances, in each person individually,

וְהֵן בְּכָל־לִוּוֹת שֶׁהוּא בְּכָל עוֹלָם וָעוֹלָם בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ [בְּפָנֵי עַצְמוֹ]

as well as generally, in each of the worlds separately,

וְהוּן בְּכָלֵי כְּלָלוֹת שֶׁהֵם הֵג' עוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

and also in a universal sense – the three Worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* in general.

כִּי בְּכָלֵי כְּלָלוֹת הֵיוּ כָּל הֵג' עוֹלָמוֹת יַחַד ג"כ רַק כְּלָלוֹת פְּרָצוֹף
אָדָם אֶחָד

In this universal sense, all three Worlds together also form a single *partzuf* in the format of an individual human.

The reference here appears to be to the World of *Atzilut*.^{[20](#)}

וְכֵן הוּא כָּל עוֹלָם בַּפֶּנ"ע הֵנָּה כ"א בְּחִי' קוֹמַת פְּרָצוֹף אָדָם בְּכָל
תְּכוּנוֹתָיו כְּנִז'.

And so too in every World individually: each one is designed according to the stature of man with all of his characteristics, as mentioned above.

וְהָרִי נִבְחָן בְּחִי' בְּרִיאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה בְּכָל עוֹלָם גּוֹפָה וְכֵן בְּכָל אָדָם
גּוֹפָה

Thus the aspects of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* have been identified in each of the worlds, as well as in each person himself.

וְכָבֵר אֲמַרְנוּ כִּי אֵלֵינוּ הֵג' מַדְרָגוֹת שֶׁבְּאָדָם הֵנָּה הֵם הַנְּשָׁמָה רוּחַ
נֶפֶשׁ שָׁבוּ

We already stated that these three levels in man are the *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* within him.

וְכֵן הֵם ג"כ בְּחִי' הַנֶּר"נ שֶׁבְּכָל עוֹלָם גּוֹפָה

And so too are there *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* within each world individually,

וְכֵן הוּא בְּכָלֵי כְּלָלוֹת

And so too in a universal sense –

כי עולם הבריאה הוא בבחי' נשמה ועולם היצירה הוא רוח ועולם
העשיה הוא נפש

the World of *Beriah* is primarily the aspect of *neshama*, the
World of *Yetzirah* is primarily *ruach* and *Asiyah* is primarily
nefesh,

הגם שיש נר"נ בכ"א מהם עצמו ג"כ

even though there is also *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* i.e. all
three aspects within each of these Worlds themselves.

אמנם בהערך כלל כל עולם זה כנגד זה

Nevertheless, when comparing one world to another in a
general sense,

הנה נבחן כ"א לגבי חברו רק בבחי' מדרגה אחת לבד

each World is distinguished from the others as manifesting
only a single level:

כי כלל כל עולם העשיה בלה שהיא התחתונה והחיצונה לכלם

For example: the entire World of *Asiyah*, which is the lowest
and most external of all the Worlds,

הנה נבחן כל הג' חלקי הנר"נ שבה כלם רק בבחי' נפש לבד

all three levels of *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* in it are all only
nefesh,

כי הם רק הנר"נ שבהנפש גופה והיא בלה רק הנפש הכללי

since they are *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* of the *nefesh* itself,
which in its entirety is the general category of *nefesh* only.

וכל עולם היצירה בכלל שהוא האמצעי לכלם הוא בלו בחי' רוח

Similarly, the entire World of *Yetzirah*, the intermediate layer of all three, in its entirety is the aspect of *ruach*.

והנר"נ שבו הם רק הנר"נ שבהרוח הכללי

And its *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* levels are *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* in the general category of *ruach*.

וכל עולם הבריאה בכלל שהוא העליון והפנימי לכלם

So too, the entire World of *Beriah*, which is the highest and most inward of all the three Worlds,

הנה הנר"נ שבו כלן בבחי' נשמה והם הנר"נ שבהנשמה הכללי

its *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* levels are *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* in the general category of *neshama*.

כי כ"א הוא כלול מכל הבחי' וישנם בכ"א כללים ופרטים ופרטי פרטים עד אין חקר

Each of them the Worlds includes all of them, and in each of them comprise general categories and specific details and details of details to an unfathomable degree,

וכמו שיתבאר עוד בעה"י לקמן בדברינו:

as we will explain in the paragraphs ahead, God willing.

Footnotes

1. Although the word used here is עצם, which can also have the meaning of "essence," in this context it means 'stuff' or substance, indicating the emergence of being *ex nihilo*. See Ramban Genesis 1:1: ואין אצלנו בלשון הקדש בהוצאת היש ... אבל הוציא מן האפס הגמור מאין אלא לשון "ברא" ... אבל הוא כוח ממציא, המוחלט יסוד דק מאד, אין בו ממש, אבל הוא כוח ממציא, ... מוכן לקבל הצורה ולצאת מן הכוח אל הפועל [↩](#)

2. in the original. Emended according to *Meir HaLeshem* [↩](#)
3. Perhaps we can describe this using a hologram as a paradigm. [↩](#)
4. 'Impression' here is meant in the sense of a signet ring used to stamp a unique seal in wax that reveals all the contours of the signet ring. Perhaps encryption would be a good modern example. [↩](#)
5. Although the word *partzuf* is generally used for facial features, in this context it refers to the entire human stature. See *Meir HaLeshem*. [↩](#)
6. "Rabbi Eliezer, the son of Rabbi Yose HaGalili, taught: everything that the blessed Holy One created in His universe, He also created in man." The text lists quite a number of such parallels. [↩](#)
7. *Tikunei Zohar* 116b. [↩](#)
8. The regular translation of גידין is 'tendons.' However, in *Etz Chaim* (41:1) we see that גידין includes tendons (called גידין הלבנים), arteries (גידין הדופקים) and veins (גידין בלתי דופקים). [↩](#)
9. See *Zohar* II p. 76a; *Etz Chaim* (9:2). [↩](#)
10. In this parenthetical note the Baal HaLeshem offers a resolution to an apparent contradiction in *Etz Chaim* regarding the primary seat of *nefesh* – whether it is in the heart or the liver. The solution is that both are correct: its primary abode is in the heart, but its revelation is in the liver. [↩](#)
11. See *Etz Chaim* (26:1). [↩](#)
12. [↩](#) כל עצמותי תאמרנה יהוה מי כמוך – Psalms 35:10

13. This is confirmed by medical science. The embryo's brain and spinal cord begin to develop in the fifth week of pregnancy, before most other internal organs, and long before the limbs. ↩
14. The placenta first starts to form soon after the egg has been fertilized. Later the placenta forms tiny hair-like projections (villi) that extend into the wall of the uterus. Blood vessels from the embryo, which pass through the umbilical cord to the placenta, develop in the villi. ↩
15. This parenthetical remark presents an abstruse comparison of various sources in an attempt to clarify Abba Saul's view of this matter and what he actually said. We have left it untranslated as it is not germane at all to our discussion. ↩
16. The aorta is the main and largest artery in the human body, originating from the left ventricle of the heart and extending down to the abdomen, where it splits into two smaller arteries. It seems that just as the navel is the source from which the embryo receives all its nourishment, so too the body receives all its life-force via the blood from the aorta, which is therefore called 'the navel of the heart.' ↩
17. *Yoma* 85a. ↩
18. The diaphragm is a dome-shaped, muscular and membranous structure that separates the thoracic (chest) and abdominal cavities. ↩
19. Makover. ↩
20. *Meir HaLeshem*. ↩

Chapter 2 — Though there are 5 levels in nefesh, ruakh, neshama, chaya and yeshida, only the first 3 reside in the body. This is the same for the worlds.

Shaar 3 Chapter 2

אַמְנָם מָה שְׁאַמְרָנוּ שְׁחֻלְקֵי הַצּוּרָה הֵם ג' וְהֵם נר"נ

However, what we said in the previous chapter that there are three aspects of *tzurah* – *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* –

הִנֵּה הָאֵמֶת הוּא שְׁחֻלְקֵי הַצּוּרָה הֵם חֲמִשָּׁה וְהֵם נרנח"י

in truth there are actually five aspects of *tzurah* – *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida*.

וְכִמּוֹ שְׁאַמְרּוּ רז"ל בְּבִרְאשִׁית רַבָּה פ' י"ד סִימָן ט' וְכֵן בְּדִבְרֵי רַבָּה
פ' ב' סִימָן ל"ו

As our Sages taught in *Midrash Bereishit Rabba* (14, 9), and similarly in *Devarim Rabba* (2:36):

חֲמִשָּׁה שְׁמוֹת יֵשׁ לְנִשְׁמָה נֶפֶשׁ רוּחַ נִשְׁמָה חַיָּה יְחִידָה וְהֵם בְּאֵמֶת
ה' בְּחַי' נִשְׁמָה כ"א גְבוּהָ מִחִבְרוֹ

"The soul has five names: *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida*." And they are actually five aspects of the soul (*neshama*) with each one on a higher level than the other.

The fact that there are five names of the soul indicates that there are five different levels, signifying five different types of relationship to the One Above. Perhaps this can be compared to a man who is called 'son' by his parents, 'father' by his children, 'boss' by his employees, 'friend' by his colleagues and so on. Each relationship is indicated by a different name.¹

אך מָה שְׁאַמְרָנוּ שֶׁהֵם ג' הוּא מְשׁוּם כִּי מְקוֹמָם וּמִשְׁכָּנָם בְּהִגּוּף
הוּא וְק' ג' לְבַד

Although we stated earlier that there are three aspects to the soul, not five, this is because as regards their place and manifestation in the body there are only three –

שֶׁהֵם נֶפֶשׁ רוּחַ נְשָׁמָה וְעַל יְדֵיהֶם נִתְחַלֵּק הַגּוּף לִגְּמִדְרָגוֹת שֶׁהֵם רִג"ב [רֹאשׁ גּוּיָה בִטֶּן] וּפֶת"ח [פְּנִימִי תִיכוֹן חִיצוֹן] כִּנ"ל.

nefesh, ruach and neshama. And as a result, the body is also divided into three levels, which are the head, torso and abdomen along the vertical axis, and the inner, middle, outer on the horizontal plane, as explained above in chapter 1.

וְלֹא נִמְצָא בְּהַגּוּף מְקוֹמוֹת וְחֲדָרִים לְחֻלְקֵי הַצּוּרָה אֲלָא רַק ג' לְבַד

In the body there are only three places i.e. organs for housing the three aspects of the *tzurah* –

שֶׁהֵם מֶחֱ לֵב כְּבֵד וְהֵם הַמְּקוֹם וּמַעוֹן לִנְר"נ

– the brain, the heart and the liver. They are the locus and the housing for the *neshama, ruach* and *nefesh* in this order, as explained above.

אֲבָל לְהַחֲיָה וְהַיְחִידָה לֹא נִמְצָא לָהֶם כָּלִים בְּהַגּוּף לְהַתְלַבֵּשׁ בָּהֶם

But as for *chaya* and *yechida* – there are no bodily organs² in which they are vested

כִּי אֵין בָּכֶם הַגּוּף לְקַבֵּלָם מִחֲמַת אוֹרָם הַגָּדוֹל

since the body does not have the ability to receive them, due to their great light.

אֲלָא שֶׁהַחֲיָה הִיא בְּתוֹךְ הַנְּשָׁמָה שֶׁהַנְּשָׁמָה הוּא הַגּוּף וְהַכָּלִי שֶׁלָּהּ וְהַיְחִידָה הִיא שׁוֹרָה בְּתוֹךְ הַחֲיָה.

How then are *chaya* and *yechida* expressed? Instead of being manifested in any bodily organ, *chaya* is infused within the *neshama* which acts as its 'body' and 'vessel,' and *yechida* resides within *chaya*.

וְהַעֲקָר הוּא כִּי הַחַיָּה וְהַיְחִידָה הֵנָּה הֵם אֵינָם מְתַלַּבְשִׁים בְּעַקָּר
אוֹרָם בְּהַגּוּף כָּלֵל

The main point being that the primary light of *chaya* and *yechida* are not clothed in the body at all.

אֲלֹא שֶׁהֵם מְרַחֲפֵת עַל הַגּוּף מִבְּחוּץ

Rather they hover³ above the body from outside of it,

כִּי הַחַיָּה הִיא מְרַחֲפֵת עַל הַנֶּר"נ שֶׁבְּהַגּוּף וְהִיא לָהֶם בְּבַחֲי' אוֹר
מְקִיף

since *chaya* hovers tenuously, as a transcending light,⁴ above the *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* that are within the body.

וְהַיְחִידָה הִיא מְרַחֲפֵת עַל הַחַיָּה וְהוּא מְקִיף לְמְקִיף

And *yechida* hovers above *chaya* as transcendent⁵ i.e. transcending even the transcending quality of *chaya*.

וְזֶמָּה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁהֵם מְתַלַּבְשִׁים בְּהַנְשָׁמָה הוּא רַק הָאֲרִתָּם לְבַד

So when we said that they are 'clothed' in the *neshama* this is referring to their radiance alone.

אֲבָל הֵם עֲצָמָם אֵינָם מְתַלַּבְשִׁים בְּהַגּוּף כָּלֵל

But they themselves are not clothed within the body at all.

אֲלֹא הֵם רַק בְּבַחֲי' מְקִיף וּמְקִיף לְמְקִיף

Rather, they are only in a state of transcending (*makif*) and transcendent (*makif of makif*) respectively.

וּמִשּׁוּם שֶׁהֵם אֵינָם מְתַפְשָׁטִים לְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהַגּוּף מִמֶּשׁ וְלֹא נִמְצָא
בְּהַגּוּף אֲלֹא רַק ג' כָּלִים לַהֲנֵר"נ לְבַד

And because they do not extend and spread out to become actually clothed in the body, there are only three vessels in the

body for *neshama, ruach* and *nefesh* –

שהם מוח לב כבד כנז'

the brain, the heart and the liver, as mentioned.

לכן אמרנו שחלקי הצורה אשר בהגוף הם ג' שהם הנר"נ.

Therefore we stated that there are only three aspects of *tzurah* in the body – *neshama, ruach* and *nefesh*.

והנה ע"ד שאמרנו בכל אדם בפרט כן הוא עד"ז בהעולמות בכלל

Now in the same way that we described this structure as regards individual human beings, so too as regards the Worlds in general:

כי הנה הם ג' עולמות בריאה יצירה עשיה אשר הם כלל העולמות הנפרדים

There are three Worlds – *Beriah, Yetzirah, Asiyah* – which are in the category of 'disconnected' worlds,

משום שהם כלם אינם אלהות כלל

since they are not Godly at all, as opposed to the World of *Atzilut*, which is fully connected to the *Ohr Ein Sof*.

והנה הם ג' כלים לקבל בתוכם את הנר"נ הכלליים

And they the disconnected worlds act as vessels in which to receive the macro-level i.e. the non-personal, or the universal *neshama, ruach* and *nefesh*.

כי הנפש הכללי הוא בעשיה והרוח הכללי הוא ביצירה והנשמה הכללי בבריאה

The macro-*nefesh* is in *Asiyah*, macro-*ruach* in *Yetzirah*, and the macro-*neshama* in *Beriah*.

אבל לחיה ויחידה הכללים לא נמצא עוד עולמות נבראים להיות
כלים להם

But as for macro-level *chaya* and *yechida* – there are no created worlds to contain them.⁶

אלא הוא כי הסיה ויחידה הכלליים הם רק מרחף עליהם
מבחוץ בבחי' מקיף ומקיף למקיף

Rather, the macro-level *chaya* and *yechida* merely hover above them, outside of them in a state of transcending (*makif*) and transcendent (*makif of makif*) respectively,

ולא נכנס מהם בהעולמות מבפנים אלא רק הארתם לבד.

and nothing from them enters the created worlds, other than a mere radiance.

והנה ע"ד שאמרנו שישנם ה' צורות כלליים שהם נרנח"י

Now in the same way that we said there are five general *tzurot* (plural of *tzurah*) – i.e. *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida*,

כן הוא ג"כ שכ"א מאלו ה' הוא כלול ג"כ מה' שישנם ה' בחי' נרנח"י

so too, each one of the five is also comprised of five aspects – *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida*:

בהנפש הכללי נפש שבנפש רוח שבנפש נשמה שבנפש חיה
שבנפש יחידה שבנפש – וכלם הם נפש הכללי

On the macro-level of *nefesh*, there is *nefesh of nefesh*, *ruach of nefesh*, *neshama of nefesh*, *chaya of nefesh*, *yechida of nefesh* – and all of them are aspects of the macro-level of *nefesh*.

וכן עד"ז ה' בחי' נרנח"י בהרום הכללי וכן ה' בחי' נרנח"י
בהנשמה הכללי

Similarly, there are five aspects of *ruach* on the macro-level – *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida* of *ruach*, and five aspects of *neshama* on the macro-level – *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida* of *neshama*,

וה' בְּחַי' נִרְנַח"י בְּהִתְחַה הַכִּלִּי וְה' בְּחַי' נִרְנַח"י בְּהִתְחַה הַכִּלִּי.

and five aspects of *chaya* on the macro-level – *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida* of *chaya*, and five aspects of *yechida* on the macro-level – *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida* of *yechida*.

וְכֵן ע"ד שְׁאֻמְרָנוּ שֶׁהִתְחַה וְהִתְחַה הַכִּלִּי לֹא נִמְצָא לָהֶם כֵּלִים
בְּהִתְחַה

And just as we said that the macro-level *chaya* and *yechida* have no vessels in the 'body' i.e. within the created worlds,

וְהֵם אֵינָם מְתַלַּבְּשִׁים בְּהִתְחַה אֶלָּא שְׁנִשְׁאָרִים מִבְּחוּץ בְּבְּחַי' מְקִיף
וּמְקִיף לְמְקִיף

and they are not clothed within the 'body' but remain outside of them as *makif* and *makif* of *makif*,

כֵּן הוּא ע"ד ז' בְּהִתְחַה וְהִתְחַה הַפְּרָטִיִּים אֲשֶׁר בְּכ"א מֵהִנְרַח"י
הַכִּלִּיִּים

so too regarding the sub-divisions of *chaya* and *yechida* in each of the macro-levels of *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida*.

הִנֵּה הֵם ג"כ אֵינָם מְתַלַּבְּשִׁים בְּהִתְחַה אֶלָּא שְׁנִשְׁאָרִים ג"כ רַק בְּבְּחַי' מְקִיף
וּמְקִיף לְמְקִיף

Likewise, they are not clothed in the body but also remain in a state of *makif* and *makif* of *makif*.

וְכַגֻּן הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלִּי אֲשֶׁר אֻמְרָנוּ שֶׁהוּא מְתַלַּבֵּשׁ בְּהִתְחַה וּמְקוּמוֹ
וְגַלְוִיו הוּא בְּהִתְחַה

For example *nefesh* in the macro sense, which we said is clothed in the body and is situated in the liver, where it is revealed,

ומשם הוא משלח פארותיו² בכל הגוף כולו

and from there it sends forth its shoots throughout the entire body

ומאיר ושולט בחלקי החיצונית דהגוף וכנ"ל

and it illuminates the external aspects of the body and controls it, as explained previously –

הנה כל התלבשות הנה הנה הוא רק בבחי' הנר"נ שבתנפש

Now this 'clothing' within the body is only as regards the aspects of *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* of *nefesh*,

אבל החיה והיחידה שבתנפש הנה הם אינם מתלבשים בהגוף
אלא רק בהארותם לבד

but *chaya* and *yechida* of *nefesh* are not clothed within the body, other than as a mere radiance –

אבל עקר אורם נשאר מבחוץ בבחי' מקיף ומקיף למקיף

but their primary light remains on the outside, as *makif* and *makif* of *makif*.

וכן עד"ז ברוח הפללי המתלבש בהלב ומאיר ושולט בהחלק
האמצעי שבגוף

In a similar manner, *ruach* in the macro sense is clothed in the heart and illuminates and controls the middle part of the body on the horizontal plane, as explained in chapter 1.

והנה הוא כלול מנרנח"י שהם הנרנח"י שבהרום הפללי וכנ"ז

It too comprises the micro levels of *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida*, which are the *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida* of *ruach* at the macro level.

הנה אינו מתלבש בהלב והגוף אלא רק בהנר"נ שבו לבד

However, only *nefesh, ruach* and *neshama* are clothed in the heart and the body,

אבל הסיה והיחידה שבו הם נשאר מבחוץ בבחי' מקיף ומקיף
למקיף

while *chaya* and *yechida* remain on the outside as *makif* and *makif* of *makif*.

וכן הוא עד"ז בהסיה והיחידה הפרטניים אשר בכ"א מהנרנח"י
הפכליים

And so too regarding the micro-level *chaya* and *yechida* of each of *ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida* –

הנה הם ג"כ אינם מתלבשים בהגוף אלא שנשארים ג"כ רק בבחי'
מקיף ומקיף למקיף.

– they the *chaya* and *yechida* are not clothed within the body, but likewise remain as *makif* and *makif* of *makif*.

וכן עד"ז הנשמה הפכלי אשר היא מתלבש בהמוח ומאיר ושולט
בהחלק הפנימי שבגוף

Similarly regarding the macro level of *neshama*, which is clothed in the brain and illuminates and controls the inner part of the body on the horizontal plane, as explained in chapter 1 –

והנה היא כלולה מנרנח"י שהם הנרנח"י שבהנשמה הפכלי

– it too comprises the micro levels of *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida*, which are the *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida* of *neshama* at the macro level.

הנה אינו מתלבש בהמוח והגוף אלא רק בהנר"נ שבה לבד

Only *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshamah* are clothed in the brain and the body,

אבל החיה והיחידה שבה הם אינם מתלבשים בהגוף כלל

***chaya* and *yechida* are not clothed within the body at all,**

אלא שהם נשאר מבחוץ בבחי' מקיר ומקיר למקיר

but remain on the outside as *makif* and *makif* of *makif*.

והרי נמצא כי יש לכל גוף ו' מני מקיפים פרטיים

So we find that for every body there are six specific levels of *makif* –

והם החיה והיחידה אשר בכ"א מהג' אורות נר"נ הפלליים

***chaya* and *yechida* for each of the macro-level lights of *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshamah*.**

והוא לבד החיה והיחידה הפלליים שהם כלם רק מקיפים לבד
בכל הה' בחי' נרנח"י שבכ"א מהם

And this is besides the macro-level *chaya* and *yechida* which are entirely *makif* in each of their five aspects of *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshamah*, *chaya*, *yechida*.

In other words, all the sub-levels of *chaya* (i.e. *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshamah*, *chaya*, *yechida* of *chaya*), and all the sub-levels of *yechida* (i.e. *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshamah*, *chaya*, *yechida* of *yechida*) remain in a state of *makif*.

והרי הם בסך הכל ט"ז מני מקיפים לכל פרצוף ופרצוף וכן הוא
בכל עולם ועולם.

Accordingly, there are in total sixteen types of *makif* in each and every *partzuf*, and so too in each World.

The sixteen are: the six specific levels of *makif*, comprising the *chaya* and *yecheda* of each of *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshamah*, plus the five sub-levels each of *chaya* and *yecheda* themselves, making sixteen.

אָמַנָם הוּא כִּי כ"ז הוּא רַק בְּדֶרֶךְ כָּלָל

However, this is only in a general sense.

אָבֵל בְּפִרְטוּיֹת הֵמָּה מִתְרַבִּים הָאֵרֶת הַנִּרְנַח"י שֶׁבִּכ"א בְּהִפְנִימִים
וְהַמְקִיפִים שֶׁבָּהֶם לְפִרְטִים רַבִּים אִין חֶקֶר

But more specifically the radiances of *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshamah*, *chaya*, *yecheda* in each of the immanent and transcendent aspects increase in detail to an incalculable amount,

וְכַמוֹ שֶׁמִּבְּאֵר בְּהַדְרוֹשִׁים וְע' דְּבָרֵינוּ בְּשַׁעַר הָעֵקֻדִּים פ"ב אוֹת ז' סִי'
ב'.

as is explained in various expositions. See also our comments to *Sha'ar haAkudim* chapter 2, paragraph 7 (b).

וְעִנְיֵן צֶרֶךְ וְתוֹעֵלֶת הַמְקִיפִים ע' דְּבָרֵינוּ שָׁם אוֹת ח'

As for the need for and benefit of the *makifim*, see our comments there to paragraph 8.

וְכֵן יִתְבָּאֵר כ"ז ג"כ קֶצֶת לְפָנֵינוּ בְּשַׁעְרֵי הַבָּאִים בַּעַה"י.

This will also be explained to a lesser extent in the sections below.

אָמַנָם דַּע כִּי הִנֵּה הַגִּם שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁחֲלָקֵי הַצִּוְרָה הַמְתַּלַּבְּשִׁים בְּהַגּוּר
הִנֵּה הֵם ג' שֶׁהֵם נר"נ

Know however that even though we stated that the aspects of *tzurah* which are clothed in the body are only three, *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshamah*,

ואמרנו כי נתיסד להם ג' כלים בהגוף שהם מח לב כבד והם מקום
ומעון להנר"נ וכנ"ל

and we stated that there are three vessels in the body which were reserved for them – the brain, the heart and the liver – which are the place and residence for the *neschama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* listed here in the order of the vessels in which they are manifested, as mentioned,

הנה האמת הוא כי עקר הצורה המתלבש בהגוף ממש הם רק
שנים שהם נפש ורוח לבד

the truth is that the primary aspects of *tzurah* which become clothed in the body are only *nefesh* and *ruach*.

והנר"נ דהנפש והרוח הם אשר מתלבשים במח לב כבד

It is the *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neschama* of *nefesh* and *ruach* alone that are fully clothed in the heart and liver,

אבל הנשמה הכללית היא אינה מתלבש בהמוח אלא רק בהקצה
התחתון שלה

whereas *neschama* on the macro level is not clothed in the brain other than via its lowest extremity.

כי עקר מדרגת האדם הוא רק הנפש והרוח אבל הנשמה היא
באמת למעלה ממדרגתו

This is because man's spiritual level is defined primarily by his *nefesh* and *ruach*, whereas his *neschama* is really beyond his spiritual level

ואינה מתלבשת בהאדם אלא רק כדי להתעלה ולהתגדל על ידה
למעלה ממדרגתו

and is clothed in him (via its lowest extremity) only in order for him to thereby become elevated and distinguished beyond his level.

שהוא נפש ורוח ולהתעלה על ידיה למדרגת הנשמה ג"כ

So that the *nefesh* and *ruach* that he is (i.e. that define him) can be elevated by his *neschama* to the level of *neschama*.

ומשום שעקר מדרגת האדם הוא רק נפש ורוח

And since man's spiritual level is defined primarily by his *nefesh* and *ruach* alone,

לכן הם אשר מתלבשים ומשתתפים עם הגוף וחמר ונעשים חד עמו

Therefore they become clothed in the body and corporeality and form a partnership with him and become one with him.

אבל הנשמה אין לה השתוות עם הגוף כלל אלא רק בהקצה
היותר תחתון שבה לבד

But the *neschama* has no common ground with the body at all other than via its lowest extremity.

ובזה לבד היא מתלבשת בו והתלבשותה הוא ג"כ רק ע"י הנשמה
שברוח אשר מקומה הוא בהמום

It is only this that is clothed in the body, and also only the *neschama* of *ruach*⁸ whose place is in the brain.

ומה שאמרנו לעיל שהרוח הוא בלב הוא רק הרום שברוח

What we said above – that *ruach* is revealed in the heart – refers only to *ruach* of *ruach*.

אבל הנשמה שברוח שורה ג"כ רק בהמום והוא עקר הנשמה
שבאדם

But the *neschama* of *ruach* rests only in the brain, and this is primarily what we refer to when discussing the *neschama* in man.

אֲשֶׁר בַּמַּדְרַגַּת הָאָדָם וּבִתּוֹךְ אוֹתָהּ הַנִּשְׁמָה שְׁבוּרוֹחַ

On the level that defines man – i.e. his *nefesh* and *ruach* alone, as explained above – in his *neshama* of *ruach*

מִתְלַבָּשִׁים הֵנּוּ "נ שְׁבֵה־נִשְׁמָה הַכִּלִּית

is clothed the *nefesh*, *ruach* and *neshama* of *neshama* in the macro-sense –

בְּהִקְצָה הַיּוֹתֵר תַּחֲתוֹן שְׁבֵהֵם וְכִדִּי לְהַתְעַלָּה וּלְהַתְגַּדֵּל עַל יָדוֹ
לְמַעַלָּה מִמַּדְרַגָּתוֹ

but only their lowest extremes. And this is for the purpose of thereby elevating and magnifying his *ruach* beyond its innate spiritual level.

וְע"י אוֹתָהּ הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלִּית קָשׁוּר הָאָדָם לְמַעַלָּה לְמַעַלָּה

And via that *neshama* on the macro-level a person is connected above and beyond.

וְעַל יָדָהּ שׁוֹרָה הַשְׂכִּינָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל וּמִיַּחַד שְׁמוֹ עֲלֵיהֶם

And by means of that *neshama* on the macro-level the *Shechinah* rests upon the Jewish People as a whole and He unites His Name upon them,

כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר כ"ז לְמַטָּה בְּאֵר הַיָּטִיב בְּעֶזְרַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ:

all of which will be explained fully below, with God's help.

Footnotes

1. See *Shemot Rabbah* 3:6 – God's response to Moses when he wished to know His name was "according to My deeds I am called. When I judge the world I am called *Elokim*; when I wage war on the wicked I am called *Tzva'ot*..." אמר ליה הקדוש ברוך הוא למשה שמי אתה מבקש לידע לפי מעשי

אני נקרא פעמים שאני נקרא באל שדי בצבאות באלהים
 בה' כשאני דן את הבריות אני נקרא אלהים וכשאני עושה
 מלחמה ברשעים אני נקרא צבאות וכשאני תולה על חטאיו
 של אדם אני נקרא אל שדי וכשאני מרחם על עולמי אני
 ...נקרא ה' שאין ה' אלא מדת רחמים ↵

2. Literally, 'vessels.' ↵

3. The word מרחף in Hebrew has the sense of an ethereal
 higher plane tenuously making an appearance on a lower
 plane, as in Genesis 1:2 רֹחַ אֱלֹהִים מְרַחֵף עַל פְּנֵי הַמַּיִם
 – And the spirit of God hovered tenuously over the surface
 of the waters. ↵

4. 'Transcending light': *Ohr makif* is often translated as
 'surrounding or enveloping light' to contrast it with the
 internalized, immanent light that fills the vessel it fills from
 within. 'Transcending light' is a more precise
 characterization. ↵

5. We will use *transcendent* for *makif l'makif* and *transcending*
 for *makif*. ↵

6. Literally: "There can no longer be found created worlds to
 be vessels for them." ↵

7. See Ezekiel 17:6 וַתְּהִי לְגִפֶּן וַתַּעֲשׂ בְדִים וַתִּשְׁלַח פְּאוֹרוֹת... ↵

8. But not the level of *neshama* itself. ↵

Chapter 3 — The generic nefesh and ruakh of the lower worlds bi" a are not at all Divine energy in and of themselves.

Shaar 3 Chapter 3

וְהִנֵּה אֲמָרְנוּ כִּי יֵשׁ נִרְנַח"י כָּלְלִים וְנִרְנַח"י פְּרָטִים

We said in the previous chapter that there is a macro-level *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida*, and also micro-levels of *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya, yechida*. We will abbreviate this below as *nrnch*"y where appropriate.

וְהִינּוּ שֶׁכ"א מֵהִנִּרְנַח"י הַכָּלְלִים הֵנָּה כָּלֹל כ"א ג"כ מִנִּרְנַח"י
וְכָנ"ל

That is to say, each of the macro-levels of *nrnch*"y also comprises micro-levels of *nrnch*"y.

אֲמָנָם הֵנָּה יֵשׁ חֲלוּק גָּדוֹל בֵּין הִנִּרְנַח"י הַכָּלְלִים לִהִנִּרְנַח"י
הַפְּרָטִים

Nevertheless, there is a tremendous difference between the macro-level *nrnch*"y and the micro-level *nrnch*"y,

כִּי הִנִּרְנַח"י הַכָּלְלִים הֵנָּה הָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכָּלְלִים הֵם נִבְרָאִים
נוֹצְרִים נַעֲשִׂים

because the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of *nrnch*"y are created, formed and made,

וְהֵם אֵינָם אֱלֹהוֹת כָּלֵל

and they are not Godly at all (according to what we will explain below).

אֲבָל הַנִּשְׁמָה וְהַיְחִידָה וְהַיְחִידָה הַכָּלְלִים אֵלֹהֵי ה' הֵם כָּלֵם אֱלֹהוֹת
גָּמוֹר

But *neshama*, *chaya* and *yechida* in the macro sense – all three – are all entirely Godliness,

גם בְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע.

even in the Worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*.

שֶׁאֵפִי בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הוּא מִהַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית וּלְמַעַלָּה כָּלוּ אֱלֹהוֹת
גָּמוּר

So that even in the World of *Asiyah* the macro-level of *neshama* and above are all entirely Godliness,

כִּי הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית אֲשֶׁר גַּם בְּהָעֲשִׂיָּה הִנֵּה הִיא מְעוֹלָם הָאֲצִילוֹת

since the macro-level of *neshama*, even in *Asiyah*, is from the World of *Atzilut*

אֲשֶׁר הוּא אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוּר כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר בַּשָּׁעָרִים הַבָּאִים.

which is entirely Godliness, as will be explained in the coming sections.

אִמָּנָם הַנִּרְנַח"י הַפְּרָטִיִּים אֲשֶׁר יֵשְׁנָם גַּם בְּהַנֶּפֶשׁ וְהָרוּחַ הַכִּלְלִיִּים

However, the micro-level *nrnch*"y, which are sub-strata in macro-level *nefesh* and *ruach* as well,

הִנֵּה יֵשׁ בָּהֶם בְּחִי שֶׁהֵם אֱלֹהוֹת וְיֵשׁ בָּהֶם בְּחִי שֶׁאֵינָם אֱלֹהוֹת

have aspects which are Godliness and aspects which are not Godliness.

וְיֵשׁ חִלּוּק בֵּינָם הָעוֹלָמוֹת

In this respect there is a difference between the Worlds:

כִּי בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הוּא הָאֱלֹהוֹת שֶׁבָּהֶם רַק הַיְחִידָה לְבַד שֶׁבָּהֶם

in the World of *Asiyah* the Godliness in it is only in its *yechida*,¹

כי היחידה הפרטית אשר גם בהרוח והנפש הכלליים דהעשיה
הוא אלהות גמור

since the micro-level *yechida*, even in macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of *Asiyah*, is entirely Godliness.

אבל מהחיה ולמטה אשר בהרוח והנפש הכלליים דהעשיה הם
אינם אלהות כלל.

But from *chaya* and below in the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of *Asiyah* is not Godliness at all.

ובעולם היצירה הוה גם החיה הפרטית אשר בהרוח והנפש
הכלליים דהיצירה ג"כ אלהות גמור

In the World of *Yetzirah* even micro-level *chaya* of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of *Yetzirah* is entirely Godliness.

אך מהנשמה הפרטית ולמטה אשר בהרוח ונפש הכלליים
דהיצירה

But the micro-level *neshama* and lower of the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*

הם אינם אלהות כלל.

are not Godliness at all.

ובעולם הבריאה הוה גם הנשמה הפרטית אשר בהרוח והנפש
הכללים דהבריאה ג"כ אלהות גמור

However, in the World of *Beriah* even the micro-level *neshama* of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of *Beriah* is also entirely Godliness.

ורק הרוח והנפש הפרטיים אשר ברוח ונפש הכלליים דהבריאה

Only the micro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of *Beriah*

הם אינם אלהות כלל.

are not Godliness at all.

ונמצא כי בעולם הבריאה הנה אלהות מהנשמה ולמעלה לעולם

It turns out that the World of *Beriah* is Godliness from the level of *neshama* and above,

ר"ל גם הנשמה הפרטית אשר בהרום ונפש הכלליים שבה

i.e. including the micro-level *neshama* of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* in it – in the World of *Beriah*.

אבל בעולם היצירה הנה האלהות אשר גם בהרום והנפש הכלליים שבו רק מהחיה ולמעלה.

But in the World of *Yetzirah* there is Godliness in the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* only from the level of *chaya* and above i.e. *yechida*.

אך בעולם העשיה לא הנה אלהות ברום ונפש הכלליים שבה

Whereas in the World of *Asiyah* there is no Godliness in its macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*

אלא רק היחידה לבד שבהם.

other than in its *yechida*.

והרי נמצא מכ"ז כי היחידה היא לעולם אלהות

So it emerges from all of this that *yechida* is always Godliness,

ור"ל גם היחידה הפרטית אשר גם ברום ונפש הכלליים דהעשיה

meaning to say, including the micro-level *yechida* of *ruach* and *nefesh* on the macro-level.

אבל הרום והנפש הפרטיים דהרום ונפש הכלליים

But the micro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*

הם לעולם אינם אלהות אפי' בעולם הבריאה

are never Godliness, even in the World of *Beriah*.

אך הנשמה והחיה הנה בעולם הבריאה הם ג"כ אלהות גמור לעולם

Whereas *neshama* and *chaya* in the World of *Beriah* are also always entirely Godliness.

ור"ל אפי' הנשמה והחיה הפרטיים אשר גם בהרום והנפש הכלליים

Meaning to say, even the micro-level *neshama* and *chaya* of *ruach* and *nefesh* on the macro-level are entirely Godliness.

אבל ביצירה הנה האלהות רק מהחיה לבד אך לא מהנשמה ולמטה

But in the World of *Yetzirah* there is Godliness only in *chaya* and above, but not from *neshama* and below.

ובעולם העשיה הוא רק היחידה לבד ולא מהחיה ולמטה.

And in the World of *Asiyah* only *yechida* is Godliness, but from *chaya* down is not.

וכ"ז הוא רק בהנשמה והחיה הפרטיים אשר ברום ונפש הכלליים

All of this is only as regards the micro-level *neshama* and *chaya* of *ruach* and *nefesh* on the macro-level,

אבל הנשמה והחיה הכללים ומכש"כ היחידה

but as for macro-level *neshama* and *chaya* —

הם כלם לעולם אלהות גמור בכל חלקי הנרנח"י שבהם גם בעולם העשיה

– they are always entirely Godliness in all their aspects of *nrnch*"y, even in the World of *Asiyah*.

וכמ"ש האריז"ל בשער הצלם פ"א ובשער השמות פ' א' ב' ובכ"מ

[As the Arizal writes in *Shaar HaTzelem* chapter 1, and in *Shaar HaShemot* chapters 1 & 2, and in a number of other places.

וכן כתב ג"כ הגר"א ז"ל בהיכלות בראשית היכל א' בספר יהל אור דף י"א ע"ד.

The GR" A also writes thus in his commentary on the section of the *Zohar* known as the *Heichalot, Bereishit, Heichal* 1, printed in his book *Yahel Ohr* p. 11d.

ובמה שכתבתי החלוק בין הכללים להפרטים

And this distinction between the macro and micro levels that we wrote about

בזה יתישב דברי הגר"א בלקוטיו שבסוף הספד"צ דה"מ ידוע שהבדל עצמי כו' ע"ש

resolves an apparent contradiction in the words of the GR" A in his *Likutim* at the end of his commentary on the section of the *Zohar* known as the *Sifra d'Tziniuta*, beginning with "It is known that there is an essential difference..."

שהוא נראה כסותר את עצמו למה שכתב בהיכלות הנז'

in which he appears to contradict himself regarding his commentary to the aforementioned *Heichalot*.

אבל לפי מה שכתבתי הוא נידח

But according to our explanation written above, there is no problem,

כי בלקוטיו שם מדבר בהנרנח"י שבנפש רוח הכלליים

because in his *Likutim* he is referring to *nrnch*"y of *nefesh* and *ruach* on the macro-level,

כִּי יֶרַק הֵם לְבַד הֵם עֶקֶר מִדְּרַגַּת דִּהְעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

since only they are the primary level of the Worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* –

וְהוּא מִדְּרַגַּת הָאָדָם וְהַבְּנִי:

and this is the level of man. Understand this.]

To summarize the contents of this chapter, the diagram² below may help:

Macro-level *neshama*, *chaya*, *yechida* are always Godliness, but –

	<i>Nefesh</i> (micro)	<i>Ruach</i> (micro)	<i>Neshama</i> (micro)	<i>Chaya</i> (micro)	<i>Yechida</i> (micro)
<i>Beriah</i>	Not Godliness	Not Godliness	Godliness	Godliness	Godliness

	<i>Nefesh</i> (micro)	<i>Ruach</i> (micro)	<i>Neshama</i> (micro)	<i>Chaya</i> (micro)	<i>Yechida</i> (micro)
<i>Yetzirah</i>	Not Godliness	Not Godliness	Not Godliness	Godliness	Godliness
<i>Asiyah</i>	Not Godliness	Not Godliness	Not Godliness	Not Godliness	Godliness

Thus, micro-level *nefesh* and *ruach* are never Godliness, whereas micro-level *yechida* is always Godliness.

Footnotes

1. Literally, "...the Godliness in them is only in their *yechida*."



2. From the Makover edition. [↩](#)

Chapter 4 — The locations of all the specific aspects of the nefesh, ruakh and neshama are the brain, heart and liver.

Shaar 3 Chapter 4

ידע כי הנשמה הפרטית אשר גם ברוח והנפש הכלליים

Know that micro-level *neshama*, even of *ruach* and *nefesh* on the macro-level,

הנה מקומם הוא ג"כ רק במוח

is also located only in the brain – so that not only the level of *neshama* of *neshama* resides in the brain, but even *neshama* of *ruach* and of *nefesh* resides there, as will be explained below.¹

והוא מה שאנו רואין שיש ביהי מוח גם לבהמה

This is evident in that we see that even animals have a brain.

וכן יש ביהי מוח גם לנפש הצומחת שבכל מין צומח

Furthermore, there is some semblance of a brain² in the vegetal life-force³ of every type of plant.

וכן הוא גם לנפש המרכבת שבכל חלקי הדומם

And the same is so even regarding the integrating existential force⁴ that permeates all aspects of the inanimate world.

והוא המקום דהנקדה הפנימית דכל גשם שהיא הנושא אותו

This is the central inner point of all matter that sustains its existence (as stated in *Sefer Yetzirah* 4:4, see GR"A⁵),

כי שם שוכן הצורה העקרית דכל מציאות

for it is there that the primary *tzurah* of every entity resides,

שכ"א הוא כלול מחומר וצורה כנ"ל שער ב'

since every entity is comprised of matter and form, as explained above in *Shaar 2*.

ואותו המקום דהנקדה הפנימית אשר בו שוכן הנפש המרכבת

Now within that inner point resides the integrating existential force

שהיא הצורה אשר ישנו גם בהדומם הוא בחי' המוח שבו

which is the *tzurah* that is present even in the inanimate world – and that is its brain.

ושם הוא שרשו והתחלתו שהוא בחי' הראש שבו.

And there is its root and its beginning, which can therefore be referred to as its 'head.'

וע' שער פרקי הצלם רפ"ב שאמר שם הרב כי אין דבר שאין בו נרנח"י

See the section of *Eitz Chaim* titled *Pirkei HaTzelem* beginning of chapter 2, where Rabbi Chaim Vital states that there is nothing that does not have *nrnch*"y,

והוא כללות הנפש המרכבת שאמרנו שישנו גם בהדומם

which is the general integrating existential force that is also present in inanimate entities

והוא הכח המקיים את המרכבתו שהוא בחי' נפש דהדומם

as the sustaining force that integrates their various elements. This is the *nefesh* of the inanimate world.

וע' בדברי הרב בשער קצור אבי"ע פ"ב ושם פ"י בדה"מ הדומם ע"ש.

See Rabbi Chaim Vital's words in the section of *Eitz Chaim* titled *Kitzur Abiy*"a chapter 2, and chapter 10 beginning with the words, 'The inanimate.'

וְנִחָזַר לְהַעֲנִין כִּי הִנֵּה עַכ"פּ הוּא כִּי מְקוֹמָהּ שֶׁל הַנֶּשְׁמָה הַפְּרִטִית

Let's return now to our subject, which is that in any event, the proper place of the micro-level *neshama*,

אֲשֶׁר גַּם בְּהָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִיִּים הוּא ג"כ רַק בְּהִמּוֹם

even of the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*, is also only in the brain.

וְעַל זֶה נִתְּיָסַד ג' מְקוֹמוֹת בְּהַגּוּף דְּכָל פְּרָצוּף שֶׁהֵם מִמֶּלֶךְ לֵב כְּבֵד

It was due to this that three places were established in the body of each *partzuf* – the brain, the heart and the liver –

כִּי הֵם הַמְשָׁכָן וְהַמְעוֹן לַהֲנֵר"נ הַפְּרִטִיִּים אֲשֶׁר בְּהָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִיִּים

because they are the abode and home for micro-level *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh*⁶ of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*,

שֶׁהֵם עֶקֶר מִדְּרַגַּת שֶׁל כָּל פְּרָצוּף וְכַנ"ל

which are the primary levels of each *partzuf*, as mentioned above.

וְלִכְךָ נִתְּיָסַד לַהֲנֵר"נ שְׁבָהֵם ג' כִּלִּים מַל"כ

And therefore, for the *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* three vessels were designated – the brain, the heart and the liver –

וְהֵם מְעוֹן וּמִדּוֹר לָהֶם שְׁבָהֵם הֵם שׁוֹכְנִים

and they serve as their housing and a lodging in which they reside.

אבל הנשמה הכללית שהיא בלה אלהות אין לה השתוות כלל עם
שום גוף וכלי

But the macro-level *neshama*, which is entirely Godliness, has nothing in common with any bodily entity or receptacle.

ולכן לא נתיסד לה כלי כלל בהגוף לקבל אותה בתוכה

And for this reason no receptacle in the body was assigned to the *neshama* in which to receive her.

אלא שהיא שוכנת בתוך הנשמה דהרוח אשר במח

Instead she resides in the *neshama* of *ruach* in the brain.

שהנשמה דהרוח הוא הכלי שלה

Thus the *neshama* of *ruach* is her – the macro-level *neshama*'s – receptacle

ושם היא מתפשט בהקצה היותר תחתון דהנר"נ שלה

and there she spreads forth via the lowest extremity of her micro-level *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh*,

ובזה לבד הוא מתלבש בכל פרצוף.

so that only this aspect is clothed in the entire *partzuf*.

והנה בעולם העשיה אשר האלהות שבה היא רק היחידה דהרוח
ונפש וכנ"ל פ"ג

Now in the World of *Asiyah*, where the only Godliness is in *yechida* of *ruach* and *nefesh*, as explained in chapter 3,

הנה מתיחדת הנשמה הכללית בהאדם ע"י היחידה שבו

the macro-level *neshama* unites with a person via their micro-level *yechida*.

והיחידה הרי היא מתפשטת ומתלבש בהארתה בהחיה

And this *yechida* spreads forth and its radiance becomes clothed in *chaya*,

וְהַיְחִידָה בְּהִנְשָׁמָה שְׂבִימָח (שֶׁהוּא הִנְשָׁמָה דְּרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ כְּנִז') וְכָנָ"ל פ"ב.

and *chaya* in the *neshamah* in the brain (which is the *neshamah* of *ruach* and *nefesh*, as mentioned) – as was explained above in chapter 2.

וּבְעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה מְתִיחֶדֶת הִנְשָׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית בְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

And in the World of *Yetzirah* the macro-level *neshamah* unites with the entire *partzuf*

ע"י הַיְחִידָה וְהַיְחִידָה שְׂבִימָח וְנֶפֶשׁ

via the *yechida* and *chaya* of *ruach* and *nefesh*.

וּבְעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה מְתִיחֶדֶת הִנְשָׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית שְׂבִימָה

And in the World of *Beriah* the macro-level *neshamah* in it is united with it – with the World of *Beriah* –

ע"י הַיְחִידָה וְהַיְחִידָה וְהִנְשָׁמָה אֲשֶׁר בְּהָרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ

via the *yechida*, *chaya* and *neshamah* of *ruach* and *nefesh*.

וְאוֹתָן הִנְשָׁמָה וְהַיְחִידָה וְהַיְחִידָה דְּרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ שְׂבִימָה

And that *neshamah*, *chaya* and *yechida* of its *ruach* and *nefesh*

הֵם הַג' ר [ג' רָאשִׁין] דְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה הַנִּקְרָא כֶּסֶם הַכְּבוֹד

are the three 'heads' i.e. *binah*, *chochmah* and *keter* (from lowest to highest)⁷ of the World of *Beriah*, which is called *Kisei Hakavod* – the Throne of Glory.

וְהֵנָּה הֵם בְּהִיכָל הַז' דְּבְרִיאָה שֶׁהוּא בְּחִי' הַמֶּלֶךְ שְׂבִימָה

In fact they are vested in the seventh Chamber of *Beriah* which is the aspect of 'brain' within it – i.e. *keter*, *chochmah* and *binah* of *Beriah* are its 'intellectual' aspect, referred to here as *mo'ach* or brain.

וּבְהֵם מִתְפַּשְׁטוֹת וּמִתְיַחֲדוֹת הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלִּית דִּהְבִּיאָהּ וּכְמ"ש
בְּשַׁעַר כֶּסֶף הַכְּבוֹד פ"א.

And through them the macro-level *neshama* spreads into and unites with *Beriah*, as it states in *Eitz Chaim*, *Shaar Kisei HaKavod* chapter 1.

אֲמַנָם מָה שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַנִּשְׁמָה דְרוּם וְנִפְשָׁהּ הֵם בְּהִמּוּם

However, our statement at the beginning of this chapter that micro-level *neshama* of the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* are vested in the brain needs elucidation –

הִנֵּה עֵקֶר הַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁבְּהִמּוּם עֲצָמוֹ הוּא וְכִּי הַנִּשְׁמָה דְרוּם

in fact the primary aspect of the *neshama* vested in the brain itself is only the *neshama* of *ruach*, but not the *neshama* of *nefesh* –

אֲבָל הַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁבְּנִפְשָׁהּ הִנֵּה הִיא אֵינָה בְּהִמּוּם עֲצָמוֹ

since the *neshama* of *nefesh* is not vested in the brain itself

אֲלָא וְכִּי בְּהִקְרוּמִין דְּהִמָּם וְהִקְרוּמִין

but rather in the membranes, called the meninges⁸ (or *krumin* in Aramaic) surrounding the brain.

הֵם בְּבִחִי' בָּשָׂר שֶׁהוּא מִשְׁרֵשׁ הַדָּם וְהַכֶּבֶד מְשָׁכֵן דִּהְנִפְשָׁהּ

For our purposes these are in the same category as flesh – from the same root as the blood and the liver in which the *nefesh* physical life-force resides.

וְאוֹתָן הַקְרוּמִין הֵנָּה בְּהִיּוֹת הַזֶּלֶד בְּבַחֲיוֹ עֲבוּר שְׂאֵז אִין בּוֹ רַק נֶפֶשׁ
לְבַד

Regarding these *krumin*-membranes – when the fetus is in the womb, when only *nefesh* is manifested in them (this state is called *ibbur*) –

הֵנָּה אוֹתָן הַקְרוּמִין אֵז בּוֹ בְּמַצִּיאוֹת מַחִין מִמֶּשׁ וְהֵם הַמַּחִין דְּעֲבוּר

then these *krumin*-membranes have the de facto status of brain in the fetus, and they are called *mochin d'ibbur* (prenatal intellect).⁹

Mochin d'ibbur is a state of developing (but still immature) intellect.

אֲךָ אַח"כּ בְּגִדְלוֹת כְּשֶׁנִּגְמַר בּוֹ הַמַּחִין הָאֱמֵתִי

But later, in the state of maturity when the real brain has developed – in our analogy, when the child has developed into an adult and has gained intellectual maturity –

הֵנָּה נַעֲשֶׂה מִהַמַּחִין דְּעֲבוּר לְקְרוּמִין עַל הַמַּחִין

then the *mochin d'ibbur* (prenatal intellect) become the membranes surrounding the brain rather than the mere de facto status of brain in the fetus.

וְשֵׁם שׁוֹרָה בּוֹ הַנֶּשְׁמָה דְּהַנֶּפֶשׁ

There, as they surround the fully developed brain, the micro-level *neshama* of macro-level *nefesh* resides therein in the *krumin*-membranes,

וְהוּא לְבוּשׁ עַל הַנֶּשְׁמָה דְּהַרוּחַ שֶׁהוּא בְּהִמּוּחַ מִמֶּשׁ

which function as the 'garment' or surrounding membrane enveloping the micro-level *neshama* of macro-level *ruach* which is vested in the actual brain,

כמו הקרומין שהם לבוש על המוח

just like the *krumin*-membranes that function as a 'garment' surrounding the brain.

ונמצא כי עכ"פ הוא שהם שניהם בהמום שבראש זה בהמום מממש וזה בהקרום.

So it turns out in any event that both of them (*neshama* of *ruach* and *neshama* of *nefesh*) are vested in the brain in the head – this *neshama* of *ruach* in the actual brain, and that *neshama* of *nefesh* in the membrane surrounding the brain.

וכן עד"ז בהקרום שבשניהם כי הן הרום שברום והן הרום שבנפש שניהם הם בלב

And similarly regarding *ruach* in both of them – both micro-level *ruach* of macro-level *ruach* and micro-level *ruach* of macro-level *nefesh* are both vested in the heart.

וזהו מציאת השני חללים שבלב באחד רום ואחד דם

And this is the parallel to the existence of two chambers in the heart – in one *ruach* and in the other blood i.e. the *nefesh*, "for the blood is the *nefesh*" (Deut. 12:23) – as the Baal haLeshem will explain shortly –

הימין רום והשמאל דם

in the right, *ruach*; in the left, blood.¹⁰

והם הרום שברום והרום שבנפש

When we said that *ruach* and *nefesh* are vested in the heart, these are *ruach* of *ruach*, and *ruach* of *nefesh*.

ומה שהוא דם הוא משרש הכבד אשר בו ששם הוא עקר מציאותו וגליו

The reason that *nefesh* is referred to as 'blood' is because it is rooted in the liver, for there is its primary existence and where it is primarily revealed,

כי עקר מציאותו וגליו דהנפש הוא רק בכבד.

since the primary aspect of the existence and revelation of the *nefesh* is only in the liver.¹¹

וכן הוא עד"ז בהנפש שבשניהם כי הן הנפש שברוח והן הנפש דהנפש

The same concept applies to the *nefesh* in both of them, since *nefesh* of *ruach* and *nefesh* of *nefesh*

שניהם הם בהכבד הנפש דהרוח מבפנים והנפש דהנפש מבחוץ

are both vested in the liver – *nefesh* of *ruach* inwardly, and *nefesh* of *nefesh* outwardly.

'Inwardly' and 'outwardly' here possibly refer to two of the general functions of the liver – metabolism and synthesis of nutrients (inward), and purifying the blood of toxins (outward).

והוא אשר משתתף ומתערב עם הדם והבשר

It is the liver that interfaces and intermingles with the blood and flesh,

וכמ"ש (דברים יב, כג) כי הדם הוא הנפש ולא תאכל הנפש עם הבשר

as it is written (Deut. 12:23) "For the blood is the life *nefesh* and you shall not eat the life *nefesh* with the meat."

והוא הנפש דנפש אשר הוא משתתף ומתערב עם הדם והבשר

This is the level of *nefesh* of *nefesh* which interfaces and intermingles with the blood and flesh.

אבל הנפש דהרוח הוא מפנים אליו ושניהם הם בכבד

But *nefesh* of *ruach* is internal to that, although both of them are in the liver.

וזהו הענין מה שתלוי טריפת הכבד בשעור ב' זיתים

This is the concept that the kosher or non-kosher status of a liver is determined by the measure of two olives'-worth:

כזית במקום מרה ושם הוא הנפש שבנפש

if there is an olive's-worth in the area of the gall-bladder where the *nefesh* of *nefesh* is situated,

וכזית במקום חיותו ששם הוא הנפש דהרוח שבנפש

and an olive's-worth in the place of its life i.e. in the place from which it receives its nourishment, so that the animal can survive, which is the *nefesh* of *ruach* of *nefesh*, then it is kosher.¹²

ונקרא הוא מקום חיותו כי הרוח הוא עקר החיים.

And it is called 'the place of its life' since *ruach* is the primary aspect of life.

והרי נתבאר לנו מכ"ז כי הן הנר"נ דהרוח והן הנר"נ דהנפש

All the above clarifies for us that the *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* of *ruach* as well as the *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* of *nefesh* –

שניהם הם במח לב כבד שהם ראש גויה בטון

both of them are vested in the brain, heart and liver, which are housed in the head, torso and the abdominal section.

וכן הם שניהם בכל חלקי פנימי תיכון חיצון דהגוף שאמרנו לעיל
פ"א

Both of them are also vested in all parts of the body – inner, middle and outer, as described in chapter 1 above.

וְהָרִי הֵם מִתְחִילִים שְׁנִיָּהֶם מִן הַמֶּחֱ וְכֵן הֵם מִתְפַּשְׁטִים שְׁנִיָּהֶם עַד
סוֹף הַגּוּף:

And both of them begin in the brain, and both of them spread into the body all the way down to the final i.e. the lowest and least important aspects of the body.

Footnotes

1. Makover. ↩
2. Perhaps we can refer to this as the plant's 'situational-awareness' or 'survival-intelligence.' ↩
3. Literally, 'plant soul.' ↩
4. Literally, 'the soul that combines....' ↩
5. Every material object is demarcated by six spatial dimensions (right, left, front, back, above, below) radiating from its central point. ↩
6. We have listed them in this order specifically, corresponding to the brain, the heart and the liver. ↩
7. *Binah*, *chochmah* and *keter* in this order, so that they correspond to *neshama* (*binah*), *chaya* (*chochmah*) and *yechida* (*keter*) mentioned in the previous line. ↩
8. There are three layers of meninges: dura mater (closest to the bone), arachnoid loosely around the brain, pia mater is closely attached to the brain and spinal cord surface. ↩
9. Recent studies also suggest that rather than acting as a passive connective tissue 'neural container' during

development, the meninges may also interact with and regulate cranial skull and neural development. [↩](#)

10. In general the Sages relied on the knowledge of their times.
See *Moreh Nevuchim* 3:14. [↩](#)

11. As noted in *Eitz Chaim* 1:3. [↩](#)

12. *Chulin* 46a, Rashi; Tur and *Shulchan Aruch Yoreh De'ah* 41:1. [↩](#)

Chapter 5 — Just as we find *nefesh*, *ruakh* and *neshama* one above the other and one inside the other, we also have each grouping within each of them.

Shaar 3 Chapter 5

אַמנם מָה שִׁישׁ לְכַאוֹרָה לְתַמָּה בְּזֶה כִּי הוּא נֶגֶד הַנוֹדֶעַ

However, at first glance, what we just said¹ – that *neshama* of *ruach* and *nefesh* is in the brain, rather than *neshama* of *neshama*² – seems surprising, because it contradicts what we know,

וְנֶגֶד מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לְעֵיל בְּכָל דְּבָרֵינוּ

and it goes against everything we said above –

שִׁישְׁנוּ לַכ"א מֵהֵנֶר"נ מְקוֹם מִיָּחָד בְּהִגּוּף וְהֵם הֵג' פְּלִים מִן לֵב כְּבֵד

that *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* [from here on abbreviated as NR"N for the macro-level and nr"n for the micro-level] each have a designated location in the body, which are the three 'vessels' for the three parts of the soul – the brain, the heart and the liver –

שֶׁהַנֶּשְׁמָה הִיא לְמַעַלָּה בְּהַמוֹחַ וְהָרוּחַ הוּא בְּאֶמְצַע שֶׁהוּא בִּלְב

such that the *neshama* is located above in the brain, *ruach* in the middle, in the heart,

וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הוּא לְמַטָּה שֶׁהוּא בְּכֵבֶד

and *nefesh* below, in the liver.

כִּי כְמוֹ שֶׁהוּא בְּכָלֵלוּת הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֵּן הוּא בְּפִרְטוֹת כָּל פְּרָצוּף

The answer is that just as it is in the general or universal i.e. macro-level Worlds, so too is it in the individual or local i.e. micro-level of every *partzuf*:

In order to maintain the proper perspective regarding these two aspects – the general/universal as opposed to the individual/local – and thus avoid misunderstanding, we will refer to them as macro-level and micro-level respectively.

וּבְכָל לְלוֹת הָעוֹלָמוֹת שֶׁהֵם בְּרִיָּאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה

in the macro-level Worlds – *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* –

וּבְרִיָּאָה הִיא נִשְׁמָה וְיְצִירָה רוּחַ וְהָעֲשִׂיָּה נֶפֶשׁ

***Beriah* is *neshama*, *Yetzirah* is *ruach* and *Asiyah* is *nefesh*.**

הֵרִי הֵם בְּכָל עֶקֶרָם זֶה לְמַעַלָּה מִזֶּה לְגִמְרִי

Thus inherently they are one above the other completely, as discrete levels with no overlap.

וְהֵם הֵנֶר"נ הַכְּלָלִיִּים

And they are *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* [NR"N] on the macro-level.

וְכֵן הוּא בִּפְרָטוֹת ג"כ שֶׁבְּמָקוֹם שֶׁמִּסְתִּיִּם הָעֲלִיּוֹן שֶׁם מִתְחִיל
הַתְּחִתּוֹן

And similarly on the micro-level – where the higher level ends, only there does the lower level begin, with no overlap.

אֲבָל לְפִי מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ עַתָּה הֵרִי יִהְיֶה נִמְצָא שֶׁאֵין חֲלוּק מְקוֹמוֹת
בִּיְנֵיהֶם כָּלֵל

But according to what we just said – that nr"n are arranged in an integrated, overlapping manner, not one below the other – it would turn out that there is no separation of place i.e. (spiritual) boundary separating them at all,

כי הרי הם שלשתם במח שהוא הנשמה שבהם

since all three of them are manifested in the brain which is the *neshama*-level among them,

ושלשתם בלב שהוא הרוח שבהם

and all three of them are manifested in the heart which is the *ruach*-level among them,

ושלשתם בכבד שהוא הנפש שבהם

and all three of them are manifested in the liver which is the *nefesh*-level among them.

והוא ע"פ מה שאמרנו שגם הנר"נ דהנשמה הכללית

This is according to our statement that NR "N of *neshama* at the macro-level

הם מתפשטים ג"כ ומתלבשים עם הקצה היותר תחתון שבהם
בהרוח

also spread forth and become clothed – via their lowest edge – in *ruach*.

ופשוט הוא שאותן הבחי' דהנר"נ הם מתפשטים ומתחלקים ג"כ

And it is obvious that those aspects of NR "N also spread out and subdivide

ע"ד הסדר דהנר"נ שבהרוח ונפש הכלליים

in the same manner and order as NR "N of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*,

והרי הוו שלשתם בהמוח ושלשתם בהלב ושלשתם בהכבד

so that all three of them are vested in the brain, all three of them in the heart, and all three of them in the liver.

וא"כ הרי אין חלוק מקומות בין מעלה ומטה בהנר"נ הפלליים

Accordingly, there is no separation i.e. no boundary separating between upper and lower of the macro-level NR"N

אשר בכל פרצוף ופרצוף גופה כלל.

that is in each *partzuf* itself; none at all.

משא"כ בהנר"נ הפלליים דהעולמות הרי הם חלוקים במקומם
לגמרי

But this is not so as regards the macro-level NR"N of the Worlds.

שהרי עולם הבריאָה שְׁהִיא הנְשָׁמָה הפללית דהעולמות

Thus the World of *Beriah*, which is the macro-level Neshama of the Worlds,

היא עומדת בכל עקרה למעלה

is located entirely there in the upper segment of the map of the Worlds.

ועולם היצירה שהוא הרוח הפללי הוא עומד בכל עקרו באמצע

And the World of *Yetzirah*, which is the macro-level Ruach of the Worlds, is located entirely in the middle segment of the map of the Worlds.

ועולם העשיה שְׁהִיא הנֶפֶשׁ הפללי היא בכל עקרה למטה

And the World of *Asiyah*, which is the macro-level Nefesh of the Worlds, is located entirely in the lower segment of the map of the Worlds.

והרי לא הוו הנר"נ הפלליים שבהעולמות

Hence the NR"N of the macro-level Worlds

עם הנר"נ הפלליים שבכל פרצוף ופרצוף בסדר אחד כלל

and the NR"N of each macro-level *partzuf* are not of one configuration i.e. they do not parallel each other.

והוא לכאורה קושיא גדולה כי הרי לעיל פ' א' וב'

Now this would seem to present a tremendous difficulty, for above in chapters 1 and 2

אמרנו שסדר מציאת העולמות עם סדר בגין כל פרצוף שוים הם בכל וכל:

we stated that the manner in which the existence of the Worlds is arranged, and the manner in which each *partzuf* is configured, is identical in every respect!

אך הענין בזה הוא כי הרי כבר מתבאר מדברינו לעיל פ"א

However, the solution to this conundrum was already comprehensible from what we said in chapter 1 –

כי כל נר"נ הנה כשם שהם חלוקים בין מעלה ומטה

that in all instances of NR"N, just as there is a distinction between top and bottom i.e. on the vertical plane,

שהנשמה הוא למעלה והרוח באמצע והנפש למטה

so that *neshama* is in the top segment, *ruach* is in the middle segment, and *nefesh* is in the bottom segment,

כן הם חלוקים ג"כ בין פנימי לחיצון

so too are they distinct in terms of inner and outer i.e. on the horizontal plane.

שהנשמה היא בחלק הפנימי שבגוף

Thus the *neshama* is in the inner layer of the body,

וְהָרוּחַ הוּא בְּחֶלֶק הַתִּיכוֹן וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ בְּחֶלֶק הַחִיצוֹן

***ruach* is the central layer, and *nefesh* is in the outer layer.**

וְהָרִי הֵם ג' מַדְרָגוֹת בְּגִבָּה שֶׁהֵם מַעֲלָה וְאִמְצָע וּמִטָּה

Thus there are three levels vertically – top, mid-level, bottom –

וְכֵן ג' מַדְרָגוֹת בְּעֵבִי שֶׁהֵם פְּנִימִי תִיכוֹן חִיצוֹן

and so too there are three layers horizontally – inner, central and outer.

וְהֵנָּה הֵם תִּשְׁעַ בְּחִי שֶׁהֵם רֹאשׁ תוֹךְ סוֹף

Thus in all there are nine aspects: top, middle, bottom – transliterated: *rosh, toch, sof* –

שֶׁכ"א הוּא כָּלּוּל מִג' שֶׁהֵם פְּנִימִי תִיכוֹן חִיצוֹן

such that each of them comprises three subdivisions – inner, central, outer –

וְהֵנָּה הֵם הֵנֶר"ן שֶׁבִּנְשָׁמָה וְהוּא בְּמוֹחַ

and these are nr"n of *neshamah* in the brain;

וְהֵנֶר"ן שֶׁבְּרוּחַ וְהוּא בְּלֵב

nr"n of *ruach* in the heart;

וְהֵנֶר"ן שֶׁבִּנְפֶשׁ בְּנֶפֶשׁ וְהוּא בְּכֶבֶד וְהֵם ט'

and nr"n of *nefesh* in the liver – making 9 altogether, since each of the three macro-levels is subdivided into three.

וְעַם שֶׁרֶשׁ הַנִּעְלָם דכ"א אֲשֶׁר מִמֶּנּוּ הוּא יוֹצֵא וְנִמְשָׁךְ הוּא עֶשֶׂר.

[Author's note: Together with the hidden root of each of them – from which they emerge and are drawn down – there are 10.

וְהֵם בְּחִי הָעֶשֶׂר סְפִי שֵׁשָׁנָם בַּכ"א

These are the 10 *sefirot* that are in each level:

כִּי הֵנֵר"נ שְׁבַהֲנֶשְׁמָה בְּהַפְנִימִי תִיכּוֹן חִיצוֹן שְׁבָה הֵם חב"ד
[חֻכְמָה, בִּינָה, דַּעַת].

The nr"n of *neshama* in its inner, central and outer layers are *chochmah, binah* and *da'at*.

וְהֵנֵר"נ דְּהַרוּחַ בְּהַפְת"ח [פְּנִימִי, תִיכּוֹן, חִיצוֹן] שְׁבָה הֵם חג"ת
[חֶסֶד, גְּבוּרָה, תְּפָאֶרֶת].

The nr"n of *ruach* in its inner, central and outer layers are *chesed, gevurah* and *tiferet*.

וְהֵנֵר"נ דְּהַנֶּפֶשׁ בְּהַפְת"ח שְׁבָה הֵם נה"י [נֶצַח, הוֹד, יְסוֹד]

And the nr"n of *nefesh* in its inner, central and outer layers are *netzach, hod, yesod*.

וְהַמַּלְכוּת הִנֵּה הוּא פְּרָצוּף בַּפִּנ"ע פְּרָצוּף הַנוֹקְבָא

(And *malchut* is an independent *partzuf*, called the *partzuf* of *nukvah*, the female *partzuf*,

שֵׁשָׁנָם בָּה ג"כ כָּל אוֹתָן הָעֶשֶׂר)

which also has all those ten *sefirot* in it). End of author's note.]

וְכ"ז הוּא הֵן בְּכָל־לֹוֹת הָעוֹלָמוֹת וְהֵן בְּפִרְטוֹת כָּל עוֹלָם וְכָל פְּרָצוּף

And all this is so in the Worlds on the macro-level, and also on the micro-level in each world and each *partzuf*,

כִּי כ"א הוּא כָּלֹל מִנֵּר"נ כָּנ"ל

since each of them the macro-levels of NR"N is comprised of micro-level nr"n, as explained above,

וַיִּשְׁנֻם בַּכּ"א כָּל הַתְּשֻׁעַ בְּחַי' שֶׁהֵם ג' חֲלָקִי נר"נ וְהֵם הִי' סִפִּי
שֶׁבַכ"א.

such that there is in each of them all nine aspects – the three layers of the inner, central and outer layers of each of NR"N – and these are the ten *sefirot* in each of them.

As explained above: the nr"n of the inner layer (*neshama*) are *chochmah*, *binah* and *da'at*; the nr"n of the central layer (*ruach*) are *chesed*, *gevurah* and *tiferet*; and the nr"n of the outer layer (*nefesh*) are *netzach*, *hod*, *yesod* – plus *malchut*.

וְהִנֵּה הֵם עוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה שֶׁהֵם הֵם הַכָּלָלִים

Now in the three worlds, *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*, which are the macro-level NR"N,

וַיִּשְׁנֻם בַּכּ"א מֵהֵם הַתְּשֻׁעַ בְּחַי' הַנִּזְ'

the nine aspects mentioned are present in each of them.

הָרִי דַעַת לְגִבּוֹן נִקְלָ³

Behold, (Proverbs 14:6) "...wisdom will come easily to one who understands"⁴

כִּי הֵם חֲלָקֵי רוּחַ הַפְּרָטִיִּים אֲשֶׁר בְּרֹאשׁ תוֹךְ סוּף דְּהִנְשָׁמָה הַכָּלָלִית,
שֶׁהִיא עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה,

that the three micro-level aspects of *ruach* – the aspect of *ruach* of *rosh*, *toch*, *sof* of the macro-level *neshama*, which corresponds to the World of *Beriah*,

וְהֵם בְּחֲלָקֵי הַתִּיכוֹן שֶׁבָּהֶם,

are the subsections of their central layer horizontally, since we are referring to *ruach*, the central layer –

הִנֵּה הֵם הַשָּׁרֵשׁ לְכָל עוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה כָּלוּ

– they the three micro-level components of the macro-level i.e. macro-level Neshama are the root of the entire World of *Yetzirah*,

שהוא הרוח הכללי בכל פרטיו שבו

which is the macro-level Ruach with all of its subsections.

וכן הג' חלקי נפש הפרטיים אשר בראש תוך סוף דהנשמה
הכללית

Similarly, the three micro-level components of the *rosh, toch, sof* of the macro-level *neshama*,

שהוא בחלקי החיצון שבהם

which is their outer layer horizontally,

הנה הם השרש לכל עולם העשיה בלה

are the root of the entire World of *Asiyah*,

שהיא הנפש הכללי בכל פרטיה שבה:

which is the macro-level Nefesh with all of its details.

והענין בבאור הוא כי הנה מחלק הרוח הפרטי שבהנר"נ
דהנשמה דבריא

The explanation of this concept is that from the micro-level *ruach* of nr"n of *neshama* of *Beriah*,

שהוא החלק התיכון שבה

which is its central layer horizontally,

הנה מזה נמשך הנשמה הפרטי שבהנר"נ דהנשמה דהיצירה

from this is drawn the micro-level *neshama* of nr"n of *neshama* of *Yetzirah* (#1 in Diagram 6)

שהוא החלק הפנימי שבה

which is its inner layer horizontally.

כי מהרום דהנשמה שבהנשמה הכללי נעשה הנשמה שבנשמה
דהרום הכללי

So that from the *ruach* of *neshama* of macro-level Neshama is produced *neshama* of *neshama* of macro-level Ruach. (See Diagram 1 below and #1 in Diagram 6).

אמנם אח"כ מתפשט ומסתער גם היא לנר"נ

Nevertheless, subsequently it too spreads out and branches out to micro-nr"n

והם הנר"נ שבהנשמה דהיצירה.

and they comprise nr"n of *neshama* in *Yetzirah*.

ומחלק הרום הפרטי דהנר"נ שבהרום דבריא

And from the micro-level *ruach* of nr"n of *ruach* of *Beriah*

הנה מזה נמשך ונעשה הנשמה הפרטי שבהנר"נ דהרום דהיצירה

– from this is drawn down and produced the micro-level *neshama* of nr"n of *ruach* in *Yetzirah* (#3 in Diagram 6).

כי מרום שבהרום דהנשמה הכללי

Since from *ruach* of *ruach* of the macro-level Neshama

נעשה מזה הנשמה שברום אשר בהרום הכללי

is produced *neshama* of *ruach* of macro-level Ruach. (#3 in Diagram 6)

אמנם אח"כ מתפשט ומסתער גם היא לנר"נ

Nevertheless, subsequently it too spreads forth and branches out into nr"n –

וְהֵם הֵנֵר"נ שֶׁבְּהָרוּחַ דְּהִיצִירָה.

and comprises the nr"n of *ruach* of *Yetzirah*.

וּמִחֶלֶק הָרוּחַ הַפְּרָטִי שֶׁבִּהֵנֵר"נ דְּהִנְפֵּשׁ דְּבְרִיאָה

And from the micro-level *ruach* of nr"n of *Nefesh* of *Beriah*

הֵנָּה מִזֶּה נִמְשָׁךְ וְנַעֲשֶׂה הַנִּשְׁמָה הַפְּרָטִי שֶׁבִּהֵנֵר"נ דְּהִנְפֵּשׁ דְּהִיצִירָה

– from this is drawn down and produced the micro-level *neshama* of nr"n of *nefesh* of *Yetzirah* (#5 in Diagram 6),

כִּי מִהָרוּחַ שֶׁבִּנְפֵשׁ דְּהִנְשָׁמָה הַכִּלְי

since from *ruach* of *nefesh* of the macro-level *neshama* in *Beriah*

נַעֲשֶׂה מִזֶּה הַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁבִּנְפֵשׁ דְּהָרוּחַ הַכִּלְי

is produced *neshama* of *nefesh* of macro-level *ruach*. (See Diagram 2; #5 in Diagram 6)

אֲמָנָם מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִסְתַּעַף גַּם הֵיא לֵנֵר"נ וְהֵם הֵנֵר"נ שֶׁבְּהִנְפֵּשׁ
דְּהִיצִירָה

However, it too spreads forth and branches out into nr"n of *nefesh* of *Yetzirah*.

וְהָרִי נִמְשָׁךְ כָּל הִיצִירָה מִהִבְרִיאָה מִהַחֶלֶק הַתִּיכוֹן שְׁבָהּ

Thus the entirety of *Yetzirah* is drawn from *Beriah*, from its central layer (i.e. from *ruach* of *neshama*, *ruach* of *ruach*, and *ruach* of *nefesh*).

וְנַעֲשֶׂה כָּל הָרוּחַ הַכִּלְי בְּכָל פְּרָטִי הַג' חֶלְקֵי נֵר"נ שְׁבוּ

And the entire macro-level *ruach* which is *Yetzirah* is produced with all its micro-level aspects of nr"n

מהרוח הפרטי אשר בהג' חלקי נר"נ שבהנשמה הכללי.

from micro-level *ruach* of the three-part nr"n of macro-level *neshama* in *Beriah* — i.e. from *ruach* of *neshama* (#1), from *ruach* of *ruach* (#3), and from *ruach* of *nefesh* (#5).

Diagram 1 — Micro-level *ruach* of *Beriah* as the root of macro-level *ruach* (*Yetzirah*)

<i>Beriah</i> (source)	→	<i>Yetzirah</i> (derived)
<i>ruach</i> of NESHAMA of <i>Beriah</i>	→	Root of <i>neshama</i> of NESHAMA of <i>Yetzirah</i> (#1 in Diagram 6)
<i>ruach</i> of RUACH of <i>Beriah</i>	→	Root of <i>neshama</i> of RUACH of <i>Yetzirah</i> (#3 in Diagram 6)
<i>ruach</i> of NEFESH of <i>Beriah</i>	→	Root of <i>neshama</i> of NEFESH of <i>Yetzirah</i> (#5 in Diagram 6)

Thus the three micro-levels of *ruach* of nr"n of *Beriah* (#1, 3, 5 in Diagram 6) are the respective origins of the three micro-levels of *neshama* in *Yetzirah*.

ועד"ז העולם העשיה שהיא הנפש הכללי בכל הג' חלקי נר"נ
שבה

Similarly the World of *Asiyah*, which is the macro-level *Nefesh* with its three divisions of nr"n,

הנה נעשה היא מכל בחי' הנפש הפרטי

is produced from all the aspects of micro-level *nefesh*

אשר בהג' חלקי נר"נ דעולם הבריאה שהיא הנשמה הכללי

in each of the three aspects of nr"n of the World of *Beriah*, which is the macro-level *neshama* (#2, 4, 6 in Diagram 6),

ומכל בחי' נפש הפרטי אשר בהג' חלקי נר"נ דעולם היצירה שהוא הרוח הכללי

and in addition⁵ from all the micro-levels of *nefesh* in each of the three aspects of nr"n of the World of *Yetzirah*, which is the macro-level *ruach*,

והיינו כי מחלק הנפש הפרטי שבהנר"נ דהנשמה דבריא

i.e. the micro-level of *nefesh* in each of nr"n of *neshama* of the World of *Beriah* (#2, 4, 6 in Diagram 6)

שהוא חלק החיצון שבה

— note that this micro-level of *nefesh* is its outermost layer —

הנה מזה נמשך ונעשה הנשמה הפרטי שבהנר"נ

from this outermost layer is drawn and produced the micro-level *neshama* of each of nr"n of *Asiyah* (#2, 4, 6 in Diagram 6),

דהנשמה דהעשיה שהוא החלק הפנימי שבה

such that the *neshama* of the World of *Asiyah* constitutes its inner layer.

כי מהנפש דהנשמה שבהנשמה הכללי

Hence from *nefesh* of *neshama* of the macro-level *neshama* of *Beriah*

נעשה הנשמה שבהנשמה דהנפש הכללי

is produced *neshama* of *neshama* of macro-level *nefesh* of *Asiyah* (#2 in Diagram 6).

והחלק הרוח דהנר"נ שבהנשמה דהעשיה

And the aspect of *ruach* of nr"n of the *neshama* of *Asiyah*

הנה הוא נמשך ונעשה מחלק הנפש דהנר"נ שבהנשמה דהיצירה

is drawn forth and produced from the *nefesh* of nr"n of the *neshama* of *Yetzirah*. (#7 in Diagram 6)

כי מהנפש שבהרום הכללי נעשה הרום דהנשמה
שבהנפש הכללי

Because from the *nefesh* of *neshama* of macro-level *ruach* is produced *ruach* of *neshama* of macro-level *nefesh*. (#7 in Diagram 6)

אמנם אם"כ הנה מתפשט גם הוא לאור דבחי' נפש ג"כ

Nevertheless, subsequently it too spreads into the light of the aspect of *nefesh* as well,

והם הנר"נ שבהנשמה דהעשיה.

and they constitute nr"n of the *neshama* of *Asiyah*.

ומחלק הנפש הפרטי דהנר"נ שבהרום דבריא

And from the micro-level *nefesh* of nr"n of *ruach* of *Beriah*

הנה מזה נמשך ונעשה הנשמה הפרטי שבהנר"נ דהרום דהעשיה

– from this is drawn and produced the micro-level *neshama* of nr"n of *ruach* of *Asiyah*. (#4 in Diagram 6)

כי מהנפש שבהרום דהנשמה הכללי נעשה הנשמה דהרום
שבהנפש הכללי.

Because from the *nefesh* of *ruach* of macro-level *neshama* of *Beriah*, is produced the *neshama* of *ruach* of macro-level *Nefesh* in *Asiyah*.

וחלק הרום שבו הנה הוא נמשך ונעשה מחלק הנפש דהנר"נ
דהרום דהיצירה

And the aspect of *ruach* therein i.e. the *ruach* of *ruach* of *Asiyah*, is drawn down and produced from the *nefesh* of nr"n of *ruach* of *Yetzirah*. (#8 in Diagram 6)

כי מהנפש שברוח דהרוח הכללי נעשה הרוח דרוח שבהנפש
הכללי

Because from the *nefesh* of *ruach* of macro-level *ruach* (*Yetzirah*) is produced the *ruach* of *ruach* of macro-level *Nefesh* of *Asiyah*.

אמנם אח"כ הוא מתפשט לאור דבחי' נפש ג"כ

However, subsequently it too spreads into the light of the aspect of *nefesh* as well,

והם הנר"נ שבהרוח דהעשיה.

and they constitute nr"n of the *ruach* of *Asiyah*.

ומחלק הנפש הפרטי דהנר"נ שבהנפש דבריא

And from the micro-level *nefesh* of nr"n of *nefesh* of *Beriah* (#6 in Diagram 6),

הנה מזה נמשך ונעשה הנשמה הפרטי שבהנר"נ דהנפש דהעשיה

– from this is drawn and produced the micro-level *neshama* of nr"n of *nefesh* of *Asiyah*. (#6 in Diagram 6)

כי מהנפש שבנפש דהנשמה הכללי נעשה הנשמה שבנפש דהנפש
הכללי

Because from the *nefesh* of *nefesh* of macro-level *neshama* is produced the *neshama* of *nefesh* of macro-level *nefesh*.

וחלק הרוח שבה הוא נמשך ונעשה מהנפש דהנר"נ שבהנפש
דהיצירה

And the aspect of *ruach* therein of *nefesh* of *Asiyah* is drawn down and produced from the *nefesh* of nr"n of *nefesh* of

Yetzirah.

כי מהנפש שבנפש דהרוח הכללי נעשה הרוח שבנפש שבהנפש
הכללי

Because from the *nefesh* of *nefesh* of macro-level Ruach (*Yetzirah*) is produced the *ruach* of *nefesh* of macro-level *nefesh* (*Asiyah*). (See Diagram 3, and #9 in Diagram 6).

אמנם אם"כ הוא מתפשט לאור הנפש ג"כ

However, subsequently it too spreads into the light of the aspect of *nefesh* as well,

והם הנר"נ דהנפש דהעשיה.

and they comprise nr"n of the *nefesh* of *Asiyah*.

Diagram 2 — Micro-level *nefesh* of *Beriah* as the root of macro-level Neshama of Nefesh (*Asiyah*)

<i>Beriah</i> (source)	→	<i>Asiyah</i> (derived)
<i>nefesh</i> of NESHAMA of <i>Beriah</i>	→	Root of <i>neshama</i> of NESHAMA of <i>Asiyah</i> (#2)
<i>nefesh</i> of RUACH of <i>Beriah</i>	→	Root of <i>neshama</i> of RUACH of <i>Asiyah</i> (#4)
<i>nefesh</i> of NEFESH of <i>Beriah</i>	→	Root of <i>neshama</i> of NEFESH of <i>Asiyah</i> (#6)

Diagram 3 — Micro-level *nefesh* of *Yetzirah* as the root of macro-level Ruach of Nefesh (*Asiyah*)

<i>Yetzirah</i> (source)	→	<i>Asiyah</i> (derived)
<i>nefesh</i> of NESHAMA of <i>Yetzirah</i>	→	Root of <i>ruach</i> of NESHAMA of <i>Asiyah</i> (#7)
<i>nefesh</i> of RUACH of <i>Yetzirah</i>	→	Root of <i>ruach</i> of RUACH of <i>Asiyah</i> (#8)

Yetzilah (source)	→	Asiyah (derived)
<i>nefesh</i> of NEFESH of Yetzilah	→	Root of <i>ruach</i> of NEFESH of Asiyah (#9)

וְהָרִי נִמְצָא כִּי בְנִין כָּל הָעֲשִׂיָּה שֶׁהִיא הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי

Thus we find that constructing the World of *Asiyah*, which is the macro-level Nefesh –

בְּכָל פְּרָטִי הֵג' חִלְקֵי נר"נ שָׁבָה

in each of the three aspects of nr"n thereof of the World of *Asiyah* –

הֵנָּה הוּא מֵהֵג' חִלְקֵי נֶפֶשׁ הַפְּרָטִיִּים דְּהַנִּשְׁמָה וְהָרוּחַ הַכִּלְלִיִּים

is from the three micro-level aspects of *nefesh* of macro-level *neshamah* and *Ruach*,

שֶׁהֵם הַבְּרִיאָה וְהִצְיָרָה

which are i.e. correspond to the Worlds of *Beriah* and *Yetzilah* respectively,

וְהוּא מַחֲלֵק הַחִיצוֹן שְׁבָהֵם.

and are of their outer layer.⁶

וְכֵן הָרִי נִמְצָא ג"כ כִּי עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה הִיא הַשְּׂרֵשׁ וְהַנִּשְׁמָה לְהִצְיָרָה וְהָעֲשִׂיָּה.

We also find that the World of *Beriah* is the root and the *neshamah* of *Yetzilah* and *Asiyah*,

וְעוֹלָם הִצְיָרָה הוּא הָרוּחַ לְהַבְּרִיאָה וְהָעֲשִׂיָּה,

and that *Yetzilah* is the *ruach* of *Beriah* and *Asiyah*,

וְעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הִיא הַנֶּפֶשׁ לְהַבְּרִיאָה וְהִצְיָרָה.

and that *Asiyah* is the *nefesh* of *Beriah* and *Yetzirah*.

כי עקר הגלוי דרוח ונפש אשר נעשה בהבריאה

This is because the primary emergence of *ruach* and *nefesh* generated in *Beriah*

הוא רק אחר שיצא ונעשה עולם היצירה והעשיה

is only after the Worlds of *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* emerge and are produced.

The primary aspect of *Beriah* is *neshama* (since it characterizes *Beriah* on the macro-level) and therefore it has no 'need' for *ruach* and *nefesh*. However, once *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* are created, the *ruach* of *Beriah* becomes the source of the *neshama* of *Yetzirah* (#a in Diagram 6), and *nefesh* of *Beriah* becomes the source of the *neshama* of *Asiyah* (#b in Diagram 6).

אבל מקדם היה כל בחי' רוח ונפש בעולם הבריאה רק בכם ולא בפעל.

But prior to this, any aspect of *ruach* and *nefesh* in the World of *Beriah* was only in potential, but was not actualized.

ויצא הרוח בבריאה מן הכח אל הפועל רק לצורך המציאות
דהיצירה ועל ידו

Thus *ruach* emerged from a state of potential to actual in *Beriah* only for the requirements of the existence of *Yetzirah*, and by way thereof.

וכן הגלוי דמציאת הנפש בעולם הבריאה והיצירה

And likewise the emergence of the actualization of *nefesh* in the Worlds of *Beriah* and *Yetzirah*

הוא רק לצורך המציאת דעולם העשיה ועל ידה דוקא

is only for the requirements of the existence of *Asiyah*, and precisely by way thereof.

nefesh of *Beriah* is required for *neshama* of *Asiyah* (#b in Diagram 6), and *nefesh* of *Yetzirah* is required for *ruach* of *Asiyah* (#c in Diagram 6).

וְהָרִי הָיָה הָעֲשִׂיָּה הַנֶּפֶשׁ לְשִׁנְיָהּם וְהִצִּירָה הָרוּחַ לְשִׁנְיָהּם
וְהִבְרִיָּאָה נִשְׁמָה לְשִׁנְיָהּם

Thus *Asiyah* constitutes the *nefesh* of both of them – of *Beriah* and *Yetzirah*; and *Yetzirah* constitutes the *ruach* of both of them – of *Beriah* and *Asiyah*; and *Beriah* constitutes the *neshama* of both of them – of *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*.

כִּי לֹא נִתְגַּלוּ כ"א בְּכָל הַג' בְּחִי' נר"נ שֶׁבּוּ אֶלָּא ע"י שְׁלֹשֶׁתָם דְּוָקָא

This is because none of them became revealed in all three aspects of its nr"n, other than precisely by way of all three of them.

אֲבָל מִקֵּדָם שִׁצְאוּ שְׁלֹשֶׁתָם כ"א עַל שְׁלֵמוֹתוֹ הָיָה כ"א רַק בְּבַחֲנֵתוֹ
לְבַד

But prior to all three emerging in a state of completion with all three aspects of nr"n, each of them possessed only its own aspect –

הִבְרִיָּאָה בְּבַחֲיָה נִשְׁמָה וְהִצִּירָה רוּחַ וְהָעֲשִׂיָּה נֶפֶשׁ

Beriah had only *neshama*, *Yetzirah* had only *ruach*, and *Asiyah* had only *nefesh* –

וְשֹׁאֵר הַב' בְּחִי' הָיָה בַּכ"א רַק בְּכַח וְלֹא בְּפִעֹל

while the other two aspects were only in potential in each of them, but were not actualized.

וְנִגְמַר וְנִשְׁלַם כ"א רַק ע"י שְׁלֹשֶׁתָם דְּוָקָא וְהָרִי הֵם כְּלוּלִים זֶה בְּזֶה

Hence each one of them becomes complete and fulfilled only by way of all three of them, and thus they are all inter-included, one with the other.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר הַסֵּפֶר יְצִירָה פ"א מִשְׁנָה ז'

And this is what it states in *Sefer Yetzirah*, chapter 1 mishnah 7:

עֶשֶׂר סְפִי בְּלִימָה נְעוּץ סוּפוֹ בְּתַחֲלָתוֹ וּתְחִלָּתוֹ בְּסוּפוֹ

"The ten *sefirot* without substance (*bli mah*, meaning 'of incomprehensible nature') – their end is wedged in their beginning, and their beginning in their end."

וְהוּא ע"פ מָה שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כִּי הֵם מְשֻׁרָשִׁים וְכְלוּלִים זֶב"ז

This is according to what we said above that they are rooted in each other, and are inter-included with one another,

וּמִתְגַּלִּים זֶה ע"י זֶה וְנִמְשָׁכִים וְנִעָשִׂים זֶה מִזֶּה:

and become revealed one via the other, and they are drawn from and produced from each other.

וְהִנֵּה הֵג' חֲלָקֵי נר"נ אֲשֶׁר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהֵם בְּכָל עוֹלָם וְכוּן בְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

Now regarding the three sections called nr"n which we stated are in every World, and in every *partzuf* –

הִנֵּה הִנֵּר"נ שֶׁבְּהִנְשָׁמָה הוּא בְּחִי' הִנְשָׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁבְּכָל עוֹלָם
וְשֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

The nr"n of *neshama* is the aspect of macro-level Neshama in each World and in each *partzuf*.

The *neshama* level of each World and the *neshama* level of each *partzuf* of that World ultimately derive from the macro-macro-level Neshama of *Beriah*.

וְהִנֵּר"נ שֶׁבְּהָרוּחַ הוּא בְּחִי' רוּחַ הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁבְּכָל עוֹלָם וְשֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

And the nr"n of *ruach* is the aspect of macro-level Ruach in each World and in each *partzuf*.

The *ruach* level of each World ultimately derives from the macro-macro-level *ruach* of *Yetzirah*.

והנר"נ שבנפש הוא בחי' נפש הכללי שבכל עולם ושבכל פרצוף

And the nr"n of *nefesh* is the aspect of macro-level Nefesh in each World and in each *partzuf*.

The *nefesh* level of each World ultimately derives from the macro-macro-level *nefesh* of *Asiyah*.

והרי נמצא כי הנר"נ הכלליים שבכל עולם ושבכל פרצוף

Thus we find that the macro-level nr"n in each of the Worlds and in each *partzuf*

הנה הם ג"כ באמת רק זה למעלה מזה לגמרי

are also in fact only arrayed one completely above the other without overlap,

כי הרי הם מסדירים בראש תוך סוף

so that they are arranged in the manner of *rosh*, *toch*, *sof* – or top, middle, bottom – with no overlap.

והרי הם זה למעלה מזה לגמרי כמו הנר"נ דכללי כללות⁷

Hence they are arrayed one completely above the other, just like the NR"N of the macro-macro-level,

שהם העולמות בריאה יצירה עשיה שהם זה למעלה מזה לגמרי

– i.e. the general or macro-macro-level Worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*, which are arrayed one completely above the other with no overlap,

שהקרע דהעליון הוא הגג דהתחתון

so that the floor of the upper World is the roof of the lower World,

כי הם בבחי' עליות זו על גבי זו וכמ"ש הרב בשער דרושי אבי"ע פ'
י"ד

and they are like the ascending floors of a building, one on top of the other, as Rabbi Chaim Vital writes in the name of the Arizal in *Eitz Chaim, Shaar Drushei Abiy*"a chapter 14.

כן הוא ג"כ הבחי' נר"נ הכללים שבכל עולם ושבכל פרצוף

And so too regarding the aspect of macro-level nr"n in each World and in each *partzuf* –

הם זה למעלה מזה עד שבמקום שמסתים העליון שם מתחיל
התחתון

they too are arrayed one above the other to the extent that where the upper one ends, only then does the lower one begin, and again there is no overlap.

אלא שעכ"ז המה הם כלולים זב"ז ג"כ

Nevertheless, they are all inter-included one with the other as well.

Even though each level is distinct and there is no overlap between the Worlds or between the *partzufim*, the inner structure of all the Worlds is similar, as will be explained.

והוא ע"י כי מה שהם יורדים זה מזה ע"י שהם מסדרים בראש
תוך סוף

This is due to the fact that although they descend from one another since they are arrayed in the manner of *rosh, toch, sof* (top, middle, bottom – vertically),

הנה הם חוזרים ועולים זב"ז ע"י הסדר דפנימי תיכון חיצון

they also return and ascend via one another due to their inner configuration of inner, central and outer layers horizontally.

כי היתך והתיכון הם משרש אחד ונעשים לבחי' אחת

The inner layer horizontally and the middle section vertically stem from the same root and become one composite aspect.

וכן הסוף והחיצון שהם משרש אחד נעשים לבחי' אחת.

Also the bottom section (*sof*) and the outer layer (*chitzon*) stem from the same root and become one composite aspect.

והרי נמצא כי הגם שהם יורדים זה מזה עכ"ז הנה הם חוזרים ועולים זה בזה

Thus we find that they descend from one another, nevertheless, they also return and ascend into one another,

והם עומדים כלולים זב"ז לעולם.

and they always maintain their inter-included state.

וכ"ז הנה הוא הן בכל עולם ובכל פרצופים הפרטיים

Now all of this is in each of the worlds and in all of the micro-level *partzufim*

והן בהעולמות בריאה יצירה עשיה הכלליים

as well as in the macro-macro-worlds of *Beriah*, *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*.

והרי לנו כי האמת הוא שהכלל והפרט הם שניהם מסדרים בסדר אחד

Thus we come to the conclusion that in truth the macro-macro-level i.e. NR"N and their sub-levels i.e. nr"n are arranged in the identical manner –

כי הרי בשניהם הנה עקר הנשמה הכללית למעלה

since in both of them the primary aspect of macro-level *neschama* is above at the top,

וְעָקֵר רוּחַ הַכָּלְלִי בְּאִמְצָע וְעָקֵר הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכָּלְלִי לְמַטָּה

and the primary aspect of macro-level *ruach* is in the middle, and the primary aspect of macro-level *nefesh* is below at the bottom.

אֲלָא שֶׁ"י הַסֵּדֶר דִּהְפָּנִימִי תִּיכּוֹן חִיצוֹן שְׁבָהֶם

However, via the arrangement of inner, central and outer,

הֵנָּה כָּלּוּל הַנִּשְׁמָה דכ"א שְׁבִשְׁנֵיהֶם לְמַטָּה ג"כ⁸

the *neshamah* of each level in both of them is integrated below into the Worlds of *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah* as well,

וְהָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ דכ"א שְׁבִשְׁנֵיהֶם לְמַעְלָה ג"כ וְהֵם כָּלּוּלִים זב"ז לְעוֹלָם:

and the *nefesh* and *ruach* of each level in both of them is above in *Beriah*⁹ as well, and they are forever inter-included with one another.

וְהֵנָּה בְּאִשְׁרֵי תַתְּבוּנוֹ בְּכָל דְּבָרֵינוּ הַלָּלוּ

Now when you contemplate all of these words of ours,

תִּבְיִן כִּי עֲצָמוֹת הָעֲקָרִי דִּהְנִשְׁמָה¹⁰

you will understand that what we refer to primarily as 'the *neshamah* itself'

הֵנָּה הוּא רַק חֵלֶק הַנִּשְׁמָה הַפָּרָטִי מֵהֵנָּה שְׁבִנְשָׁמָה

is actually only the micro-level aspect of *neshamah* of nr"n of macro-level Neshama

וְהוּא חֵלֶק הַפָּנִימִי דִּהְנִשְׁמָה הָעוֹמֵד לְמַעְלָה שֶׁהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה דְּנִשְׁמָה.

i.e. the inner aspect of the Neshama as it is above, that is to say, the *neshama* of macro-level Neshama.

וְעֲצָמוֹת הָעֶקְרִי דִּהְרוּם הִנֵּה הוּא רַק חֵלֶק הָרוּם הַפְּרָטִי מֵהֵנֶר"ן
דִּהְרוּם

And what we refer to primarily as 'the *ruach* itself' is actually only the micro-level aspect of *ruach* of nr"n of macro-level Ruach

וְהוּא חֵלֶק הַתִּיכוֹן דִּהְרוּם הָעֵמֶד בְּאֶמְצַע שֶׁהוּא הָרוּם דִּרוּם.

which is the central layer horizontally of the *ruach* that is situated in the middle vertically, that is to say the *ruach* of macro-level Ruach.

וְעֲצָמוֹת הָעֶקְרִי דִּהֶנֶפֶשׁ הִנֵּה הוּא רַק חֵלֶק הֶנֶפֶשׁ הַפְּרָטִי מֵהֵנֶר"ן
שֶׁבִּנְפֶשׁ

And what we refer to primarily as 'the *nefesh* itself' is actually only the micro-level aspect of *nefesh* of nr"n of macro-level Nefesh

וְהִיא הַחֵלֶק הַתַּחְתּוֹנָה וְהַחִיצוֹנָה שֶׁהוּא הֶנֶפֶשׁ דִּנְפֶשׁ.

which is the lowest and outermost layer, that is to say the *nefesh* of macro-level Nefesh.

Diagram 4 — The primary aspect of each soul-level¹¹

Vertical section	Horizontal layers	Primary aspect
NESHAMA (top)	inner / central / outer	<i>neshama</i> of nr"n
RUACH (middle)	inner / central / outer	<i>ruach</i> of nr"n
NEFESH (bottom)	inner / central / outer	<i>nefesh</i> of nr"n

וְהִרִי הִנֵּה עֶקֶר הַנִּשְׁמָה רַק הַפְּנִימִי דִּהָעֲלִיוֹן

Thus the primary aspect of *neshama* is the inner layer of the uppermost level,

ועקר הנפש רק החיצון דהתחתון

and the primary aspect of *nefesh* is the outer layer of the lowest level,

ועקר הרוח הוא רק האמצעי דאמצעי.

and the primary aspect of *ruach* is the central layer of the middle section.

והרי נמצא כי גם בעצמות העקרי שבהם

Thus we find that even in terms of the primary aspect of what they are,

הרי הנה ג"כ עקר הנשמה למעלה ומבפנים,

the main aspect of *neshama* is also at the topmost level and innermost layer,

ועקר הרוח באמצע ובתיכון

and the main aspect of *ruach* is in the mid-level and the central layer,

ועקר הנפש למטה ובחיצון:

and the main aspect of *nefesh* is also at the bottom-most and outermost level.

Diagram 5 — The nine aspects with the ten *sefirot*¹²

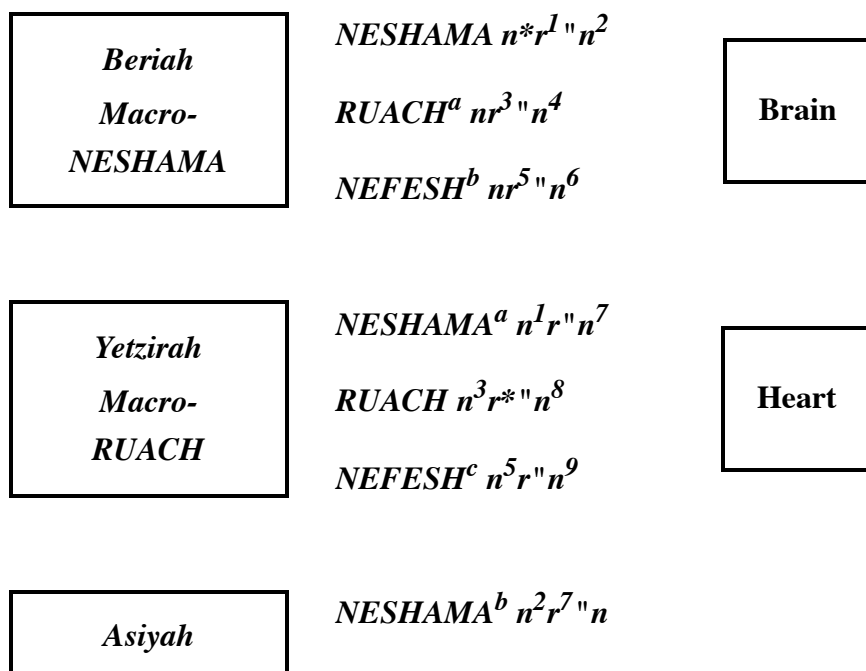
	Inner (<i>pnimi</i>)	Central (<i>tichon</i>)	Outer (<i>chitzon</i>)	Soul- level	Organ
Top (<i>rosh</i>)	<i>chochmah</i>	<i>binah</i>	<i>da'at</i>	<i>neshama</i>	Brain – מוח

	Inner (<i>pnimi</i>)	Central (<i>tichon</i>)	Outer (<i>chitzon</i>)	Soul- level	Organ
Middle (<i>toch</i>)	<i>chesed</i>	<i>gevurah</i>	<i>tiferet</i>	<i>ruach</i>	Heart – לב
Bottom (<i>sof</i>)	<i>netzach</i>	<i>hod</i>	<i>yesod</i>	<i>nefesh</i>	Liver – כבד

Diagram 6 — Inter-level correspondences¹³

In Diagram 6: The root of *neshama* of *Yetzirah* is from *ruach* of *Beriah* (a); the root of the *neshama* of *Asiyah* is from *nefesh* of *Beriah* (b); the root of the *ruach* of *Asiyah* is from *nefesh* of *Yetzirah* (c).

The nine aspects of *rosh*, *toch*, *sof* are depicted below. Soul-levels in CAPS are the macro-levels. The raised numbers show the relationship between each higher micro-level and the lower micro-level that derives from it.



*Macro-
NEFESH*

RUACH^c n⁴r⁸"n

Liver

*NEFESH n⁶r⁹"n**

* The primary reflection of this soul-level

אִמָּנָם סֹדֶר יֵצֵאתָם זֶה מִזֶּה וְכָל מִצִּיאת פְּרִיָּתָם

However, the way they emerge one from the other, and the manner of emergence of all their sub-levels the micro-levels of nr"n –

הָרִי כָּבֵד אֶמְרָנוּ כִּי הַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁבְּהָרוּחַ הַכֶּלְלִי אֲשֶׁר בֵּלֵב

we already discussed – that the *neshama* of macro-level Ruach in the heart (#a in Diagram 6)

הִנֵּה הִיא נִמְשָׁךְ וְנִעֲשֶׂה מִהָרוּחַ שֶׁבִּמֶה

is drawn down and produced from the *ruach* in the brain, (#a in Diagram 6)

שֶׁהִיא הָרוּחַ שֶׁבְּהַנִּשְׁמָה הַכֶּלְלִי

which is the *ruach* of macro-macro-level Neshama.

כִּי מִהָרוּחַ שֶׁבְּנִשְׁמָה נִעֲשֶׂה נִשְׁמָה שֶׁבִּרוּחַ

Because from *ruach* of macro-macro-level Neshama is produced *neshama* of macro-macro-level Ruach,

וְהִיא מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִסְתַּעַף לְכָל הַנֶּר"נ שֶׁבּוֹ שֶׁהֵם הַנֶּר"נ דְּהָרוּחַ הַכֶּלְלִי.

which spreads forth and branches out to all of its nr"n, which is the nr"n of macro-level *ruach*.

וְכֹן הַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁבַּהֲנֶפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי אֲשֶׁר בְּהַכֵּבֶד

And similarly, the *neshama* of macro-macro-level Nefesh in the liver (#b in Diagram 6)

הִנֵּה הִיא נִמְשָׁךְ וְנִעָשָׂה מֵהֲנֶפֶשׁ שֶׁבַּהֲנִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי אֲשֶׁר בַּמֶּחֶ

is drawn down and produced from the *nefesh* of macro-macro-level Neshama in the brain,

כִּי מֵהֲנֶפֶשׁ דֵּהֲנִשְׁמָה נִעָשָׂה הַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁבַּנֶּפֶשׁ.

because from *nefesh* of Neshama is produced *neshama* of Nefesh.

וְהָרוּחַ דֵּהֲנֶפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי אֲשֶׁר בְּכֵבֶד הִנֵּה הוּא נִעָשָׂה מֵהֲנֶפֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר
בְּהָרוּחַ הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁבֶּלֶב

Now *ruach* of macro-macro-level Nefesh in the liver is produced from *nefesh* of macro-macro-level Ruach in the heart, (#c in Diagram 6)

כִּי מֵהֲנֶפֶשׁ דֵּהָרוּחַ נִעָשָׂה הָרוּחַ שֶׁבַּנֶּפֶשׁ.

because from *nefesh* of macro-macro-level Ruach is produced *ruach* of macro-macro-level Nefesh.

וְנִמְצָא כִּי הָרוּחַ וְהֲנֶפֶשׁ שֶׁבַּהֲנִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁבַּמֶּחֶ

Thus we find that *ruach* and *nefesh* respectively of macro-level Neshama in the brain

הֵם הַשְּׂרֵשׁ לַהֲנִשְׁמָה שֶׁבַּהָרוּחַ הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁבֶּלֶב

are the root of *neshama* of macro-macro-level Ruach in the heart

וְלַהֲנִשְׁמָה שֶׁבַּהֲנֶפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁבְּכֵבֶד.

and of *neshama* of macro-macro-level Nefesh in the liver.

וְכֵן לֹא נִתְגַּלָּה מְצִיאוֹתָם בַּהֲנֻשָּׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי

In addition, the presence of *ruach* and *nefesh* in the macro-macro-level Neshama was not revealed

אֶלָּא רַק לְצַרֵּךְ הָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִיִּים וְעַל יָדָם דִּוְקָא

other than for the requirements of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*, and explicitly via them, as was explained previously.

אָבֵל קִדָּם שֶׁהִגִּיעַ עַת הַמְצִיאוֹת דֵּהָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִיִּים

But prior to the advent of the proper time for revealing the presence of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*,

הָיוּ הָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַפְּרָטִיִּים שֶׁבַּהֲנֻשָּׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי רַק בָּכֶם לְבַד וְלֹא
בַּפֶּעַל

the micro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* of macro-level Neshama were only in a state of potential, but were not actualized.

וְהָיוּ בָכֶם בְּחִינַת הַנֻּשָּׁמָה שְׁבָה שֶׁהִיא הַנֻּשָּׁמָה דִּנְשָׁמָה.

Instead, they were in a state of potential in the aspect of *neshama*, that is to say *neshama* of Neshama.

אֲמָנָם אוֹתָהּ הַנֻּשָּׁמָה דִּנְשָׁמָה שֶׁהִיא הַנֻּשָּׁמָה שֶׁבַּנֻּשָּׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית

However, that level of *neshama* of Neshama, which is the macro-level *neshama* of Neshama,

הִנֵּה הִיא אֵינָה שֹׁרֵשׁ לְשׁוּם דָּבָר כִּי הִיא רַק עֶקֶר מְצִיאוֹתָהּ גּוּפָה

is not a source for anything else, since it is just primary existence itself.

Accordingly, there is no link to the levels below it, as we see clearly in Diagram 6, where n (*neshama* of Neshama) is not marked with any raised letter or number.

וּר"ל שֶׁהִיא אֵינָה לְצַרֵּךְ זִוְלָתָהּ אֶלָּא לְצַרֵּךְ עֲצָמוֹ

Meaning to say, it is not for the sake of something else, but rather for its own sake,

כי היא עקר עצמותה וכמו שאמרנו לעיל בסמוך

since this is its primary essence, as we just explained above –

כי עקר עצמות דהנשמה הכללי הוא הנשמה דנשמה.

the primary essence of the macro-level *neschama* is the *neschama* of *neschama*.

ועד"ז הוא בְּהָרוּחַ הַכִּלְי שְׂבִיל

Similarly regarding macro-level *ruach* in the heart –

כי הנפש שבו הנה היא השרש להרוח שבהנפש הכללי אשר בכבד
וכנזכר

the micro-level of *nefesh* therein i.e. *nefesh* of *ruach* is the root of *ruach* of macro-level *nefesh* in the liver, as mentioned above.

ולא נתגלה אותו הנפש שבו אלא רק לצורך הנפש הכללי ועל ידה
דוקא

Now this micro-level *nefesh* was not revealed therein in *ruach* other than for the needs of the macro-level *nefesh*.

אבל קדם שהגיע עת המציאות דהנפש הכללי

But, prior to the advent of the proper time for the presence of the macro-level *nefesh* to become revealed,

היה הנפש הפרטי שבהרוח הכללי רק בכם לבד ולא בפעל

the micro-level *nefesh* of macro-level *ruach* was only in a state of potential, and was not actualized.

והיה בכם בהרוח שבו שהוא הרוח דרוח.

Instead, it was in a state of potential in the aspect of *ruach*, that is to say *ruach* of *ruach*.

אִמָּנָם אוֹתוֹ הָרוּחַ דְּרוּחַ שֶׁהוּא הָרוּחַ דְּרוּחַ הַכִּלְי

However, *ruach* of *ruach*, that is the micro-level *ruach* of macro-level *ruach*,

הִנֵּה הוּא אֵינוֹ שֶׁרֶשׁ לְשׁוּם דָּבָר ר"ל שֶׁהוּא אֵינוֹ לְצַרֵּךְ זֹלָתוֹ

is not the root of anything. Meaning to say it is not there for the sake of something else,

אֵלָּא שֶׁהוּא עֶקֶר מְצִיאוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה וְכֵן"ל בְּסִמּוֹךְ

but rather its primary existence is for itself, as was just explained –

שֶׁעֶקֶר הָעֲצָמוֹת דְּהָרוּחַ הַכִּלְי הוּא הָרוּחַ דְּרוּחַ.

since the primary essence of macro-level *ruach* is *ruach* of *ruach*.

וְהַנִּשְׁמָה שָׁבוּ ר"ל הַנִּשְׁמָה שֶׁבְּהָרוּחַ הַכִּלְי

And the level of *neshama* therein, meaning to say *neshama* of macro-level *ruach*,

הִנֵּה הִיא בְּחִי' תְּלִיתִי לְמַעַלָּה בְּהַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְי¹⁴

is linked in to the level above, to the macro-level *neshama*,

וְכֵן"ל שֶׁהִיא מִהָרוּחַ שֶׁבְּהַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְי

as was explained previously – that it is from *ruach* of macro-level *neshama* (#3 in the diagram above).

To recap: the root of the *neshama* of macro-level *ruach* (corresponding to *Yetzirah*) is from *ruach* of *neshama* (corresponding to *Beriah*); the root of the *neshama* of macro-level *nefesh* (corresponding to *Asiyah*) is from *nefesh* of *Beriah*; the root

of the *ruach* of macro-level *nefesh* (corresponding to *Asiyah*) is from *nefesh* of *Yetzirah*.

וְעוֹמֵד הַנִּשְׁמָה שְׁבוּרוֹם בְּבַחֲי הַמְּצִיאוֹת

And the *neshama* of *ruach* is in the state of actualized existence – unlike the *ruach* and *nefesh* levels of *ruach*, which were only in a state of potential but were not actualized –

אֲשֶׁר בָּהּ וְעַל יָדָהּ הוּא קָשׁוּר לְמַעַלָּה בַּהֲנִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי

so that in it, and via it – in and via the *ruach* of *neshama* – it the *neshama* of *ruach* is bound up above to the macro-level *neshama*.

וְכֵן יֵשׁ לַהֲנִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי ג"כ בְּחִי אַחַת הַמְּרָמָז עַל תְּלִיָּתָהּ לְמַעַלָּה]

[Author's Note: Similarly, the macro-level *neshama* also has an aspect that hints to its being linked in to a higher level –

וְהוּא סְפִירַת הַכֶּתֶר הַמְּרָמָז בְּקִיצוֹ שֶׁל י' דְּהוּי"ה הַכִּלְלִית שֶׁבִּנְשָׁמָה

to the *sefirah* of *Keter*, hinted to by the 'thorn' on top of the letter *yud* of the macro-level Name Y-H-V-H of the *neshama*,

שֶׁהִיא סְפִירַת הָעֲשִׂירִית הָעֲלִיוֹנָה אֲשֶׁר אָמְרָנוּ לְעִיל בְּדִבְרֵנוּ

which is the tenth *sefirah* above, counting from below to above, as we mentioned previously.

שֶׁהִיא הַשָּׂרֵשׁ הַנִּעְלָם שָׁבָה. וְהִבֵּן.]

And this is the hidden root of the macro-level *neshama*. Understand this well. End of author's note.]

וְעַד"ז הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁהִיא בְּכַבֵּד כִּי הִנֵּה הַנֶּפֶשׁ שָׁבָה הוּא עֶקֶר מְצִיאוֹתָהּ גּוּפָה

Similarly regarding macro-level *nefesh* in the liver –

כִּי הִנֵּה הַנֶּפֶשׁ שָׁבָה הוּא עֶקֶר מְצִיאוֹתָהּ גּוּפָה

the micro-level of *nefesh* therein i.e. *nefesh* of *nefesh* is its primary existence,

שהוא עצמותה העקרי וכמו שאמרנו לעיל בסמוך

since this is its primary essence, as we just explained above.

שעצמות העקרי דהנפש הכללי הוא הנפש שבנפש

Since the primary essence of the macro-level *nefesh* is the *nefesh* of *nefesh*.

והרוח שבה הוא תלייתה למעלה

And the aspect of *ruach* therein in the macro-level *nefesh* links the *nefesh* in to a higher level –

ור"ל כי הוא בחי' המציאות אשר בו ועל ידו היא קשורה למעלה
בהרוח הכללי

meaning to say that it is that 'entity' in which and through which it the *nefesh* is bound above into macro-level *ruach* – #9 in the diagram above.

והנשמה שבה הוא תלייתה למעלה בהנשמה הכללי

And the aspect of *neshama* therein of *nefesh* links the *nefesh* in to macro-level *neshama* – #6 in the Diagram 6.

כי מהנשמה ורוח הכלליים נמשך ונעשה הנשמה ורוח שבה

Because from macro-level *neshama* and *ruach*, is drawn down and produced therein in macro-level *neshama* #2 in the diagram and *ruach* #4 in the diagram respectively.

ובהם היא קשורה למעלה והוא עצמותה העקרי שבה, שהיא
הנפש שבנפש

And via them it the macro-level *nefesh* is bound up above, and this – *nefesh* of *nefesh* – is the primary essence thereof of macro-level *nefesh*.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ אֵיךְ שֶׁהֵם כְּלוּלִים זֶה בָּזֶה וְכֵנֶן.

Thus we have the manner in which one is inter-included in the other, as mentioned,

וְהָרִי נִתְבָּאֵר לָנוּ בִּכ"ז בַּעֲזֵה"י כָּל הָעֲנָן עַל נִכּוֹן:

and thus the entire matter – each subject in the proper way – has been explained, with God's help.

Footnotes

1. In the previous chapter. [↩](#)

2. Makover. [↩](#)

3. משלי יד, ו: [בְּקֹשׁ לִץ חֲכָמָה וְאִיוֹ] וְדַעַת לְנִבּוֹן נִקְלָה. [↩](#)

4. A person who understands these matters can deduce that the micro-level *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* of the World of *Beriah* constitute the root of the micro-level *neshama*, *ruach* and *nefesh* of the Worlds of *Yetzirah* and *Asiyah*, as will be explained at length in the following paragraphs (Makover).

[↩](#)

5. The World of *Beriah* as well as the World of *Yetzirah* both have a hand in producing the World of *Asiyah* – *Beriah* donates the micro-level *neshama* of all of nr"n of *Asiyah*, while *Yetzirah* donates the micro-level *ruach* of all of nr"n of *Asiyah*. [↩](#)

6. Makover. [↩](#)

7. I.e. in the most general sense, ignoring the subsets. [↩](#)

8. Makover. [↩](#)

9. Makover. [↩](#)

10. It seems that the Baal HaLeshem is not actually referring to the essence of the soul here, although one could have interpreted it that way. Hence we have rendered it "primarily as 'the *neshama* itself'" rather than "the primary essence of the *neshama*." Similarly when he refers to *ruach* and *nefesh* in the next paragraphs. ↩
11. Based on a diagram in Makover. ↩
12. Based on diagrams in Makover. ↩
13. Based on Makover. ↩
14. can be translated literally as "is dependent upon." תלֵּיתוֹ
However, the intention here is more like "hangs down from"
↩ "...or "dangles down from" – hence "is linked in to

Chapter 6 — Ruakh and nefesh are the basis of creation as we know it. They are intertwined from above via the neshama.

Shaar 3 Chapter 6

ספר לשם שבו ואחלמה - הקדמות ושערים - שער ג פרק ו

אָמַנְם הָרִי עֵדִין הַדְּבָר צָרִיךְ בְּאוּר כִּי הָרִי אָמַרְנוּ לְעִיל סַפ " ב ופ " ד

However, this matter still requires some explanation, because as we said above (end of chapter 2 and chapter 4)

שָׁכַל הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית עֲצָמָה הִנֵּה הִיא לְעוֹלָם רַק אוֹר אֱלֹהוֹת

– the entire macro-level neshama itself is always only Godly light,

וְאֵין לָהּ כְּלִי כָּלֵל בְּהַגּוּף לְהַתְלַבֵּשׁ בּוֹ

and it does not have any ‘receptacle’ in the body at all in which to be clothed,

כִּי אֵין לָהּ הַשְׁתּוּוֹת עִם שׁוּם גּוּף וְכִלִּי

since it the neshama has no equivalence or affinity to a body or vessel of any sort.

Since the neshama is nothing less than a lofty spiritual existence, while the body is a lowly material entity, there is no affinity at all between them. How then can they interface with each other?

וְעַקֵּר הַמַּח אֲשֶׁר הוּא כְּלִי לְהַנְשָׁמָה הִנֵּה הוּא רַק לְהַנְשָׁמָה שְׂבִרוּחַ

And that primary aspect of the brain that is a receptacle to the neshama is only as regards neshama of ruach , but not neshama itself.

וּא " כ הָרִי יִהְיֶה נִמְצָא לִפִּי " ז שְׁמַכֵּל הַנֶּר " נ ח " י הַכִּלְלִיִּים

If this is so, it would therefore turn out that of all the aspects of macro level nr"n ch"y 1

אֲשֶׁר יֵשׁ לָהֶם הַשְׁתּוּוֹת עִם הַגּוּף הֵם רַק שְׁנַיִם שֶׁהוּא הָרוּחַ הַכָּלִלִי
וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכָּלִלִי

**that could have any affinity or potential interface with a body,
there are only two: macro- ruach and macro- nefesh .**

כִּי הֵם אוֹרוֹת נִבְרָאִים כְּמוֹ הַגּוּף

**This is because they are created 2 light 3 , similar to a body
which is also created.**

**Even though ruach and nefesh are spiritual existences, they are
nevertheless created spiritual existences. Since they are created
, they have some affinity with the physical body.**

וְהֵם אֲשֶׁר מִשְׁתּוּיִם עִמּוֹ לְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בּוֹ

**These – macro- ruach and macro- nefesh – are the ones the
only levels of soul that have some affinity with the body , and
therefore can interface with the physical body to become
clothed in it.**

אָבֵל מִהַנֶּשְׁמָה וּלְמַעְלָה וְהִיא בְּכָלֵל הוּא רַק אוֹר אֱלֹהֵי הַמַּאִיר
בְּהָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ

**But from the macro-level of neshama and up , including the
level of neshama itself , there is only the Godly light
illuminating ruach and nefesh,**

לְהַשְׁפִּיעַ בָּהֶם שֹׁפַע הַחַיּוּת לְהַחְיֹת אֶת הַגּוּף

**that flows into them in a stream of life-force that enlivens the
body.**

אָבֵל הִיא בְּעֶצְמָהּ אִין לָהּ הַשְׁתּוּוֹת עִם שׁוּם גּוּף וְכִלִּי לְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בּוֹ
כָּלֵל

But the macro-level of neshama itself does not have any affinity at all with any type of body or vessel keli (kelim in the plural) in which it could be clothed.

וא " כ הרי צריך באור לפי " ז כי למה נסדרו ג ' כלים בהגוף שהם
מח לב כבד

Accordingly, we need an explanation as to why there are three receptacles set up in the body – the brain, the heart and the liver,

ופנימי תיכון חיצון שהם כלים להנר " נ שבכל פרצוף

arrayed as inner, intermediate and outer layers – which are the kelim for the neshama, ruach and nefesh in every partzuf .

וכן בכללות העולמות הנבראים שהם ג " כ ג ' עולמות בריאה
יצירה עשיה

And so too as regards the created Worlds in general – the three Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah, but not Atzilut, which is emanated, not created,

ואמרנו כי הם להנר " נ הכללים

and as we stated earlier, they the three Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah are also kelim- receptacles for the macro-levels of neshama, ruach and nefesh respectively.

הרי מאחר שהאורות הנבראים אשר יש להם השתוות עם הגוף

Hence, since only created lights have some affinity with a body,

הם רק שנים

of which there are only two macro-level ruach and macro-level nefesh,

א " כ הרי צריך שגם כללות העולמות וכן פרטות הכלים שבכל
פרצוף

accordingly, the macro-level Worlds, and also the micro-level kelim in each partzuf ,

לא יהיו ג' כ רק שנים וכמו מציאות האורות הנבראים שהם רק ב

should also be no more than two, just like the actual created lights, which are only two,

כי הכלים צריך שיהיו רק כמספר האורות המשתווים עמהם ומתלבשים בהם .

since the number of kelim should correspond to the number of lights that interface with them and become clothed within them.

And yet we see that there are three immanent worlds, Beriah , Yetzirah and Asiyah, and three receptacles in the body, the brain, the heart and the liver.!

ומה שאמרנו כי הג' כלים שבכל גוף הם רק לפרטי הנר " נ אשר בהרוח והנפש עצמן

Now what we said regarding the three kelim in each body – the brain, the heart and the liver – this refers only to the kelim for micro-level nr”n of ruach and of nefesh themselves.

And therefore we can perhaps accept this as an explanation as to why there are three kelim in the body.

הלא גם זה גופה צריך באור כי למה נפרטו לג'

But this too requires explanation – why are there three subdivisions

מאחר שכללי אורות הנבראים הם רק שנים

when the macro-level created lights are only two, as mentioned above?

הרי הכלל והפרט הוא לעולם בסדר אחד .

Particularly since we have a rule that macro and micro levels always follow the same pattern.

ועוד כי מאחר שכללות העולמות הנבראים הם ג' שהם בריאה
יצירה עשיה

Furthermore, since the macro-level created Worlds are three – Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah –

הרי משמע מזה שגם כללי האורות הנבראים הם באמת ג' כ ג ':

we can deduce from this that the macro-level created lights are also in fact three.

אך הענין בזה כי האמת הוא כמו שאמרנו שעקרי הנבראים הם
רק שנים

However the concept here is that in fact, as we said, the primary aspects of created beings are only two ruach and nefesh.

אך מה שהם ג' עולמות בריאה יצירה עשיה

But the fact that there are three Worlds – Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah –

וכן נסדר ג' כלים בכל פרצוף שהם מח לב קבד ופנימי תיכון חיצון
וכן " ל

and that there are three kelim are arrayed in each partzuf – the brain, the heart and the liver –

ופנימי תיכון חיצון וכן " ל

arranged as inner, intermediate and outer layers, as explained above,

הנה הוא משום כי באשר שרצונו ית " ש בכל בריאת עולמו

this is because it is His will, may He be blessed, in creating His entire world

הנה היתה שיהא כל הבריאה כלו תמיד קשור עמו ותלוי בו לעולם

that all of Creation should always be bound to Him and be dependent upon Him forever.

ולכן סדר והמציא בכל הבריאה כלה הו בכלל והו בפרט

For this reason, He planned on and produced throughout the entire creation, on both macro- and micro-levels

בחי ' מציאת מקום אחת שהוא ראוי לקבל בתוכה אורו תמיד

the existence of one place that would be fitting to always receive His light within it,

אשר שם הוא משכן כבודו שהוא אור שכינתו יתברך שמו.

a place where His glory (Kavod), the light of the Divine Presence, the Shechinah , is manifested, may His name be blessed.

והוא בבחי ' בית המקדש של מטה ששורה שכינתו בבית קדש הקדשים

And that place is the Holy Temple the Beit HaMikdash below in this world, 4 in which His Shechinah resides, in the Holy of Holies.

כן הוא בכל הבריאה כלה בכלל ובפרט ,

And so it is throughout all of the Creation, on the macro- and micro-levels,

הנה נתיסד בכלם בחי ' מקום אחד אשר על ידו מתיחד עם המציאות

in all of them is established one place through which He unites with existence as it is in that World.

כי שם מתפשט ושורה אורו ית " ש למטה

Because it is there, down below, that His light or illumination spreads forth and is manifested ,

וְשֵׁם קָשׁוּר וְתִלּוּי בּוֹ הַמְצִיאוֹת כֻּלּוֹ לְעוֹלָם

and it is to that place that the entire existence is always bound and on which it depends.

וְזֶהוּ סוּד מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ רַז " ל בַּמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה פ' נִשְׂא פְּרָשָׁה י " ב סִימָן ו

This is the secret of what our Sages declare in Bamidbar Rabba, Naso 12:6 –

מִתְחִלַּת בְּרִיתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם שְׁרֵתָה הִשְׁכִּינָה בְּתַחְתּוֹנִים

“From the beginning of the creation of the world, the Shechinah was manifested in the lowest plane.”

וְהִנֵּה הוּא ע' פ' מָה שֶׁאָמְרָנוּ לְעֵיל פ' ג' ד'

Now this concurs with what we said above in chapters 3 and 4,

שֶׁגַם בְּאוֹר הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁהוּא עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הַזֶּה

that even the light of macro-level nefesh , which is this World of Asiyah ,

הַיְחִידָה שֶׁבָּהּ אוֹר אֱלֹהוֹת .

the yechida therein is Divine light , not a mere radiance generated from a secondary source.

וְהִרִי שֵׁשׁ מְקוֹם גַּם בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה לְשֹׁכֵן כְּבוֹד בְּתוֹכָהּ

Thus, even in the World of Asiyah , there is a place for the Kavod to be manifested,

לְהִתְפַּשֵּׁט אוֹרוֹ שֵׁם וּלְהִתְיַחֵד עִמָּהּ

and in which His light can spread out and unify with.

וְאִמְרָנוּ לְעִיל פ"ד כ"ע "י הַיְחִידָה דְּאוֹר הַנֶּפֶשׁ

Now we stated above, chapter 4 , that via the yechida -light of nefesh

הִנֵּה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְיַחַד שֵׁם אוֹר הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁהִיא כָּלָה אוֹר
אֱלֹהוֹת

the light of macro- neshama , which is entirely the aspect of Godliness, spreads forth and becomes one there with nefesh of Asiyah .

הַשּׁוֹכֵן בְּהִיכָל קֹדֶשׁ הַקְּדוּשִׁים דְּהַבְרִיָּאָה וּמִתְפַּשֵּׁט בְּהֶאֱרָתָהּ מִשָּׁם
וְלִמְטָה

Now the light of macro- neshama is manifested in the Holy of Holies of Beriah , and spreads forth its radiance from there on down into the lower worlds,

עַד עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה וּמִתְיַחַד בְּאוֹר הַיְחִידָה שֶׁבִּהְעֲשִׂיָּה

until it reaches the World of Asiyah and becomes one with the light of yechida of Asiyah , as we just explained.

וְהִיא הַשְּׂכִינָה הַשּׁוֹכֵן בְּבֵית קֹדֶשׁ הַקְּדוּשִׁים שֶׁל מְטָה

And this is what is referred to as the Shechinah , which is manifested in the Holy of Holies down below

שֶׁהוּא מְכּוּן נֶגֶד הִיכָל קֹדֶשׁ הַקְּדוּשִׁים שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה

and is situated precisely in line with the Chamber of the Holy of Holies of Beriah ,

שֶׁהוּא כִּסֵּא הַכְּבוֹד וְכִמוּ שֶׁכְּתֹב הָרַב בְּשַׁעַר כִּסֵּא הַכְּבוֹד וּבִדְרוּשֵׁי מ
" וְנִמְ" דְּדָרוּשׁ א' סְמוּךְ לְסוּפוֹ \

also known as the Throne of
Glory Kisei HaKavod , as the Rabbi – Rabbi Chaim Vital in the
name of Rabbi Isaac Luria, the Arizal – wrote in Etz Chaim , Shaar
Kisei HaKavod , and in Drushei Ma”n u’Ma”d, drush 1 near the
.end

וְכֵן הוּא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ תַּנְחֻמָּא פ' וַיִּקְהַל סִימָן ו'

This is stated similarly in Midrash Tanchuma, Vayakhel section 6,

שֶׁהָאֲרוֹן הָיָה מְכוּן כְּנֶגֶד כִּסֵּא הַכְּבוֹד שֶׁל מַעְלָה

that the Ark is situated directly in line with the Throne of Glory above.

וְשֵׁם בַּפ' פְּקוּדֵי סִימָן ב' שֶׁהַיִּכָּל שְׁלֻמָּטָה מְכוּן כְּנֶגֶד הַיִּכָּל שֶׁל מַעְלָה .

And in Midrash Tanchuma, Pekudei section 2, it states that the Heichal the section of the Temple comprising the Holy of Holies, the Holy and the Hall in front of them 5 below is situated directly in line with the Heichal above.

וְהָרִי לָנוּ עַכ"פ כִּי הֵג' עוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיאָה יְצִירָה וְעֲשִׂיָּה

At the very least then, we have it that the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah

הֵנָּה הֵגֶם שֶׁהֵם עֲצָמָן אֵינָם אֱלֹהוֹת כָּלֵל וְהֵם עוֹלָמוֹת נִפְרָדִים

– even though they themselves are not Godly at all, but rather are separated Worlds –

עַכ"פ ז' הֵנָּה אֹרֹר ית"ש הוּא שׁוֹכֵן בָּהֶם תָּמִיד וּמִתְיַחַד עִמָּהֶם לְעוֹלָם

even so, His light, may His Name be blessed, always manifests within them and is one with them forever.

וְהֵנָּה הוּא שׁוֹכֵן גַּם בְּעֲשִׂיָּה ע' י הַיְחִידָה שְׁבָה הַמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט בְּהַחֲרָה שְׁבָה

Thus the light manifests even in Asiyah , via its yechida which seeps into chaya of Asiyah ,

וְהַחֲזִיחַ בַּהֲנָשָׁמָה שְׂבִיחַ (שֶׁהוּא הַנְּשָׁמָה דְּהָרוּחַ דְּהַעֲשִׂיָּה וְכַן " ל פ
" ד ע " ש)

and chaya in turn into neshama of Asiyah (this is the neshama of ruach of Asiyah , as mentioned above chapter 4. See there).

וְלָכֵן נִתְּיָסַד מָקוֹם מִיָּחָד עַל זֶה בְּכָל פְּרָצוֹף בְּפָרְט

And therefore a special place is established in each individual partzuf

וְהוּא הַמָּקוֹם הַג ' הָעֲלִיּוֹן שֶׁהוּא הַמֶּח

– which is the third and uppermost area of the three – brain, heart, liver – i.e. the brain.

וְכֵן הוּא בְּהַעֲלָמוֹת בְּכָלֵל וְהוּא עוֹלָם הַג ' הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה שֶׁהוּא עוֹלָם
הַבְּרִיָּאָה .

And so it is also in the Worlds in general i.e. in the macro-sense – the third and highest World, the uppermost of the three Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah i.e. the World of Beriah, is where a place is set aside.

כִּי שֵׁם הוּא הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר אֹרֹר ית " ש מִתְּיָחַד שֵׁם עִי " ז בְּהַמְצִיאוֹת
כָּלוּ בְּכָלֵל וּבְפָרְט

Because that is the place with which His blessed light is unified, and through it, the entirety of existence becomes part of this unity, on both macro- and micro-levels.

אֲבָל עֵקֶר הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּהָאוֹרוֹת הַנִּבְרָאִים עֲצָמָן הֵם בְּאַמֶּת רַק שְׁנַיִם
וְהֵם רוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ .

Nevertheless, in reality, the primary created 6 lights themselves are actually only two , not three – ruach and nefesh .

אֲלָא מִשּׁוּם שְׁאוֹרוֹ ית " ש מִתְּיָחַד עִמָּהֶם ג " כ לְעוֹלָם

However, because His light is always one with them as well,

לְכַךְ נִתְּיָסַד עַל זֶה מָקוֹם מִיָּחָד לְשֹׁכֵן כְּבוֹד בְּתוֹכָהּ

therefore a special place was established in which the Kavod can manifest,

וְהוּא כַּעֲיוֹן מָקוֹם מִקְדָּשׁ וּמִשְׁכָּן אֲשֶׁר שָׁם שׁוֹרָה הַשְּׁכִינָה לַמָּטָה

which is akin to the place in which the Shechinah manifests below in the Mikdash the Temple and the Mishkan the Tabernacle.

כֵּן הוּא בְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בְּכָלֵל שֶׁהוּא בְּהִיכָל קֹדֶשׁ הַקִּדְשִׁים דְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה

And so too in the macro-Worlds – in the Heichal of Beriah , in the Holy of Holies of Beriah,

אֲשֶׁר שָׁם הוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְי שֶׁהוּא כֻּלּוֹ אֱלֹהוֹת

wherein is the macro- neshama, which is all Godliness,

וְשׁוֹכֵן בָּהֶן 'רַאשׁוֹנִים דְּהַבְּרִיאָה שֶׁהוּא כֶּסֶד הַכְּבוֹד

is manifested – in the first three sefirot of Beriah chochmah, binah and da'at [often abbreviated as chaba'd] and is called the Throne of Glory Kisei HaKavod ,

וְנִקְרָא כָּל עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה עַל שֵׁמָּה שֶׁהוּא בְּשֵׁם נִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְי

so that the entire World of Beriah is named after it the World of the Throne because of the macro- neshama that is manifested there. 7

וְכֵן הוּא בְּכָל פְּרָצוּף בְּפֶרֶט שֶׁהוּא הַמֶּחֱשֶׁבֶת שֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוּף

And so too on the micro-level of partzuf , which is the 'brain' of each partzuf ,

אֲשֶׁר שָׁם הוּא הַג' "ר דְּהִירוּחַ שְׁבו

this is where the first three sefirot, chochmah, binah and da'at (chaba" d), of ruach are situated,

ומתפשט ומתיחד שם אור הנשמה הכללי ג " כ כנ " ל פ " ד

and where the light of macro- neshama also permeates and unites with it, as mentioned previously, chapter 4.

ונמצא כי הגם שהאמת הוא שאין לאור האלהות שום השתוות כלל

Thus we find that even though actually for the Divine light there is no affinity

עם כל בחי ' גוף וכלי להתלבש בו ,

to any physical entity or vessel in which to be clothed,

עכ " ז הנה צמצם אור שכינתו ית " ש ושוכן בהם עכ " פ , וע " ד
שאמרו בספרא ויקרא פרשה ב '

nevertheless, He constricted the light of His Shechinah so that it can anyway manifest within them, 8 as the Sages stated in Sifra, Vayikra 2:

דמשום חבתן של ישראל דחק להיות מדבר מעל הכפרת מבין שני הכרובים .

‘Because of His love for Israel, He forced Himself to speak from on top of the lid of the Ark, between the two cherubs.’ 9

ובבראשית רבה פ ' ד ' סימן ד ' כשהוא רוצה הלא את השמים ואת הארץ אני מלא

And in Midrash Rabba, Bereishit 4:4, when this is what He wants, the verse states: “Do I not fill the heavens and the earth”? (Jeremiah 23:24)

וכשהוא רוצה היה מדבר עם משה מבין שני בדי הארון (וע ' בגמרא שבת דף פ " ח ע " ב ובשהש " ר פ " א פסוק י " ד סימן ג ')

And, when He wished to, He would speak with Moses from between the two poles of the Ark (see Talmud, Shabbat 88b; Shir Hashirim Rabba chapter 1, 14:3).

כֵּן הוּא עַד " ז בְּכָל הַמְצִיאוֹת בְּכָלל וּבְפָרֵט

And so it is throughout all of existence, on macro- and micro-levels –

הִנֵּה נִתְּיָסַד בָּהֶם מָקוֹם אֶחָד לְאוֹר שְׂכִינָתוֹ ית " ש כַּעֲיֵן מִקְדָּשׁ
וּמִשְׁכָּן

a place has been established for the light of His blessed Shechinah , just as in the Mikdash the Temple and the Mishkan the Tabernacle.

וְהוּא הַמֶּחֱשֵׁל כָּל פְּרָצוּף וְהַיִּכָּל קֹדֶשׁ הַקִּדְּשִׁים שֶׁל עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה
This is the 'brain' of every partzuf and the Chamber of the Holy \
,of Holies of the World of Beriah

וְלִכְךָ נִקְרָא כָּל הַבְּרִיָּאָה בְּלֶה עַל שֵׁם הָאוֹר דִּהַנְּשָׁמָה הַכִּלִּי

and therefore the entire World of Beriah is called by the name of macro-level neshama –

As noted in the previous chapter, macro-level nefesh corresponds to the World of Asiyah , ruach to Yetzirah , neshama to Beriah, and chaya to Atzilut.

וְכֵן נִקְרָא הַמֶּחֱשֵׁל כָּל פְּרָצוּף בְּשֵׁם הַכִּלִּי לַהַנְּשָׁמָה הַכִּלִּי שֶׁבוֹ כֵּן "
ל פ " ה

In addition, the 'brain' i.e. the chaba”d of each partzuf is called the receptacle or vessel for the macro-level neshama within it, as explained in chapter 5,

מִשּׁוּם שֶׁדֶּרֶךְ שֵׁם מִתְיַחַד אוֹר הַנְּשָׁמָה הַכִּלִּי ג " כ בְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת
בְּכָלל

because by way thereof – by way of the chaba”d of each partzuf – the light of the macro-level neshama becomes one with the Worlds in general.

וכן בכל פרצוף בפרט וכנז' ודי בזה :

This is also the case with each individual partzuf , as mentioned. We have discussed this sufficiently.

וכן הנה יש בזה ענין עוד קרוב אל האמור

There is another matter here which is close in subject to what we said above:

כי העולמות בריאה יצירה עשיה מה שהם נחשבים לג'

The fact that the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah are regarded as three separate worlds

הנה הוא רק במקרה ולא בעצם כי בעצם הם רק שנים

is only incidentally so, not inherently so, because in essence they are only two.

והוא כי הרי אמרנו לעיל פ' " ה כי הרוח ונפש דעולם הבריאה

The explanation of this is as we said above, in chapter 5, that ruach and nefesh of the World of Beriah

הנה הם השרש דהרוח והנפש הכלליים שהם עולם היצירה והעשיה

are the root or origin of macro ruach and nefesh i.e. the Worlds of Yetzirah and Asiyah.

והנה אותו השרש אלולא החטא

Now that root – the micro-level ruach and nefesh of Beriah – had it not been for the sin of Adam and Eve partaking of the fruit of the Tree of Knowledge

הָיָה מְתִיחַד עִם הַמְצִיאוֹת הָעֶקְרִי שֶׁיֵּצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ לְאַחַד מֵמֶשׁ

– would have actually been unified into one with the main aspects of existence which emerged from them.

כִּי הָרוּחַ הַפָּרָטִי שֶׁבְּהַנְשָׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁהוּא הָרוּחַ דְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיָּאָה

Because micro-level ruach of macro- neshama , which is the ruach of the World of Beriah,

הָיָה מְתִיחַד עִם עוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה שֶׁהוּא הָרוּחַ הַכִּלְלִי לְאַחַד מֵמֶשׁ

would actually have become united into one with the World of Yetzirah, which is the macro-level of ruach ,

וְכָכֵל שָׂרֵשׁ שֶׁמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט בְּהֶעָנָף וּמִתְיַחַד עִמּוֹ וְהֵם אֶחָד מֵמֶשׁ

just like any root that extends into the branches that it nourishes, and they become one entity, literally.

וְכֵן הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַפָּרָטִי שֶׁבְּהַנְשָׁמָה הַכִּלְלִי , שֶׁהוּא הַנֶּפֶשׁ שֶׁבְּבְרִיָּאָה ,

Similarly, micro-level nefesh of macro-level neshama , which is the nefesh of Beriah,

הָיָה מְתִיחַד עִם עוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה , שֶׁהוּא הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַכִּלְלִי שֶׁיֵּצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ ,
לְאַחַד מֵמֶשׁ

would have become united with the World of Asiyah, macro-level nefesh which emerged from it from nefesh of Beriah , and become one,

וְכָכֵל שָׂרֵשׁ עִם הָעָנָף וְהָיָה מְקַבֵּל הָעֲשִׂיָּה מִהַבְּרִיָּאָה מְכֻוֵּן

just like any root that extends into the branches that it nourishes, and Asiyah would have received from Beriah directly,

שֶׁלֹא דֶּרֶךְ הַיְצִירָה כָּלָל (ע ' זוה " ק פ ' נח ע " ה ע " ב ובמ " מ שם).

not via Yetzirah at all (see Zohar I, Noach 5b , and in Mikdash Melech 's commentary there).

וְהָיָה הָיָה נִחָשֵׁב הַבְּרִיאָה עִם הַיְצִירָה לְאַחַד וְכֵן עִם הָעֲשִׂיָּה לְאַחַת

Thus Beriah would have been regarded as one with Yetzirah, and similarly Beriah would have been regarded as one with Asiyah.

וְכ"ז [וְכָל זֶה] הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה הָרוּחַ וְהַנֶּפֶשׁ הַפְּרָטִיִּים דְּעוֹלָם
הַבְּרִיאָה

And all of this would have been possible because micro-level ruach and nefesh of Beriah

הִנֵּה הֵם ג' כ' רַק נִבְרָאִים וְנִבְרָאוּ מִהַנֶּשְׁמָה הַכְּלָלִית אֲשֶׁר שָׁם

are also created, and were created from the macro-level neshama there in Beriah

שֶׁהֵיא אֲשֶׁר הַמְּצִיא אוֹתָם אַחֵר אֲשֶׁר יֵרְדָה בְּהַבְּרִיאָה וְנִתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם

which produced them after descending into Beriah and becoming revealed in them in micro-level ruach and nefesh of Beriah.

The World of Beriah is characterized specifically by macro-level neshama, as explained above in chapter 5. Now when macro-level neshama becomes subdivided into its micro-level components, specifically ruach and nefesh of Beriah, that macro-level neshama is regarded as producing its micro-levels, and at the same time it illuminates them – since they are, after all, micro-levels of Beriah .

וְהֵם הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ בְּהַיְצִירָה וְהָעֲשִׂיָּה וְהֵם אֶחָד עִמָּהֶם

And they the micro-level ruach and nefesh of Beriah become the root of Yetzirah and Asiyah, as we explained in chapter 5, and are united with them.

כִּי שָׁרֵשׁ הָרוּחַ עִם הָרוּחַ הֵם אֶחָד בְּעֶצֶם

This is because the root of ruach as it is above in Beriah, and ruach below in Yetzirah and Asiyah, are one essentially. They are both of the nature of ruach.

וְכֵן שָׁרֵשׁ הַנֶּפֶשׁ עִם הַנֶּפֶשׁ הֵם אֶחָד בְּעֶצֶם וְכֵן

And so too the root of nefesh as it is above in Beriah is one in essence with nefesh below in Yetzirah and Asiyah. They are both of the nature of nefesh.

וְהָיָה נִמְצָא כִּי הֵג' עוֹלָמוֹת בְּרִיאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה אֵינָם נִחְשָׁבִים
בְּאַמֶּת לֵג' כָּלֵל

Thus we have it that the three Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah are not really regarded as three at all,

כִּי הֵם רַק שְׁנַיִם בְּעֶצֶם וְחִלְקָתָם לֵג' הוּא רַק בְּמִקְרָה

but rather as two in essence, while their division into three is merely incidental –

כִּי ע' י' הַחֲטָא יָרְדוּ מִמְדְּרָגָתָם וְאֵינוּ מִתְיַחַד הַשָּׁרֵשׁ עִמָּהֶם

as a result of the sin of the Tree of Knowledge etc. they descended from their level, and their root is not unified with them, even though they are dependent upon their root and receive their life-force from it. 10

וְנִתְחַלְקוּ זֶה מִזֶּה וְנִעְשׂוּ לֵג'

Thus they became separated from one another and became three since Yetzirah and Asiyah became detached from Beriah through the sin.

אֲבָל בְּעֶצֶם הֵם רַק שְׁנַיִם וְהַשְּׁלִישִׁי הָעֶקְרִי הוּא לְעוֹלָם רַק אֱלֹהוּת

But in essence they are really only two created worlds – Yetzirah and Asiyah – while the third and main world, Beriah, is always only Godliness.

וְהוּא הַקָּב " ה לְבַד שֶׁהוּא הַמְצִיָּאם וּמְקִיָּמם וּמַיְחֲדֵם

Nevertheless, only the Holy One, blessed is He, produced them, sustains them and unites them.

וְכֵן מְנַהִיג אֹתָם תָּמִיד בְּתוֹצְאוֹת כָּל פְּעֻלוֹתֵיהֶם שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה .

And only He directs them always, bringing forth all of their effects in this world,

וּמִתְנַהֵג סֹדֶר כָּל הַבְּרִיָּאָה כְּלָה ע " ד שֶׁאֲמָרוּ בְּנֵדָה ל " א

and the entire order of Creation behaves as the Talmudic Sages stated in Tractate Niddah 31 a :

ג ' שֶׁתְּפִין בְּאֲדָם הַקָּב " ה וְאָבִיו וְאִמּוֹ

“There are three partners in the creation of a person – the Holy One, blessed is He, his father and his mother.”\ The Talmud (Niddah 31a) explains that certain physical aspects of a fetus come from the father, others from the mother, while the Holy One, blessed is He, gives the soul. 11

כֵּן הוּא עַד " ז סֹדֶר הַבְּרִיָּאָה כְּלָה שֶׁעֶקְרֹן הֵם שְׁנַיִם

So is it in the order of the entire creation – there are primarily two partners: the father and mother,

וְהַשְּׁלִישִׁי הוּא הַקָּב " ה אֲשֶׁר הַמְצִיָּאם וּמְנַהִיגָם

and the third partner is the Holy One, blessed is He, who produced them and Who directs or supervises them.

וְהוּא ע " פ מָה שֶׁאֲמָרְנוּ כִּי עֶקְרֹן שֶׁל כָּל הַנִּבְרָאִים הֵם רַק שְׁנַיִם
שֶׁהֵם רוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ

This is according to what we stated above – that there are only two primary aspects of all created beings : ruach and nefesh.

וְהוּא מ " ש רז " ל בְּדַבְרִים רַבָּה פ ' וְאֶתְחַנֵּן סִימֹן ל " א

**This was stated by our Sages in Midrash Devarim Rabba,
V'etchanan 31:**

אמר הקב"ה לישראל בני כל מה שבראתי בראתי זוגות

**“Said the Holy Blessed One to Israel i.e. the Jewish People,
‘My children, everything I created, I created in pairs**

שמים וארץ זוגות, חמה ולבנה זוגות, אדם וחוה זוגות, העולם
הזה והעולם הבא זוגות

**Heavens and earth – a pair; sun and moon – a pair; Adam and
Eve – a pair; this world and the World-to-Come – a pair**

אבל כבודי אחד ומיוחד כו'

– but My Glory is one and unique .

וכל אלו הזוגות שאמר הם כלם בסוד רוח ונפש כנודע

**Now all of the pairs mentioned are all the mystical secret of
ruach and nefesh , as is known. 12**

אלא שאותן הרוח ונפש הנה הם כ"א בבחי' שרש ומציאות

**However, ruach and nefesh in those contexts are the aspect of
root-source and existential being respectively.**

והשרש הוא תכונה מעלה וזך גבוה מאד הראויה לקבל בתוכה
את אורו ויתברך

**The root-source is a superior quality, pure and very lofty and is
worthy of receiving His blessed light within it,**

להיות משכן ומעון אליו

serving as an abode and domicile for it for His light.

והיא בית קדש הקדשים ששם שורה שכינתו ויתברך

And in the Tabernacle and the Temple this is the Holy of Holies in which His blessed Shechinah dwells.

וּמִמֶּשֶׁיךְ שֶׁפָּעוּ מִמֶּנָּה בְּתוֹצְאוֹת וּפְעֻלַּת הַמְּצִיאוֹת כֻּלּוֹ וְכָל הַנְּהָגָתָהּ

And from there He draws down His life-force in bringing forth and implementing all of existence and all Divine supervision of the worlds.

וְהוּא הוּא עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה שֶׁנִּקְרָא כֶּסֶּא הַכְּבוֹד

Now all of this is the World of Beriah, also called the Throne of Glory,

כִּי עָלֶיהָ שׁוֹכֵן מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים הַקָּב " ה

so called because upon it the King of kings, the Holy One, blessed is He, rests

לְהַמְצִיא וּלְהַנְהִיג אֶת כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת כְּלָה

in order to bring forth and direct all of existence.

אָבֵל הַנִּבְרָאִים עֲצָמוֹ הֵם רַק שְׁנַיִם שֶׁהֵם רוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ וְהֵם יְסוּד כָּל הַנִּבְרָאִים כָּלָם

However, created beings themselves are only two – ruach and nefesh – which are the foundation of all created beings.

וְזֶהוּ מָה שֶׁמִּתְחִיל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁהוּא הַתְּחִלַּת מַעֲשֵׂה בְּרֵאשִׁית בְּאוֹת ב

And this is why the Torah commences with the account of Creation, beginning with the letter bet – the ב of בְּרֵאשִׁית .

מִשּׁוּם שֶׁהַנִּבְרָאִים הֵם שְׁנַיִם

This is because created beings are only second – the letter bet is the second letter of the Hebrew alphabet and also has the numerical value of 2, both alluding to the second thing, the first being Torah, as the Baal HaLeshem goes on to explain

אַבֶּל הַתּוֹרָה עֲצֻמָּה פֶּתַח בָּא ' שֶׁהוּא א ' דְּאֲנֹכִי

whereas the Torah itself begins with an aleph, the aleph of Anochi .

The first word of the Ten Commandments, which encapsulates the entire Torah, 13 is אֲנֹכִי . Thus the Torah itself, in the form of the two tablets of stone, begins with an aleph , which has the numerical value of 1, alluding to the fact that the worlds were created for the sake of Torah. 14

כִּי הוּא עַל הַקֵּב " הַמְמַצִּיא אֶת הַכֹּל וְהוּא אֶחָד

He, the Holy One, blessed be He, brought forth everything, and yet He is One.

וְכֵן הוּא מְיַחֵד אֶת הַב ' יְסוּדוֹת הַנִּבְרָאִים שֶׁהֵם רוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ

And He unites these two foundational aspects of created beings – ruach and nefesh –

ע " י שֶׁמְשַׁפֵּיעַ אוֹרוֹ בָּהֶם לְצַרֵּךְ תּוֹלְדוֹת כָּל הַמְצִיאוֹת כָּלֵם

by the outflow of His light into them for the purpose of generating all of existence,

הַנֶּעֱשֶׂה מִקְרוֹם וְנֶפֶשׁ הַכָּלִלִים

which is produced from macro-level ruach and nefesh.

וְאוֹרוֹ הַמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט בָּהֶם הוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכָּלִלִית וְהוּא שֶׁתַּף הַשְּׁלִישִׁי

And the light that spreads into them into macro ruach and nefesh is the light of macro-level neshama , which is the ‘third partner,’

The third partner as mentioned above, where the two primary partners in producing the body of the child are the mother and father, and the third partner is the Holy One, blessed is He, who gives the soul. All of this is an analogy for the Creation as

well, where ruach maps to the father, nefesh to the mother, and neshama to the Holy One, blessed is He.

שהוא מאורו עצמו המשתתף בהנבראים בקיומם והנהגתם

the light in and of itself i.e. the light of Beriah itself, since neshama is the essential level of Beriah which ‘partners’ with created beings in maintaining and directing them.

והנה עקר גלוייו של אותו האור שהוא הנשמה הכללית

Now the primary revelation of that very macro-level neshama light

הוא בעולם הבריאה שהיא השרש דהיצירה והעשיה

is in the World of Beriah, which is the root of Yetzirah and Asiyah ,

רוח ונפש הכלליים ועולם הבריאה הוא שרשם

and they (Yetzirah and Asiyah) are macro-level ruach and nefesh , and the World of Beriah is their root , as explained previously.

ומשום ששם הוא הגלוי דאורו עצמו היורד שם שהיא הנשמה הכללית כנזכר

And because there in Beriah is where the revelation of its own light the light of macro-level neshama descends, as mentioned,

לכן נקרא כל הבריאה בלה על שמה

therefore the entire Beriah is also called by that name – the ‘World of Creation.’

ובשם נשמה הכללית כי היא מאיר באורו ומתבטלת אליו

The World of Beriah is also called the world of macro-level neshama , since it the World of Beriah is illuminated with that light the light of macro-level neshama .

אבל עקר הבריאה עצמה הרי היא מהנבראים

However, Beriah itself is a created entity

ועצמותה היא ג' כ' רק רוח ונפש לבד אלא שהיא בבחי' שרש אליהם וכנז'

whose essence is also only ruach and nefesh , albeit that it Beriah is their root,

כי הרוח דהבריאה הוא השרש דהיצירה והנפש דהבריאה הוא השרש דהעשייה

being that ruach of Beriah is the root of Yetzirah, and nefesh of Beriah is the root of Asiyah.

ואוליא החטא היה מתיחד הבריאה עמהם

And were it not for the sin of Adam and Eve partaking of the fruit of the Tree of Knowledge Beriah would have united with them with Yetzirah and Asiyah,

ככל שרש שהוא מיוחד עם הענף היוצא ונמשך ממנו

just like any root that becomes one with the branch that emerges out of it and is drawn from it.

ולא היה נבדל מהם הבריאה לעולם בפנ' ע' [בפני עצמה] כלל כי הם רק גלויה .

Nor would it Beriah have become a world disconnected from them Yetzirah and Asiyah at all, since they are only the revelation of Beriah.

אך ע' י החטא הנה נבדל הבריאה לעצמה

However, because of the sin, Beriah did become detached from them and remains a World on its own.

הגהה והוא בסוד קטנות וגדלות]

[Author's note: This is the secret of spiritual immaturity or undeveloped consciousness – katnut, and spiritual maturity or developed consciousness – gadlut :

כִּי עוֹלָמוֹת בִּי " ע הֵם בְּבַחֲי ' בִּינָה וְזו " ו [זַעִיר אֲנָפִין וְנִקְבָּא]
כְּנוּדָע .

since the Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah are under the 'patronage' of binah, zeir' anpin, and nukvah (malchut) respectively, as is known.

Binah is in the state of gadlut since it represents expanded and developed consciousness. Accordingly Beriah is qualitatively different from Yetzirah and Asiyah, where ze'ir anpin and malchut respectively are the primary sefirot in those Worlds. The latter (and particularly malchut) are in an immature and undeveloped state compared with binah .

וּבְסוּד מ " ש הַסֵּפ " צ [הַסֵּפֶרָא דְּצִנְעוּתָא] סֵפ " א אֲתָא מִפְתָּחָא
כּו ' וַי לָמְאֵן דְּגָלִי פְתָחָהּ ... עֵין שָׁם]

And this is the secret of that which is stated in the Sifra Ditzniuta 15 a subsection of the Zohar on parshat Terumah chapter 1 : “Along comes the key that comprises six attributes... and covers the opening... Woe to one who reveals that opening...” See there. End of note].

The basic idea here is a warning to one who engages in illicit sexual behavior, as Adam did when he coupled with Eve prior to the appropriate time. This was the sin of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil as explained in the Zohar and the writings of the Arizal. This sin caused the World of Beriah to become detached from the Worlds of Yetzirah and Asiyah.

וְהֵם עֲתָה ג ' עוֹלָמוֹת , וְנִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם נֶשְׁמָה ,

And this is why there are now three Worlds – Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah – but only Beriah is named neshama

משום שְׁבִיהַּ מִתְלַבֵּשׁ אֹרֶךְ הָאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא אֹרֶךְ אֱלֹהוּתוֹ ית " ש
הַמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט לַמָּטָה

due to the fact that the light of Atzilut, which is the light i.e. revelation of His blessed Godliness, is clothed in it and spreads out into Beriah below.

וְהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית שֶׁהִיא רַק אֹרֶךְ אֱלֹהוּת כֵּן " ל

And this light that illuminates Beriah is the light of macro-level neshama , which is exclusively Godliness, as explained above.

וּמִתְבַּטֵּלֶת הַבְּרִיאָה אֶל הָאוֹר הַזֶּה הַשּׁוֹכֵן עָלֶיהָ וְנִקְרָאת עַל שְׁמָהּ

And the World of Beriah is existentially nullified to this light that rests upon it and by whose name it is called.

אֲבָל הַבְּרִיאָה עֲצָמָהּ הִיא בְּאֵמֶת ג " כ רַק רוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ שֶׁרֶשׁ דִּיצִירָה
וְעֵשִׂיָּה כֵּן " ל

But in and of itself Beriah too is actually only ruach and nefesh , which are the roots of Yetzirah and Asiyah respectively, as explained above.

וְכִנְגֻדָּהּ הוּא הַמֶּחֱשֵׁב שֶׁבְּכָל פְּרָצוֹף שֶׁהוּא הַכֹּלִי לַהֲנִשְׁמָה הַפְּרָטִית
שֶׁהִיא הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ דִּהְרוּחַ

And corresponding to it to Beriah in every partzuf is its 'brain,' which is a receptacle for the micro-level neshama that is the root of ruach ,

וְכֵן מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בָּהּ הָאֶרֶת הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית ג " כ וְכֵן " ל .

and a radiance of macro-level neshama also spreads forth into it and becomes clothed within it, as explained above.

Chapter 7 — The manner in which the five soul levels of nefesh, ruakh, neshama, chaya and yehida of neshama are derived from the world of atsilut.

Shaar 3 Chapter 7

וְהִנֵּה הַגִּם שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ לְעִיל פ' ג' שֶׁהַנֶּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית הִיא לְעוֹלָם
אֱלֹהִים גָּמוּר

Now even though we stated above chapter 3 that the macro-level neshama is always completely Godly,

גַּם בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה עכ' ז' הִנֵּה פְּשׁוּט הַדָּבָר שֶׁאֵין כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת
שׁוּיִם בְּקִבְלָתָהּ

even in the World of Asiyah, nevertheless, it is a simple fact that not all the worlds are equal in terms of how they receive it :

וְאֵינוּ דוֹמֶה אֵיכוֹת אֹר הַנֶּשְׁמָה שֶׁבְּהִבְרִיָּאָה לְאֵיכוֹת אֹר הַנֶּשְׁמָה
שֶׁבְּהִצְרָה

the quality of the light of the neshama in Beriah is not the same as the quality of the light of the neshama in Yetzirah

The light of the neshama in Beriah is obviously much greater than the light of the neshama in Yetzirah.

וְכֵן אֵינוּ דוֹמֶה אֵיכוֹת אֹר הַנֶּשְׁמָה דְּהִצְרָה לְאֵיכוֹת אֹר הַנֶּשְׁמָה
דְּהָעֲשִׂיָּה

Similarly, the quality of the light of the neshama in Yetzirah is not the same as the quality of the light of the neshama in Asiyah.

The light of the neshama in Yetzirah is obviously much greater than the light of the neshama in Asiyah.

וְהָעֵינַיִן בַּבְּאוּר הוּא כִּי הִנֵּה כָּל הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלִּית שֶׁבְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת
בִּי " ע

To explain this matter further: the macro-level neshama in each of the Worlds of BiY”A

הִנֵּה הִיא נִמְשָׁכֶת מֵהַמַּלְכוּת דִּהְאָצִילוֹת וּמִבְּחֵי ' הַגּוּף וְכֵלִים שָׁפָה

is drawn from malchut of Atzilut and from the aspect of ‘body’ and ‘vessels’ therein , as the Baal HaLeshem goes on to explain.

כִּי בְּכָל עוֹלָם יֵשׁ אוֹר וְכֵלִים שֶׁהוּא צוּרָה וְחוֹמֶר

For in every World there are lights and ‘vessels,’ which are also known in Jewish thought 2 as tzurah and chomer form and substance.

וּמֵהַכֵּלִים דְּעוֹלָם הָעֲלִיּוֹן שֶׁהֵם הַחוֹמֶר שָׁבוּ

From the ‘vessels’ of the higher world, which is the chomer therein,

נַעֲשֶׂה הַצּוּרָה וְהָאוֹר שֶׁהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה דְּעוֹלָם הַתְּחִתּוֹן כֵּן " ל שֶׁ " ב
פ " א

comes the tzurah , which is the soul of the lower world, as explained above, 2:1.

וְכָבֵד אֶמְרָנוּ לְעֵיל פ " א כִּי כָּל גּוֹף הִנֵּה הוּא נִבְחָן בִּג ' חֻלְקוֹת
שְׁסִימָנָם פֶּת " ח

We already explained above, in chapter 1, that every ‘body’ can be subdivided into three aspects, abbreviated as PTa”CH the initials of pnimi, tichon, chiztoni – the inner, in-between and outer layers.

וְהִנֵּה הִנֵּה הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלִּית שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה מִבְּחֵי ' כְּלֵי הַפְּנִימִי
שֶׁל הַמַּלְכוּת דִּהְאָצִילוֹת

Now the macro-level neshama of Beriah is from the aspect of the inner layer of the vessel of malchut of Atzilut;

וְהַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה הִיא מִבְּחִי' כְּלִי הָאֶמְצָעִי
דֵּהֶמְלָכוֹת דְּאֶצִּילוֹת

and the macro-level neshama of Yetzirah is from the aspect of the in-between layer of the vessel of malchut of Atzilut;

וְהַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית דְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה הִיא מִבְּחִי' כְּלִי הַחִיצוֹן
דֵּהֶמְלָכוֹת דְּאֶצִּילוֹת .

and the macro-level neshama of Asiyah is from the aspect of the outer layer of the vessel of malchut of Atzilut .

אֲמָנָם הָרִי אֲמָרְנוּ כִּי הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית הִנֵּה הִיא כְּלוּלָה ג' כ מִכָּל
הָה' בְּחִי' דְּנִרְנַח " י

However, we also said that the macro-level neshama is comprised of all five aspects of nrnch"y, 3

וְהִנֵּה אוֹתוֹן הַנִּרְנַח " י שְׂבָה הִנֵּה הֵם נִמְשְׁכוּ ג' כ מִכָּל הָה' פְּרָצוּפִי
הָאֶצִּילוֹת כָּלָם

and those nrnch"y in it in the macro-level neshama are also drawn from all the five partzufim of Atzilut,

מִבְּחִי' הֵג' חֲלָקֵי הַכְּלִים שֶׁבֶּכ' א מֵהֵם

from the three layers of the vessels – the inner layer, the in-between layer, and the outer layer of each of them,

כִּי יִשְׁנָם בְּחִי' כָּל הֵג' חֲלָקֵי כְּלִים שְׁסִימָנָם פֶּת' " ח בְּכָל פְּרָצוּף
וּפְרָצוּף

for there are aspects of all three aspects of the vessels, the initials of which are pt"ch – pnimi (inner), tichon (in-between), chitzon (outer) – in each and every partzuf .

וְהִנֵּה הַנִּרְנַח " י שְׂבָה־נִשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית דֵּהֶבְרִיָּאָה

So that the nrnch"y of the macro-level neshama of Beriah

מָהָה ' כָּלִים הַפְּנִימִים דְּהָה ' פְּרָצוּפֵי הָאֲצִילוֹת

derive from the inner (pnimi) layer of the vessels of the five partzufim of Atzilut i.e. Arich Anpin, Abba, Imma, Ze'ir Anpin, Malchut.

Therefore, each of the five levels of nrnch"y of the macro-level neshama of Beriah has a different origin: its yechida derives from the inner layer of the vessels of Arich Anpin ; its chaya derives from the inner layer of the vessels of Abba ; its neshama derives from the inner layer of the vessels of Imma; its ruach derives from the inner layer of the vessels of Ze'ir Anpin ; its nefesh from the inner layer of the vessels of Malchut.

והנרנח " י שְׁבַהֲנִשְׁמָה הַכְּלִלִית דְּהִיצִירָה מָהָה ' כָּלִים הָאֲמֻצָּעִים
דְּהָה ' פְּרָצוּפֵי הָאֲצִי

Similarly, the nrnch"y of the macro-level neshama of Yetzirah derive from the in-between (tichon) layer of the vessels of the five partzufim of Atzilut i.e. Arich Anpin, Abba, Imma, Ze'ir Anpin, Malchut.

Therefore, each of the five levels of nrnch"y of the macro-level neshama of Yetzira has a different origin: its yechida derives from the in-between layer of the vessels of Arich Anpin ; its chaya derives from the in-between layer of the vessels of Abba ; its neshama derives from the in-between layer of the vessels of Imma; its ruach derives from the in-between layer of the vessels of Ze'ir Anpin ; its nefesh from the in-between layer of the vessels of Malchut.

והנרנח " י שְׁבַהֲנִשְׁמָה הַכְּלִלִית דְּהִעָשְׂיָה מָהָה ' כָּלִים הַחִיצוֹנִיִּים
דְּהָה ' פְּרָצוּפֵי הָאֲצִילוֹת

And so too as regards the nrnch"y of the macro-level neshama of Asiyah derive from the outer (chitzon) layer of the vessels of the five partzufim of Atzilut i.e. Arich Anpin, Abba, Imma, Ze'ir Anpin, Malchut.

Therefore, each of the five levels of nrnch"y of the macro-level neshama of Asiyah has a different origin: its yechida derives from the outer layer of the vessels of Arich Anpin ; its chaya derives from the outer layer of the vessels of Abba ; its neshama derives from the outer layer of the vessels of Imma; its ruach derives from the outer layer of the vessels of Ze'ir Anpin ; its nefesh from the outer layer of the vessels of Malchut.

כי הנה כל הה' פרצופי האצילות הנה הם מתלבשים זב " ז

Now all five of the partzufim of Atzilut are clothed one within the other,

והמלכות היא מבחוץ לכלם וכולל את כלם

while malchut is external to all of them and thus includes all of them.

וכן הוא עד " ז בענין הכלים שלהם המתפשטים בהארתם

And similarly as regards their vessels, the radiance of which spreads forth

להעשות לנשמה הפללית בהעולמות בי " ע הנה הוא ג " כ עד " ז

to become the macro- neshama of the Worlds of BiY"A, also in a similar fashion.

כי מתלבשים כל בחי' הארת כלי הפנימים

So that what becomes clothed in the lower worlds of BiY"A is all aspects of the radiance of the inner layer of the vessels

דכל הה' פרצופי האצילות זה בזה

of all five partzufim of Atzilut, one within the other,

ומתפשט ונמשך בעולם הבריא

and they spread forth and are drawn down into the World of Beriah

וְנִעְשָׂה מֵהֶם כָּל־הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית דִּהְבִּירְיָאָה כְּלוּלָה מִנִּרְנַח " י

and from all of them is fashioned the macro- neshama of Beriah, comprising nrnch”y .

וְכֵן מִתְלַבָּשִׁים כָּל בְּחִי' הָאֶרֶת כְּלִי הָאֻמְצָעִים דְּכָל הָה' פְּרָצוּפִי
הָאֲצִי' זב"ז

Similarly, the radiances of the in-between layer of the vessels of all five partzufim of Atzilut are clothed one within the other,

וּמִתְפָּשֵׁט וְנִמְשָׁךְ בְּעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה

and they spread forth and are drawn down into the World of Yetzirah

וְנִעְשָׂה מֵהֶם כָּל־הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית דִּהְיְצִירָה כְּלוּלָה מִנִּרְנַח " י

and from all of them is fashioned the macro- neshama of Yetzirah, comprising nrnch”y .

וְכֵן מִתְלַבָּשִׁים כָּל בְּחִי' הָאֶרֶת כְּלִי הַחִיצוֹנִים דְּכָל הָה' פְּרָצוּפִי
הָאֲצִילוֹת זב"ז

Similarly, the radiances of the outer layer of the vessels of all five partzufim of Atzilut are clothed one within the other,

וּמִתְפָּשֵׁטִים וְנִמְשָׁכִים בְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה

and they spread forth and are drawn down into the World of Asiyah

וְנִעְשָׂה מֵהֶם כָּל־הַנִּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית דִּהָעֲשִׂיָּה כְּלוּלָה מִנִּרְנַח " י :

and from all of them is fashioned the macro- neshama of Asiyah, comprising nrnch”y .

אֲמָנָם הוּא כִּי הֵגַם שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַצֹּרֶה דְּכָל עוֹלָם תַּחְתּוֹן

Nevertheless, although we said that the tzurah 4 of every lower world

הנה היא נעשה מהחמר דעולם העליון שהוא הגוף וכלים שלו

is fashioned from the material aspect of the upper world – it's 'body' and 'vessels' –

ועי "ז אמרנו כי נעשה מהג' חלקי כלים דכל פרצופי האצילות

and consequently we deduced that from the three aspects of the vessels of all of the partzufim visages of Atzilut i.e. the inner, in-between and outer aspects is fashioned

הנשמה הכללית דכל העולמות בי "ע וכןז'

the macro-level neshama of each of the worlds of BiY”A, as mentioned.

הנה האמת הוא כי נמשך עם הכלים דכל עליון מהאור
והפנימיות שבו ג "כ

Now the truth is that with the vessels of all higher levels is drawn down the light and the inner aspects thereof as well.

ועי "ז הנה נעשה כל תחתון כלול מכל הבחי' כלם שבכל
העליונים כלם

And thereby the lower level comprises all of the aspects of all of the upper levels,

וכמ"ש בסדר אבי "ע פ' א' ב' ובכ"מ וכן הוא גם בענינינו

as is written in Eitz Chaim in the section titled “The Order of ABiY”A” chaps 1 & 2 and in several places. And so to as regards this matter:

כי הנה נמשך עם הג' חלקי כלים דכ"א מהה' פרצופי האצי'

For with the three aspects of the vessels of each of them, is drawn forth from the 5 partzufim of Atzilut – Atik, Arich, Abba, Imma, Zeir Anpin and Malchut or Nukbah –

המתפשטים להיות לנשמה כללית בהעולמות בי "ע

that spread forth to become the macro -neshama of the Worlds of BiY”A, (briaH, yetsira, asiya)

הנה נמשך עמהם מהאורות דכל פרצוף ופרצוף ג " כ

together with them are also drawn down from the lights from each of the partzufim .

ונמשך מכל חלקי הנרנח " י דכל פרצוף ופרצוף

so that there is drawn down from all the parts of nrnch”y of each partzuf

איזה הארה מהם עם בחי ' הכלי שמתפשט ממנו

some aspect of radiance from them, together with the aspect of the vessel that spreads out from it.

ונעשה מזה הנשמה הכללית דהעולמות בי " ע

And this becomes the level of macro- neshama of the Worlds of BiY”A

כלול ומלבש מכל העליונים כלם אשר לעלא לעלא

which comprises and is clothed within it all aspects of the higher worlds to the very highest levels

[זהו עמק פונת דברי הרב בכל ענין ההתלבשות אשר בשער]
[עגלים וישר ענף ד' ע"ש בדברינו בארוכה]

[And this is indeed the intention of the Rabbi Chaim Vital regarding the entire matter of hitlavshut – ‘enclothing’ or ‘insertion’ of one partzuf in another – as discussed in Eitz Chaim, Sha’ar Iggulim v’Yosher , anaf 4. See our commentary there at length].

ואותו האור הוא אורו ית " ש ממש השוכן בתוך הפנימית
דעולמות בי " ע

This light is in fact His light, may He be blessed, that rests within the inner dimension of the Worlds of BiY”A

בְּבַחֲי' נִשְׁמָה לְנִשְׁמָה (וּכְמ " שׁ בְּרַע " מ פ ' בְּהֵר ק " ט ב ')

– as the neshama of the neshama (as it states in Zohar vol . III in Raya Mehemna, Behar p. 109b). 5

וּמִזֶּה הָאוֹר מֵתַפְשֵׁט וְנִמְשָׁךְ כָּל הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָהּ

And from this light the entire Torah emerges and is drawn down,

אֲשֶׁר בָּהּ נִבְרָא וְנוֹצֵר וְנִעֲשֶׂה כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי " ע

and with it with the Torah all the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah were created (Beriah) , formed (Yetzirah) and made (Asiyah), 6

וְכֵן מֵתְקַיְמִים וּמֵתְנַהֲגִים רַק עַל יְדֵהּ

and they endure and are directed exclusively by her by the Torah.

וְהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה לְנִשְׁמָה דְּאוֹרֵיטָא שְׁאֲמָרוּ בְּזוֹה " ק בְּהֶעֱלִיתָךְ קֵן " ב
א'

The aspect of Torah that achieves all of this is the soul of the soul of Torah i.e. the inner dimension of Torah, Kabbalah, as they state in Zohar Beha'alotcha 152a.

וְכֵן מִזֶּה הָאוֹר הוּא שְׂרֵשׁ נִשְׁמַת כָּלֵל יִשְׂרָאֵל וּכְמ " שׁ בָּאֵד " ר ק מ "
א ע " ב

Furthermore, from very light is the root of the souls of all Israel, as the Zohar III states in the sub-section called Idra Rabba, p. 141b:

וַיִּפַּח בְּאַפּוֹ נִשְׁמַת חַיִּים כּו' בְּגִין לְאַשְׁתַּלְפָּא וּלְעֵיִלָּא בֵּיהּ

“And He blew into his nostrils the breath of life...” (Genesis 2:7) in order to draw down from above, from Arich Anpin 7 and implant in him in Adam (and in man in general, by extension,)

סְתִימִים דְּסְתִימָא עֲלָאָה עַד סוּפָא דְכָל סְתִימִין ,

the most hidden of hidden levels above, to the very limit of all hidden things all the way up until Adam Kadmon , the highest ‘world’ or plane of reality, if a person is worthy of this by virtue of his deeds 8

נִשְׁמָתָא דְכָל חַיֵּי דְעִילָא וְתַתָּא תַלְיִין מַהֲהִיא נִשְׁמָתָא , וּמִתְקַיְימִי
בָּהּ כּו' ע' ש'

And Adam Kadmon is the ultimate soul of all supernal life above, and it is also the life-force below of the lower worlds BiY”A all of which depend on that soul, and they endure thereby. 9

וְלָכֵן נֶאֱמַר בְּנִים אֲתֵם לִי " א [לָהּ אֱלֹקֵיכֶם] וְכֵן " ש' ב'פ' וַיְחִי רַמ
" ה' ו'פ' שְׁלַח קֵן " ט' ב'

And therefore it states in the verse (Deuteronomy 14:1) “You are children of the Lord your God,” as stated in Zohar I, Vayechi p. 245, and in Zohar III, Shelach p. 159b.

The highest, or most exalted, of the five worlds is called Adam Kadmon . Adam means “in the likeness of” or “in the image of”, from the Hebrew word domeh . Kadmon means “primordial”, or “primary”, from the Hebrew root kadam . So, Adam Kadmon is the primordial world which is "in the likeness of" the Infinite Light which preceded it and which was concealed in the process of creation. This means that even though Adam Kadmon is a world, meaning that it comes into being through the concealment of the Infinite Light, it is such an elevated plane of reality that it is “in the likeness of” the Infinite Light (which, by nature, “precedes” the world of Adam Kadmon). In this sense, souls that emerge from Adam Kadmon can be described as God’s children.

אבל שאר כל המציאות כלם נמשך התהוותם רק מכח הכלים

But all the rest of existence comes into being and descends from the power of the vessels rather than the light.

שהם החיצונית דהאצילות ונעלם בהם האור הפנימי הנזכר מאד
מאד

They the vessels are the outer layer of Atzilut and the inner light mentioned above is very, very concealed within them –

כי הוא להם רק לבחי' שרש השרשים

it is merely the source of their source.

ואפילו המלאכים שביצירה והשרפים שבבריאה

Even the angels in Yetzirah and the seraphs in Beriah

Different classes of angels are found in each of the worlds – ofanim in Asiyah, melachim in Yetzirah, seraphim in Beriah.

הם ג' כ' רק מהחיצוניות לבד ומזה נמשך מציאותם וכל שפעם
תמיד

are also only from the outer layer exclusively. It is from there that their existence and constant life-flow is drawn.

ולכן אמרו רז' ל' בדברים רבה פ' א' סימן י' ב' וכן הוא בירושלמי
שבת ספ' ו'

And therefore our Sages state in Devarim Rabba 1:12 and in Talmud Yerushalmi Shabbat end of chapter 6 that

עתיד הקב"ה לעשות מחיצתו של צדיקים לפנים מחיצתו של
מלאכי השרת

in the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will construct a section literally a 'partition' for the righteous closer in to the

Divine presence 10 than the area designated for the ministering angels.

וּמַלְאְכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת שׁוֹאֲלִין אוֹתָן וְאָמְרוּ לָהֶן מָה פָּעַל אֵל

And the ministering angels ask them the righteous saying to them, (Numbers 23:23) “What has God done?” Why have the righteous been given a place even closer to the divine Presence than the ministering angels?

The context of this verse: God redeemed Israel from Egypt, the epicenter of witchcraft and sorcery, and gave them the Torah, without them using magical means to foretell the future or affect events (see Nedarim 32a; Rashi on the verse). The question is thus in what merit were the righteous are given such a lofty position, even higher than the ministering angels?

וְהוּא מְשׁוּם מָה שְׁאָמְרָנוּ כִּי נִשְׁמַת יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא מְאֹר הַפְּנִימִי

The answer is as we said above – that the souls of Israel are from the inner light,

וּמַלְאְכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת הֵם רַק מִהַחֲצוֹנִית

while the ministering angels are only from the outer aspects.

וְהִרִי נִמְצָא כִּי הֵגֵם שְׁאָמְרָנוּ שֶׁהַנֶּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית דְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה

So it turns out that even though we stated that the macro-level neshama of the World of Asiyah

הִיא לְמִטָּה בְּמַדְרָגָה הַרְבֵּה מִהַנֶּשְׁמָה הַכִּלְלִית דְּהִצְרָה וְהַבְּרִיָּאָה

is on a much lower level than the macro-level neshama of Yetzirah and Beriah,

אֲךְ שֶׁרֶשׁ נִשְׁמַת יִשְׂרָאֵל הִיא עוֹלָה עַל כָּלָם כִּי הוּא מְאֹר הַפְּנִימִי

nevertheless, the root of the Israelite soul transcends them all, because it is from the inner light,

קו האמצעי המברח מן הקצה אל הקצה

the middle column that extends from end to end,

וכנודע דנשמת ישראל הוא חלק אלה ממעל וכמ "ש כי חלק ה'
עמו

and as is known the Israelite soul is part of God above, as the verse states, "For God's portion is His people" (Deuteronomy 32:9).

ואמרו בזוה "ק אחרי מות ס"ב ב' דהא אנון אתאחדו לעלא
לעלא

Regarding this, verse the holy Zohar (Acharei Mot 62b) states: They are one with the very highest of levels

ובפ' בראשית כ"ה א' אליו ישראל דנשמתייהו תליו מההוא אתר

and in parshat Bereishit 25a: "... those Israelites whose souls derive from that place

דאתמר ביה ברוך כבוד ה' מקומו

regarding which it states (Ezekiel 3:12) 'Blessed is the glory of God from His place'."

The Zohar there discusses several general types and levels of soul from the highest levels to the lowest.

אמנם בפרטות הנשמה דכ"א יש מדרגות רבות אין חקר

All of the above is in a general sense; however, in terms of the individual soul of each person there are innumerable levels,

וכמ"ש בפ' משפטים צ"ד ב' וכן ברע"מ פנחס רכ"ד סע"ב

as the Zohar states in parshat Mishpatim 94b, and in Raya Mehemna, Pinchas 224b.

אך עכ"פ כי כלם משרשים ואחדו לעלא לעלא וכנז'

Nevertheless, all of them are rooted in and united with the loftiest of levels, as mentioned.

ועי "ז אַפֿשר לב "א מישראל להִתְקַדֵּשׁ בְּקִדְשָׁהּ שֶׁל מַעֲלָה

Consequently, it is possible for each Jewish person to sanctify themselves with supernal sanctity,

וכמ "ש וְאַתֶּם הַדְּבָקִים בִּי "א [בַּה' אֱלֹהֵיכֶם] כו':

as is written (Deuternonomy 4:4) , “And you who cleave the Lord your God are all alive today!”

G A T E

*Shaar 4 — Discussion of the first three
levels of the Divine as related to us*

Chapter 1 — The narnhai leading to its final expression on the material plane.

שער ד. פרק א'

Shaar 4 Chapter 1

הנה אמרנו לעיל שער ב' שהצורה שהיא הנשמה

We stated above, Shaar 2 chapter 1 that the *tzurah*, which is the *neshamah*,

הנה היא כח החמר והגוף והיא סבתו בכל עניניו

is the power invested in the material world and the body, and is the cause of all aspects of each of them**.**

וא"כ הרי פשוט הוא כי ישנו בהצורה כל תכונות והוצאת הגוף כלו.

This being so, it is obvious that all of the qualities and modes of operation relating to the body are in the *tzurah*.

Since the *tzurah* is the source of the qualities and modes of operation of the body, it follows that these qualities and modes of operation must in some way be in the *tzurah*, albeit in a much more elevated manner. An analogy can perhaps be drawn from the way in which an idea is present in thought and how it emerges in speech. The idea expressed in speech is merely an extension of the idea as it is in thought, albeit a mere shadow of the thought, as the Baal HaLeshem will explain.

ואדרבה הוא שעקר תכונותיו דהגוף הנה הוא רק מהצורה שבו, שהצורה היא האדם העקרי.

And to the contrary, the primary qualities of the body are only due to the *tzurah* imbedded within it, since the *tzurah* is the primary aspect of a person,

והגוף הוא רק הכלי שלה שפעל ידו מוציא הצורה את כל תכונותיה
וכחותיה מן הכח אל הפועל

whereas the body is merely its vessel by which the *tzurah* manifests all of its qualities and powers from a state of
**potential to actuality. **

אבל עקר פרצוף האדם הוא רק הצורה.

So the primary aspect of man is only the *tzurah*, not the body.

אמנם עכ"ז הנה בהצורה לבד עומד שם כל עניני הגוף רק בכח
לבד

Nevertheless, in the *tzurah* itself, all aspects relating to the physical body are only in potential,

וכל הפעלה הרי הוא רק ע"י הגוף

and any action is exclusively via the body.

כי כאשר חסר איזה אבר מהגוף הרי אינו פועל בה הצורה
מאומה.

And the proof of this is **that when a limb is missing from the body, the aspect of the *tzurah* that corresponds to that limb cannot be expressed at all.**

ונמצא כי הכח והפועל הנה הוא הצורה.

It turns out that both potential and actual are embedded in the *tzurah*,

אבל הפעלה והמעשה הנה הוא בהגוף.

whereas the action and the deed are via the body exclusively,

ולא נעשה שום דבר אלא ע"י שניהם דווקא.

so that nothing is accomplished without both of them.

וְהִנֵּה אֲמָרְנוּ כִּי חִלְקֵי הַצּוּרָה הֵם ה' שֶׁהֵם נִרְנַח"י.

Now we said above¹ that there are five parts to the *tzurah*; they are *nrnch* "y – *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya* and *yechida*.

וְאֵלוּ הֵם הַנֶּעֱשֶׂה כ"א לְבוּשׁ לַחֲבֵרוֹ

And each one of these five becomes a 'garment' for its companion, i.e. for the level that transcends it.

Whereas the concept of *hishtalshehut* – the chaining down of reality from the very highest levels to the most mundane – is a fundamental concept in the writings and systems of both the Ramak and the Arizal, the concept of 'enclothing' is far more prominent in the writings and system of the Arizal. It explains how higher spiritual levels impact lower ones by becomes 'clothed' in them, and how lower ones in turn become the means by which higher levels are manifested, albeit in a concealed manner. In other words, the higher levels become 'clothed' in a 'body' or 'garment' that acts as a receptacle and thus the means of expression of the higher level, while at the same time obscuring the higher level to a greater or lesser degree, depending on the level of refinement of the 'body' or 'garment.'

שֶׁכָּל תַּחְתּוֹן לְגַבִּי עֲלִיוֹן הוּא בְּבַחֲיוֹ גּוֹף אֱלִיּוֹ

This is because every lower level is regarded as the aspect of 'body' (synonymous with 'garment' here) compared with the higher level

וְכָל עֲלִיוֹן הוּא הַצּוּרָה לַהֲתַחְתּוֹן.

and the higher level is regarded as the *tzurah* or soul of the lower,

וְעַקֵּר הַכֹּחַ וְהַפּוֹעֵל הוּא בְּהָעֲלִיוֹן וְעַקֵּר הַפְּעֻלָּה וְהַמַּעֲשֶׂה הוּא בְּהִתַּחְתּוֹן.

so that the primary potential and its actualization (actualization in the sense that is appropriate for the *tzurah*) is in the upper level,

whereas the primary activity and deed is in the lower level.

אָמָנָם הֵנָּה לֹא נִשְׁלָם שׁוּם דָּבָר אֲלָא רַק ע"י כָּלָם יַחַד דְּוָקָא

Nevertheless, nothing can be achieved without both of them together.

הֵינֵנו ע"י כָּל הַשְּׂשָׁה בְּיַחַד שֶׁהֵם הָה' חֲלָקֵי צוּרָה דִּנְרַנַּח".

That is to say, all six aspects together – the five parts of the *tzurah*, *nrnch* "y – *nefesh*, *ruach*, *neshama*, *chaya* and *yechida* –

עִם הַגּוּי כְּשֶׁהֵם כָּלָם בְּיַחַד

with the body in which they become clothed**, all of them together form a single unit.**

כִּי עֲנֵנו הָה' חֲלָקֵי צוּרָה דִּנְרַנַּח"

The nature of the five aspects of the *tzurah*, *nrnch* "y,

הוּא כִּי נִתְפָּשֵׁט בָּהֶם הַגְּלוּי דְּכָל תְּכוּנַת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם

is that in them is manifested in a revelation of all the qualities of the human *partzuf* – literally 'countenance,' but here implying the entire concept of what it means to be human, as a reflection of the Divine Image (alternatively, we could simply transliterate this as *partzuf Adam*)–

מִגְּלוּי לְגְלוּי עַד הַצּוּרָה הָאַחֲרוֹנָה שֶׁהִיא הַנֶּפֶשׁ

from illumination to illumination or revelation to revelation until the final *tzurah* which is the level of *nefesh*.

וְשֵׁם נִגְמָר כָּל תְּכוּנוֹת וְעֲנִינֵי הָאָדָם בְּכַח כָּכָל הָרָאוּי אֵלָיו

It is there that all the appropriate qualities and characteristics of man are completed in potential.

This is because the level of *nefesh* corresponds to *malchut*, which completes the revelation of the levels of soul,² just like *malchut*

completes the revelation of the array of *sefirot*.

אָבֵל עֵדִין הוּא רַק בְּכַח לְבַד אֶלָּא שֶׁהַנֶּפֶשׁ שֶׁהִיא הַצּוּרָה אַחֲרוֹנָה

Nevertheless, it is still only in a potential state, just that the *nefesh* is the final aspect of *tzurah*,

הִנֵּה בָּהּ נִגְמַר הַגְּלוּי דְּכָל מְצִיאת הַכֹּחַ הָרְאוּי לְתִכּוּנַת עֲנִינֵי פְּרָצוּף
אָדָם מִמֶּשׁ

and with it (the *nefesh*) becoming manifested, the revelation of all the latent powers that are appropriate for the characteristics of the *partzuf* of man are in fact complete.

וּמִמֶּנָּה הִנֵּה נִמְשָׁךְ וְיוֹצֵא מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפְּעֵל ע"י הַגּוּף

And from it from the *nefesh* it the latent powers are drawn down and emerge from potential to actual via the body³

אֲשֶׁר הַנֶּפֶשׁ מִתְעַרֵּב בּוֹ וּמִתְעַלֵּם עִמּוֹ לְהַעֲשׂוֹת לְאַחֵד.

which is infused with the *nefesh* concealed within it, to form a single entity,

וְכַמ"ש 'כִּי הַדָּם הוּא הַנֶּפֶשׁ' וְלֹא תֹאכַל הַנֶּפֶשׁ עִם הַבָּשָׂר.

as it is written, "for the blood is the *nefesh*" (Genesis 17:11), and "be strong and do not eat the blood, for the blood is the *nefesh*, and when you eat meat do not consume the *nefesh* with it" (Deuteronomy 12:23).

It is the *nefesh* 'clothed' in the blood that engenders life, and thus the two together, the *tzurah* and the vessel (the blood, the body etc.) form a single unit.

וְנִמְצָא כִּי גִמַּר הַשְּׁלֵמַת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם הוּא רַק ע"י כָּל הַשָּׂשׂוֹה יְחִיד
דְּיוֹקָא.

So it turns out that the completion of the human *partzuf* is only when all six aspects are together as one.

כי בהנפש עומד בזה המהות דפּרצוף אדם

Because in the *nefesh* is situated the essence of the human *partzuf*

בכל עניניו שבו רק בכח אבל לא בפעל

in all of its aspects, albeit that this is only in a potential state and not yet actual.

ובהרום הנה הוא רק בבחי' כח לכח

In *ruach* this is only in a state of latent potential (literally, 'capacity of the capacity') i.e. twice removed from actualization

ובהנשמה הנה בזה הוא רק השרש להכח דכח.

while in *neshama* only the root of latent potential is there i.e. three times removed from actualization.

וכן הוא עולה למעלה למעלה ונתמעט גליו ומהותו

And so too as we progress through the levels **higher and higher, the degree of **revelation and essential nature** of the *tzurah* becomes more and more ethereal**⁴

בכל עליון עד הצורה העליונה שהוא היחידה

at each progressively **higher level, until the **final** aspect of *tzurah*****, which is *yechida*.**

אשר שם עומד כל התכונה דפּרצוף אדם בלי מהות כלל

It is there that the entire human *partzuf* is situated without any defining characteristics at all, since, at this level, the *tzurah* completely transcends the limitations of defining characteristics.

אלא רק בבחי' שרש לשרש שרש השרשים.

Instead it is merely the aspect of the root of the root of the root of all roots.

כי בכל צורה שהיא יותר עליונה נתמַעַט ונתַעַלם בה הגלוי
דמהות ותאר פרצוף אדם.

This is because the loftier the *tzurah*, the more ethereal or transcendent and concealed the display of the human characteristics and definitions of a *partzuf* become.

ולכן נקרא היחידה בפני המקבלים בשם אפס ואין

Therefore *yechida* is referred to by the Kabbalists as "*efes*" nothingness and "*ayin*" indiscernible or inscrutable,

משום שבה מסתים ההשגה לגמרי, והיא בלי מהות משג.

since this is where understanding terminates completely, and it is of an unfathomable nature.

כי אלו ה' חלקי נשמה שבכל פרצוף שהם נרנח"י הם נמשכים
מהעשר ספירות:

Now these five aspects of the soul in every *partzuf*, i.e. *nrnch* "y, are drawn from the ten *sefirot*:

יחידה – כתר. והוא נקרא אין, כמ"ש בזוה"ק בשלח ס"ד ב'
ובאדר"ז רפ"ז ב'.

***yechida* from *keter*, and this is called *ayin*, as the *Zohar*, *Beshalach* 64a and *Idra Zuta* p. 287b state;**

חיה הוא חכמה ע"ש הכתוב (קהלת ז') 'החכמה תחיה בעליה'
וכן חכם גימטריא חיים

chaya* which is related to the word *chayim* – life is from *chochma, as in (*Kohelet* 7**:12**) "*chochma*** wisdom preserves the life *chayim* of those who possess it,"**

וְהָיָא נִמְשָׁךְ וְיוֹצֵא מִן הַכֶּתֶר וְכַמ"ש (אִיּוֹב כ"ח) וְהִתְחַכְמָה מֵאִין חֲמָצָא.

and it (*chochma*) is drawn down from and emerges from *keter*, as the verse (Job 28:12) states, "and wisdom emerges from *ayin*" (i.e. *keter*).** We have translated the verse the way it is interpreted here. However, the plain meaning of the text presents this as a question – "where is *chochma* to be found?

שֶׁהוּא מֵהַכֶּתֶר שֶׁנִּקְרָא אִין לְגֹדֶל הָעֲלָמוֹ. כִּי הוֹרָאת מֵלֵת אִין הוּא בִּר"ת אֵיהֶ נֶעְלָם.

For it comes from *keter*, which is called *ayin* – inscrutable – due to its profound concealment,**

כִּי הוֹרָאת מֵלֵת אִין הוּא בִּר"ת [בְּרָאשֵׁי תִבּוֹת] 'אֵיהֶ נֶעְלָם'

which is why the word *ayin* can be interpreted as an acronym "where is it concealed?"

The letters *aleph* and *yud* of אֵיהֶ and the letter *nun* of נֶעְלָם together form the word אִין.

וְהִתְחַכְמָה הוּא נִקְרָא יֵשׁ, כַּמ"ש בִּרְע"מ פְּנִיחָס רַל"ט א'.

By way of contrast with the 'nothingness' of *keter*, ***chochma* itself is called 'yesh' – something –**

וְהָיָא יֵשׁ מֵאִין וְנִתְגַּלָּה מְצִיאוּתָהּ וְלֹא מֵהוּתָהּ.

for it emerges *ex nihilo* in a manner that its existence, but not its essence, is revealed.

נִשְׁמָה בִּינָה וְנִקְרָא 'הוּא' וְכַמ"ש בַּפ' וְיוֹצֵא קַנ"ד ב' כִּי הָיָא עֲדִין נִסְתָּר.

Neshama* is associated with the *sefirah* of *binah**, which is referred to** in the third person, '**he**,' indicating that it is as yet remote from us.

Binah is a 'feminine' *sefirah*, often referred to in *Zohar* as *imma*, the 'mother' *sefirah*, while *chochma* is a 'male' *sefirah* referred to as the 'father' *sefirah*⁵

וְהָרוּחַ שֶׁהוּא ת"ת הכולל כל הו"ק נקרא אֵתָהּ, כמ"ש בַּתְקוּנִים
תְּקוּנוֹ י"ט דף ט"ל.

Ruach* is associated with the *sefirah* of *tiferet**, which includes all of the six extremities** i.e. the six *sefirot* from *chesed* to *yesod* **and is called 'you'** in the second person. This indicates that it is a level that is close to us, with which we can communicate directly, face-to-face so to speak, **as is explained in the *Tikunim* the *Tikunei Zohar*, *Tikun 19*, p. 39.**

הַנֶּפֶשׁ מַלְכוּת נִקְרָא אֲנִי. וכמ"ש בַּפ' מִקֵּץ ר"ד ע"ב ופ' תְּרוּמָה קנ"ו
א' וְכֵן בַּהק"ז ו' ע"א:

***Nefesh* is associated with the *sefirah* of *malchut*, and is called 'I'** in the first person, **as the *Zohar*, *parshat Miketz* p. 204b, and *parshat Terumah* 156a, and in the Introduction to the *Zohar* p. 6a state.**

Not only is it close to us, it actually is our life force and thus who we are (in this world).

וְנִחָזֵר עַל הַדְּבָרִים כְּדֵי לִבָּא לְכוּנְתָנוּ

Let's review what we've said in order to proceed to our intention:

כִּי כָל הָה' חֲלָקֵי צוּרָה שֶׁהֵם נִרְנַח"י הִנֵּה הֵם מָה שֶׁמִּתְפַּשְׁטִים
מִגִּלּוֹי לְגִלּוֹי לְתַכּוּנַת כָּל עֲנִינֵי דְתֵאֵר פְּרָצוּף אָדָם

All five parts of the *tzurah*, the *nrnch*"y, radiate from illumination to illumination or revelation to revelation, thus infusing **all of the properties of the human *partzuf* with all its characteristics.**

אֵלָּא שֶׁכָּל הַתְּפִשְׁטוּתָם וְגִלּוּיֵם הִנֵּה הוּא רַק לְמַצִּיאוֹת הַכֹּחַ לְבַד
אֲשֶׁר לָזֶה

However, all their radiating forth and illumination is only insofar as their existential aspect of the power, but not its essential inner dimension.

וְנִמְשָׁךְ הַגְּלוּי דְּהִכָּח אֲשֶׁר לָזֶה מִדְּרָגָא לְדְרָגָא עַד הַנֶּפֶשׁ.

And the revelation of that power is drawn down from level to level until the level of *nefesh*,

וְשֵׁם נִשְׁלַם אוֹתוֹ הִכָּח אֲשֶׁר לְתַכּוּנַת מַהוּת וְתֹאֵר פְּרָצוֹף אָדָם בְּכָל הָרְאוּי.

where that power becomes complete in the essential qualities and description of what it means to be human in the proper sense.

אֲךְ יִצְיָאָתָם מִן הִכָּח אֶל הַפּוֹעֵל מִמֶּשׁ הוּא רַק ע"י הַגּוּף

But again, their emergence from potential to actual corporeal reality is only via the body,

כִּי רַק בְּהַגּוּף נַעֲשֶׂה הַפְּעָלָה אֲבָל כָּל מָה שֶׁלִּמְעָלָה מִן הַגּוּף הוּא רַק בְּכָח לְבַד

because it is only an action done with the body, whereas when it is above, transcending the body, it is only in a state of potential.

שֶׁהַנֶּפֶשׁ הוּא הִכָּח הַיּוֹתֵר קְרוֹב אֲשֶׁר לָזֶה וְהָרוּחַ הוּא הִכָּח לְכָח

Thus the *nefesh* level of the *tzurah* is the closest capacity to the human being, whereas *ruach* is only the latent potential (literally, 'capacity of the capacity') twice removed.

וְהַנִּשְׁמָה הוּא הַשְּׂרֵשׁ לַכ"ז וְהַחַיָּה הוּא הַשְּׂרֵשׁ הַשְּׂרֵשִׁים

And the level of *neshama* is the root of all of them of the levels below, and *chaya* is the root of the root,

וְנִתְמַעַט גְּלוּיִים בַּכ"א שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה

so that the loftier the level the more ethereal or transcendent the revelation becomes,

עד שבהיחידה שהוא השרש לכלם אין בו לכל זה שם ומלה כלל,

until in *yechida*, which is the root of all of them, there is no name or term at all that can describe or define it,

ונעלם בו לגמרי הגם שכלם הם ממנו ולכך נקרא אין פנז'.

and in it (in *yechida*) these qualities are completely concealed, even though they all derive therefrom. And this is why *yechida* is called *ayin* – inscrutable.

אמנם עכ"ז הנה ידעת לנבון נקל' (משלי יד, ו) שכל מה שאמרנו מגדל העלמתם

Nevertheless, 'wisdom will come easily to the understanding one' (Proverbs 14:6) regarding everything we stated about these very abstruse matters,

אשר בכל יותר עליון, הנה הוא רק בערך הפעלה האחרונה,

where the loftiest of levels is only very vaguely **related to the final act, **

הפעלה הממשית הנעשה בהגוף המשג והנתפס לכל עין חמרי וגופני.

i.e. the physical act done with a body that can be comprehended and grasped by an eye that is material and corporeal.

Accordingly, there is no real paradigm by which to evaluate the lower levels by comparing them with the higher levels, since they are basically (almost) incomparable.

אבל במציאות הנרנח"י עצמו, בהערך זה כנגד זה,

But as regards the *nrnch* "y themselves, when evaluating one against the other,

הנה נבחן כל תחתון בהערך העליון ממנו

each lower level can be assessed in comparison with the level above it.

ובפרט בערך השלישי שעליו שהוא העליון דעליון

And this is particularly apropos when evaluating a lower level by comparing it with the third level above – that which is above the level above it i.e. twice removed where the distinctions between them are even more blatant,

הנה נבחן התחתון נגדו היטיב, בכל תכונת מהות ותאר אדם
ממש.

so that the lower level can indeed be appraised well in comparison with it, in every aspect of the inner essence and outer description of the human *partzuf*, since they both have the same *tzurah*, albeit one much loftier than the other,

כי הרי כל תחתון הוא בבחי' גוף ולבוש להעליון שהוא נשמה אליו

since every lower level of *nrvch*"y serves as a 'body' and 'garment' for the higher level which is its soul (neshama).

ונחשב העליון אליו בבחי' איכות ופח.

Accordingly, the higher level is regarded by the lower level as its superior quality and potential,

והתחתון הוא נחשב להעליון, שבו מוציא את תכונתו וכחו מן
הפח אל הפועל ומן האיכות אל הכמות,

while the lower level is regarded as important to the higher level – as the means by which it expresses its qualities and capabilities, from potential to actual, and from quality to quantity.

ונגמר בו המעשה והפעלה דהצורה העליונה כי הוא בבחי' חמר
וגוף נגדו.

And through it (via the lower level) the actions and effects of the higher *tzurah* are completed, since the lower level is the aspect of 'material' and 'body' in comparison with it.

וְהָיָה נִמְצָא כִּי הַכְּנוּי דְּפָרְצוּף אָדָם וְכָל הַמַּהוּת וְהַתָּאָר שֶׁבּוֹ הוּא
נִדּוּן בְּעֶרְכּוֹ.

Thus it turns out that the expression 'the human *partzuf*' with its entire inner essence and outer description is amenable to comparative analysis.

דָּכַל עָלִיוֹן לְגַבֵּי תַּחְתּוֹן הוּא אֵינוֹ מְכַנֶּה בְּשֵׁם פָּרְצוּף וּבְמַהוּת אָדָם
כָּלל

While the upper level compared to the lower level is not dubbed '*partzuf*' or given any human attributions at all,

אֲבָל כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן לְגַבֵּי עָלִיוֹן וּמִכָּל שֶׁכֵּן לְהַעֲלִיֹן דְּעָלִיוֹן הִנֵּה מְכַנֶּה
וּמִתָּאָר הַתַּחְתּוֹן הַשְּׁלִישִׁי.

such a label and description is applied to the lower level compared to the upper level, and all the more so when compared to an even higher level, as a third-level entity,

כְּגוֹן: הַנֶּפֶשׁ לְגַבֵּי נִשְׁמָה וְכוּ הַרוּחַ לְגַבֵּי הַחַיָּה

for example – *nefesh* is a third-level (i.e. twice-removed) entity in comparison with *neshama*, since the order is *nefesh, ruach, neshama*. And similarly *ruach* is a third-level (i.e. twice-removed) entity in comparison with *chaya* since the order is *ruach, neshama, chaya*,

בְּכָל תַּכּוּנַת וּמַהוּת וְתָאָר פָּרְצוּף אָדָם מִמֶּשׁ

and they are indeed labeled as a human *partzuf* with all the qualities and character and description thereof,

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁהוּא בְּהֶגוּף ע"י הַנֶּפֶשׁ רוּחַ שֶׁבּוֹ.

just like the body compared with the *nefesh* and *ruach* vested within it.

וְהִנֵּה כָּבֵד אֶמְרָנוּ לְעֵיל שְׁעַר ג' שֶׁכ"א מֵהִנֵּנֵחַ"י הוּא כָּלוּל ג"כ מִנֵּנֵחַ"י,

Now we already explained above in Sha'ar 3 that each of the *nrnch*"y *nefesh*, *ruach*, *nesham*, *chaya*, *yechida* itself comprises *nrnch*"y

וְיִשְׁגֹּם ה' בְּחִי נִרְנַח"י בְּהִנְפֹּשׁ וְה' בְּחִי נִרְנַח"י בְּהִרוּם וְכו' ה' בְּחִי בְּהִנְשָׁמָה וְה' בְּחִי בְּהִחְיָה וְה' בְּחִי בְּהִיחְיָה.

so that there are five levels of *nrnch*"y of the *nefesh*, and five levels of *nrnch*"y of *ruach*, and five levels of *nrnch*"y of *neshama*, and five levels of *nrnch*"y of *chaya**,* and five levels of *nrnch*"y of *yechida*.

וּא"כ הָרִי כָּל מָה שְׁאֶמְרָנוּ מֵעֲנִין הַתְּפִשּׁוּת הַגְּלוּיִם דְּכָל תְּכוּנַת וּמֵהוּת פְּרָצוּף אֲדָם,

This being so, then everything we discussed about the concept of radiating forth the revelation of all of the qualities and the character of the human *partzuf*,

אֵיךְ שֶׁנִּתְפָּשֵׁט וְיוֹצֵא מִגְּלוּי לְגְלוּי וּמִדְּרָגָא לְדְרָגָא,

and how they radiate forth from illumination to illumination or revelation to revelation

מֵהַצּוּרָה הָעֲלִיוֹנָה שֶׁהוּא הִיחְיָה עַד הַצּוּרָה הַתְּחִתּוֹנָה שֶׁהוּא הִנְפֹּשׁ.

from the loftiest aspect of the *tzurah***, which is *yechida*, until the lowliest** aspect of the *tzurah***, which is the *nefesh***.

וְכו' כָּל מָה שְׁאֶמְרָנוּ מֵעֲנִין שְׁלִילַת הַתֵּאָר וּמֵהוּת דְּפְרָצוּף אֲדָם

Similarly, everything that we stated regarding the negation of descriptors and definitions of human form

אשר בכל צורה היותר עליונה בערך התחתון שלמטה הימנה,

in connection with a higher *tzurah* compared with one below it,

ואיך כי עם כל זה הנה בערכין נדון אותו המהות והתאר בכלם על כל פנים.

and how, despite this, their essence and description are nevertheless comparable across the board –

הנה כ"ז הוא הן בהנרנח"י הפלליים והן בהנרנח"י הפרטיים שבכ"א גופה.

all of this is true regarding both the macro-level *nrnch* "y, and the micro-level *nrnch* "y within each of them – within each of the macro-levels.

והנה הפרטיים הרי הם כ"ה בחי' וכנזכר.

Thus, fully iterated, there are twenty-five distinct aspects, as mentioned previously.

וא"כ הרי אנו רואין מזה שכל התאר ומהות דפרצוף אדם הנעשה ונגמר בהגוף החמרי העקרי,

If so, we see from this that the entire description and essence of the human *partzuf* is fashioned and completed via the physical body as the main thing.

כמה שרחוק ומשולל הוא מבחי' הצורה היותר עליונה שהוא היחידה הפרטית

This is so despite how far apart from and how antithetical the body is to the loftiest aspect of the *tzurah* – the micro-level *yechida* –

אשר בהיחידה הפללית אשר הוא למעלה וגבוה מהגוף החמרי כ"ה מדרגות.

of the macro-level yechida, which is twenty-five lofty levels above the physical body!

וגם כ"ז הוא רק בהכ"ה בְּחִי' דנרנח"י הפְּרָטִיִּים אֲשֶׁר בהנרנח"י
הַכְּלָלִיִּים שֶׁבְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה לְבַד.

Moreover, all this is only the twenty-five individual levels of the micro-level *nrnch*"y into which the macro-level *nrnch*"y of the World of Asiyah alone is subdivided.

וְכֵן הֲרִי יִשְׁנָם כ"ז בְּעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה, וְכֵן בְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה,

Add to that the fact that all these are also present in the World of Yetzirah, and similarly in the World of Beriah.

כִּי בְּכָל עוֹלָם הֲרִי יִשְׁנָם ה' בְּחִי' נרנח"י כְּלָלִיִּים וּכ"ה בְּחִי' נרנח"י
פְּרָטִיִּים

And so too in every world – there are the five aspects of macro-level *nrnch*"y and twenty-five levels of the micro-level *nrnch*"y

וְהֵם בְּסֵךְ הַכֹּל קכ"ה בְּחִי' וְהוּא בְּפָנִימִיּוֹת וְכֵן הוּא ג"כ בְּחִיצוֹנִיּוֹת)

(for a total of 125 inner-dimensional aspects, and similarly in the outer dimension,

וּכְמ"ש הָרַב בְּשַׁעַר פְּנִימִיּוֹת וְחִיצוֹנִיּוֹת דְּרוּשׁ י"א וּבכ"מ)

As the rabbi Rabbi Chaim Vital writes in the name of the Arizal in *Sha'ar Pnimit v'Chitzoniyut* [*Sha'ar* 40] chapter 11, and in a number of places).

וְהֲרִי אֲנִי רוֹאִין מִכ"ז אֵיךְ שֶׁנֶּעְלָם וּמְשׁוּלָּל מִהֲשֻׁגָּת וּתְפִיסַת בְּנֵי
אָדָם

So we see from all this the extent of concealment and inaccessibility to man's grasp and understanding

מִלְּהַבְחִין שׁוּם תְּמוּנַת מַהוּת וְתֹאֵר גַּם בְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה,

by which he could discern an image of the nature of the world of Beriah, or even a description thereof.

הגם שהוא באמת ג"כ עולם מלא מכל המציאות והענינים
שבהעלם הזה

This is so despite the fact that Beriah is indeed also a world, replete with its existence and those matters concealed there

והוא כלו נברא ומחדש ואינו אלהות כלל.

and Beriah is a creation and is renewed and originated from nothing, and it is not Godliness at all.

אך כבר אמרנו לעיל שער ב' שמהחמר דעולם העליון נעשה
הצורה דעולם התחתון

Now we already stated above in *Sha'ar 2* that the *tzurah* of the lower world is fashioned from the 'material' aspect of the higher world,

וכל צורה נגד החמר הרי אין בה תאר מפרצוף אדם כלל וכנזכר.

and that *tzurah* compared with materiality has no human countenance at all, as mentioned.

וא"כ הרי כמה רחוק ומשולל הוא מהשגתנו להשיג את מהות
החמר והגשם

This being so, it shows how remote from and inaccessible to our intellectual grasp it is to fathom the essence of 'materiality' and 'physicality' –

אשר גם בעולם הבריאה בתכלית הרחוק והשלילה היותר אפשרי:

even in the World of Beriah, which is as remote and as inaccessible as could possibly be from our understanding.

וזהו שאמרו בזהר חדש בראשית י"א סע"א: אמר ר' יוחנן בן זכאי:
כמה נצטער ההוא גברא

This is what is meant when the *Zohar Chadash, Bereishit 11a*⁶ states: Rabbi Yochanan ben Zakkai declared, "How great was the yearning of that great man to behold the Divine Glory.

דְּכָתִיב בִּיה 'לֹא כֵן עֲבָדִי מֹשֶׁה בְּכָל בֵּיתִי נֶאֱמָן הוּא' לְמַחְזִי חֵד
שֶׁמֶשָׁא דְּמִשְׁמֶשָׁא קָמִיה

Regarding him the verse (Numbers 12:7) states 'This is not true of My servant Moshe, who is a trusted servant throughout My house'⁷

וְלֹא אֶתְיָהֲבֵת לֵיהּ רְשׁוּתָא, דְּכָתִיב 'הֲרֵאֵנִי נָא אֶת כְּבוֹדְךָ'.

and yet he was not granted permission, as when the verse (Exodus 33:18) states, "Please show me Your Glory"

וְהוּא דְּכָתִיב בִּיה 'כְּבוֹד אֵל' וְהוּא מַטְטְרוֹן שֶׁר הַפָּנִים

referring to the one of whom it is written 'he is the glory of God,' – the angel Metatron, the Angel of the Presence.

וְהֵאִיךְ שְׂאִיל מֹשֶׁה לְמַחְמֵי דָא?

Now how did Moshe think to request this? After, all was he not a human being?

אֶלָּא מֹשֶׁה סָבַר כִּיּוֹן דִּחְמָא גּוּפִיה אֶרְבָּעַן יוֹמִין וְאַרְבָּעַן לַילִין דָּלָא
אָכִיל וְשָׁתִי,

However, Moshe opined that since he saw that his own body did not eat or drink for forty days and nights,

וְהוּהּ נִזּוֹן מֵאַסְפִּקְלָרְיָא דְּלַעֲיָלָא, סָבַר דְּכֻדָּאי הוּא לְמִשְׁאַל דָּא.

and he was nourished by a supernal radiance he opined that he was worthy of this request.

וּמָה אֶתִּיב לֵיהּ? 'לֹא תוּכַל לִרְאוֹת אֶת פָּנַי'. הוּא מָרָא דְּאַפִּיָא.

But what was the response to him? "You cannot view My countenance" (Exodus 33:20),⁸ referring to the Master of the Presence the Angel Metatron.

וְלֹא יִהְיֶה לִי הַרְשָׁוָה כֹּה

And he was not given permission...⁹

כִּי מִט"ט הֵנָּה הוּא כּוֹלֵל אֶת כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע.

for the Angel Metatron includes all the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Assiya,

וְכַמ"ש בְּזוֹהַר ק"פ וַיְחִי רַכ"ג רע"ב: חֲדָ עוֹלָמָא דְאִוְרָכִיָּה מְרִישָׁא דְעֵלְמָא לְסִיפֵי דְעֵלְמָא.

as the holy Zohar (Vayechi 223b) states in reference to the Angel Metatron: One 'youth' who extends from the beginning of the world of Beriah to the end of the world of Asiyah.¹⁰

וְאָמְרוּ עוֹד בְּתִקּוּנִים תִּקּוּן ס"ח שֶׁכָּל דִּיּוּקָנִין דְּמַלְאכֵיָּא

The *Tikunim* (Tikun 68) states further that all the images of the angels

וְדִיּוּקָנִין דְּנִשְׁמָתֵין וְדִיּוּקָנִין דְּכָל מָה דְּאִתְבְּרִי בְּשָׁמַיָּא וּבְאַרְעָא כֻּלָּם כְּלוּלִים בּוֹ.

and all the images of the soul, and all the images of whatever was created in the heavens and earth are all included in him in Metatron,

כִּי הוּא צוּרָתָם וְלָכֵן לֹא הָיָה אֶפְשָׁר גַּם לְמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ ע"ה בְּהִיוּתוֹ בְּהַעוֹה"ז לִרְאוֹתוֹ בְּחוּשׁ.

for he is their form, and therefore even Moshe Rabbeinu could not apprehend him with his sense of sight while he Moshe was in this world.

כִּי אֵי אֶפְשָׁר לְאָדָם לִרְאוֹת תַּאֲרֵי הַצּוּרָה בְּשׁוּם אִפֵּן

Because it is absolutely impossible for a person to see the image of a *tzurah*,

מאחר שבערך הגוף אין להצורה תמונה ותאר כלל וכנז':

since, compared with the body, the *tzurah* does not have a picture and an image at all, as mentioned.

התבונן בכל הדברים הללו הגם שפשוטים הם.

So contemplate all of these matters, even though they are straightforward,

וקח אותם בלבך כי הם מהקדמות הנצרכות מאד

and take them to heart, for they are the exceedingly necessary introduction

לכל מי שרוצה לכנס בעדן גן אלהים

for anyone who wishes to enter Eden, the Garden of God,

ולטעם טעם עץ החיים כדי להדבק באלהים חיים,

and savor the taste of the Tree of Life in order to cleave to the Living God.

והקדמנו כ"ז להרחיק את התפיסה והדמיון מכל מה שנדבר עוד בזה למטה.

We have made this introduction in order to dissociate people from the mistaken idea and erroneous impression that will be discussed below.

וע"ז אמרו (בהקדמת הזהר ז' רע"א) 'ואם רץ לבך שוב לאחד'.

In this regard, our Sages declared (in the Introduction to the *Zohar* p. 7a) "If your heart runs, return to the One,"

כי גם והחיות שבמרקבה הם רצוא ושוב:

because even the angels of the Divine Chariot (the *Merkava*), known as the *chayot***, are in a state of 'running and returning'** (See Ezekiel 1:14).

The intention here is that even the holy angels, who are capable of great profundity of thought, grasp these lofty ideas only fleetingly and must return to a lower level in order to process them.¹¹

Footnotes

1. Shaar 3, chapter 2. ↩
2. Makover. ↩
3. Thus the *nefesh* is the intermediary by which the body and the higher levels of soul become connected, as the Baal HaLeshem will explain below (Makover). ↩
4. Another way of saying this is that the 'footprint' of the *tzurah* becomes less and less obvious. ↩
5. *Chochmah* as an unformed flash of revelation or insight is compared to a drop of semen, while *binah*, which develops and fleshes out the seminal idea, is compared to the womb where the drop develops into a fully formed embryo. See e.g. Ramak's *Eilimah ma'ayan* 3, *tamar* 6, chapter 15; *Etiz Chaim sha'ar* 39, chap. 6. ↩
6. p. 13b in our printed version. ↩
7. The context: Aaron and Miriam criticized Moshe for divorcing his wife Tzipora, which he had done due to the fact that he was always on call to God and could not fulfill his marital duties. They argued that they too were prophets had received Divine communication, and yet they remained married. In response, God called Moshe and Miriam and Aaron to the Tent of Meeting where He declared that Moshe's prophecy was different from theirs – "I make Myself known to them in a vision; I speak to them in a

dream. This is not true of My servant Moshe, who is a trusted servant throughout My house. With him I speak face to face..." [↩](#)

8. The entire verse: וַיֹּאמֶר לֹא תוּכַל לִרְאוֹת אֶת פָּנַי כִּי לֹא יֵרָאֶנִּי הָאָדָם וְחַי [↩](#)

9. The *Zohar* ibid continues: "until his soul departed from him" on the day of his passing from this world. [↩](#)

10. His head in Beriah, his body in Yetzirah, and his feet in Asiyah. Makover. [↩](#)

11. See Makover. [↩](#)

Chapter 2 — The revelation of the Divine Light in the world of Atsilus and in the worlds of Bi"a (bria, yetsira, asiya) via His Holy Names.

Sha'ar 4 Chapter 2

Parts of Bi'a that are Divine and those that are not.

Matter of God's Names.

וּמַעֲתָה נֶאֱמַר עוֹד כִּי הִנֵּה לְעִיל שְׁעַר ג' נִתְבָּאֵר כִּי מִהַנִּשְׁמָה
הַכִּלְיִית וְלִמְעָלָה

Now we can state further, after what was explained in Sha'ar 3 chapter 3 – that from the macro-level *neshama* and above

הוא כלו אלהות גמור גם בכל העולמות בי"ע.

is all completely Godliness, even in the Worlds of BiY"A
Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

וְכֵן בְּהַרוּחַ וּנְפֶשׁ הַכִּלְיִים הִנֵּה אֶמְרָנוּ שֶׁם ג"כ

Similarly, regarding macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*, we also stated there in Sha'ar 3, chapter 3

כִּי הִיחִידָה שְׁבָהֶם הוּא אֱלֹהוּת גָּמוּר גַּם בְּהַעֲשִׂיָּה.

that their level of *yechida* i.e. the micro-level *yechida* of macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* is also completely Godliness.

וּבְעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה הִנֵּה גַם הִחֲיָה אֱלֹהוּת.

And in the World of Yetzirah the level of *chaya* is also Godliness.

וּבְעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה הִנֵּה גַם הִנִּשְׁמָה אֱלֹהוּת.

And in the World of Beriah even the level of *neshama* is Godliness.

וְהִנֵּה כָּל אֵלֹו הַבְּחִינֹת הַגָּם שֶׁהֵם אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוּר

Thus it is that all of these aspects, even though they are completely Godliness,

עכ"ז הִנֵּה נִתְצַמְצְמוּ וְעוֹמְדִים בְּבַחֲיַת צוּרָה פְּנִימִית

are nevertheless constrained into the state of an internal *tzurah*
(a configuration of spiritual powers and qualities defined by certain parameters

לְכָל הַתּוֹאֲרִים דְּתִכּוּנַת קוֹמַת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם אֲשֶׁר בְּהֶעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע.

with all the demarcations of the stature of the *partzuf* or the 'persona' of Adam in the Worlds of BiY" A.

וְכַגּוֹן הַיְּחִידָה שֶׁבְּהָרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ דְּעוֹלָם הָעֲשִׂיָּה.

For example, the *yechidah* of *ruach* and *nefesh* of the World of Asiyah,

וְכֵן מִהַנִּשְׁמָה הַכְּלָלִית שֶׁבָּהּ וּלְמַעְלָה.

and from its macro-level of *neshama* and above,

הַגָּם שֶׁהֵם אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוּר, הִנֵּה הֵם עוֹמְדִים בְּבַחֲיָ צוּרָה פְּנִימִית

even though they are completely Godliness, they nevertheless have the status of an internal *tzurah* a defined configuration of spiritual powers etc. –

שֶׁהוּא נִשְׁמָה לְנִשְׁמָה לְכָל הַתּוֹאֲרֵי דְּתִכּוּנַת קוֹמַת אָדָם דְּעֲשִׂיָּה

as the *neshama* of the *neshama* for all the parameters of the stature of Adam of Asiyah

אֲשֶׁר הֵם מִהַחֲזִיקָה הַפְּרָטִית דְּהָרוּחַ וְנֶפֶשׁ שֶׁבָּהּ וּלְמַטָּה.

and this *neshama* of *neshama* is from the micro-level *chaya* of its macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* and below.

In other words, in the persona of Adam of Asiyah, the macro level *ruach* and *nefesh* are not Godliness from the micro-level of *chaya* and below.

וּבְעוֹלָם הַיְצִירָה אֲשֶׁר הִחְיָה וְהִיחִידָה דְהָרוּחַ וְנַפְשׁ שָׁבוּ,

In the World of Yetzirah, where the micro-level *chaya* and *yechida* of its macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh*,

וְכֵן מִהַנְשָׁמָה הַכְּלָלִית שָׁבוּ וּלְמַעְלָה,

and even its macro-level *neshama* and above,

הִנֵּה הֵגֶם שֶׁהֵם אֱלֹהוּת גָּמוּר, עַכ"ל הִנֵּה הֵם עוֹמְדִים בְּבַחֲיוֹ צוּרָה פְּנִימִית

even though they are completely Godliness, nevertheless, they are in a state of an internal *tzurah* –

שֶׁהוּא נִשְׁמָה לְנִשְׁמָה לְכָל הַתּוֹאֲרֵי דִתְכוּנַת קוֹמַת אָדָם בְּהִיצִירָה

which is the *neshama* of the *neshama* for all the parameters of the stature of Adam of Yetzirah,

אֲשֶׁר הֵם מִהַנְשָׁמָה הַפְּרָטִית דְהָרוּחַ וְנַפְשׁ שָׁבוּ וּלְמַטָּה.

that are from the micro-level *neshama* of its macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* and below.

In the World of Yetzirah, the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* are not Godliness from the micro-level of *neshama* and below.

וּבְעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה אֲשֶׁר מִהַנְשָׁמָה הַפְּרָטִית וְהַכְּלָלִית שָׁבָה וּלְמַעְלָה הוּא כֻּלּוֹ אֱלֹהוּת גָּמוּר.

In the World of Beriah, from the micro-level and macro-level *neshama* and above is all completely Godliness,

עכ"ז הנה הם עומדים בבחי' צורה ונשמה פנימית

nevertheless, they are in a state of internal *tzurah* and *neshama*

לכל התוארי דתכונת קומת אדם דהבריאה

for all the parameters of the stature of Adam of Beriah;

אשר הם מהרוח הפרטי דרוח ונפש שבה ולמטה:

i.e. from micro-level *ruach* of its macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* and below.

In the World of Beriah, the macro-level *ruach* and *nefesh* are not Godliness from the micro-level of *ruach* and below.

אמנם ראוי לנו לדעת מאד, כי עכ"ז הנה יש חלוק גדול

**However, it is proper for us to know that there is still a big distinction **

בין כל אותן הצורות אשר הם מהבי"ע עצמן, והם אינם אלהות,

between all those *tzurot* (configurations, plural of *tzurah*) that are from BiY"A themselves, and are not Godliness,

לכל אותן הבחי' הנזכרים שהם אלהות.

and all those aspects mentioned that *are* Godliness.

הגם שהם מתלבשים ועומדים בהם בבחי' צורה פנימית להם

This is so **even though** the latter Godly aspects **are clothed in an inner state within them** in the aspects that are not Godliness **as their internal *tzurah*.**

כי כל אותן הצורות אשר הם אינם אלהות והם מהמציאות דהעולמות עצמן.

Because all those *tzurot* that are not Godliness, but are part of the reality of the worlds themselves,

הנה כל התכונות והאיכות והכחות דקומת אדם שבהם

all of the characteristics and the qualities and faculties of the stature of Adam in them

הנה הם עצמיים בהם והם מחיבים עליהם, כי כל זה הוא עקר מציאותם.

are intrinsic to them i.e. they are essential to who they are, **and they are 'compelled' by them, since all of them** – their characteristics and the qualities and faculties – **are their primary existence.**

'Compelled by them' in this context means that these characteristics etc. form the intrinsic parameters and classifications of their existence.

שכל צורתם ותוארם ותמונתם הוא עצמית בהם,

For their entire *tzurah* and their description and image are intrinsic to them,

ורק זהו מציאותם גופה לא זולת.

and are their very existence, to the exclusion of any others – other qualities and characteristics do not define their existence.

משא"כ כל אותן הבחי' המתלבשים בהם מאלהות.

But this is not so regarding all those Godly aspects that become clothed within them

Note that the following parenthetical statement will continue for several lines:

הנה הגם שהם נתצמצמו ג"כ ומתלבשים ועומדים בבחי' צורה פנימית

- **for even though they also become constricted, and become clothed within them as an inner *tzurah*,**

ופְּנִימִית לְפְּנִימִית לְכָל אוֹתוֹן הַתְּכוּנוֹת וְהַתּוֹאֲרִים אֲשֶׁר בְּהַצּוּרוֹת דְּהַבִּי"ע עֶצְמוֹ.

and as the innermost aspect of all those characteristics and parameters of the *tzurot* of AbiY" A,

וְהֵרִי מִתּוֹאֲרִים הֵם מֵעַתָּה ג"כ בְּכָל אוֹתוֹן הַתּוֹאֲרִים כָּלָם,

and they too are characterized from this point on by all those parameters,

וְלֹא עוֹד אֵלָּא שֶׁכָּל שֶׁהוּא יוֹתֵר פְּנִימִי הֵנָּה הוּא יוֹתֵר עֲקָרִי

(and furthermore, the more internal it is the more fundamental it is,

וְהוּא הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ לְכָל הָעֲנִינִים כָּלָם אֲשֶׁר נִבְחַן וְנִעֲשָׂה בְּהַחֲצוֹנִית

so that it serves as the root-cause for all of those aspects that are identified and produced externally

וּבְהַחֲצוֹנִית דְּחִיצוֹנִית אֲשֶׁר הוּא מִתְלַבֵּשׁ בָּהֶם,

including the outermost aspects in which it becomes cloaked) –

שֶׁכָּל הָעֲנִינִים שֶׁבָּהֶם כָּלָם הֵם מִסְתַּעֲפִים וְנִמְצָאִים וְנִעֲשִׂים רַק מִמֶּנּוּ.

all of these external aspects branch out of and emerge from and are produced by it exclusively by the inner *tzurah*. This is the end of the parenthetical statement.

עכ"ז הֵנָּה כָּל אוֹתוֹן הָעֲנִינִים כָּלָם אֵינָם ח"ו תּוֹאֲרִים עֶצְמִיִּים בָּהֶם כָּלָל,

Nevertheless, of all those matters, none of them are parameters integral to them, God forbid.

אֵלָּא שֶׁהֵם רַק ע"ד הַמָּשָׁל שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּרַע"מ פ' בָּא מ"ב ב' ב'

Instead, they are like the analogy given in *Raya Mehemna*, Bo
p. 42b

מהמים הנכנסים בהכלי שנעשה בהמים צורת הכלי

of water poured into a container, where the water takes on the
shape of the container

אם עגל או משלש או מרבע וצורת כל גבוליה.

- whether round or triangular or square – according to the
shape of its the container's boundaries.

ובהכלי הנה הם צורת עצמיים

As regards the container, the *tzurah* is an integral aspect
thereof;

אבל בהמים הרי אינם עצמיים כלל

however, as regards the water in the container, the *tzurah* is not
an integral aspect of it at all.

אלא שנעשה הצורה בהמים ע"י הכלי

Rather the water temporarily acquires that *tzurah* from the
container

כי נתצמצמו המים בגבולי הכלי

because the water becomes confined within the boundaries of
the container

ונצטר בהם ע"י הכלי כל צורת הגבולים שבה.

and is shaped by them, as long as it is in the container whose
entire shape is defined by those boundaries.

The water itself has no inherent shape or *tzurah*, it merely
temporarily acquires the shape imposed on it by the vessel as long
as it remains contained therein.

וְכֵן הוּא עַד"ז בְּעִנְיָנָנוּ, כִּי כָל אוֹתָן הָאוֹרוֹת פְּנִימִיּוֹת שֶׁהֵם אֱלֵהוּת

Similarly with our concept: all those intrinsic Godly illuminations i.e. those manifested as immanent, innate *tzurot*,

בְּאֶשֶׁר שֶׁמֵתפְשָׁטִים לִהְיוֹת שָׂרֵשׁ לִהְיוֹת"י דֵּהבִי"ע

when they diffuse throughout to become the root-cause of the *nrnch* "y of BiY" A

לְכָל הַכּחוֹת וְהַתְּכוּנוֹת מֵהוּת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם שֶׁרָצָה בָּהֶם,

as the soul-roots **for all the powers and characteristics** defining the persona of the *partzuf* of man the way He wanted them to be,

הִנֵּה נִקְרָא אוֹתוֹ הַשָּׂרֵשׁ אַחֵר שֶׁרָצָה לְהַמְצִיא אֶת כָּל הַתְּכוּנוֹת דְּמֵהוּת אָדָם וּלְהַתְּפֹשֵׁט בְּהִיוּתָם,

that root-cause is named – since He wished to produce all of the characteristics delineating the *partzuf* of man, and extend into their existence –

הִנֵּה נִקְרָא הוּא בְּכָל הַתּוֹאֲרִים הַלְלוּ ג"כ ע"י הַתְּלַבְּשׁוּ בָּהֶם,

and is designated by all those parameters, by virtue of being clothed within them,

In other words, the soul-root clothed within those human characteristics etc. is given the same name that the sum of those human characteristics is known by – Adam

וְע"ד הַמִּים שֶׁנִּצְטָרְרוּ בְּכָל גְּבוּלֵי הַכְּלִי ע"י הַכְּלִי וְכַנֶּזֶר.

similar to the way all the contours of the container are ascribed to the water in it, as mentioned.

אָבֵל אֵין כָּל הַתּוֹאֲרִים הַלְלוּ עֲצָמִים בּוֹ ח"ו [חֵס וְשָׁלוֹם]

However, just like the water in a container, none of these contours are part of its the water's essence, heaven forbid,

כי עצמותם ממש הוא רק בהבי"ע גופה.

since they are fundamentally merely characteristics of BiY" A itself, and not of their root-cause in Atzilut.

אֵלָא ע"י שְׁהִתְפָּשֵׁט אֹרֶךְ רְצוֹנוֹ בְּמִצִּיאוֹתָם נִקְרָא הוּא ג' כ' בָּהֶם
כָּלָם.

But because His will spreads though their existence, it the light of His will is also referred to by all those terms

ע"י שְׁנִתְגַּלָּה אֹרֶךְ רְצוֹנוֹ לְהִיּוֹת שֶׁרֶשׁ לְכָל זֶה.

by virtue of the light of His will being revealed as their root-cause.

וְהוּא ע"ד שְׁכָתוֹב (הוֹשֵׁעַ יב, יא) "וַיִּבְדֵּד הַנְּבִיאִים אֲדָמָה",

This is similar to what is written in the verse, "Through the Prophets I am depicted in metaphors" (*Hosea 12:11*)

שְׁנִתְגַּלָּה לְכָל אֶחָד כְּפִי כָחוֹ.

– for He is revealed to each Prophet according to his individual aptitudes.

וכמ"ש בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא רַבְתִּי פִּיֶּסְקָא כ"א: "בְּדַמּוּיּוֹת הַרְבֵּה נִדְמָה לָהֶם,

As it states in *Pesikta Rabbati* (21): "He appeared to them to the Prophets in many guises –

לְזֶה עוֹמֵד לְזֶה יוֹשֵׁב, לְזֶה בְּחוּר לְזֶה זָקֵן כו' עֵין שָׁם וְכֵן בְּמַכִּילְתָּא
בְּשִׁלַּח, יִתְרוֹ.

to this one He was standing, and to another, sitting. To this one He appeared as a young man, to another as an elder, and so on. A similar teaching is found in *Mechilta, parshat Beshalach* and *parshat Yitro*.

כֵּן נִתְגַּלָּה עַד"ז לְצֶרֶךְ כָּלֵל הָעוֹלָמוֹת דְּבִי"ע

Similarly, He becomes revealed according to the needs of the Worlds of BiY"A in general,

להיות שרש לכל התוארים הללו אשר המציא את העולמות עליהם.

thus becoming the root-cause of all those representations such as Creator, Former, Maker etc. by way of which He produces the worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah respectively.

ונקרא הוא ג"כ באותן התוארים על שם שהוא שרשם.

And He too is referred to by way of those same designations because He is their root-cause.

ועין בדברינו בעקודים פ"ג אות ה' ובספר הדע"ה ח"א דרוש ה' סימן ז' בארוכה בזה.

****See in our exposition *Akudim* chapter 3, *siman* 5, and in *Sefer Ha'De'ah* part 1, *Drush* 5, *siman* 5 and *siman* 7 at length in this regard. ****

ועל כל פנים הוא כי בו אינם עצמיים ח"ו.

In any event, these representations and designation are not of His essence, heaven forbid.

אלא שנתגלה בהם להיות שרש להבי"ע.

They apply only because He is revealed in them as the root-cause of BiY"A

וגם לא נקרא בו אלא ע"י הבי"ע

and they only refer to Him via BiY"A

אחר שמתפשט ומתלבש בפנימית פנימיותם להמציאם בדרך זה.

after He permeates them and becomes clothed in their innermost aspect in order to produce them thereby.

ורצונו לומר בכל זה כי הרי בהמשל מהמים שבכלי שאמרנו,

The intention here is that the analogy we mentioned of water in a container –

הנה המים כאשר נכנסים בהכלי ונעשה גם בהם כל צורת גבולי הכלי וכנזכר

where the water enters the container and is shaped by the boundaries of the container –

הנה הגם שכל אותה הצורה אינה עצמית בהם אבל על כל פנים הוא כי היא מחיבת בהם.

albeit that the entire shape of the water imposed on it by the container is not of its essence, nevertheless, the water is in fact compelled into that shape by those boundaries,

שגבולי הכלי מתגבר על תכונת הנוזל שבמים ומצמצם אותם בגבוליה נגד טבעם.

so that the boundaries of the container override the fluidity of the water and constrict it to the container's boundaries, contrary to their nature.

משא"כ בעניננו הנה כל התוארים שנעשה לאור אלוה

This is not so as regards this matter – the Godly light bounded by the vessels of the *sefirot* – all of the metaphoric descriptive terms and parameters that are attributed to the Godly light,

ע"י שמתפשט בהתהוות המהות אדם דהבי"ע

by virtue of that light extending into the creation of the 'persona' of Adam of BiY" A,

ונעשה נשמה וצורה פנימית להם

where it becomes their soul and inner form,

וְנִתְצַמְצַם אוֹתוֹ הָאוֹר ג"כ לְכָל הַתּוֹאֲרִים הַלְלוּ אֲשֶׁר הִמְצִיא אוֹתָם
בְּהִבִּי"ע.

**and that same light is also constrained into all of those
descriptive terms or titles which it produced in BiY"A,**

הִנֵּה כָּל הַצְמָצוּם הַזֶּה הִנְעָשָׂה בּוֹ הוּא אֵינָה מְחִיבֶת בּוֹ ח"ו.

**all of those constraints imposed on it on that light do not compel
Him in any way, heaven forbid.**

אֶלָּא שֶׁהוּא רַק רְצוֹנִית.

Instead, those constraints **are discretionary** and are by choice.

כִּי הִרִי אֶדְרֵבָּה הוּא שְׁאוֹתוֹ הָאוֹר הוּא מַעֲמִיד אֶת כָּל הַתּוֹאֲרִי
דְּמֵהוֹת אָדָם שְׁבֵהִי"ע

**On the contrary, it is the light itself that establishes all of the
parameters of the metaphor delineating the 'persona' of Adam
in the Worlds of BiY"A.**

It is not the parameters and characteristics of the *partzuf* that define the contours of the light; it is the Godly light that ultimately defines the parameters and characteristics of the *partzuf*.

וּמוֹצִיא וּמְהוֹה אוֹתָם בְּרְצוֹנוֹ וּמִתְצַמְצָם בְּרְצוֹנוֹ לְהִמְצִיאָם בְּכָל
הַתּוֹאֲרִים הָאֵלֶּה

It is the Godly light that **produces and creates them according to
His will, and by His will the light is constricted into all these
descriptive metaphors**

וְלִהְיוֹת שֶׁרֶשׁ לָהֶם בְּכָל עֵת קִיּוּמָם וְהוּא רַק רְצוֹנִית בּוֹ "וּבְרְצוֹתוֹ
חוֹגֵג וּבְרְצוֹתוֹ מְמוֹגֵג".

**to become their root-cause throughout their being, and this is
discretionary** i.e. not compelled, as the prayer-book¹ states, "like
molten glass in the hands of the glass-blower – **he shapes it as he
wishes and he melts it as he wishes...**

Just like a glass-blower decides the shape of the glass vessel he makes, so too, God designs the *partzufim* in whatever way He chooses.

וְהָיָה נִמְצָא כִּי הִבְחִינָה כָּל אוֹתוֹן הַתּוֹאֲרִים אֲשֶׁר בְּאוֹר אֱלֹהִים
שֶׁבְּפְנֵימִיּוֹתָם הוּא לֹא בִּפְעֹל,

So it turns out that discerning all those metaphoric descriptions that are in the Godly light, that in their inner core they are not actually manifest,

שֶׁהוּא בּוֹ עֲצָמוֹ ח"ו,

in other words, they are not **in Him, heaven forbid,**

אֲלָא רַק בִּפְעֻלָּה שֶׁהוּא לִפְעֹל וְלַעֲשׂוֹת אוֹתוֹן הַתּוֹאֲרִים הָעֲצָמִיִּים
בְּמַצִּיאוֹת הַבִּי"ע

rather, they are manifested through an activity – when He brings about and creates those metaphoric descriptions that are an essential aspect of the existence of BiY" A.

שֶׁהֵם כָּלֵם בְּמַהוּת אָדָם כִּנ"ל וְכַנּוּדָע.

All of them are characteristics delineating the fundamental persona of Adam, as mentioned, and as is known.

The Baal HaLeshem here is expounding the Midrash² which declares that all the Names and appellations ascribed to Hashem are only names of His *activities*, but not of Himself – "According to My deeds am I called," as he will state explicitly later in this chapter.

אֲבָל הָאוֹר הַפְּנִימִי הַמוֹצִיא אוֹתָם בְּכָל זֶה, הֵנָּה אֵין בְּעֲצָמוֹתוֹ גּוֹפָה
שׁוּם הִבְחָנָה מֵהֶם.

Whereas the inner Divine light that produces them in their entirety, has no trace of them within Himself.

וְהוּא ע"ד כָּל מַצִּיר אֲמֵן שֶׁמַּצִּיר אֵיזָה צוּרָה

This can be compared to an expert artist who paints a picture on a canvas –

הנה לא נבחן אותה הצורה במחשבת האמן

surely that picture itself cannot be identified in the artist's mind;

אלא רק מה שנוגע לאותה הפעלה לבד, והוא רק מה שנמשך ממנו להפעלה.

only that which is relevant to that particular activity, and which is drawn from it from the artist's imagination into that activity.

שהרי כל ציור הפעלה אשר נעשית במחשבתו הרי הוא רק לצורך הפעלה,

Accordingly, the entire act of forming the picture in his mind is only for the sake of the activity of painting that image on the canvas

ואינו נוגע באמת לו לעצמו כלל.

but it does not truly impact him the artist at all.

והוא מה שנאמר (מלאכי ג') "כי אני ה' לא שניתי".

This is the meaning of the verse that states (*Malachi 3:6*) "For I, God, have not changed."

כי הרי כל הצמצום הזה הנעשה באורו

For the entire *tzimtzum* the contraction of the *Ohr Ein Sof* which is implemented in His light

הנה הוא רק מה שנמשך ממנו לצורת העולמות,

is drawn from Him only for the purpose of structuring the Worlds.

אבל בו בעצמו זולת פעלתו הנה לא נעשה בו שום שנוי כלל:

But in Himself, other than in His actions, there is no change at all.

והנה כל התוארים שאמרנו שנעשה באותו אור אלוה, בבחינת רצונית כנזכר,

Thus all of the descriptive metaphorical terms we mentioned that are initiated in that Godly light are by virtue of His will, as noted,

ע"י שרצה להיות שרש לכל התוארים העצמיים והעקריים שבהבי"ע.

– due to His desire that there be a root-cause above³ for all those descriptive terms and metaphors that are essential and primary in BiY"A –

הנה הם עשרה שמות הקדושים המבארים בזוה"ק פ' ויקרא י' וי"א

and those are the ten Holy Names explained in the Holy Zohar, Vayikra p. 10, 11

וכן בתקונים תקון ע' קמ"א סע"ב וקמ"ב רע"ב, והובא בבאור היטיב בדברי הרב בסו"ך שער דרושי אבי"ע והם:

and in the *Tikunim* (the *Tikunei Zohar*), *Tikun 70* at the bottom of p. 141b and the top of p. 142b

אֵהִיָּה. יֵה. הִנֵּה בְּנִקּוּד אֱלֹהִים. אֵל. אֱלֹהִים. הִנֵּה. הִנֵּה צְבָאוֹת. אֱלֹהִים צְבָאוֹת. אֵל חַי שְׂדֵי. אֲדֹנָי.

These ten Names are: *Ehye" h; Ya" h; Havaye vocalized as E-lohim; E-l; E-lohim; Havaye; Havaye Tzva'ot; E-lohim Tzva'ot; E-l Chai Sha-dai; Adon-ai.*

כי אלו העשרה שמות הם אורו וגלוייו ית"ש אשר נתגלה בהם

For these ten Names are the lights and revelations the *sefirot* in which He becomes revealed, may He be blessed,

להיות שרש לתוצאות כל המהות אדם שבהעולמות בי"ע.

and they become the root-cause of the developments of the entire persona of Adam in the Worlds of BiY"A:

כי הג' ראשונות, שהם אהיה יה הויה בנקוד אלהים,

For the first three Names, *Ehye "h; Ya "h; Havaye* vocalized as *E-lohim*,

הם הגלוי והשרש להקרקפתא והגלגלתא כלו בכללות הג' מחין שבו.

are the revelation and root of the entire head and skull, including the three aspects of the brain therein.

Specifically, *Ehye "h* corresponds to *keter*; *Ya "h* corresponds to *chochmah*; *Havaye* vocalized as *E-lohim* corresponds to *binah*.

הב' שמות אל אלהים הם הגלוי והשרש להב' ידים ימין ושמאל.

And the two Names *E-l* and *E-lohim* are the revelation and the root of the two arms, right and left.

The right arm (*chesed*) corresponds to *E-l*, and the left (*gevurah*) to *E-lohim*

שם הויה ב"ה כשהוא בלי נקדה הוא הגלוי והשרש לכללות הגוף,

The Name *Havaye*, blessed is He, without vowel points, is the revelation and root of the torso in general corresponding to *tiferet*

אשר עד הטבור אשר שם הלב והריאה שהחיים תלוי בהם.

from the neck down where the heart and lungs are situated (upon them life depends) – until the navel.

הַיְהִיָּה צְבָאוֹת אֱלֹהִים צְבָאוֹת הֵם הַגְּלוֹי וְהַשְׁרֵשׁ לְהַתְרִין כּוֹלֵן תְּרִין
בִּיעוֹן תְּרִין יִרְכִּין.

Havaye Tzva'ot and E-lohim Tzva'ot are revelation and root of the two kidneys, the two testicles and the two thighs
corresponding to *netzach* and *hod*.

אֵל חַי שְׁדֵי הוּא כָּלֹ שֵׁם אֶחָד, וְהוּא הַגְּלוֹי וְהַשְׁרֵשׁ לְאוֹת בְּרִית
קֹדֶשׁ.

E-l Chai Sha-dai is all one Name, and it is the revelation and root of the organ that bears the sign of the holy covenant,
corresponding to *yesod*.

אֲדֹנֵי הוּא הַגְּלוֹי וְהַשְׁרֵשׁ לְכָל פְּרָצוֹף הַנִּקְבָּא אֲשֶׁר הִיא שְׁלִימוֹ
דְּאָדָם.

Adon-ai is the revelation and root of the entire partzuf of nukvah malchut, the female element, which is the completion of the stature of Adam and corresponds to malchut,

כִּי עַל יְדֵהָ נִעְשֶׂה אָדָם שְׁלֵם וְכַמּ"ש "זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה בְּרָאָם... וַיִּקְרָא אֶת
שְׁמָם אָדָם".

because it is through her *nukvah* or *malchut*, that Adam becomes complete, as the verse (*Genesis* 5:2) **states, "Male and female He created them... and He called their name Adam." **

וְהָרִי הֵווּ אֵלֹהֵי הָעֶשְׂרָה שְׁמוֹת הַגְּלוֹיִם שֶׁבְּאוֹר אֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה
בָּהֶם

Thus these ten Names are revelations of the Godly light which is revealed in them

לְהַעֲשׂוֹת שְׁרֵשׁ לְכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּקוּמֵת אָדָם דְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע.

so that they become the root of the entire being of the stature of Adam in the Worlds of Biy"A.

וְהוּא מָה שֶׁאָמַר הוּא ית"ש לְמִשְׁה רַבְּנֵנוּ ע"ה (בשמו"ר פ"ג סימן ו')

****This is as the Holy One, blessed is He, said to Moses our Master, peace be upon him (*Midrash Rabba, Exodus 3:6*) ****

"שְׁמִי אֵתָּה מְבַקֵּשׁ לֵידַע? לִפִּי מַעֲשֵׂי אֲנִי נִקְרָא".

"My Name you wish to know? According to My deeds I am called."

כִּי כָּל גְּלוּיָיו וְשִׁמוֹתָיו הוּא רַק לַפְעֻלּוֹתָיו לְבַד,

This is because all of His revelations and Names refer only to His actions,

וְכָל מָה שֶׁאֲנִי אֹמְרִים בּוֹ שֶׁנִּתְצַמְצַם הֵנָּה הוּא רַק בְּמָה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה לַפְעֻלָּתוֹ.

and everything that we say about Him that expresses limitation (i.e. whatever is constricted by the *Tzimtzum*) refers only to that which becomes revealed as an action of His.

וּבִאוֹתָיו הַגְּלוּיִּי הַנִּמְשָׁךְ מֵאֲמִתּוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה לַפְעֻלּוֹתָיו הֵנָּה בְּזָה לְבַד נִתְצַמְצַם,

It is in that revelation that is drawn down from His true recondite i.e. incomprehensible Self into His actions – it is only in this that He is constrained, but not in His essence,

וְהוּא גְּלוּיָיו וְהוּא שְׁמוֹ. אֲבָל זֹלַת גְּלוּיָיו לַפְעֻלָּתוֹ הִרִי לֹא נִתְצַמְצַם כָּלֵל

and that revelation from Him is His Name. But besides His being revealed in His actions, He is not constrained by the *tzimtzum* at all;

וְלֹא נִתְפָּס בְּשֵׁם כָּלֵל, כִּי אֵין גְּבוּל אֵלָיו וְאֵין גְּלוּיִי אֵלָיו:

He is not captured within a Name at all, for He is without limitations and there is nothing that can reveal Him.

אֲמָנָם כָּל אוֹתָן הַגְּלוּיִּים אֲשֶׁר לַפְעֻלּוֹתָיו,

However, all those revelations via His actions,

הִנֵּה הוּא מֵה שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה הוּא עֲצָמוֹ בָּהֶם אַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְצַמֵּץ,

**– are that He Himself is revealed in them even after the
tzimtzum –**

וְהֵם הַשְּׁמוֹת שֶׁל אֲמִתּוֹתָיו עֲצָמוֹ לֹא זוּלַת ח"ו.

**such that those revelations are His true Names, not anything
else, heaven forbid.**

אֲלֹא שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה בְּכָל אוֹתוֹ הַשְּׁמוֹת כֻּלּוֹ רַק אַחֵר שֶׁנִּתְצַמֵּץ,

**However, He is revealed in all of those Names only after the
tzimtzum;**

אֲבָל הֵם עַל אֲמִתּוֹתָיו עֲצָמוֹ.

but they still refer to His true being.

וְכִשְׁאֲנוּ קוֹרְאִים אוֹתוֹ בְּשֵׁמוֹ וְכֵן כִּשְׁאֲנוּ עוֹבְדִים לְשֵׁמוֹ,

**So that when we call out to Him by Name, and when we toil in
our spiritual service **for His sake, ****

כִּי כָל הָעֲבוֹדָה הוּא רַק לְשֵׁמוֹ כִּמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר לְקִמּוֹ, הִנֵּה עוֹמֵד
הַקְּרִיָּאָה וְהָעֲבוֹדָה אֵלָיו עֲצָמוֹ,

**all that toil is only for His sake, as we will explain below, that
calling out and that service is to Him Himself –**

שֶׁהוּא לְכָל אֲמִתּוֹת עֲצָמוֹתוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה אֵלָיו גּוֹפָה.

it is entirely to His true concealed essence itself.

כִּי הוּא עֲצָמוֹ נִתְגַּלָּה ע"י הַצְמָצוּם בְּהֵשֵׁם הַיְּהִיָּה ב"ה וּבְכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת
וְכִינּוּיִם הַמְסִתְעִפִּים מִמֶּנּוּ.

**For He Himself is revealed when He constricts Himself into His
Name Havaye, may He be blessed.**

וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ הָאָדָם הַיּוֹשֵׁב בְּבֵית וּמִשְׁתַּמֵּשׁ בְּאוֹר הַחֲלוֹן שֶׁהוּא ד' על ד',

This may be compared to a person who sits in his house and uses the light coming through a window measuring four cubits square,

וְהָרִי נִתְצַמָּצֵם ג"כ הָאוֹר בְּהַחֲלוֹן לְפִי צוּרֵת הַחֲלוֹן.

– the light has become constricted to the shape of the window.

הָרִי אוֹתוֹ אוֹר הַחֲלוֹן שֶׁמִּשְׁתַּמֵּשׁ בּוֹ הֵנָּה הוּא אוֹתוֹ הָאוֹר עֲצָמוֹ
אֲשֶׁר מִחוּץ לַחֲלוֹן

But the light that he uses as it filters through the window is the very same light that is outside the window,

וּמִמָּלָא אֶת כָּל חֲלַל הָעוֹלָם כֻּלּוֹ, כִּי הָרִי הוּא נִמְשָׁךְ בְּאֶחָד עִם
הָאוֹר שֶׁהוּא בְּלֹא צִמְצוּם כָּלֵל.

that fills the entire open space of the world; for the light coming through the window is drawn down together with the light that is not constricted at all by the window.

וְהוּא מָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (יִתְרוֹ פ"ו א') "הוּא וְשְׁמִיהָ חֵד הוּא":

This is as our Sages **stated (Zohar II, Yitro 86a) "He and His Name are one.**

וְהֵנָּה נִתְבָּאֵר לָנוּ מִכָּל דִּבְרֵינוּ כֵּאֵן, שֶׁכָּל הַכֹּחַ פְּנִימִי וּפְנִימִית
לְפְנִימִי

Thus, from all of our discussion here, we have clarified that every immanent faculty or power i.e. when a Godly light is contained in a vessel, and every intrinsic aspect of that immanent faculty

דְּכָל הַתּוֹאֲרֵי צוּרוֹת הַבֵּי"ע אֲשֶׁר יִשָּׁנָם בְּאוֹר אֱלֹהוּתוֹ ית"ש,

across the entire spectrum of descriptive terms for the various *tzurot* of BiY"A as they are their root-cause in the blessed Godly light,

ע"י שְׁנִתְגַּלְהָ לְהִיּוֹת שֶׁרֶשׁ לָהֶם וּמִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּמִצִּיאוֹתָם

by becoming revealed as the root-cause of those *tzurot* as they spread into them and become clothed within their existence

הִנֵּה הֵם אֵינָם עֲצָמִים בּוֹ ח"ו.

they these descriptive terms, and even these faculties or powers are nevertheless **not part of His essence, heaven forbid.**

אֲלֹא שֶׁהֵם רַק רְצוּנוֹיִית בּוֹ אַחֵר שֶׁרָצָה לְהִתְצַמֵּצֵם לְהִיּוֹת שֶׁרֶשׁ לָזֶה.

Instead they are only discretionary or voluntary in Him – after He decided to impose that constriction in order to become the root-cause thereof.

וְגַם גְּלוּיִים הוּא רַק ע"י הַבִּי"ע. וְכֵן לְמִשְׁשׁ הַמִּים שֶׁבְּכָלִי.

Furthermore, these illuminations are only via BiY"A, as mentioned above regarding the analogy of water in a container.

וְכִבֵּר בְּאֶרְנוֹ לְעֵיל פָּרַק א' אֵיךְ שֶׁבְּאַמַּת הִנֵּה רְחוּק וּמִשׁוּלָּל הוּא

Now we already explained above in chapter 1 to what extent it is very far from and indeed precluded from us

מִלְתַּפּוֹס אֵיזָה צִיּוֹר וְתֹאֵר וְתִמְוִנָה גַם בְּהַאֲרוֹת הַיּוֹתֵר פְּנִימִים
אֲשֶׁר גַּם מִהַבִּי"ע עֲצָמוֹ,

to grasp some form or description or image, even of the most immanent illuminations that are from BiY"A itself,

וּמִכַּש"כ [וּמִכָּל שְׁכֵן] בְּהַאֲוֹר אֵלּוּה שֶׁהוּא רַק הַשֶּׁרֶשׁ הַשֶּׁרָשִׁים לָהֶם.

and how much more so in the Godly light which is only the root-cause of their root.

וגם כל מה שאמרנו שנעשה אורו ית"ש צורה פנימית להם,

In addition, everything that we said about His light becoming their inner *tzurah*,

הנה כבר אמרנו לעיל שער א' וכן יתבאר עוד לקמן בדברינו,

we already stated above in *sha'ar* 1, and it will be explained more further on,

כי הוא רק בתמצית אורו והארתו לבד מהאור של מעלה.

that this is only a distillation and a radiance of the light from above.

אבל עקר אור גלוי שהם האורות דכל השמות הקדושים עצמן.

But the primary light of His revelations, which are the lights vested in all of the Holy Names themselves

הנה הם רק באצילות לבד, וכמו שיסדו "ושכינת עזו בגבהי מרומים".

these are all in Atzilut alone, as they the *Anshei Knesset HaGedola* established in the *Aleinu* prayer – "and the abode of His majesty is in the loftiest heights."

אלא שבתמצית אורו ברא ויצר ועשה את כל העולמות דבי"ע.

Nevertheless, with a distillation of His light He created, formed and made all the Worlds of BiY" A.

Created corresponds to the World of Beriah, formed corresponds to the World of Yetzirah, and made corresponds to the World of Asiya.

והוא שרש להם בכל מציאותם וקיומם ובכל הנעשה בהם תמיד

which is the root-cause of their entire existence and their continuity, and of everything that occurs with them at all times.

שְׁהוּא הַנִּשְׁמָה לַנִּשְׁמָה לְכָלָם, אֲבָל אוֹרוֹ עֲצֻמוֹ הוּא נֶעְלָם בְּתַכְלִית
הַהֶעָלָם:

**For this is the soul of all their souls. But His own light is
concealed absolutely.**

Footnotes

1. *Machzor* for Yom Kippur, *piyut* כִּי הִנֵּה בְּחֹמֶר [↩](#)

2. See *Shemot Rabba* 3:6 [↩](#)

3. In *Atzilut*. Cf. Makover note 49. [↩](#)

Chapter 3 — The first three levels of unfolding from above to below (hitpashtut) of Divine Light.

Sha'ar 4, Chapter 3

Divinity is far away from us.

וְהִנֵּה נִדְבָר בְּעֵינֵינוּ הַזֶּה בְּעֵמֶק יוֹתֵר קֶצֶת

Let's now discuss this matter the revelation of His light in a little greater depth

וְנִתְחִיל וְנֹאמַר כִּי כָּל מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ מִבְּחִינַת אֹר אֱלֹהוֹתוֹ ית"ש

We'll begin by saying that everything we said about the aspect of His Godly light (may He be blessed)

אֲשֶׁר נִתְפָּשֵׁט וְנִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּהַעֲלָמוֹת בִּי"ע וְנִנְעָשָׂה צוּרָה לְהַצּוּרָה
דְּבִי"ע

that spreads out and becomes clothed in the Worlds of BiY"A, becoming the *tzurah* of the *tzurah* of BiY"A

וְרָצוֹנוּ לומר הַנְּשָׁמָה לְנִשְׁמָה לַהֲבִי"ע.

- **in other words**, as explained in the previous chapter, **the *neshama* of the *neshama* of BiY"A** –

הִנֵּה אוֹתוֹ בְּחִי אֱלֹהוֹת הַמִּתְלַבֵּשׁ שָׁם הוּא בְּאֶמֶת רָחוֹק

that aspect of Godliness clothed therein in the Worlds of BiY"A is in truth very distant

מִמַּדְרַגַּת אֶמֶתוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה הָעֲצֻמוֹתִית בּוֹ הַרְבֵּה מְאֹד.

from His hidden essential true Being – very, very distant!

כִּי כָּל מֵלֶת וְתֹאֵר אֱלֹהוֹת אֲשֶׁר הוּא ית"ש נִקְרָא בּוֹ,

Because every word and descriptive term for Godliness by which He is called

הנה הוא כביכול רק בבחי' מדרגה החמישית ממדרגות הכלליים

is, so to speak, only the fifth of the general levels

אשר מאחר אמתתו הנעלמה ולמטה.

that ensue from His true concealed being on and down.

The Baal HaLeshem will explain shortly that there are five levels of revelation. The only one we have any access to is the fifth and lowest one.¹

והגם שכל בחי' אלהות ית"ש הנה הוא מעצם האחדות לעולם,

Now even though every aspect of His Godliness is always part of His essential oneness.

אך הוא ע"ד שאנו רואין חלקת המדרגות בקדשת אורו ית"ש

nevertheless, this can be compared to the division we see of His holy light into five levels of holiness

המתפשט ונמשך בעוה"ז בכל דבר שבקדשה.

that spread out and are drawn down into this world in every holy matter.

כי הרי יש חלוק בין קדשת התורה לקדשת הנביאים וכתובים,

For example: **there is a difference between the holiness of the Torah and the holiness of the Prophets and the Writings,**

וכן בין קדשת בית המדרש לקדשה בית הכנסת וכמ"ש במגלה כ"ז ע"א.

and between the holiness of a Beit Midrash study hall and a Beit Knesset prayer hall, as is documented in Tractate *Megilah*

27a.

וְכֵן בֵּין כָּל הָעֵשֶׂר קְדוּשׁוֹת שְׁבָאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל. בְּכֵלִים פ"א.

And similarly there are differences between the ten levels of holiness in the Land of Israel, as mentioned in Mishnah **Keilim 1:6 ff.**

וְכֵן יֵשׁ חֲלוּק בֵּין קְדֻשַּׁת הַשְּׁמוֹת שְׂאִינָם נִמְחָקִים

And similarly there is a difference between the holiness of the Names that may not be erased

לְקְדֻשַּׁת שְׂאֵר כָּל הַתּוֹרָה, וְכִיוּצָא בְּזֶה הַרְבֵּה.

and the holiness of the rest of Torah, and likewise in numerous similar cases.

וּכ"ז הוּא ע"ד הַכְּתוּב (אִיּוֹב י"ט) "וּמִבֶּשֶׂרִי אֶחְזֶה אֱלֹהִים".

All of this similar to the way the verse (Job 19:26) "From my flesh I see God" is explained:**

כִּי הוּא ע"ד חֵיוֹת הָאָדָם,

– Just as with the life-force of a person,

שֶׁהִגֵּם שֶׁהִנְשָׁמָה הוּא מְמַלֵּא אוֹתוֹ בְּכָל מְלוֹאוֹ וְנִעְשֶׂה עַל יְדוֹ כָּל
הַגּוּף כְּלוּ חַי

albeit that the soul fills the entire body, by virtue of which the entire body is alive,

עַכ"ז הֵרִי יֵשׁ חֲלוּק גָּדוֹל בֵּין הַחַיּוֹת שֶׁבְּמוֹחַ וְלֵב לְהַחַיּוֹת שֶׁבְּשָׂר
אֲבָרִים.

nevertheless, there is a tremendous difference between the life-force of the brain and the heart and the life-force of the rest of the body.

The implication is that since the life of the body depends upon the brain and the heart (the *vital* organs), the life-force invested in them is superior to that animating the rest of the body. For if a limb had to be removed (God forbid) this would not cause the person's death (under normal circumstances), whereas removing a vital organ would.

וְכֵן הוּא עַד"ז בְּכָל גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה וַיֵּצֵא בָּהֶם מֵאִמְתָּתוֹ
הַנֶּעְלָמָה,

And similarly with all of God's revelations that are revealed from and emerge from His true concealed being –

הֵנָּה הִיא מְמַשִּׁיךְ גְּלוּיָיו בְּבַחֲיוֹ חֲלֻקַּת מַדְרָגוֹת רַבּוֹת אֵין חֶקֶר.

His revelations are drawn down in innumerable diverse levels.

Some of these levels are seen to be absolutely vital, i.e. the existence of the worlds depends upon them; other levels are of lesser importance and are perhaps even discretionary.

אֶךְ מַדְרָגוֹת הַכּוֹלָלִים הֵנָּה הֵם ה' מַדְרָגוֹת.

But in general there are five levels,

וְהוּא שֶׁרֶשׁ הַשְּׂרָשִׁים לְהָה' בְּחִי' נִשְׁמָה שֶׁבְּכָל עוֹלָם שֶׁהֵם נִרְנַח"י.

and He is the root-cause of all the roots of the five levels of soul in each of the Worlds, which are *nefesh, ruach, neshama, chaya and yechida* (nrnch"y).

וְאוֹר אֱלֹהוֹתוֹ ית"ש הַמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּבַחֲיוֹ נִשְׁמָה לְנִשְׁמָה
בְּהַעֲלָמוֹת בִּי"ע.

And His Godly light that spreads forth and clothes itself in the *neshama* of the *neshama* of the Worlds of BiY"A

הֵנָּה הוּא רַק הַמַּדְרָגָה הַחֲמִישִׁית.

is merely the fifth level down.

ואלו הם ה' מדרגות:

Now these are the five levels:

א' הוא אור אין סוף המזכר בכל דברי הזוה"ק והאר"ל.

1. **The *Ohr Ein Sof* the Infinite Light mentioned throughout the *Zohar* and the writings of the *Arizal*.**

והוא גלוי הראשונה מאמתתו הנעלמה

This is the first revelation from His true concealed being

אשר אין לנו ולא לשום נברא וגם לא להנאצלים כלם שום תפיסה

of which we have no conceptual grasp at all, nor does any other creation, not even those emanated beings in the World of Atzilut.****

ושום שם ומלה במה לכנותו ולדבר בו אלא רק בדרך שלילה לבד.

There is no Name or word with which He can be designated, or by which we can refer to Him, other than in a manner of repudiation – i.e. He is *not* this, and *not* that and *cannot* be described by any name, descriptive title or phrase.

היינו לשלל משם כל ענין המורה איזה חסרון לפשיטותו

That is to say, we reject or disavow from there any concept that would indicate any deficiency in His uncompounded or non-complex existence,

The idea of Divine simplicity or His uncompounded, uniform essential existence is fundamental in Jewish thought in general and in Kabbalistic thought in particular.

ולרוממות מעלת אמתתו,

Similarly, we reject or disavow any concept of deficiency in the sublime transcendence of His true being

וְכֵן לְשַׁלֵּל מִשָּׁם אֵיזָה הַשָּׂגָה וְאַפְשָׁרִית הַדְּבֹר בּוֹ.

And we also reject from there any conceptualization or possibility of a reference to Him in speech.

כִּי הוּא מְרוֹמָם וְנִעְלָה עַל כָּל דְּבֹר וּמַלָּה וְעַל כָּל מַחְשְׁבָה וְשָׂכָל.

This is because He transcends all utterances, words, and thoughts or concepts,

וּכְבָּר כָּתַב הַגָּר"א ז"ל בְּלִקְוֹטֵיו שֶׁבְּסוֹף סֵפֶד"צ [סִפְרָא דְּצִנְיֵוֹתָא] הַנִּדְפָּס בְּוִילְנָא תרמ"ב.

as the Vilna Gaon, of blessed memory, wrote in his Collected Works at the end of *Sifra d'Tzniuta*, printed in Vilna 5642 (1881/2) –

שֶׁגַם אֵין סוֹף אָסוּר לְקִרְוֹתוֹ וְאָסוּר לַחֲשֹׁב בּוֹ כָּלֵל וּכְלָל.

that it is forbidden to refer to Him even as *Ein Sof* ("the Infinite One"), and it is absolutely forbidden to contemplate Him, i.e. in His essence.

וְהִנֵּה הָיָה גְלוּיֹו הָרֵאשׁוֹן מֵאַמְתָּתוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה בְּבַחֲי' אֹר אֵין סוֹף.

Now the first revelation from His true concealed being is the aspect of *Ohr Ein Sof*, the Infinite Light.

וּבְאֻתוֹ הַגְּלוּי הָרֵאשׁוֹן הִנֵּה אָסוּר ג"כ לְהַבְחִין שָׁם

And even in that first revelation it is forbidden to attempt to discern

שׁוּם חֲלוּק בַּחֲי' וְחֲלוּק מִדְּרָגָה כָּלֵל וְלֹא שׁוּם שֵׁם וְכַנּוּי.

any distinctions or distinct levels at all, nor any appellation,

כִּי הוּא אֹר פְּשוּט בְּתַכְלִית הַפְּשִׁיטוּת.

since it is all undifferentiated uniform light of absolute simplicity – simple in the sense of being uncompounded and

fundamental.

וְעָקֵר מַלְת אֵין סוֹף הִרִי הוּא ג"כ רַק הוֹרָאת שְׁלִילָה,

Furthermore, **the primary meaning of the term "Ein Sof" also indicates only rejection or disavowal,**

שֶׁהוּא מוֹרָה שְׁמֻחוּלָל מִשֵּׁם כָּל חֲלָקֶת מִדְרָגָה בּוֹ וְשׁוּם הִבְחָנָה.

denoting the repudiation of any division into levels, or any other distinction in Him.

וְרַק בְּזֶה לְבַד נִתְגַּלָּה בּוֹ שֶׁאֵין סוֹף לְאוּרוֹ וּלְרוֹמְמוֹתוֹ

And this is the only manner in which it is revealed that there is no limit to His illumination and loftiness,

וְהוּא פָּשוּט בְּתַכְלִית הַפְּשִׁיטוּת.

and that He is absolutely undifferentiated uniform simplicity – simple in the sense of being uniform, uncompounded and undistinguishable, as mentioned.

וְהִנֵּה הוּא גִלּוּי הָרֵאשִׁין אֲשֶׁר מֵאַחֵר אֲמַתָּתוֹ הִנְעֲלָמָה הָעֲצֻמוֹתִית שָׁבוּ.

This is all regarding His first revelation subsequent to His true concealed essential existence.

הַגִּלּוּי הַב' הוּא בְּהֶעָלֶם דְּקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם.

The second revelation is the concealment that constitutes the kav and the tzimtzum.

The *kav* is the limited revelation (the 'line' of light stretching from the edge of the *Ohr Ein Sof* downward) that ensues **after** the *tzimtzum* (the concealment of His infinite revelation in order to make room for finite revelation). Accordingly, we understand that the order here – first the *kav* and then the *tzimtzum* – should not be taken literally.²

וְהִנֵּה הוּא יֵרֵד מִדְּרָגָה הַרְבֵּה מְאֹד מִמִּדְרָגָה הָרִאשׁוֹנָה דְּאוֹר אֵין סוּף.

****And it is a tremendous descent from the first level, the *Ohr Ein Sof* ****

כִּי הִנֵּה בִּתְחִלָּה נִתְּצַמְצַם שֵׁם בְּאוֹתוֹ הַמָּקוֹם מֵהָאוֹר דְּאֵין סוּף לְגַמְרִי,

since the *Ohr Ein Sof* was first removed completely by the act of *tzimtzum* from that same place (where the *Ohr Ein Sof* was originally) leaving the *chalal*³ (the void) that remained after the *tzimtzum*

וְנִסְתַּלַּק וְעָלָה לְמַעְלָה וְכֵמו שִׁיתְבָּאָר עֲנִין הַצְמָצוּם בְּדֶרֶךְ כָּלֵל בְּדִבְרֵינוּ לְקֶמֶן.

and the *Ohr Ein Sof* light was removed and lifted up above thereby forming the *chalal*, as will be explained regarding the concept of *tzimtzum* in general further on in our work.

וְאַח"כּ הִנֵּה חָזַר וְנִתְפַּשֵּׁט שֵׁם בְּבַח"י קוֹ דֵּק מְאוּר אֵין סוּף הָרִאשׁוֹן,

Subsequently the light was returned to spread forth there into the *chalal* in the form of a thin line of light, called the *kav*, from the original *Ohr Ein Sof*,

וּמִמֶּנּוּ וְעַל יָדוֹ נֶאֱצַלּוּ כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כְּלָם, וְכֵן כְּלָם כְּלוּלִים בּוֹ כִּי הוּא שֶׁרֶשׁ הַכָּל.

so that by means of the *kav* all the worlds were emanated, and wherein all of them are included, since it the *kav* is the root of everything in existence.

וְנִקְרָא אוֹתוֹ הָעוֹלָם דְּקוֹ וְצְמָצוּם בְּשֵׁם אֲוִירָא עֲלָאָה,

Now the region of the *kav* and the *tzimtzum*⁴ is called *avira ila'a* supernal space,

וְכֵן טְהִירוֹ עֲלָאָה וְכֵן אֲוִיר קַדְמוֹן וְכִמּוֹ שְׁמֵת בְּאֵר כ"ז בְּדִבְרֵינוּ בְּשַׁעַר
עֲגָלִים וַיֵּשֶׁר עָנָף ב'.

and it is also called *tehiru ila'a***, ** the supernal purity, and also *avir kadmon* primordial space, as will all be explained in *Sha'ar Igulim v'Yosher* of our work, section 2.

וְהִנֵּה כָּאֵן הַתְּחִיל גְּלוּיָו ית"ש בְּאַיְזָה חֲלוּק בְּחִינּוֹת.

It is here that His revelation first began to exhibit distinct levels of sorts,

כִּי בְּהִגְלוּי הָרֵאשׁוֹן דָּאִין סוֹף הָרִי אֵין שֵׁם חֲלוּק בְּחִינַת כָּלֵל

since in the first revelation of the *Ein Sof* there were no distinct aspects;

אֶלָּא שֶׁהוּא אֹר פָּשוּט כְּנִז'.

instead it was a simple, undifferentiated uniform light.

אָבֵל כָּאֵן בְּהֶעֱלָם דְּקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם שֶׁהוּא הִגְלוּי הַשֵּׁנִי,

But here, in the concealment forming the *kav* and *tzimtzum*, which is the second revelation,

הִנֵּה נִתְגַּלָּה בְּאַיְזָה חֲלוּק בְּחִי' עַל כָּל פְּנִים.

certain distinctive levels in some sense were revealed,

כִּי הָרִי יֵשׁ כָּאֵן ב' בְּחִי' שֶׁהֵם הַצִּמְצוּם וְהַקוֹ.

for there are indeed two aspects here, the *tzimtzum* and the *kav*,

וְהוּא סְלוּק וְאוֹר, הָעֶדֶר וּמְצִיאוֹת, וְהֵם הַשְׁרָשׁ דְּחֻסָּדִים וּגְבוּרוֹת,

constituting removal and revelation, absence and presence, and these are the root of the *chasadim* the aspects of 'kindness' and *gevurot* the aspects of 'restriction,' also known as

אוֹר וְחֹשֶׁךְ, וְכֵן דִּין וְרַחֲמִים.

light and dark, and also strict justice and compassion.

אך יותר מזה לא נתגלה כאן כי לא נתגלה בשום חלוק מדרגות
בהצמצום עצמו

**But more than this was not revealed here at this stage, since no
distinct levels were manifested in the *tzimtzum* itself,**

ולא בשום חלוק מדרגות באור הקו עצמו.

nor were there distinct levels in the light of the *kav* itself.⁵

והגם שהאמת הוא כי בהעלם הנה משרש שם כל החלוקי
מדרגות כלם.

This is so, **even though in reality all the distinct levels that
emerge later have their root there in a concealed form.**

אשר יצא משם אח"כ בכל הגלויים דלמטה,

All the distinct levels just mentioned **emerge later in all the
revelations below**

כי רק הוא השרש לכל הגלויים כלם

because this is the only root of all the later revelations,

והרי כל מה שיוצא בענף והפרי הנה בהכרח שכלול הכל בהשרש.

**and everything that develops in the branch and the fruit was
necessarily included in the root.**

אמנם הנה עומד שם הכל רק בהעלם גדול

Now indeed everything is in a state of great concealment there,

וכל גלוייו הוא רק בב' בחינות כלליים

and all revelations from there are only two general aspects –

והם השרש דחסדים וגבורות כנזכר.

the root of the *chasadim* the aspects of 'kindness' and *gevurot* the aspects of 'restriction.'

הגלוי השלישי הוא העולם דאדם קדמון.

The third revelation is the World of Adam Kadmon

והוא יוצא ונתפשט מהעולם דקו וצמצום.

which emerges and spreads out from the region of the *kav* and the *tzimtzum*.

והנה כאן נתגלה בחלוק מדרגות ג"כ.

Here too distinct levels are revealed

כי נתגלה בו בעשרה מדרגות שהם מדרגות דעשר ספירות מכתר עד המלכות.

- **indeed, ten levels are revealed therein, which are the ten levels of the *sefirot* from *keter* to *malchut*.**

ואלו הי' מדרגות הם נקרא בשם אדם.

And these ten levels together are called 'Adam'

כי הוא שרש השרשים דתכונת אדם שלם.

for this is the root of the root of all the characteristics of the complete Adam,

וכמו שכתבנו לעיל שער ג' פ"א דכל עולם הוא בתכונת קומה שלמה

and, as we mentioned above (Sha'ar 3 chapter 1), every World has the characteristics forming a complete stature,

מבחינת פרצוף אדם שלם.

of the aspect of Adam as a complete *partzuf*.

וְכָאן הוּא הָרֹאשִׁית וְהַתְּחִלָּה אֲשֶׁר לָזֶה.

****And this is the head and the beginning thereof. ****

וְר"ל כִּי עֲנִין הַתְּהוּוֹת כָּל עוֹלָם וּבְנִינּוּ

Meaning to say, the coming into being of every World and its development,

אֲשֶׁר נִבְנָה וְנִסְדָּר בְּסֵדֶר הַכֶּנֶּה,

built and structured in a manner that can be titled

פְּרָצוּף אָדָם הוּא מִתְחִיל מִכָּאן וּלְהֵלָּאָה,

the 'partzuf of Adam,' begins from here and on,

אֲבָל לֹא בְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת דְּאֵין סוּף שְׁלִמְעָלָה.

but not in the *Ein Sof* infinite Worlds above.

וְלָכֵן נִקְרָא הוּא בְּשֵׁם אָדָם קַדְמוֹן כִּי מִמֶּנּוּ וּלְמַטָּה בְּסֵדֶר בְּנִין כָּל עוֹלָם

And that is why this aspect is called 'Adam Kadmon' – kadmon signifying 'primordial' – because from here and below is the system of construction of every world

בְּסֵדֶר דִּתְכוּנַת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם וְהוּא הָרֹאשׁוֹן לָזֶה.

according to the paradigm of the *partzuf* of Adam, and this *partzuf* – Adam Kadmon – is the first of them.

אֲמָנָם עֶקֶר עֶמֶק הַטַּעַם מָה שֶׁהוּא נִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם אָדָם

But for the primary and profound reason that this level is called *Adam*

עֵין דְּבִרְיֵנוּ בְּסֵפֶר הַכְּלָלִים כָּלֵל י"ז עֲנָף א'.

see our explanation in *Sefer HaKelalim*, klal 17 anaf 1.⁶

וְהִנֵּה הַגִּלּוּי דְּאוֹתוֹ הָעוֹלָם אֲשֶׁר הוּא נִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם אָדָם קַדְמוֹן

Thus the revelation of the World called Adam Kadmon

הִנֵּה הוּא הַגִּלּוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי לְגִלּוּיֵי ית"ש.

is the third of His revelations, may He be blessed,

אֲמָנָם הוּא הַגִּלּוּי הָרִאשׁוֹן אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בּוֹ בְּבַחֲי עֲשָׂרָה מַדְרָגוֹת

although it is the first revelation in which are revealed the aspect of ten levels,

שֶׁהוּא סוּד הָעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת כְּמוֹ שִׁיתְבָּאָר,

which are the mystery of the ten *sefirot*, as will be explained.

וְכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר מִמֶּנּוּ וּלְמַטָּה הֵם כֻּלָּם בְּהִגִּילוֹי דְּעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת,

All the Worlds, from this one Adam Kadmon and down are all characterized **by the revelation of ten *sefirot*, **

וְהוּא הָרִאשׁוֹן לָהֶם.

and this one Adam Kadmon is the first of them.

אֲמָנָם דַּע כִּי כָל אוֹתָן הִג' גִּלּוּיִם שֶׁאֲמָרְנוּ הִנֵּה הֵם רַק בְּסוּד רָצוֹן וּמַחְשָׁבָה וְהִרְהוּר.

However, be aware that all three of those revelations mentioned are all according to the mystery of will ([ratzon](#))⁷, thinking to oneself (*machshava*)⁸ and mulling over how to communicate a thought⁹ to someone else (*hirhur*)¹⁰.

כִּי הָרָצוֹן הִנֵּה הוּא קֹדֶם לְהַמְחָשֶׁבָה שֶׁ"י שְׂרוּצָה בְּהִדְבָּר

Will precedes thinking to oneself – when a person strongly wants something

ע"ז חושב בו, והנה הרצון סבת המחשבה.

this causes him to think to himself about it. Thus the will is the cause of his thinking.

והמחשבה הוא קדם להרהור והוא עצמותו ועקרו.

And his thinking (*machshava*) precedes mulling over the idea in a practical sense (*hirhur*), and is indeed of its essence and at its root.

כי הרהור הוא התפשטות המחשבה וגליו.

For an idea is an instance of the faculty of *machshava* at work and its revelation,

שהמחשבה לבד אין לה גלוי כלל והיא רק כח לבד

since thinking on its own is not revealed to others, and is merely a potential state,

והיא כח נבדל היוצא מהרצון והיא תולדתו.

and is indeed a potential detached from manifestation that emerges from the will and is the product thereof.

אמנם היא רק עצם כח לבד בלי גלוי כלל.

***Machshava* is in fact only an intrinsic potential, and is not revealed at all – it is thinking to oneself.**

אך היא מתפשט תכף למציאת הרהור ושם היא מתגלה.

However, when *machshava* is activated to think about how to communicate this idea to another person, it is immediately manifested as an instance of thought, and there it becomes revealed.

והיא פעלת המחשבה היוצא ממנה מהכח אל הפעל.

Hirhur is thus the effect of thinking and emerges from it – from a state of potential into actuality.

וְהִנֵּה הַנֶּה כָּל הַג' גְּלוּיִם הַנִּזְכָּרִים

Thus we have all three stages of revelation mentioned above – the *Ohr Ein Sof*, the *tzimtzum* and the *kav*, and *Adam Kadmon*, paralleling

בְּבַחֲיִנַת רָצוֹן וּמַחְשָׁבָה וְהִרְהוּר אֲשֶׁר מֵהִמָּאֲצִיל ית"ש.

the aspect of will, thinking and mulling over an idea (in that order) from the Emanator, may He be blessed.

וּכְבֹּר לְמַדְנוּ רַבְּנוּ הַקְדוֹשׁ הַרָּמ"ק ז"ל כִּי הַמַּחְשָׁבָה הָעֲלִיוֹנָה אֵינָה
בְּמַחְשַׁבַת בְּנֵי אָדָם.

Our holy master, Rabbi Moshe Cordovero, of blessed memory, already taught us that Supernal 'Thinking' is not anything like human thinking.

שָׂאֵם יַחֲשֹׁב הָאָדָם לַפֶּעַל אִיזָה פֶּעַלָּה לֹא מִפְּנֵי זֶה יַעֲשֶׂה רָשָׁם

For if a person would think about doing a certain act, this would not have any impact

וַיִּתְּהוּה מִמֶּנָּה שׁוּם צִיּוּר כָּלֵל עַד שִׁיּוּצִיא מַחְשַׁבָתוֹ לַפֶּעַל דְּוָקָא.

that could create in some form – until the person actually put his idea into action.

וְאִין הַמַּחְשָׁבָה הָעֲלִיוֹנָה כֵּן

But Supernal 'Thinking' is not like that.

אֶלָּא בַּעֲלֻת הַמַּחְשָׁבָה לְשׁוּם הַיִּת אִיזָה מְצִיאוֹת

Instead, when it arises in the Supernal Thinking to bring something into reality,

מִיָּד נִצְטִיר שָׁם בְּמַחְשָׁבָה הָעֲלִיוֹנָה הַצּוּרָה הֵיא בְּמַצִּיאוֹת דָּק.

immediately there is formed in the Supernal Thinking the format of that thing as a rarefied existence.

וַיִּתְעַלֶּה הַמְצִיאוֹת הַהוּא מִן הַהִנָּה הַמְתִּיהָ בַּמְצִיאוֹת הַמְתַּגַּלָּה,

Now the preeminence of that existence over the actual being of revealed existence,

בְּהַבְדִּיל הַצּוּרָה הַשְּׂכֵלִית וּכְעֻיָּה מִן הַצּוּרָה הַגְּשָׁמִית,

is akin to the difference between a mental image and its preeminence over a physical shape,

וּכְהַבְדִּיל צוּרֹת הַמְשָׁכָל אֶל הַמְרָגֵשׁ.

and is like the difference between the contours of a concept and that of a feeling.

וּכְמִ"שׁ כ"ז בְּסִפּוּר אֵילָמָה מֵעֵין ב' תָּמַר א' פ' ט"ז וְכֵן שָׁם מֵעֵין ד'
תָּמַר א' פ' ב'

All this is explained in Rabbi Moshe Cordovero's book *Elimah, ma'ayan 2, tamar 1*, chapter 16, and *ibid. ma'ayan 4, tamar 1*, chapter 2

וְכֵן אָמַר ג"כ בְּפֶרֶדֶס שְׁעַר הַצְחָצְחוֹת פ"ג וְכֵן "ל בְּדַבְּרֵינוּ שְׁעַר א'
פ"ח.

and he states the same thing also in *Pardes Rimonim, Sha'ar HaTzachtzachot***, chapter 3, and above in this work *Sha'ar 1* chapter 8.**

וּכ"ז הוּא ג"כ בְּעֻנְיֵנוּ בְּכָל הַג' גְּלוּיִם הַנִּזְכָּרִים.

All of this also applies to our subject regarding all the three revelations mentioned:

כִּי הַגְּלוּי הָרִאשׁוֹן הֵנָּה "ל הִנֵּה הוּא בְּבַחֲי רָצוֹן.

The first revelation, as noted, is the aspect of *ratzon* (the Divine Will)

ששם הוא הרצון לכל גלויי כלם ולכל פעולותיו כלם.

wherein resides the *ratzon* for each and every one of His revelations, and for all of His deeds.

והגם שהגלוי הראשון הרי אמרנו כי הוא בבחי' האור דא"ס,

The very first revelation is the aspect of *Ohr Ein Sof* – infinite revelation – as we stated,

וכל פעולותיו כלם הרי הם בבחי' גבול ומדה,

whereas all of His deeds are performed within boundaries and limitations. Now these seem to be contradictory statements.

אך כבר בארנו בספר הכללים כלל ב' ובעגולים וישר ענף ב' אות י"ח ואות כ'

****However, we have already explained in *Sefer HaClalim*, clal 2 of *Igulim v'Yosher*, section 2:18, 20 ****

כי יסוד הראשון דכל המציאות כלו הוא באמת רק אור אין סוף,

that the very first foundation of all existence is in fact only the *Ohr Ein Sof*

ונתיסד כל המציאות כלו רק על אור אין סוף וממנו יצאו ואליה ישובו.

and all of existence in its entirety is founded only upon the *Ohr Ein Sof***, from whence everything emerged and to which everything returns.**

וכן רק הוא מסתכל עליהם תמיד ומנהיג אותם,

Furthermore, it is only He who oversees them constantly and who guides them with His Divine Providence,

ומזה הוא כל ההנהגה הנעלמה דכל הכבשי דרחמנא

and from there stems the entire hidden providence pertaining to the secrets of the Merciful One¹¹

שנלאה כל שכל למצא טעם להם.

which all human intellect struggles to find a reason for.

והוא מהנהגת דאור אין סוף המנהיג את כל המציאות תמיד לתכלית תקויו האחרון.

This is the manner in which the *Ohr Ein Sof* guides all of existence continuously towards its final rectification.

וזהו כל עקר הענין מה שהיה הגלוי הראשון רק אור אין סוף.

This is the entire fundamental reason that the first revelation was only *Ohr Ein Sof*,

כי רק הוא היסוד דכל המציאות כלו ועליו הם עומדים תמיד

for only He is the foundation of all existence, and it is upon Him that they endure throughout time,

כמו שבארנו כ"ז שם בארכה.

As we have explained above.

וע' עוד דברינו בזה בדע"ה ח"א דרש' ה' סימן ה' אות כ', כ"א.

**See more on this matter in *Deah* part 1, essay 5, chapter 5 #20, 21. **

והרי עכ"פ הוא כי הגלוי הראשון שהוא האור דאין סוף

In any event, we have it that the first revelation is the *Ohr Ein Sof*,

הנה הוא בחי' הרצון לכל גלוייו כלם ולכל פעלותיו כלם.

which is the aspect of the overarching *ratzon* for all His revelations and all of His deeds.

וְזֶהוּ מָה שֶׁנִּמְצָא בְּאִיזָה דְּבָרֵי קְדוּשֵׁי עֲלִיוֹן

This is precisely what we find in the words of some of the most exalted holy rabbis¹²

שְׂאוּמְרִים שֶׁכָּל מָה שֶׁאֲנִי מְדַבְּרִים מִמֶּנּוּ ית"ש הוּא רַק מְרְצוֹנּוּ.

who declare that whatever we can say about Him refers only to His will,

כִּי רַק בְּזֶה לְבַד נִתְגַּלָּה בְּגִלּוּי הָרָאוֹן.

for in this manner alone was the first revelation,

וְרַק זֶה הוּא הָרָאוֹשִׁית וְהַשְׂרֵשׁ לְכָל הַגִּלּוּיִם כָּלָם.

and only this is the beginning and the root of all the subsequent revelations.

הַגִּלּוּי הַשֵּׁנִי שֶׁהוּא הָעוֹלָם דֶּהֱקוּ וְצִמְצוּם וְנִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם אֲוִיר קַדְמוֹן וְכָנ"ל.

The second revelation is the region of the *kav* and the *tzimtzum*, called *avir kadmon* – primordial space.

הִנֵּה הוּא בְּבַחֲיוֹ מַחְשָׁבָה הַנִּמְשָׁךְ וְיוֹצֵא מִן הָרָצוֹן וּמִיחָד עִמּוֹ כֵּן הוּא הֶקֶן.

This is the aspect of *machshava* that is drawn out of and emerges from *ratzon*, while remaining united with it, and this is true of the *kav* as well.

כִּי נִמְשָׁךְ מֵאִין סוּף עֲצָמוֹ וְכֵן הַצִּמְצוּם הוּא דְּבוּק וּמִיחָד בְּאִין סוּף מִמֶּשׁ

Because the *kav* is drawn from the *Ein Sof* Himself¹³, and the *tzimtzum*¹⁴ also cleaves to and is united with the *Ein Sof*, literally.

כִּי הוּא מִמֶּנּוּ עֲצָמוֹ, וְכֵמוֹ שֶׁבְּאַרְנוּ בַּעֲגָלִים וְיֵשֶׁר עָנָף ב'.

This is because it emerges from Him Himself, as we explained in *Igulim v'Yosher, anaf 2*.

וְלָכֵן נִקְרָא הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה בְּשֵׁם טְהִירוֹ עֲלָאָה

And therefore that plane is referred to as the *tehiru ila'ah* – the Supernal Purity

כִּי בּוֹ הוּא הֶקֶף הָאוֹר דא"ס כְּמוֹ שֶׁבְּאַרְנוֹ שָׁם.

because it is surrounded by the *Ohr Ein Sof*, as explained there.

וְהוּא בְּבַחֲיוֹ מַחְשָׁבָה מֵהַמְּאֻצִּיל ית"ש.

This is the aspect of *machshava* of the blessed Emanator

וְהוּא עֲדִין סֵתֵם וְנִעְלָם כִּי הוּא רַק בְּבַחֲיוֹ כֹחַ הַמַּחְשָׁבָה בְּעֻצְמָהּ

which is as yet closed off and concealed from any recipient since it is merely in a state of potential *machshava* on its own i.e. prior to the intention to communicate it to any recipient

אֲשֶׁר כָּל מַצִּיאֹתָהּ הוּא רַק בְּחִיוֹ כֹחַ לְבַד וְכָנֶ"ל.

being that *machshava's* entire existence is exclusively in a state of potential, as explained above.

הַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי שֶׁהוּא הָעוֹלָם דְּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן.

The third revelation is the World of Adam Kadmon

הִנֵּה הוּא בְּבַחֲיוֹ הַרְהוֹר, שֶׁהוּא הַתְּפִשְׁטוֹת הַמַּחְשָׁבָה וְגִלּוּיָו וְכָנֶ"ל.

which is the aspect of *hirhur* – an instance of *machshava* i.e. a specific thought and its revelation, as explained above.

וְכֵן הוּא הָאָדָם קַדְמוֹן כִּי בּוֹ נִתְגַּלָּה הַבְּחִינֹת דְּכָל הָעֲשָׂרָה מַדְרָגוֹת

The same is true of Adam Kadmon since here the distinctions between all the ten levels of the *sefirot* are revealed.

כי על זה היה כל הרצון והמחשבה שהם הב' גלויים הראשונים.

Indeed it was to this end that there were *ratzon* and *machshava*, the first two revelations,

ונתגלה פעלתם בבחי' יציאה מן הכח אל הפעל באדם קדמון
שהוא הגלוי השלישי.

so that their effects would be revealed in emerging from potential to actual as Adam Kadmon, the third revelation,

וע"ד ההרהור שהוא יוצא מן הרצון והמחשבה

similar to the manner in which *hirhur* emerges from *ratzon* and *machshava*,

שהם בכח לבד והם נעלמים

which are merely in a state of potential and are therefore concealed,

ויוצאים ומתגלים בהרהור.

and emerge and are revealed by *hirhur*.

אמנם כל הגלוי דהרהור הרי הוא עדין ג"כ רק בלב החושב לבד

However, *hirhur* is as yet only revealed in the heart of the thinker,

ואין גלוי מהם עדין לזולתו מאומה,

and no revelation at all therefrom is accessible to someone else

כי הוא רק התפשטות המחשבה בנזכר.

since the *hirur* is merely an instance of *machshava*, as mentioned.

כן הוא כל אלו הג' גלויים שאמרנו הנה הם הכל רק בבחי' מחשבת המאציל עצמו,

So too regarding all three revelations mentioned – the *Ohr Ein Sof*, the *tzimtzum* and *kav*, and Adam Kadmon – all of them are only in the thoughts of the Emanator Himself,

וְהָיָה כָּל אֱלוֹהֵי הַג' גְּלוּיִם הַנִּזְכָּרִים בְּבַחֲי' רָצוֹן וּמַחְשָׁבָה וְהִרְהוּר
בְּהַמְאֲצִיל ית"ש.

and all three revelations just mentioned are dubbed *ratzon*, *machshava* and *hirhur* in the Emanator, blessed is He.

וְהוּא אוֹר דְּאֵין סוּף – רָצוֹן. הַקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם – מַחְשָׁבָה. אָדָם קַדְמוֹן –
הִרְהוּר.

So that *Ohr Ein Sof* is compared to *ratzon*; the *kav* and *tzimtzum* to *machshava*, and Adam Kadmon to *hirhur*,

וְהֵם מְצִיאת גְּלוּיָיו שֶׁבְּהַמְאֲצִיל עֲצָמוֹ

and they signify the presence of these revelations within the Emanator Himself,

וּע"פ מָה שֶׁאִמְרָנוּ מִדְּבַרֵי קְדוּשַׁת ה' הָרַמְ"ק ז"ל וְכַנֵּ"ל.

according to what we have cited from the words of the holy Rabbi Moshe Cordovero, of blessed memory, as mentioned.

אֲךָ גְּלוּיָיו אֲשֶׁר הוּא בְּבַחֲי' פְּעֻלָּה וּמַעֲשֵׂה מִמֶּנּוּ ית"ש,

However, His revelations as *effects* and *actions* stemming from Him

הֵנָּה הוּא רַק מִשֵּׁם וּלְמַטָּה כִּי מֵאַחֵר הַג' גְּלוּיִם הַנִּזְכָּרִים שֶׁהֵם
כֻּלָּם בְּהַמְאֲצִיל עֲצָמוֹ.

are only from there on down, since the first three revelations just mentioned are all within the Emanator Himself.

הֵנָּה מִשֵּׁם וּלְמַטָּה מִתְּחִיל גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש אֲשֶׁר בְּבַחֲי' פְּעֻלָּה מִמֶּשׁ.

Thus only from there on down begin His revelations as *actual* effects and actions

וְהוּא נִחְלָק לְשִׁתִּים שֶׁהֵן אַרְבַּע וְכִמוּ שִׁיתָבָאֵר:

which are divided into two that are four, as will be explained.¹⁵

Footnotes

1. Makover. ↩
2. Unless the intention is that since the *kav* emerges from the *Ohr Ein Sof* that was removed from the *chalal*-void therefore it is higher than the *chalal*-void, which is identified with the *tzimtzum*, and therefore it is appropriate to list the *kav* first and then the *tzimtzum*. However, this is mere speculation on the part of the translator. ↩
3. Makover. ↩
4. Note that the *tzimtzum* preceded the *kav*, and technically the phrase should have read 'the *tzimtzum* and the *kav*.' ↩
5. Presumably this refers to the very top of the *kav* as it first emerges from the *Ohr Ein Sof*, prior to the stage when it circles around the inner perimeter of the *chalal*, forming the various *sefirot* of the *igulim* of *Adam Kadmon*. See *Eitz Chaim sh'ar 1 anaf 2*: ↩
6. ד"ה והנה ↩
7. Corresponding to the *Ohr Ein Sof* (Makover has this as corresponding to *Ein Sof*, but that seems to be an error). ↩
8. Corresponding to the *tzimtzum* and the *kav* (Makover). ↩
9. Corresponding to *Adam Kadmon* (Makover). ↩
10. The Vilna Gaon, of blessed memory, in his commentary to the *Tikunei Zohar* (p. 20c ד"ה בריש הורמנותא דמלכא) explains that *ratzon*, *machshava* and *hirhur* correspond to *keter*, *chochmah* and *binah* (in that order). In his

commentary on *Sefer Yetzirah* (p. 10c) he explains that *machshava* is when a person contemplates an idea but does not put it into words (even in his own mind) that could be communicated, whereas *hirhur* is mulling over how to communicate an idea to someone else. (*Meir haLeshem*). ↩

11. See *Berachot* 10a: When King Chizkiyahu became gravely ill, Isaiah the Prophet visited him and told him that the reason for his illness was that he had not established a family. When King Chizkiyahu replied that he had avoided having children because he knew by Divine Inspiration (*ruach hakodesh*) that he would have children who would not follow in the ways of Torah, Isaiah replied "what business do you have interfering in the secrets of the Merciful One? You must do your part, and He will do as He wishes." ↩
12. See Ramchal, *Kla"ch, petach* 25; *Likutim* printed at the end of the GR"A's commentary on *Sifra d'Tzinuta* 38b. ↩
13. I.e. from the *Ohr Ein Sof* that was removed by the *tzimtzum*. See *Eitz Chaim shaar* 1, *anaf* 2. (*Meir HaLeshem*). ↩
14. I.e. the *reshimu* – traces of the root of the *gevurot* mentioned above – that remained after the *tzimtzum*. (*Meir HaLeshem*).
↩
15. "Two that are four" is a fairly common Rabbinic statement in the *Mishnah* (e.g. *Shabbat* 1:1; *Sh'vuot* 2:1; *Nega'im* 1:1. The intention is to classify a subject broadly and then specify sub-categories. ↩

Chapter 4 — The fourth level of unfolding from above to below (hitpashtut) of Divine Light, the world of Atsilus.

Sha'ar 4 Chapter 4

Revelation of His Actualization

הָנָה גְּלוּיּוֹ בִּפְעֻלָּתוֹ ית"ש אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בָּזֶה בִּפְעֵל מִמֶּשׁ

Now we will discuss His revelation within His actions – where He is revealed in actuality –

הָנָה הוּא בְּכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת דָּהֵד' עוֹלָמוֹת אֲצִילוֹת בְּרִיָּאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה,

this takes place throughout the existence of the four Worlds, Atzilut, Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

וְהֵנָּה הִיָּה גְּלוּיּוֹ בָּזֶה בְּשֵׁנֵי בְּחִינּוֹת,

His revelation in this manner is of two types:

אֶחָד בְּבְּחִינַת פְּעֻלָּה שְׁחוּץ מִמֶּנּוּ.

One is the type of activity outside of Himself;

וְאֶחָד בְּבְּחִינַת פְּעֻלָּה שֶׁהִיא אֶצְלוֹ

and the other is the type of activity that is with Him

וּמִיָּחָד עִמּוֹ עַד שֶׁנַּעֲשִׂית חֵד עִמּוֹ.

and is united with Him to the extent that it becomes one with Him.

וְהֵנָּה הֵם שְׁתֵּים שֶׁהֵם הֵב' בְּחִינּוֹת הַנִּזְכָּרִים,

Now these 'two that are four'¹ as just mentioned

וְהֵן אַרְבַּע שְׁהִם הַד' עוֹלָמוֹת אֲבִי"ע.

are the four worlds of ABY" A – Atzilut, Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

וְהֵינּוּ כִּי הֵנָּה מֵהַגְלִי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי הֵנָּה לִשְׁהוּ אָדָם קַדְמוֹן.

That is to say, from the third revelation mentioned above –
Adam Kadmon –

אֲשֶׁר בּוֹ נִתְגַּלָּה רָצוֹנוֹ וּמַחְשַׁבְתּוֹ ית"ש לְהַמְצִיא מְצִיאוֹת עַל תְּכוּנַת
אָדָם

in which His *ratzon*² and *machashava*³ are revealed and
produce an existence in the format of Adam,

שְׁהוּ אָדָם בְּנוֹי וּמִסְדָּה עַל עֲשָׂרָה מַדְרָגוֹת כַּח"ב חֲגִ"ת נְהִי"ם [כְּתֹר-
חֲכָמָה-בִּינָה; חֶסֶד-גְּבוּרָה-תִּפְאַרֶת; נֶצַח-הוֹד-יְסוֹד-מַלְכוּת]

i.e. with the ten levels the ten *sefirot keter-chochmah-binah*;
chesed-gevurah-tiferet; netzach-hod-yesod-malchut^{**4**}

וּמִסְדָּר בִּג' קוּיִם חַח"נ בְּיָמִין

arranged in three columns: *chochmah-chesed-netzach* on the
right;

בִּג"ה בְּשִׁמְאֵל

binah-gevurah-hod on the left;

כְּתִי"ם בְּאֶמְצַע.

keter-tiferet-yesod-malchut in the middle

הֵנָּה יֵצֵא בְּמַחְשַׁבְתּוֹ לַפְעַל וְהוֹצִיא מֵאוֹתוֹ הַגְלִי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי שְׁהוּ
הָאָדָם קַדְמוֹן

Thus it arose in His thought (i.e. at the level of *machshava*) to
produce and emanate from that third revelation, Adam

Kadmon,

בְּכֹחוֹ וְעַל יָדוֹ,

with the capability thereof and by means thereof,

וְהַמְצִיא אֶת כָּל הָעֲשָׂרָה מַדְרָגוֹת שֶׁהֵם הָעֵשָׂר סְפִירוֹת

to bring out all of the ten levels, which are the ten *sefirot*,

כַּח"ב חג"ת נהי"ם בְּמַצִּיאוֹת מִמֶּשׁ,

keter-chochmah-binah; chesed-gevurah-tiferet; netzach-hod-yesod-malchut⁵** into actual manifest existence.**

וְהוּא יִצְיָאָתוֹ ית"ש מָה שִׁיָּצָא מֵהַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפְּעֹל,

This is His emergence, blessed is His Name, from potential to actual.

Although the Baal HaLeshem does not mention it explicitly here, it is self-understood that this revelation is of course post-*tzimtzum* and *kav*.

וְהוּא הַגְּלוּי הָרְבִיעִי שֶׁנִּמְשָׁךְ וְיִצָּא מֵהַגְּלוּי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי

This is the fourth revelation, which is drawn from and emerges out of the third revelation, Adam Kadmon,

וְבוֹ יִצָּא בַּפְּעֻלָּה מִמֶּשׁ.

and by way of which it emerges into actuality.

וְהִנֵּה אוֹתָהּ הַמְצִיאוֹת הִנֵּה הִיא מְצִיאוֹת סְפִירֵי וּבְהִיָּרָה כְּזוֹ,

Now that existence is so luminous and radiant

עַד שֶׁאֵינּוּ נֹפֵל עָלֶיהָ לֹא שֵׁם עֲשִׂיהָ וְלֹא שֵׁם יִצְרָה וְלֹא שֵׁם בְּרִיאָה
כִּי הִיא זָכָה וְדָקָה מְאֹד,

that it cannot be labeled 'made' or 'formed' or 'created' – terms associated with the lower worlds of Asiya, Yetzirah and Beriah,⁶ because it is so pure and refined,

למעלה הרבה מכל האיכות והעצמות דהבריא,ה,

that it far transcends the entire quality and essence of created being,

והשם שלה הוא אצילות,

and is named 'Atzilut,'

על שם הכתוב "וְאֶצְלֵתִי מִן הָרוּחַ אֲשֶׁר עֲלֶיךָ",

as in the verse (Numbers 11:17) "I will emanate (v'Atzalti) from the spirit that is upon you and place it on them" – on the seventy elders,

כי היא נאצלה מא"ק [מאדם קדמון] ונשפע ממנו,

for it was emanated (ne'etzlah) from Adam Kadmon and is impacted by it,

ומשום שהוא למעלה ומרום מאיכות העצמות דכל נברא.

and because it is loftier than, and is elevated beyond the essential qualities of every created being.

לכן אי אפשר לשום נברא להשיג את מהות אותה המציאות מה שהיא,

Therefore it is impossible for any created being to grasp the inner disposition of that existence and what defines it.

והוא מה שקורא אותן הספר יצירה בשם עשר ספירות בלימה,

This is why that they are called 'the ten sefirot bli mah' – ten undefined sefirot – in Sefer Yetzirah,⁷

ור"ל שהם בלי מהות משג.

meaning that that they are without discernible character.

וכן אי אפשר לשום נברא להבין בדיוק הוראת ובאור דשם ומילת
אצילות מה שהוא,

It is similarly impossible for any created being to understand exactly the significance and meaning of the word *Atzilut*, and what it is,

כי כל שם הוא נמשך מעצם המציאות ומשך התהוותו,

because every name is drawn from the essential existence and the root from which it came into being,

וכנודע במה שכתוב ויקרא האדם שמות, וכמ"ש בתקונים תקון
מ"ט**.

as is known from the verse (Genesis 2:20) "He (Adam) gave names to all the animals...", as it states in the *Tikunim* (*Tikunei Zohar*) *Tikun* 49.

ולכן כשם שנעלם מכל נברא להשיג את מהות האצילות

Therefore, just as the essence of *Atzilut* is impenetrable to the grasp of a created being,

כן נעלם מכל נברא להבין בדיוק הוראת דשם אצילות ג"כ,

so too is it beyond the comprehension of every created being to understand precisely the significance of the name *Atzilut*,

כי הוא למעלה ומרומם מעצם איכות כל נברא,

since it is loftier than, and is elevated above the essential quality of every created being,

והרי אי אפשר להשיג ג"כ את הוראת שמו בדיוק:

making it is impossible to also grasp the significance of its name precisely.

אָמַנָם הוּא הִנֵּה כָּל הַנִּצָּצִים כָּלָם

Now although it is true that all things emanated

הִנֵּה הֵגֶם שֶׁהֵם לְמַעַלָּה הַרְבֵּה מִכָּל הַנִּבְרָאִים כָּלָם,

are much loftier than all of the other creations,

עַם כָּל זֶה הִנֵּה הֵם מֵצֵד עֲצָמָם אֵינָם אֱלֹהוּת כָּלָל,

nevertheless, in and of themselves they are not Godliness at all,

כִּי הֵם נִצָּצוּ וְנִמְצְאוּ מִחֲדָשׁ אַחֵר שֶׁלֹּא הָיוּ,

since they were emanated and emerged anew from non-existence i.e. *ex nihilo*,

וְאֵינָם אֱלֹהוּת אֶלָּא מֵצֵד יַחֲדוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ בָּהֶם,

and they are not Godliness other than in terms of His unification with them, blessed be His Name.

כִּי הָאִין סוּף הִתְיַחַד בָּהֶם וְנַעֲשֶׂה חֵד מִמֶּשׁ עִמָּהֶם

Because the *Ein Sof* united Himself with them and He actually became one with them,

וְהֵם מַעֲתָה אֱלֹהוּת גָּמוּר עַל יְדוֹ יְחִיד וּמִיחָד,

so that now they are wholly Godliness as a result of this, and are one and united with Him.

כִּי הֵם תְּכוּנָה יְקָרָה נִעְלָה וּמְרוֹמָם כָּזוֹ,

Thus they are now of a very precious and lofty character and are elevated to the extent that

שִׁרְאוּיָם לְקַבֵּל אֶת יַחֲדוֹ בָּהֶם וּלְהַעֲשׂוֹת עִמּוֹ חֵד מִמֶּשׁ.

they are worthy of receiving his Oneness in them to become one with Him literally.

אָבֵל הֵם מִצַּד עֲצָמָם זֹלַת יְחִידוֹ בָּהֶם, אֵינָם אֱלֹהוֹת כָּלֵל,

But in and of themselves, without his unity in them, they are not Godliness at all,

וּכְמִ"שׁ אֱלִיהוּ זָכוֹר לְטוֹב בְּתַפְּלוֹתוֹ

as Elijah (may he be remembered for good) said in his prayer⁸:

וְכַד אַנְתָּ תִסְתַּלַּק מִנִּיהוּ אֲשֶׁתִּאָרוּ כִלְהוּ שְׁמָהּ כְּגוֹפָא בְּלֹא
"נִשְׁמָתָא".

"if You were to remove Yourself from them, all those Names i.e. from the *sefirot* of *Atzilut* they would be like a body without a soul."

אִמָּנָם מֵאַחַר שֶׁהִתְיַחַד עִמָּהֶם, וְהוּא מַעַת הִתְקוּן דִּמְעָשָׁה בְּרֹאשִׁית
וּמֵאֲזוּ וּלְהֵלָאָה,

But since He united Himself with them – from the time of the *Tikun* during the Work of Creation and on –

The account of Creation in the first chapter of Genesis reveals that first the World of Chaos, called *Tohu*, was created. *Tohu* was a deliberately unstable world that shattered and fell apart, and only then was the rectified world of *Atzilut*, known also as the World of *Tikun* (rectification), created. The World of *Tikun* rectifies the World of *Tohu*. His Godliness was not manifested in, or united with, the World of *Tohu*.

הֵנָּה לֹא סָר וְלֹא יָסִיר יְחִידוֹ מֵהֶם לְעוֹלָמִים,

He did not and will not ever remove his Oneness from them.

וּמִיַּחַד עִמָּהֶם בְּיַחֲדוֹ עָצוּם מְאֹד עַד שְׁנַעֲשִׂים חַד עִמּוֹ.

Thus He unites with them in a potent unity to the extent that they become one with Him,

ועי"ז נתגלה הוא להקרא בשם על ידיהם,

and in this manner He becomes revealed, so that He can be called by Name through them,

כי הם עצמם נעשים לשמו, והוא כל השמות הקדושים כלם,

since they themselves become His Name. And this is true of all the Holy Names

אשר הוא עצמו נקרא בהם ע"י התלבשו באצילות

by which He Himself is called through becoming clothed in Atzilut

והתיחדו עמהם להיותם חד עמו,

and by unifying with them so that they become one with Him.

ועי"ז שהתלבש בהם נעשו הם כלם ג"כ לחד וכמ"ש אליהו זל"ט

Moreover, through His becoming clothed within them they also all become one in themselves, as Elijah declared:

ואנת הוא דקשיר לון ומיחד לון ובגין דאנת מלגאון

"You are He who binds them together and unifies them, and because You are within them,

כל מאן דאפריש חד מן חברה מאלן עשר ספירין אתחשב ליה
כאלו אפריש בך".

anyone who separates one of them from the other of these ten sefirot is regarded as if he made a separation in You,"

כי הם מעתה אלהות גמור יחיד ומיחד,

because from now on they are wholly Godliness, one and united,

וְהוּא ע"י יְחֻדוֹ בָּהֶם, שְׁנַעֲשִׂים חֵד עַל יְדוֹ וְחֵד עִמּוֹ:

by way of His oneness in them, and thus they are made into a unity by Him, and become one with Him.

וְהוּא מ"ש הוּא ית"ש לֹא יִהְיֶה לָךְ אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים עַל פָּנָי

This is what is stated in the verse (Exodus 20:3), "You shall not give credence to the gods of others in My Presence."⁹

וּר"ל זולת האצילות שהוא פָּנָיו,

Meaning to say that this commandment applies even outside of the world of Atzilut which is His 'Presence,'

כִּי שֵׁם הוּא מְתַיַּחַד וּמְתַגַּלָּה וְהוּא פָּנָיו מִמַּשׁ,

since that is where He is revealed and there He is one and is in a state of revelation. This is therefore referred to as 'His Presence', literally.

וּכְמ"ש בְּזוֹהַר ק' פ' אָמור צ"ג ע"ב, בְּקִשּׁוֹ פָּנָי, אֵלָיו עֲטָרֵי מַלְכָּא (ר"ל הָעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת)

As is written in the Holy Zohar *parshat Emor* 93b on the verse (Psalms 27:8) "...seek My Presence¹⁰" – this refers to those crowns of the King (i.e. the ten *sefirot*)

דָּאָהוּ אֶחָיד בְּהוּ, וְאֵנּוֹן בִּיהוּ, אֵינּוֹן שְׁמִיהּ, וְאִיהוּ וּשְׁמִיהּ מְלָה חֵדָּא הוּא,

with which He unites, and they are united with Him; they are His Name, and He and His Name are One.

בְּגִין כֵּךְ אָמַר דָּוִד אֶת פָּנֶיךָ ה' אֲבַקֵּשׁ (ר"ל שִׁיְאָר פָּנָיו אֵלָיו),

For this reason King David declared (Psalms ibid) "Your Presence¹¹, O Lord, I seek" (meaning to say David prayed that His Presence shine upon him).

וְכֵן אָמְרוּ בַּזוֹהַר "ק יִתְרוֹ פ"ו א', עַל פָּנָיו, לְאַפְקָא אִפִּי מַלְכָּא.

And so too, in the Holy Zohar Yitro 86a on the verse (Exodus 20:3) "in My Presence" – 'this excludes the Presence of the King from the category of "the gods of others" or "other gods" mentioned in the above prohibition.

דְּבָהוּ אֶתְחִיזִי מַלְכָּא קַדִּישָׁא, וְאֲנֹן שְׁמִיהּ וְהוּא אֲנֹן.

for in them in the sefirot the Holy King is revealed; they the sefirot are His Name and through them He guides all the worlds**¹²** **and He is them'** He is essentially the life-force of the sefirot**¹³**

הוּא שְׁמִיהּ דְּכְתִיב אֲנִי ה' הוּא שְׁמִי, הוּא וְשְׁמִיהּ חֵד הוּא.

'He is His Name', as is written (Isaiah 42:8) "I am God, this is My Name" – that is to say, 'He and His Name are one!'¹⁴

וְכֵן כְּתִיב ג' כ הֵרַח"ו ז"ל בַּפ' שְׁמוֹת ג' ע"ב בְּהִגָּהוֹת מֵהֵרַח"ו שֵׁם אוֹת ד' ע"ש,

Rabbi Chaim Vital writes in similar vein in a comment on the Zohar, Exodus p. 3b, and in his Hagahot Maharchu para. 4.

וְלִזְהָרָם זַמְזָם גַּם הָרַמְבַּם בְּפֶרֶשְׁת יִתְרוֹ בְּפֶסוּק ל"א לֹא יִהְיֶה לָּךְ.

The Ramban (Nachmanides) also alludes to this interpretation in his commentary to the section in Yitro on the verse (20:3) "You shall not give credence to the gods of others..."

וַיֹּאמֶר כִּי בִּזְהָרָא יָבֵא כָּל הַכְּתוּב בְּפִשְׁטוֹ וּמִשְׁמַעוֹ,

And he declares that with this interpretation the entire verse can be understood simply and at its face value.

וְכֹן כְּתִבּוּ הָרַקְנָטִי וְהַצִּיּוֹנִי וְרַבֵּנוּ בַּחֲיֵי בִּפְרָשֶׁת יִתְרוֹ שָׁם,

And so too write the Recanati,¹⁵ the Tzioni¹⁶ and Rabbeinu Bachye¹⁷ on that verse in *Yitro*.

וכ"ז הוא כי ע"י יחודו בַּאֲצִילוֹת נַעֲשֶׂה כָּל הָאֲצִילוֹת כְּלוּ אֱלֹהוֹת
גָּמוּר,

This is all because of His unifying with the World of Atzilut, so that the entire Atzilut became wholly Godliness.

כִּי מֵעַתָּה הִתְקוּן אֲשֶׁר לְצֶרֶךְ מַעֲשֶׂה בְּרֵאשִׁית הַנָּה הִתְיַחַד א"ס ית"ש
בַּאֲצִילוֹת

Because from the time of the *Tikun* that was necessary to rectify the Work of Creation, from that time on, the Infinite One, blessed is He, united himself with the world of Atzilut.

During the early process of creation the World of *Tohu* was formed. *Tohu* was a deliberately unstable world that shattered and had to be reconstructed as the World of *Tikun*, which is essentially the World of Atzilut,¹⁸ as explained in a previous note.

וְנַעֲשֶׂה עִם הָאֲצִילוֹת חֵד גָּמוּר וְעִי"ז הָנָה כָּל הָאֲצִילוֹת כְּלוּ אֱלֹהוֹת
גָּמוּר יַחֲיד וּמְיַחַד.

He made Himself absolutely one with the world of Atzilut, and thus the entire Atzilut is wholly Godliness, one and united.

אֲבָל זֹלַת יַחְדוֹ בָּהֶם וְקֹדֶם שֶׁהִתְיַחַד עִמָּהֶם,

But without His oneness in them in the *sefirot*, prior to His uniting Himself with them the *sefirot* of Atzilut

הֵנָּה הֵם מִצַּד עֲצָמָם אֵינָם אֱלֹהוֹת כָּלָל וְכָלָל,

in and of themselves, they are not Godliness at all.

וְלָכֵן אֵרַע בָּהֶם בְּעוֹלָם הִתְהוּ כָּל מָה שְׁאֵרַע. וַיֵּצֵא מֵהֶם אֶז כָּל מָה
שְׂיֵצֵא:

And therefore what occurred to them in the world of *Tohu* occurred, the vessels shattered and what transpired, transpired.

וְהָאֵמֶת וְהָעֶקֶר הוּא כִּי אֶזְלָא הָיוּ נִקְרָאִים בְּשֵׁם אֲצִילוֹת כָּלֵל

The truth and the main point is that then prior to this first *tikun* they were not called 'Atzilut' at all

וְלֹא בְּשֵׁמוֹת הַסְּפִירוֹת כָּלֵל,

and not by the names of the *sefirot* at all. Prior to this point all the revelations were transcendent and therefore undefinable,

וכמ"ש באד"ר פ' נִשְׂאָ דָף קל"ה ע"ב, וְכִלְהוּ אֶתְקִירוּ בְּשֵׁמָהוּ
אֲחֵרִין מִן קִדְמָאין כו' ע"ש.

As is written in the *Idra Rabba*,¹⁹ page 135b: "...and all of them are now in the World of Atzilut called by names other than the initial ones."

In this section of the *Zohar* Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai explains the fate of the seven *sefirot* of the World of *Tohu* which shattered and fell. The names given initially were *Bela*, which comes to be called *da'at* in Atzilut; *Yovav* becomes *chesed*; *Chusham*, *gevurah* etc.

וְשֵׁמוֹת הַסְּפִירוֹת וְשֵׁם אֲצִילוֹת הוּא נִתְחַדֵּשׁ וְנַעֲשֶׂה בָּהֶם רַק מֵעַתָּה
הַתְּקוּן

Thus **the names of the *sefirot*, and indeed the name Atzilut** itself**, were all innovated and became relevant to them only from the time of *Tikun*,**

אֲשֶׁר לְצֹרֶךְ מַעֲשֵׂה בְּרָאשִׁית וּמֵאֵז וּלְהִלָּאָה.

for the needs of the Work of Creation and on.

וְהוּא מֵעַתָּה אֲשֶׁר הִתְיַחַד הַמֵּאֲצִיל ית"ש בָּהֶם לְהִקְרָא שֵׁם בְּשֵׁמוֹ.

That is – from the time that the blessed Emanator unified Himself in them so that they could be called by His Name.

וְנַעֲשׂוּ מֵאֵז וּלְהִלָּאָה אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוּר עַל יָדוֹ וְכִנְזָכָר.

As a result, from then on, they the *sefirot* of Atzilut became wholly Godliness, as mentioned.

וְכֵן נִקְרְאוּ מֵאֵז וּלְהִלָּאָה בְּשֵׁמוֹת הַסְּפִירוֹת

And they are also called from then on by the names of the *sefirot* as we now know them:

כח"ב חג"ת נהי"מ, ובשם אֲצִילוֹת,

keter-chochmah-binah; chesed-gevurah-tiferet; netzach-hod-yesod-malchut, and that world itself is known by the name Atzilut.

וְזֶהוּ מָה שֶׁאָמַר הָאָרִיז"ל, בְּשֵׁעַר הַצֶּלֶם פ"א וּבְשֵׁעַר הַשְּׁמוֹת פ"א
ובכ"מ,

The following are the words of the Arizal in *Etz Chaim Sha'ar HaTzelem* chapter 1 and *Shaar HaShemot* chapter 1, and in a number of other places:

כִּי כָל הָאֲצִילוֹת כָּלוּ הוּא אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוּר אֶחָד יָחִיד וּמִיּוֹחָד,

All of Atzilut is wholly Godliness, one, unique and united.

כִּי הָרִי מַעַת אֲשֶׁר זָכוּ לְשֵׁם הָאֲצִילוֹת,

Because from the time that they were worthy of being called Atzilut,

וְהוּא מֵאַחֵר אֲשֶׁר הִתְיַחַד עִמָּהֶם וְכִנְזָכָר,

i.e. from when He united Himself with them, as mentioned,

הִנֵּה מֵאֵז וּלְהִלָּאָה הָיָה הָאֲצִילוֹת בְּאַמֶּת אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוּר עַל יָדוֹ וְכָכָל
מָה שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ.

from then on Atzilut was truly wholly Godliness, because of this and everything else we explained above.

וע' בזה בדברינו בספר הדע"ה ח"א דרוש ה' סי' ז'.

See further in *Sefer HaDe'ah* section 1 drush 5:7

שם הארכנו בזה ובארנו כל זה באר היטיב, ע"ש ותמצא כל
מבקשך בענינים הללו:

where we explain at length and clarify this subject well. Search
there and you will find what you seek regarding these matters.

והנה כל העשר ספירן כלם הנה הגם שהם נעלה ומרומם
במדרגה ומעלה

Now all the ten *sefirot*, even though they are of a very lofty and
exalted status,

וגבוהים מאד מתכנת כל נברא,

far above the qualities of all created beings,

אמנם בעצמותם ותכונתם המתחס להם

nevertheless, the essence and the character associated with
them with the *sefirot* of Atzilut

הנה יש בהם מצד עצמם (ר"ל זולת יחודו בהם)

in and of themselves (aside from His unification in them) they
have

כל הענינים כלם וכל הסדר כלו כמו בהעולמות ב"ע.

all of the same conceptual content, and the same entire order of
that of the lower Worlds of Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah.

ואדרבה הוא, כי בהם הוא השורש לכל זה.

On the contrary, it is in them the *sefirot* of Atzilut that the root
of all these aspects of BiY"A is to be found, and therefore these
similarities exist.

והוא כי גם עקר כל מציאותם הם ג"כ רק השרשים לכל המציאות
דבי"ע

For their existence the existence of the *sefirot* of Atzilut is primarily to serve as the roots of the existence of BiY" A²⁰

ולכן מסדרים הם ג"כ בכל הענינים אשר בהבי"ע בבחינת שרש
להם.

and therefore they the *sefirot* of Atzilut are arranged in exactly the same manner as in BiY" A, as constituting their root.

אלא שבכל עולם ועולם הוא לפי ערכו ולפי מהותו ועצמותו
המתיחס אליו.

The only difference being that the manifestation of the *sefirot* in each of the worlds is according to the character and essence associated with it with each world.

וכשם שמהות כל האצילות הרי הוא נעלם מכל נברא

Just as the inner nature of all of Atzilut is concealed from all created beings,

משום שהוא נעלה ומרומם מהם,

since it is so exalted and elevated above them,

כן הוא נעלם מלהשיג איך שעומדים שם כל אותן הענינים כלם
ג"כ, גם ברוממות מעלתם,

so too is it masked from our comprehension how all the features of the lower worlds are also present there, even in the very loftiest echelons.

אבל עכ"פ הוא כי לפי ערכם המתיחס להם

But in any event this is so, and however worthy the stature attributed to them is,

הנה ישנו בהם כל הענינים אשר בהעולמות בי"ע.

all the same concepts manifested in the worlds of BiY" A are found in them too.

כי אדרבה הוא שבאצילות הוא היסוד והשרש לכל זה.

And on the contrary, that which is in Atzilut is the foundation and root of all these qualities in the lower worlds.

ושם הוא הכל בעצם, וכמ"ש הגר"א בספר יצירה פ"א משנה ב' אפן ג'.

But there everything is an integral part of the essence of the World of Atzilut, as the Gaon of Vilna writes in his commentary to *Sefer Yetzira* 1:2, third approach:

כי כל דבר שהוא במקרה הו בשרשם בעצם

Anything that appears here as happenstance has its roots in the essence,

ועמיד שם בהוה תמיד, כי כל האצילות הרי הוא אלהות כנזכר:

where it is exists in the continuous present, since Atzilut is indeed Godliness, as mentioned.

והענין הוא כי הנה המאציל ית"ש אשר נתפשט ומתלבש באורו

The concept is as follows: the blessed Emanator spread forth and clothed His light

בכל הספירות דאצילות ונעשה חד עמהם

in all the *sefirot* of Atzilut, and became one with them.

הנה הוא פועל ופועל על ידיהם את כל המציאות דבי"ע בכמותם ואיכותם וכל עניניהם ופעלותיהם.

Now by means thereof i.e. via the *sefirot* of Atzilut He brought into being, and He continues to sustain the existence of the

**Worlds of BiY"A in quantity and quality in all matters
pertaining to them and in all their effects.**

הכל ע"פ סדר אותן הענינים המסדר באצילות לפי ערך המתיחס
שם,

**Everything is according to the structure of those matters as
arranged in Atzilut, and according to the principles that
pertain there.**

וזהו גלוייו ית"ש אשר נתגלה באצילות.

And this is His revelation as it is revealed in Atzilut,

היינו במציאות התהוות הנאצלים עצמן

**that is to say, in bringing into being the emanations of Atzilut
itself**

והתלבשו בהם ויחדו עמם בכל סדרם וענינם.

**and clothing Himself within them and uniting with them
throughout their structure and the principles that pertain there,**

ולפעל על ידיהם את כל המציאות דהבי"ע בכל אותו הסדר
והענינים ג"כ,

**and via them, the entire existence of BiY"A is imbued with that
same entire structure and the principles that pertain there as
well.**

וע"י כ"ז הנה נתגלה להקרא בשם.

By means of all this He becomes revealed to be called by Name

כי ע"י התלבשו וגלוייו באצילות ובכל עניני הנזכר,

**– by clothing Himself in the *sefirot* and His revelations in Atzilut
in all the matters mentioned,**

הנה נתגלה להקרא בשמו הגדול שהוא השם הנה ב"ה

He becomes revealed so that He can be called by His great Name, the blessed Name Havaye the ineffable Name,

ובְּכָל הַשְּׁמוֹת הַמְּסֻתָּעִים מִמֶּנּוּ, וַכְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ לִפִּי מַעֲשֵׂי אֲנִי
נִקְרָא,

and all the other holy Names that derive from that Name, as we explained previously, "according to My deeds I am called."

כִּי הַשְּׁמוֹת הֵם עֲצָמָם עֲצָם כָּל הַכּוֹחוֹת וְהַפְעָלוֹת,

This is because the Names themselves are those very powers and actions,

וְהִרִי יֵצֵא מֵעַתָּה לְהִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם.

and thus He emerged from now on to be called by Name.

וְהוּא גִלּוּי הַרְבִּיעִי מִמְּדֻרְגַת אֲמִתּוֹת הַנִּעְלָמָה,

This is the fourth revelation from His true concealed being

וְהוּא בְּחִי גִלּוּי אֲשֶׁר בִּפְעֻלָּה מִמֶּשׁ.

– His revelation of Himself within His deeds, literally.

וּבִזְהָ הִנֵּה הִנֵּה הוּא ית"ש שֶׁרֶשׁ כָּל נִמְצָא וְיִסּוּד כָּל נִבְרָא.

In this manner He becomes the root of everything in existence, and the foundation of all created things.

וְהוּא ע"פ מָה שֶׁאָמְרָנוּ שֶׁהָאֲצִילוֹת הוּא הַיִּסּוּד וְהַשֶּׁרֶשׁ דְּכָל
הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע עִם כָּל עֲנִינֵיהֶם,

This concurs with our statement that Atzilut is the foundation and the root of all the Worlds of BiY" A and all of their aspects,

וְהוּא עִם הָאֲצִילוֹת הִרִי הוּא חֵד עִמָּהֶם כִּנ"ל

and He, as He clothes Himself in Atzilut and becomes one with Atzilut, is one with them (the lower worlds) as well, as mentioned above.

וא"כ הרי נתגלה ע"י התלבשו באצילות להיות שרש הכל. והבו כ"ז היטיב:

This being so, He becomes revealed by clothing Himself in Atzilut where He becomes the root of everything. Understand all this well!

והנה זהו שאמרו בזהר הקדוש ויקרא י"א ב' בענין העשרה שמות

This is in fact what the holy *Zohar* states (*Vayikra* 11b) regarding the Ten Names,

דעשר ספי' דאצילות שאמרנו לעיל פ"ב,

which correspond to the ten *sefirot* mentioned above in chapter 2.

אמרו שם ואילין אנון כתרין קדישין דמלכא, דהוא אשתמודע בהו

This is what they said there: "These are the holy crowns of the King; through them He is known

ואינון שמיה ('שמתלבש בהם ומתגלה בהם בכל הגלויים הנז')
והוא אנון עכ"ל.

(because He is clothed within them and reveals Himself in them in all the manners of revelation mentioned). They are His Name, and He is them."

והוא ע"פ מה שאמרנו כי כל האצילות הוא מעתה הוא עצמו ית"ש.

This concurs with what we stated earlier that the entire Atzilut from now on is He himself, blessed is He,

אשר נתגלה בזה הוא עצמו אחר שיירד ממדרגה למדרגה.

for in this way He Himself is revealed, having descended level after level,

שהוא מדרגה הרביעית מאמתתו הנעלמה.

this being the fourth level from His true hidden being.

ובמדרגה הרביעי הזה הנה יצא בבחינת פעלה מממש.

It is at this fourth level that His actual effects emerge

ונתגלה בו כביכול בבחינת יציאה מן הכח אל הפעל.

and where He becomes revealed, so to speak, as emerging from potential to actual.

והנה הוא גלוי גמור והוא גלוי שמו.

This is full revelation – the revelation of His Name –

וכמו שיתבאר עקר הדברים בזה לקמן פ"ו בעה"י:

the main points of which will be explained below in chapter 6, God willing.

Footnotes

1. As we noted at the end of the previous chapter "two that are four" is a fairly common Rabbinic statement in the *Mishnah* (e.g. *Shabbat* 1:1; *Sh'vuot* 2:1; *Nega'im* 1:1). The intention is to classify a subject broadly and then specify sub-categories. [↩](#)
2. The mystery of the Divine Will as explained in the previous chapter. [↩](#)
3. The concept of God 'thinking to Himself' (so to speak), as explained in the previous chapter. [↩](#)

4. In the text the ten *sefirot* are listed in abbreviated form, with the first six arranged in triads *k-ch-b*; *ch-g-t*, and then the last four as a group *n-h-y-m* [↩](#)
5. In the text the ten *sefirot* are again listed in abbreviated form, as in the previous footnote. [↩](#)
6. Cf. Isaiah 43:7: כָּל הַנִּקְרָא בְּשֵׁמִי וְלִכְבוֹדִי בִּרְאֵיתִי יֵצְרֵתִי אֵךְ עֲשִׂיתִי – a verse that alludes to all four Worlds. See *Pardes* 16:1. [↩](#)
7. 1:4. [↩](#)
8. *Tikunei Zohar*, Intro. p. 19a. [↩](#)
9. An alternative translation: "You shall not give credence to other gods in My Presence." [↩](#)
10. Alternatively: "My Countenance." [↩](#)
11. Alternatively: "My Countenance." [↩](#)
12. *Matok Midvash* on the *Zohar ad loc.* [↩](#)
13. *Matok Midvash* on the *Zohar ad loc.* [↩](#)
14. Here ends the quote from the *Zohar.* [↩](#)
15. Rabbi Menachem Recanati (late 13th C to early 14th C) was an Italian Kabbalist who wrote a Kabbalistic commentary on the Torah, another on the Prayers and a third on the Mitzvot. [↩](#)
16. Rabbi Meanchem Tzioni, a 14th C German Kabbalist who wrote a Kabbalistic commentary on the Torah, and a commentary on *Sefer Yetzirah.* [↩](#)
17. Rabbeinu Bachye (d. 1340) was a Spanish Kabbalist who wrote a commentary on the Torah combining various modes

of explanation, including Kabbalah. He also authored several other works. [↩](#)

18. See *Eitz Chaim*, *Sha'ar HaKlalim* ch. 2; *sha'ar* 9:1; 10:1; 11:7; 13:3. [↩](#)

19. *Zohar III*, *Nasso*. [↩](#)

20. The Divine intention is not the revelations themselves, even the loftiest revelations, but rather Torah and mitzvot in this world. It may be argued that this follows from what is later taught in this text that all that happens above, so to speak, is for the sake of what takes place below. [↩](#)

Chapter 5 — The fifth level of the revelation of Divine Light, the worlds of Bi" a (briaḥ, yetzira, asiya).

Sha'ar 4 Chapter 5

Various aspects of His Revelations

הַמְדַּרְגָּה הַחֲמִישִׁית מִגְּלוּיָיו הוּא מָה שֶׁיֵּצֵא אֶחָ"כ לַפֶּעַל ע"י
הָאֲצִילוֹת

The fifth level of His revelations following Atzilut, the fourth-level, **is what emerged afterwards to bring about, via Atzilut,**

אֶת כָּל הַמְּצִיאוֹת דִּהְיוּלָמוֹת בִּי"ע [בְּרִיָּאָה, יִצְרָה, עֲשֶׂיהָ]

the entire existence of the Worlds of BiY" A [Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah]

בְּכָל מְצִיאוֹתָם בְּכָל וּבְפָרֵט וּבְכָל עֲנִינֵיהֶם וְתִהְיוּכֹתֵיהֶם,

in all of their existence in general and specifically, and in all of the matters associated with them and the way in which they operate,

אֲשֶׁר מֵעַתָּה שֶׁנִּבְרָאוּ וְנוֹצְרוּ וְנַעֲשׂוּ עַד סוֹף זְמַן קִיּוֹמָם,

from the time that they were created, formed, and made until the end of their existence.

'Created' alludes to Beriah, 'formed' alludes to Yetzirah, 'made' alludes to Asiyah.

שֶׁהוּא כָּל הַהִנְהָגָה אֲשֶׁר עַד עַתָּה הִתְקוֹן הָעֵתִיד.

This includes **the entire manner in which they are divinely guided** or conducted **until their future *tikun*.**

הנה כ"ז הוא גלויי החמישית שיוצא ומתגלה מגלויי הרביעי שבאצילות.

All of this is His fifth revelation that emerges out of, and is revealed from, His fourth revelation – that is Atzilut.

והוא המציאות והנהגת דהעולמות בי"ע שברא ויצר ועשה

This is the existence and divine guidance of the Worlds of BiY"A which He created, formed and made,

ומנהיג אותם ע"י גלויי שבאצילות.

and which He guides via His revelation in Atzilut.

וירדתו בפעלת הבי"ע הוא גלויי החמישי

This descent into bringing the Worlds of BiY"A into reality is His fifth revelation

שהוא מדרגה החמישי מאמתתו הנעלמה ית"ש:

– the fifth level from His true concealed Being, blessed is His Name.

והנה הגלוי הראשון הרי אִמְרָנוּ לְעִיל פ"ג שהוא נקרא בִּשְׁם אֵין סוף,

Now the first revelation we mentioned above in chapter 3 is called *Ein Sof*,

וכמו שאִמְרָנוּ שֵׁם ש"ס הוא ג"כ מכלל הגלויים.

and as we said there *Ein Sof* is also in the category of revelation, which is why we refer to this revelation as *Ohr Ein Sof*, the revelation of *Ein Sof*

וכן נקרא הוא ג"כ בִּשְׁם מַאֲצִיל עֲלִיוֹן.

and also as Supernal Emanator (*Ma'atzil Elyon*),

וְכֵן הוּא נִקְרָא עוֹד בְּשֵׁם עֶלְת עַל כָּל הָעֲלוֹת ע' זוה"ק [זהר הקדוש]
בְּרֵאשִׁית כ"ב ע"ב.

**and he is also called Exalted over all the exalted ones (see
Zohar, Bereishit 22b).**

וְהַגְלוֹי הַשֵּׁנִי הוּא הַצִּמְצוּם וְהַקוֹ, וְכֵן נִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם טְהִירוֹ עֲלָאָה.

**The second revelation is the *tzimtzum* and the *kav*, also called
the 'supernal clear light', the word טְהִירוֹ is an Aramaic word for
light**

וְכֵן בְּשֵׁם אָוִיר קַדְמוֹן, אָוִירָא קַדְמָאָה סְתִימָאָה, אָוִירָא עֲלָאָה. ע'
זֶהַר בְּרֵאשִׁית ט"ו א' ט"ז ב'.

**and primordial 'space'¹ (*avir kadmon*), or the hidden supernal
'space' (*avira kadma'a ila'a*), or ethereal 'space' (*avira ila'a*) See
Zohar Bereishit 15a, 16b**

וְהַגְלוֹי הַשְּׁלִישִׁי שֶׁהוּא אָדָם קַדְמוֹן, וְכֵן נִקְרָא הוּא בְּשֵׁם כְּתָר עֲלִיוֹן
סְתֵם וְטָמִיר.

**The third Revelation is Adam Kadmon which is also called
supernal *keter*, which is hidden and concealed.**

ע' תְּקוּנִים תְּקוּן ע' קל"ח א'.

See *Tikunim* (*Tikunei Zohar*), *Tikun 70*, page 138a.

וְהִנֵּה אֱלוֹי הַב' שֶׁהֵם גְּלוֹי הַב' וְהַג', הִנֵּה הֵם כְּלוּלִים בְּהָא'.

**Now these two just mentioned as the second and third
revelation are actually included in the first,**

וְהֵם נִקְרָאִים בְּשֵׁם עוֹלָמוֹת דָּאִין סוּף כִּי הֵם בּוֹ עֲצָמוֹ,

**and they are called the Infinite Worlds, because they are as yet
within Him,**

הָרְצוֹן וְהַמְחֻשָּׁבָה וְהַהֲרֹחוֹר שֶׁבּוֹ כָּנָ"ל פ"ג.

and are referred to as *ratzon*, *machshava* and *hirhur* as discussed in chapter 3 of this section.

וְאֵלֹהֵי הַג' גְּלוּיִם הֵם בְּסוּד אֶפְסֵי, אִין, א"א (אֲרִיךְ אֲנֹפִין).

[These three revelations are also the mystery of Nothingness, non-being² and *Arich Anpin*

וְכֵן רַדל"א [רִישָׁא דְלֹא אֲתִידַע] עֲתִיק (כִּי רַדל"א הוּא הַג' רִאשׁוֹנִים שְׁבוּ [עֲתִיק הוּא הַז' תַּחְתּוֹנִים שְׁבוּ] א"א,

And are also known as *Radl"a* [*Reisha d'lo ityada* – the 'head' which cannot be known], *Atik* (since *Radl"a* refers to the first three *sefirot* of *keter*, while *Atik* refers to the lower seven) and *Arich Anpin*

וְכֵן הֵם הַג' צַחְצָחוֹת הָעֲלִיוֹנִים הַכִּלְלִיִּים.

and also as the three supernal, inclusive 'brilliant illuminations'

וְכֵן סוּד הַג' רִישִׁין הַכִּלְלִיִּים. וְהַשִּׁי"ת יִכְפֹּר.

also referred to as the mystery of the three all-inclusive heads.³ May God grant me forgiveness for divulging these secrets.

וְע' בַּהֲגֵר"א בְּתִקּוּנִים רִישׁ תִּקּוּן ע' דָּף קל"ח ע"א וּבִתְז"ח [תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר חֲדָשׁ] דָּף נ' ע"א ד"ה בְּרִישׁ]:

See GR "A *Tikunim*, *Tikun 70*, p. 138a; *Tikunei Zohar Chadash* p. 50a, starting with the words *B'reish*]. The note ends here.

וְהִנֵּה כָּל אֵלֹהֵי הַג' גְּלוּיִם הָרִאשׁוֹנִים הֵנָּה הֵגֶם שְׁאֲנֹ קוֹרְאִים אוֹתָם בְּשֵׁם גְּלוּיִם

Now all these first three revelations, even though we refer to them as 'revelations,'

אֲךְ אֵינָם גְּלוּיִם אֲלֵא רַק בְּעֶרְךָ אֲמַתְתָּן הַנִּעְלָמָה ית"ש אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה.

are not actually revelations per se, but only relative to their true concealed Source above, may His Name be blessed.

וּבְעֶרְךָ זֶה הָיָה בְּחִי' א"ס וְהָעוֹלָמוֹת דא"ס ג"כ מְכַלֵּל הַגְּלוּיִם וְכַנ"ל
פ"ג.

But relative to that to His concealed essence the aspects of *Ein Sof*⁴ and the infinite worlds are in the category of revelation, as noted in chapter 3.

אָבֵל בְּאַמֶּת הִנֵּה הֵם אֵינָם גְּלוּיִם מִמֶּשׁ כָּלֵל מֵאַחַר שֶׁהֵם רַק
בְּבַחֲיִנַת מַחֲשָׁבָה וְרָצוֹן,

Although in truth they are not really 'revelations' at all, since they are merely the aspects of *machshava* (internal thought) and *ratzon* (will)

וּבא"ס עֲצָמוֹ ית"ש אֲשֶׁר אֵין בוֹ שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה כָּלֵל בְּשׁוּם אוֹת וּנְקָדָה

in the *Ein Sof* Himself, blessed be His Name, which no letter or vowel point can express.

וא"כ הֵרִי הוּא נֶעְלָם מִכָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת שְׁלֵמָטָה בְּתַכְלִית הַהֶעָלָם

It follows that He is hidden from all the worlds below with the utmost concealment.

וְכֵן גַּם הָקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם וְאָדָם קִדְמָאָה שֶׁהֵם מֵהָעוֹלָמוֹת דא"ס

Similarly, even the *kav* and the *tzimtzum* and *Adam Kadmon*, which are in the category of the Infinite Worlds,

הֵם כֻּלָּם טָמִיר וְנֶעְלָם מִפְּלֹא וּמִכֶּסֶה:

are all also hidden and concealed, invisible and obscured.

אֲמָנָם הַגְּלוּי הָרְבִיעִי שֶׁאֲמָרְנוּ אֲשֶׁר בוֹ יֵצֵא מִן הַכַּח אֶל הַפְּעַל
כְּבִיכּוֹל

However, the fourth revelation that we mentioned – the World of Atzilut – by which He emerged from a state of potential to actual, so to speak,

הנה שם הוא עקר גלוי כי שם נתגלה המאציל א"ס ית"ש

that is where the primary revelation takes place, for it is there that the blessed Infinite Emanator is revealed

להקרא בשם גמור והוא השם הוי"ה ב"ה, והוא גלוי
שבהאצילות.

in a manner that He can be referred to by an actual name, the Name *Havaye*⁵, may He be blessed, and this is His revelation in Atzilut.

כי ע"י התלבשו באצילות ויחודו בהם, ר"ל בהעשר ספירות.

By means of clothing Himself in Atzilut, and manifesting His Oneness therein, that is to say, in the ten *sefirot*,

נקרא המאציל א"ס עצמו יהו"ה ב"ה וכנ"ל.

the Infinite Emanator Himself is called *Havaye*, blessed is He, as mentioned above.

והרי הוא גלוי מממש כי נתגלה להקרא בשם שהוא שם העצם
ית"ש:

Now this is indeed revelation, for He is revealed in a manner that He can be called by Name, the Essential Name, may His Name be blessed.

אך הגלוי החמישי אשר נתגלה בו במציאות העולמות בי"ע.

However, the fifth revelation, which becomes manifest in the Worlds of BiY" A,

הנה הוא נקרא בשם אלהים,

is referred to by the Name *Elokim*,

וְהוּא מָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (בראשית א א) בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים

as is stated in the verse (Gensis 1:1), "**In the beginning God (*Elokim*) created...**"

וְכֵן הוּא בְּכָל הָעֲשָׂרָה מֵאֲמֵרוֹת כָּלֵם וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים,

Indeed, all of the Ten Utterances through which the world was created**⁶ begin with the words "**And *Elokim* said...**"

כִּי גִלּוּיוֹ בְּכָל הַמְּצִיאוֹת דְּהָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע הוּא רַק בְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים.

since what He reveals of Himself throughout the existence of the Worlds of BiY "A is only in the Name *Elokim*

, עֵין שֵׁם הַיָּטִיב (עֵין זוּה"ק בְּרֵאשִׁית כ' ע"א),

(See *Zohar Bereishit 20a*). Delve into that passage well,

ובהגר"א בספד"צ [ספרא דצניעותא] ספ"ה ד"ה כְּתִיב וַיִּתְּהֵלךְ

and see the commentary of the GR" A to *Sifra d'Tzniuta* end of chap. 5, the words beginning "It is written, 'And he Enoch walked together with...'"⁷

וְשֵׁם פ"ג ד"ה כְּתִיב וַיֹּאמֶר, וְהוּא גִימְטְרִיָּא הַכֶּסֶּא

Also *ibid.* chap. 3, the words beginning "It is written, 'And he said...' " where he explains that the Name *Elokim* has the numerical value *gematria* of 'the Throne' – both add up to 86 –

שֶׁהוּא עוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה הַנִּקְרָא כֶּסֶּא הַכְּבוֹד ע"ש

which is the World of Beriah, called 'the Throne of Glory,' (see there)

שֶׁעָלָיו שׁוֹרָה אוֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש אֲשֶׁר בְּאֲצִילוֹת.

upon which rests the light of His holiness as it is in Atzilut.

וְשֵׁם מִתְגַּלֶּה כְּבוֹדוֹ שֶׁהוּא שְׁכִינָתוֹ ית"ש הַמִּתְפַּשֵּׁט וְשׁוֹכֵן בַּהֲבִי"ע.

And it is there that His Glory is revealed. This is the blessed Shechinah, which spreads forth to and lodges in BiY"A,

כִּי שֵׁם, ר"ל בְּעוֹלָם הַבְּרִיאָה, הֵנָּה שֵׁם הוּא הַבֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁל
מַעֲלָה

since there, i.e. in the World of Beriah, is the Supernal Temple,

הַמִּכּוֹן כְּנָגֵד בִּיהֶמ"ק שֶׁל מָטָה,

which corresponds precisely⁸ to the Temple below.

וְנִקְרָא בִּיהֶמ"ק שֶׁל מַעֲלָה בְּשֵׁם כְּסֵא הַכְּבוֹד, וּבִיהֶמ"ק שֶׁל מָטָה
בְּשֵׁם הַדּוֹם רַגְלָיו.

The Supernal Temple is called "the Throne of Glory," and the Temple below is called "His footrest,"

וְכַמ"ש בְּדִבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א' כ"ח, הֲ9 לְבָנוֹת בֵּית כו' לַהֲדוֹם רַגְלָיו
אֱלֹהֵינוּ,

as the verse states (I Chronicles 28:2) "...to build a House of rest for the Ark of the Covenant of God, as a footrest for our Lord..."

ע' דִּבְרֵינוּ בְּאַרְכָּה בְּזֶה בְּסֵפֶר הַדַּע"ה ח"א דְּרוֹשׁ ה' ס' ז'.

See at length our *Sefer haDe'ah* part 1, *drush* 5:7

וְעַכ"פּ הוּא כִּי גִלּוּי ית"ש אֲשֶׁר בְּהַעֲלָמוֹת בִּי"ע הֵנָּה הוּא בְּשֵׁם
אֱלֹהִים.

In any event, what He reveals of Himself in the Worlds of BiY"A is through the Name *Elokim*,

אָבֶל הָאוֹר דֶּהשֵׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה הוּא גָנוּז וְנֶעְלָם שָׁם וְגִלּוֹ הוּא רַק
בְּאַצִּילוֹת:

whereas the light of the blessed Name *Havaye* is concealed and hidden there, and is revealed only in Atzilut.

אִמָּנָם כָּל עֵקֶר הַגִּלּוֹי דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים

In fact, the primary revelation of the Name *Elokim*

הוּא מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְנִמְשָׁךְ רַק מִגִּלּוֹי ית"ש אֲשֶׁר בִּהְשֵׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה.

flows forth from, and is drawn only from His revelation that is within the Name *Havaye*, blessed is He.

כִּי אֱלֹהִים שְׁמִסְפָּרוֹ פ"ו הִיא נִמְשָׁךְ וְיוֹצֵא מִהַמְלּוֹי דְּמִסְפָּר הַשֵּׁם
הוּי"ה ב"ה

This is because the numerical value or *gematria* of *Elokim*, which is 86, is drawn from and emerges out of the *milui of the numerical value (*gematria*) of the Name *Havaye*,**

*The *milui* of any letter is its full iteration when spelled out. E.g. the letter א spelled out in full is אל"ף (*aleph = aleph, lamed, pai*). The *Baal HaLeshem* uses the same idea here to expand the numerical value of the Name *Havaye*

שְׁמִסְפָּרוֹ הוּא כ"ו, וּמִלּוּי הוּא כ"ף ו"ו, וְהִרִי הָוָה הַמְלּוֹי פ"ו,

whose numerical value (*gematria*) is 26 since $20 = כ$ and $6 = ו$, and the *milui* of which is written out as כ"ף ו"ו – thus the *milui* (i.e. the additional letters *besides* the כ and ו) is $86 = פ"ו$.

וְלָכֵן 'מִלּוּי' גִּימְטְרִיָּא אֱלֹהִים (ע"ח תְּקוּן ג')

Thus the *milui* of the *gematria* of the Name *Havaye* is the *gematria* of *Elokim* = 86,

כִּי הִיא נִמְשָׁךְ מִמִּסְפָּר הַמְלּוֹי לְבַד,

since it is drawn only from the *gematria* of the *milui* but not from the *gematria* of the Name *Havaye* itself.

וכן הוא עוד כי השם הוי"ה דאלפין

Furthermore, the Name *Havaye* when spelled out with the *aleph-milui*

The letters of the Name *Havaye* itself can be spelled in a number of ways: the *milui* of the first letter *yud* is always the same – יו"ד, but the *milui* of the last three letters of the Name can be spelled with the *yud-milui* $72 = \text{יו"ד ה"י ויו"ו ה"י}$, the *aleph-milui* $45 = \text{יו"ד ה"א}$, the *hai-milui* $52 = \text{יו"ד ה"ה ו"ו ה"ה}$, or with a *yud-aleph* combination $63 = \text{יו"ד ה"י וא"ו ה"י}$. Now the *aleph-milui*

שהוא בְּחִי הָרוּחַ הַכִּלְי דְּאֲצִילוֹת וְגִלוּי,

is the aspect of the inclusive *ruach* of Atzilut and its revelation

The 72 value name (with the *yud-milui*) is the soul-level of *yechida* consciousness; the 63 value name (a *yud-aleph* combination) is the level of *chaya* consciousness; the 45 value name (the *aleph-milui*) is the level of *ruach* consciousness, and the 52 value name (the *hai-milui*) is the level of *nefesh* consciousness, as will be explained shortly.

וכמ"ש אֵלֶיהוּ זָכוֹר לְטוֹב מְלָגָאֻ אִיהוּ יו"ד ה"א נָא ו"ו ה"א דְּאִיהוּ
אֶרֶח אֲצִילוֹת

As Eliyahu (who is remembered for the good) stated: "Within i.e. within the *sefirot*, which is the outer aspect, is the animating and illuminating consciousness – יו"ד ה"א נָא ו"ו ה"א – which is the path of Atzilut i.e. the manner in which the soul-consciousness is drawn down into Atzilut. ¹⁰

וְהוּא הַשֵּׁם הַמְפָּרֵשׁ הָעֶקְרִי כְּשֶׁהוּא בְּנִקּוּד מוֹצֵא אוֹתִיּוֹתָיו
[הַפְּשׁוּטִים חֲצֵקֶצ (=חִירִיק, צִירִי, קִמֶץ, צִירִי)].

[This is the explicit and primary Name, whose vowel-points articulating the basic letters of the Name are *chirik*, *tzeirei*,

kametz, tzeirei].¹¹

וְהָיָא גִימְטְרִיא מ"ה, וּבְמַלּוּי הוּא מ"ם ה"א שְׁמִסְסֵרוּ פ"ו כְּמִסְפֵּר
אֱלֹהִים,

The numerical value (*gematria*) of the letters of the name together with their *milui* is 45 (in Hebrew letters 45 = מ"ה), and with the *milui* of 86 = א"ה ס"ח – מ"ה – מ"ה, the same *gematria* as the name אלהים – *Elokim*.

כִּי מִמֶּנּוּ עֲצָמוּ הֵנָּה נִמְשָׁךְ וּמִתְגַּלָּה בְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים.

Thus in and of itself the name Havaye is drawn down and revealed by the name *Elokim*

וְהוּא כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע שְׁנַעֲשִׂים בְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים.

as all the worlds of BiY"A, which are created with the name *Elokim*.

הֵנָּה הֵם נַעֲשִׂים רַק מֵאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא הָאוֹר דֶּהשֵׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה

Thus they are made only from Atzilut, which is the light of the name Havaye,

וְכֵמוּ שִׁחְתָּם הַתּוֹרָה בְּסוּף כָּל מַעֲשֵׂה בְּרָאשִׁית (ב, ד)

in the same way that the Torah concludes the account of the work of Creation (Genesis 2, 4),

וְאָמַר בְּיוֹם עָשׂוֹת יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים אֶרֶץ וְשָׁמַיִם,

stating: "...on the day that *Havaye Elokim* made earth and heaven" using both Divine Names.

אֶלָּא שֶׁהָאוֹר דֶּהשֵׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה הוּא גָּנוּז וְנִעְלָם שָׁם,

However, the light of the name Havaye is concealed and obscured there,

וְגִלּוּיִים הוּא רַק בְּהַאֲוֹר דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים.

and the revelation is only from the light of the name *Elokim*.

וְכֵן הוּא אֱלֹהִים בְּגִימְטְרִיא הַטֵּבֶע כִּי בּוֹ נַעֲשֶׂה הַטֵּבֶע כָּלּוֹ.

It is also the case that the name *Elokim* is the same *gematria* as *hateva* – Nature,¹²

אֲלָא שְׁעָקְרוּ וְיִסּוּדוֹ הוּא הָאוֹר דְּהֵשֵׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה הַגָּנוּז בּוֹ

although the root and foundation of Nature is the light of the blessed Name *Havaye* that is concealed therein.

וְלָכֵן אֵין לְהַטֵּבֶע קִיּוֹם הַחֲלָטִי אֲלָא 'בְּרִצּוֹתוֹ חֻגֵּג וּבְרִצּוֹתוֹ מְמוֹגֵג'.

and therefore Nature has no absolute existence, but "when He wishes He extrudes [the glass] and when He wishes He melts it"¹³

וְע' בְּזֶה בְּדִבְרֵינוּ בְּסֵפֶר הַכְּלָלִים כָּלֵל ב' ענ"ג בְּאַרְכָּה.

See our comments on this in *Sefer HaKlalim*, klal 2:3 at length,

וּבַחֲלָק הַבְּאוּרִים בְּעֵגְלִים וְיֵשֶׁר עֲנָף ב' אוֹת י"ח וְאוֹת כ':

and the explanatory section of *Sha'ar Igulim v'Yosher* 2:18, 20.

אֲמָנָם מָה שְׁאֲמַרְנוּ שְׁאֵלּוֹ ב' הַגִּלּוּיִם, הָרַבִּיעִי וְהַחֲמִישִׁי,

However, as regards our earlier statement that these two revelations, the fourth and the fifth,

הֵם הַשְּׁמוֹת הוּי"ה אֱלֹהִים, וְהַגִּלּוּי דְּשֵׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה הוּא בְּאַצִּילוֹת

are the names *Havaye* and *Elokim*, and that the revelation of the blessed Name *Havaye* is in *Atzilut*,

וְהַגִּלּוּי דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים הוּא בְּעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

while the name *Elokim* is manifested in BiY"A,

הנה הוא רק בכללות ובעצמותם העקרי שבהם.

this is only in a general sense, in their primary essence,

כי כלל האצילות והעצמות העקרי שבו הוא השם הוי"ה ב"ה.

since Atzilut in general, and the primary essence within it, is the blessed Name *Havaye*.

וכלל העולמות בי"ע והעצמות העקרי שבהם הוא השם אלהים
הכללי

Whereas the Worlds of BiY"A in general, and the primary essence within them is in general the Name *Elokim*

המתפשט ויוצא מהשם הוי"ה הכללי דהאצילות.

which spreads forth and emerges from the general Name *Havaye* of Atzilut.

אבל בפרטיות הנה ישנם כל השמות כלם באצילות

But in specific terms, all the Names are present in Atzilut,¹⁴

כי הם בבחינת פנימית וחיצונית; נשמה, רוח, נפש; גוף, ולבוש
והיכל.

since they are expressed in the aspects of inner and outer;
neshama, ruach and *nefesh*; body, garment, chamber.¹⁵

ע' לקוטי הגר"א בסוף אגדות ברכות דף מ"ג ע"ב.

See *Likutei HaGra* end of *Agadot, Berachot* 43b.

וכן ישנם עד"ז כל השמות כלם בהעולמות בי"ע.

In a similar manner, all the Names are distributed throughout the Worlds of BiY"A,

וְהֵם נִבְחָנִים בְּכָל לִוְיָ וּפְרָטוֹת וּפְרָטֵי פְּרָטוֹת.

and they can be differentiated by whether they apply generally, specifically or in a particular instance of a specific situation,

וְכֵן בְּפָנִימִית וּפְנִימִית לְפָנִימִית, וּבַחִיצוֹנִית וְחִיצוֹנִית לַחִיצוֹנִית.

and whether they apply to the inner dimension or to the innermost aspect of the inner dimension, or to the outer dimension or to the outermost aspect of the outer dimension.

וְהֵם מִתְחַלְפִּים לְפִי עֶרֶךְ הַמַּדְרָגוֹת כִּי מָה שֶׁהוּא פְּנִימִית לָזֶה הוּא חִיצוֹנִית לָזֶה.

They also change according to the stature of the various levels, for what is the inner dimension in one situation, is the outer dimension in another.

וְכֵן מִתְחַלְפִּים תָּמִיד בְּגִלּוּיִם, לְפִי מַצֵּב הָעוֹלָמוֹת וְזִכּוּתָם וּלְפִי הַעֵת וְהַזְמַן.

There are also constant changes in terms of revelation, according to the status of the worlds and their refinement, and according to the time and the season,

וְאֵינוּ יוֹמָה יוֹם אֶחָד לַחֲבֵרוֹ וְשָׁעָה אַחַת לַחֲבֵרָתָהּ

so that one day is not similar to another, and one hour is not the same as another –

אֲבָל כָּל־שֵׁם יִשְׁנָם בְּכָל־אֶלָּא שֶׁזֶה בְּהֶעֱלָם וְזֶה בְּגִלּוּי.

instead, all of them all of the Names are present at all levels, just that at any level a certain Name may be concealed, while another is revealed.

וְעֵין בָּזֶה בְּאַרְכָּה בְּתִקּוּנִים תִּקּוּן כ"ב דף ע"ב ב' וע"ג א'.

See at length *Tikunim*, *Tikun 22*, p. 72b, 73a¹⁶

וְאָמַר שֵׁם דְּלְבוּשֵׁין אִיהוּ מְשַׁתַּנִּי בְּהוֹן לְכַמָּה שְׁנוּנִין

where it states that He 'changes His garments' a number of times –

וּלְבוּשֵׁין דְּאֵהוּ לְבוּשׁ בְּצַפְרָא לֹא לְבִישׁ בְּרִמְשָׁא

the garments He wears in the morning He does not wear in the evening,

וּלְבוּשֵׁין דְּלְבִישׁ יוֹמָא חֲדָא לֹא לְבִישׁ יוֹמָא תַּנְיָנָא.

and the garments He wears one day, He doesn't wear a second day,

וְהֵכִי בְּכָל יוֹמָא וְיָרֵחָא וְשַׁתָּא וְשַׁבָּתָא וְיוֹמִין טָבִין כּו' כּו'.

and so too every day, every month, every year, every Sabbath and Yom Tov... He changes His garments.

וּמִלְגָּאוּ מִיְנֵה כּו' נִהִיר קב"ה דְּאֵהוּ הַיְיָ"ה, כְּנִשְׁמָתָא בְּגוּפָא, לְגוּ
מִכָּלָא

And inside of those garments shines the Holy One, blessed be He, who is *Havaye*, and like the soul within the body in man, He is within everything,

הֵהוּא דְּאַחִיד כָּלָא וְקָשֶׁר כָּלָא כּו' דְּבְכָל חַד וְחַד רָשִׁים אַרְבַּע אַתָּון
כו'.

He unifies all things and binds all things together... and in each one of them in every creature is engraved the four letters of His Name.

עוֹד שֵׁם דָּף ע"ב סוּף ע"א: וְכָל חַד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל דְּהוּא אָמַר נַעֲשֶׂה
וְנִשְׁמַע

Also there in the *Tikunim*, p. 72a¹⁷ it states: ****Each Israelite who declared '**Whatever God says, we will do, and we will obey'** (Exodus 24:7)

הָהָה שְׂרָא בְּפִמִּיה וְהָה אוֹלִיף לִיה אוֹרִיָּתָא כָּלָה.

an angel rested upon his mouth and taught him the entire Torah.¹⁸

וּלְבַתֵּר מִלִּיל עֲמָהוֹן מִן שְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא, הֵה"ד מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם הַשְּׁמִיעַךְ
אֶת קִלּוֹ...

And after this He spoke to them from the heavens and the earth, as the verse (Deuteronomy 4:36) states, "From the heavens He enabled you to hear His voice..."

וְעַל הָאָרֶץ הִרְאָךְ אֶת אֲשׁוֹ הַגְּדוֹלָה כּו'.

and upon the earth He showed you His great fire..."

לְבַתֵּר הָהָה מִמִּלְל עֲמָהוֹן מֵאַרְבַּע סְטָרִין כּו'

After this He spoke to them from all four directions at once

לְאַחְזָאָה דְּמְכָל אֲתֵר מִלִּיל עֲמָהוֹן וְלֹא הָהָה אֲתֵר לְעֵלָא וְתַתָּא דְּלֹא
מִלִּיל עֲמָהוֹן.

to demonstrate that from every place He spoke to them, and there was no place above or below from which He did not speak to them,

לְאַחְזָאָה ד' מְלֵא כָּל הָאָרֶץ כְּבוֹדוֹ.

showing that 'the whole world is filled with His glory' (Isaiah 6:3).

דָּאָהוּ סְבִיל עֲלָאִין וְתַתָּאִין וְאִיהוּ סְמִיךְ עֲלָא וְתַתָּא כּו'

For He upholds the upper and the lower worlds,

אִיהוּ סְבִיל כּוֹלָא וְקֶשֶׁר כּוֹלָא וּמִיַּחַד כּוֹלָא כּו'.

He lifts up all things and binds them all together and unifies all...

וְאִי־הוּ אֶתְקָרִי בְּכָל שְׁמָהּ לְאַשְׁתַּמּוֹדָעַא תּוֹקֶפֶיָּה בְּכָל שְׁמָא וְשְׁמָא
כּו' וְלִית לִיה שְׁמָא יָדִיעָא כּו' ע"ש:

He is called all the holy names to make known His power in each and every name... and yet He has no knowable name.

וְהִנֵּה כָּל הַשְּׁמוֹת כֻּלָּם הֵם מִסְתַּעְפִּים מִהֵשֵׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה

Now all the holy names derive from the Name *Havaye*, may He be blessed.

וְכֵן כָּל הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָה כִּי הִיא כְּלָה שְׁמוֹתָיו שֶׁל הַקֵּב"ה.

Furthermore, the entire Torah is the names of the Holy One, blessed is He,¹⁹

וכמ"ש בפ' ויקרא י"ג ע"ב. דְּהָא אוֹרִיטָא כְּלָה שְׁמָא דַּקב"ה הוּי.

as the Zohar III *Vayikra* 13b states: The entire Torah is the Name of the Holy Blessed One,

וְכָל מָאן דְּאִנְשִׁי (שְׁשׁוּכַח) מְלוּלֵי אוֹרִיטָא וְלֹא בָּעִי לְמַלְעֵי בָּהּ כְּאֵלוֹ
אִנְשִׁי לַקֵּב"ה.

and anyone who forgets the words of Torah, and does not desire to study them – it is as if he forgets about the Holy Blessed One.

וּבִפְרָשֶׁת יִתְרוֹ צ' ע"ב וְאוֹרִיטָא כּוּלָּא שְׁמָא חַד הוּי.

And Zohar II *Yitro* 90b states the entire Torah is one single name

—

שְׁמָא קַדִּישָׁא דַּקב"ה מְמֵשׁ. מָאן דְּזָכִי בְּאוֹרִיטָא זָכִי בְּשְׁמָא קַדִּישָׁא.

the holy name of the Holy Blessed One, literally. Thus one who merits Torah knowledge is deemed worthy of the holy name.

ר' יוֹסִי אָמַר בַּקֵּב"ה מְמֵשׁ זָכִי דְּהָא הוּא וְשְׁמִיהּ חַד הוּא:

Rabbi Yose declared: he is deemed worthy of the **Holy Blessed One Himself**, since **He and His name are one**.

וְהִנֵּה כָּל הַתּוֹרָה הִנֵּה הִיא ג"כ ע"פ אֱלוֹהֵי הַכִּלְלִים.

Thus the entire Torah is also revealed in these two general types of revelation:

אֶחָד הוּא גִלּוּי שְׁבָאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא בְּהַאֲוֹר דְּכִלְלוֹת שֵׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה

one, His revelation in Atzilut, which is in general the Name Havaye,

וְנִקְרָא הִיא תּוֹרַת הָאֲצִילוֹת.

and is called the 'Torah of Atzilut,'

וְאֶחָד הוּא גִלּוּי שְׁבִהַעֲוִלְמוֹת בִּי"ע שֶׁהֵם בְּהַאֲוֹר וְגִלּוּי דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים

and the other, His revelation in the Worlds of BiY" A, which are the revelation and light of the name *Elokim*,

וְנִקְרָא הִיא תּוֹרַת הַבְּרִיאָה.

and is called the 'Torah of Beriah.'

וְאֵלּוּלָא הַחֲטָא דְּעַץ הַדַּעַת הָיָה זִוְכָּה אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן לְתוֹרַת הָאֲצִילוֹת.

Now were it not for the sin of the Tree of Knowledge, Adam would have been worthy of the Torah of Atzilut,

כִּי הָיָה נִתֵּן לוֹ כָּל הַתּוֹרָה כְּלָה וּכְמ"ש "וַיִּנַּחֲהוּ בְּגֵן עֵדֶן לְעִבְדָּהּ וּלְשָׁמְרָה".

since the entire Torah would have been given to him, as the verse states "He placed him Adam in the Garden of Eden to work it and to guard it." (Genesis 2:15).

וְאָמְרוּ בַּפֶּדֶר"א [בְּפִרְקֵי דְרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר] פ' י"ב לַעֲסֹק בְּדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה

Commenting on this verse, *Pirkei d'Rabbi Eliezer* chapter 12²⁰ states: 'to work it' means 'to occupy himself with the words of Torah,'

ולשמר את דרך עץ החיים והוא אוריתא דאצילות

And 'to guard it' means to guard the path to the Tree of Life, which is the Torah of Atzilut,

שעקרה על יחודי אורות עליונים

the primary aspect of which is unification of the supernal illuminations,

שהם הפנימית דכל התורה והמצות.

that are the inner dimension of all of Torah and mitzvot.

ועל זה אמרו (עבודה זרה דף ג') שהקב"ה עוסק בתורה,

Regarding this the Sages stated (*Avodah Zara* 3b) that the Holy Blessed One occupies Himself with Torah i.e. with the inner dimension of Torah.

כי אור פנימית התורה היא כחות כל הבריאה כלה בכלל ובפרט
ובפרטי פרטית.

For the light of the inner dimension of Torah is the animating power of the entire Creation in general, specifically, and down to the minutest detail.

וכל מציאות המתחלפים ומתחדשים בכל עת וכל מקריהם שבכל
רגע

And the entire existence, as it changes and is renewed all the time,

וכל מקריהם שבכל רגע

and all the events that take place at every moment,

הוא נמשך הכל מגלויי אור פנימית התורה

are all drawn from the revelations of light of the inner dimension of Torah

שמתגלית בכל עת בגלויים חדשים מעסק הקב"ה שעוסק בה בכל יום:

that are revealed in all the new illuminations produced by the Holy Blessed One occupying Himself therein every day.

וזה היה ענין התורה שהיה נתן לאדם הראשון אלולא החטא.

Now this was the Torah that would have been given to Adam, were it not for the sin of partaking of the Tree of Knowledge.

וכן היה נתן לנו ג"כ אלו שזכינו להלוחות הראשונות

And so too would it have been granted to us, had we merited the first Tablets,

וכמ"ש "אני אמרתי אלהים אתם".

as the verse (Psalms 82:6) states, "I said, 'You are *Elokim*...'"

The one speaking here is God, so some translate this as "you are angelic" as the name *Elokim* often refers to angels. The implication is that we would have lived forever, like the angels, had Adam not sinned.

וע' דברינו נוראות בזה בספר הדע"ה ח"ב דרוש ד' מענ"י"ב והלאה.

See some of our awe-inspiring words cited in our commentary on this in *Sefer HaDe'ah II* 4:12.

כי כ"ז הוא מרוממות מעלת גדלת תורה הקדושה

For all of this is from the loftiest rungs of the greatness of the holy Torah,

שהיא מיסד מרמ"ח ושס"ה וכל מצוה ומצוה הרי היא כולל
פרטים רבים אין חקר.

the basis of which is the 248 positive commandments and the 365 prohibitions; and each of the mitzvot includes innumerable details that cannot be fathomed.

והוא באשר שהוא היסוד והשרש דכל המציאות כלה

This is because it the Torah is the foundation and root of all existence

שהיא נתיסדה ג"כ על תכונת פרצוף אדם כנודע וכמ"ש באדר"נ
ס"פ ל"א.

which is also based on the characteristics of the human *partzuf*, as is known, and as *Idra d'R. Natan* (end of chap. 31) states.

וכל המון ברואים לאין תכלית הנמצא בהמציאות

The vast array – without limit – of creatures that exist

הנה הם רק פרטי הקומה הכללי.

are merely the specifics of a general structure

אבל כלם הם רק כללות קומת פרצוף אדם שלם.

and all are merely part of the general stature of a complete human *partzuf*.

ובפרט מין האדם ר"ל האישים שבכל דור

This is particularly the case with humans, i.e. the individuals in each generation

הנה הנה כללות כל דור רק אדם אחד שלם עם כלל המציאות
יחד.

in a sense comprise a single complete person, together with the entire existence.

וְלָכֵן הֵם נִצְרָכִים זֶה לָזֶה (רְצוֹנִי לֹמַר אָדָם אֶחָד לַחֲבֵרוֹ וְלִכְל
הַמְצִיאִיוֹת שֶׁבָּהֶעָלָם)

**And therefore they need each other (by which I mean to say
one person needs another, as well as needing everything in
existence in the world),**

וּמִשְׁתַּמְשִׁים זֶב"ז [זֶה בְּזֶה] וְנִעְזָר כ"א [כָּל אֶחָד] ע"י חֲבֵרוֹ

and they benefit one another, and one helps the other,

וְהֵם כֻּלָּם רַק כְּלָלוֹת אָדָם אֶחָד שָׁלֵם.

thus together comprising a single complete 'Adam.'

'Adam' is meant here as a spiritual profile in the macro-sense. The
idea seems to be that all things together have a symbiotic,
interdependent relationship and form a single unit – 'Adam.'

וְכֵן הוּא בְּכָלֵי כְּלָלוֹת בְּכָל הַדּוֹרוֹת כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר מֵאֲדָה"ר

**And so too on the general macro-level: all the generations from
Adam**

עַד סוֹף כָּל הַדּוֹרוֹת הֵנָּה הֵם כֻּלָּם רַק קוֹמַת פְּרָצוּף אֶחָד,

until the last generation are all one *partzuf*-stature,

כִּי כִשֶּׁם שֶׁכָּל דּוֹר הַקּוֹדֵם הוּא רַק הַסִּבָּה לַהֲדוֹר הַבָּא

**just as every preceding generation is the cause of the
generation that follows,**

כֵּן הוּא כָּל דּוֹר הַבָּא הוּא הַתְּכֵלִית לַהֲדוֹר הַקּוֹדֵם

**so too, every future generation is the objective of the one
previous to it.**

וְהֵם כֻּלָּם רַק קוֹמַת פְּרָצוּף אָדָם שָׁלֵם

In this way, they form one single *partzuf* of a complete 'Adam.'

זֶה עֵמֶק כְּנֻת מֵאֲמָרָם ז"ל עֵדוּת פ"ב מ"ט. הָאֵב זֹכָה לְבָנוּ (כו')
בְּמִסְפַּר הַדּוֹרוֹת לְפָנָיו,

This is the deep mystical intention of the statement of our Sages in *Eduyot* 2:9: The *Mishnah* there states: "A father bequeaths to his son attractiveness, strength, wealth, wisdom, life-span and God's promises to him **for a number of generations to come**²¹....

The Baal HaLeshem now explains the latter mystically, as follows:

כִּי מָה שְׁנוּגֵעַ לְתַקּוּן הַקּוֹמָה הַכִּלְלִי מִכָּל הַדּוֹרוֹת שֶׁלִּפְנֵינוּ,

What is relevant to rectifying the macro-profile of Adam spanning all the previous generations –

הִנֵּה זֶה מוֹסֵר וּמִזְכֶּה כָּל אֵב לְבָנוּ.

that is what the father contributes and bequeaths to his son.

כִּי תַקּוּן כָּל דּוֹר הוּא תְלוּי בְּכֻלָּם דְּוָקָא, כִּי הֵם קוֹמָה אַחַת,

This is because the *tikun* of every generation depends upon all of its members, since they all form a single macro-profile,

וּמַעֲכָב כ"א עַל תַּקּוּן זִוְלָתוֹ. (ע' דִּבְרֵינוּ בְּזֶה בְּאַרְכָּה קֶצֶת בְּחֻלְק
הַבְּאוּרִים שֶׁעַר עֲקוּדִים פ"ג אוֹת מ' ס' ג').

and each individual can prevent the *tikun* of another. (See more on this in our commentary section to *Shaar Akudim* chap. 3, 40:3).

וְהָרִי עכ"פ הוּא כִּי כָלְלוֹת הַקּוֹמָת אָדָם הוּא כּוֹלֵל פְּרָטִים רַבִּים אִין חֶקֶר,

In any event, we conclude that the macro-profile of Adam includes innumerable details

וְהֵם מִתְחַלְפִּים וּמִתְחַדָּשִׁים בְּהִתְחַדָּשׁוֹת כָּל דּוֹר

that change and arise anew in every generation,

ובמציאות כל איש, הן בהאדם והן בהעלם.

and in the existence of every individual, whether in man or in the world.

וכ"ז הנה הוא נמשך ונעשה מגלויי אור התורה

And all of this is drawn down and brought about by the revelation of the light of the Torah,

שמתחלפים ומתחדשים גלוייה תמיד במה שהקב"ה עוסק בה בכל יום,

whose illuminations constantly change and are renewed by the Holy One, blessed is He, occupying Himself with it every day.

כי התורה היא אמון פדגוג, אמון רבתיא כלי אומנותו של הקב"ה.

Because the Torah is referred to (in *Midrash Rabba, Bereishit* 1:1) as 'the master teacher, the great master, the implement of the Holy One, blessed is He,

ונעשה הכל ע"פ אורה וגלוייה וכמ"ש בריש ב"ר [בראשית רבה].

and everything is achieved with its light and revelation, as is written in at the beginning of *Bereishit Rabba* ibid.

והנה העקר בכ"ז הוא אורייתא דאצילות שהיא תורתו של הקב"ה

Now the main point in all of this is that we are referring here to the Torah of Atzilut, which is the Torah of the Holy One, blessed is He,

המאירה ומתגלה ע"פ גלויי אור דהשם הוי"ה ב"ה וכנזכר:

that shines forth and is revealed according to the revelations of the light of the blessed Name *Havaye*, as mentioned.

אמנם הנה גלוייה למעלה הוא לפי ערך גלוייה למטה,

Although the revelation above is commensurate with the revelation below,

וכמ"ש "וְאֵשֶׁת דְּבָרִי בְּפִיךָ... לִנְטֹעַ שָׁמַיִם וְלִיסֹד אֶרֶץ".

as the verse (Isaiah 51:16) states, "And I have placed My words in your mouth... to implant the heavens and set a foundation for the earth,"

"My words" the revelation above; "in your mouth" the revelation below. "Set a foundation for earth, the revelation of Torah in Beriah; "to implant the heavens" – the revelation of Torah in Atzilut. [22](#)

אך למטה הנה היא אינה בגלויה אשר באצילות

nevertheless, below in the lower worlds it the Torah is not revealed in the same manner as in Atzilut,

אלא רק בגלויי דאור השם אלהים,

but merely as the light of the name *Elokim*,

אשר הוא ע"פ הראוי רק לתכונת ואיכות הבריאה.

which is the proper revelation for the nature and quality of Beriah,

והיא רק תמצית הארה מהאור דאצילות.

and is merely the condensation of a radiance of the light of Atzilut.

וזהו שאמרו במדרש קהלת רפ"ב כל התורה שהאדם לומד בהעולם הזה

This is the meaning of the statement in *Midrash Kohelet* beg. Chap. 2: "All the Torah a person learn is this world

הכל הוא לפני תורה שבהעולם הבא.

is as fleeting as a breath²³ compared with Torah in the World to Come...

The Midrash continues: Because in this world we forget the Torah we have learned, whereas in the World to Come it will be set permanently within us.

וְזֶהוּ הָעֲנָן ג"כ מ"ש "פָּנִים בְּפָנִים דְּבַר ה' עִמָּכֶם".

This is also the concept expressed in the verse (Deuteronomy 5:4): "God spoke with you face-to-face."

וַיֵּשׁ שָׁם פְּסִיק בֵּין פָּנִים בְּפָנִים, כִּי לֹא הִשְׁיגוּ אֶת הַפָּנִים דְּהַשֵּׁם
הוּא מַמְשֵׁ

A cantillation note denoting a slight pause, called a *psik*, is placed between the words face-to-face, like this: פָּנִים | בְּפָנִים because they did not achieve true face-to-face communion with *Havaye*,

אֶלָּא רַק ע"י הַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהִים.

but rather via the name *Elokim*.

וְזֶהוּ ג"כ מ"ש וַיְדַבֵּר אֱלֹהִים כו' אֲנֹכִי הוּא אֱלֹהֶיךָ

This is also the meaning of the verse (Exodus 20:2): "And *Elokim* spoke... I am *Havaye* your God..."

לֹא הִשְׁיגוּ אֶת הָאוֹר דְּהַשֵּׁם הוּא ב"ה

and they did not attain the light of the blessed Name *Havaye*

אֶלָּא רַק ע"י הָאוֹר דְּהַשֵּׁם אֱלֹהִים.

other than via the light of the name *Elokim*, which is why the verse begins "And *Elokim* spoke..."

וְכֵן "וַיּוֹצֵא מֹשֶׁה אֶת הָעָם לִקְרַאת הָאֱלֹהִים" כו'

The verse (Exodus 19:17) can be interpreted **similarly**: "**And Moshe brought the people forth from the camp towards Elokim...**"

Note that the name *Elokim* is the focus of the verse.

הגם שְׁכָתוּב וְהָרַסִינִי כו' מִפְּנֵי אֲשֶׁר יָרַד עָלָיו ה'.

Now even though the next verse (Exodus 19:18) states: "All of Mount Sinai was smoking because Havaye had descended upon it in fire..."

Here the verse uses the essential Name, *Havaye*, not the name *Elokim*, which seems to contradict the previous verse,

אֲמַנָם אֵלֹהֵי הַב' מִיָּנִי גְלוּיִים הֵם בְּאֶמֶת אֶחָד.

However, the explanation is that these two types of revelation are in fact one,

אֵלֹהִים שֶׁהֵם בְּבַחֲיִנַת פְּנִימִית וְחִיצוֹנִית, וְזֶה מִסְתַּעַר מִזֶּה.

only that they are two aspects of the same revelation – the **inner and outer aspects**, *Havaye* and *Elokim* respectively, **one of which derives from the other** – *Elokim* derives from *Havaye*, as explained earlier.

וְהוּא מָה שְׁכָתוּב בִּפ' וְאֶתְחַנֵּן אֶת הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה דְּבַר הוּי"ה אֵל כָּל קְהִלָּתְכֶם

The same point is understood from the verse written in *Parshat V'etchanan* (Deuteronomy 5:19): "These words *Havaye* spoke to your entire congregation..." the message comes from *Havaye* but is delivered through *Elokim*,

כִּי רַק הוּא הָיָה נוֹתֵן הַתּוֹרָה בְּאֶמֶת וּכְמ"ש אֲנֹכִי הוּי"ה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

for it was only He who truly gave us the Torah, as is written (Exodus 20:2), "I am Havaye your Lord,"

אֵלֹהִים שֶׁהֵם לֹא הַשְׁיִיגוּהוּ רַק ע"י הָאוֹר דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים.

albeit that they did not apprehend the light of that Name, other than via the name *Elokim*.

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁכְּתוּב "אַתָּה הָרְאֵתָ לְדַעַת כִּי הוּי"ה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים" כו'

This is also the meaning of **the verse** (Deuteronomy 4:35): "**You have been shown in order to know that *Havaye* is *Elokim*...**"

כִּי הֵגַם שְׁלֹא רָאוּ אֶת הַגְּלוּי אֹר דְּהַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה בְּעֶצְמוֹ

for although they did not see the revelation of the light of the Name of *Havaye* Himself,

אֲךְ הוֹכִיחוּ לְדַעַת ע"י הַגְּלוּי דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים כִּי הוּי"ה הוּא עֶצְמוֹ
אֱלֹהִים אִין עוֹד:

they were "shown in order to know that *Havaye* Himself is *Elokim*... there is none other."

וְהָרִי לָנוּ עכ"פ כִּי כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּידֵינוּ הִיא בְּהַגְּלוּי דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים,

Thus we have it that the entire revelation of the Torah in our possession is via revelation of the name *Elokim*,

וְהָאֹר דְּהַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה הִיא גְּנוּז וְנֶעְלַם בָּהּ וְהוּא בְּפִנְימִיּוּתָהּ
תָּמִיד.

and the light of the Name *Havaye*, may He be blessed, is concealed and obscured, but it is always in her the Torah's inner dimension.

וְזֶהוּ מ"ש בְּזוֹה"ק בְּרֵאשִׁית כ"ג סע"א וְכֵן בַּתז"ח דָּף מ"א סע"ב

Indeed, this is what the holy *Zohar*, *Bereishit* 23a and *Tikunei Zohar Chadash* 41b state –

שְׁאוּרֵי תֵּא דִלָּן הִיא אוּרֵי תֵּא דְּבְרִיָּא.

that our Torah is the Torah of *Beriah*, and is therefore the revelation of the name *Elokim*,²⁴

וְלָכֵן הִיא מֵיֵסֵד עַל טְהוֹר טָמֵא אָסוּר וּמִתֵּר חֵיב זָכָאִי.

and therefore it is based on the categories of (and the distinctions between) pure and impure, prohibited and permissible, culpable and innocent,

כִּי הִיא מֵהַגְלוֹי דְּשֵׁם אֱלֹהִים שֶׁהוּא שֵׁם הַמְּשִׁתָּף כַּמ"ש בַּפ' מִשְׁפָּטִים צ"ו א'.

since it is from the revelation of the name *Elokim*, the 'associate' name, as the *Zohar Mishpatim* 96a states.

אָבֵל בְּאַצִּילוֹת הוּא הַכֹּל קֹדֶשׁ וְשֵׁם לֹא יִגוּרָךְ רַע.

But in Atzilut everything is holy, and there "no evil abides with You" (Psalms 5:5).

אֲךָ בִּירִידָתָהּ לְמַטָּה מִתְּפַשְׁטִין לַמ"ט פָּנִים טְהוֹר וּמ"ט פָּנִים טָמֵא וּבִסוּד עַץ הַדַּעַת.

However, when the revelation descends below it divides into 49 aspects of purity and 49 aspects of impurity, which is the mystery of the Tree of Knowledge,

וְנִעְשָׂה שֵׁם הַטָּמֵא וְהָאָסוּר מִצַּד הַזֵּוֹהָמָא וְהָרַע הַנִּעְשָׂה בְּבִי"ע.

where the impure and the forbidden are produced due to the spiritual poison and the evil that are produced in BiY" A.

וְהִנֵּה הַטָּמֵא וְהָאָסוּר שֶׁבְּהַתּוֹרָה כְּדִי לְהִתְרַחֵק מִמֶּנּוּ.

And so the impure and the forbidden are outlined in the Torah so that we can distance ourselves from them.

אָבֵל בְּאַצִּילוֹת שֵׁם הוּא הַכֹּל בִּסּוּד עַץ הַחַיִּים וְהַכֹּל קֹדֶשׁ.

But in Atzilut everything is the mystery of the Tree of Life, and everything is holy,

כי שם הוא הגלוי אור דהשם הוי"ה ב"ה שהוא הגלוי דמדרגה
הרביעית כנ"ל.

since there in Atzilut is the revelation of the Name *Havaye*, may He be blessed, which is the fourth stage of revelation, as mentioned above.

אבל מאחר האצילות ולמטה הנה כל גלוי ית"ש

But post-Atzilut – below that lofty spiritual world – all of His revelations,

הן בהתורה והן בהמצאות רק בהגלוי דשם אלהים והוא הגלוי
החמישי.

whether in Torah or in created existence, are only from the name *Elokim*, which is the fifth stage of revelation.

והרי נמצא שכל מה שאנו משיגים מאלהות ית"ש

Thus it turns out that everything we can comprehend of His blessed Godliness

הנה הוא רק הגלוי החמישי אשר מאחר אמתתו הנעלמה ולמטה
וכנ"ל רפ"ג:

is only the fifth stage of revelation after His true concealed Being

אמנם הנה ישנם באותו הגלוי

Nevertheless, within that severely limited revelation,

הגם שהוא רק תמצית הארה לבד מהגלוי הרביעי וכנ"ל.

even though it is merely the condensation of a radiance of the fourth stage of revelation,

עכ"ז הנה ישנם בו כל הענינים והפרטים כלם אשר באצילות

with all of that, it has within it all the principles and details that there are in Atzilut,

וְכֵן כָּל אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה לְמַעַלָּה שֶׁהוּא גַם אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל הַג' גְּלוּיִים
הָרָשׁוֹנִים.

and also that which is far beyond Atzilut – everything in those first three revelations.

כִּי בְּכָל גְּלוֹי וְגְלוֹי וּמִדְרָגָה וּמִדְרָגָה הֵנָּה מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וְנִקְרָא כְּמוֹ
מַחוֹתֶם לְנִחָתָם.

Because in each and every revelation, and each and every level, there spreads forth and is replicated – as from a seal into the sealed i.e. like the seal of a signet ring pressed into wax –

כָּל הַבְּחִינֹת כֻּלָּם אֲשֶׁר בְּהִגְלֵיוֹ וּמִדְרָגָה הָעֲלִיּוֹנָה וְהֵם נִמְשָׁכִים
כֻּלָּם בְּאַחַד.

all the aspects of the higher revelation and level, and they are all drawn down as one.

כִּי אֲמִתּוֹ הַנִּעְלָמָה עֲצָמוֹ הֵנָּה הוּא אֲשֶׁר נִמְשָׁךְ וּמִתְפַּשֵּׁט מִגְּלוֹי
לְגְלוֹי.

Because His hidden true being itself is what is drawn down and spreads forth from revelation to revelation –

מִהֶעֱלָמָתוֹ לְהִגְלֵיוֹ דְּאוֹר א"ס.

from His concealed state to the revelation of the *Ohr Ein Sof*,

וּמִשָּׁם לְהִגְלֵיוֹ דְּאוֹר קַדְמוֹן.

and from there to the revelation of the *avir kadmon* (primordial 'space'),

וּמִשָּׁם לְאָדָם קַדְמוֹן. וּמִשָּׁם לְהַאֲצִילוֹת.

and from there to Adam Kadmon, and then to Atzilut,

ומשם לאור אלהותי שבהבי"ע הממציא את כל, ומקים את הכל,

and from there to the Godly light invested in BiY" A that produces everything and sustains everything,

ומשגים בכל ומנהיג את הכל, ואפס זולתו.

and which oversees everything, and guides everything, and besides whom there is nothing.

והוא מה שנאמר (דברים ו, ד) "שמע ישראל יהוה אלהינו יהוה אחד".

This is as the verse (Deuteronomy 6:4) states, "Hear O Israel, God our Lord, God is one."

We have translated the Name *Havaye* as 'God' and the name *Elokim* as 'Lord.'

וביאורו וכונתו הפשוטה הנה הוא כי הוי"ה אלהינו הנה הוא אחד בכל גלוייו כלם,

Now the explanation and simple intention of the verse is that *Havaye*, who is our Lord *Elokeinu* (the possessive form of *Elokim*), is one in all of His revelations.

כי מפשיטותו הנעלמה האמתית נתגלה להמציא את הכל

Because from His simple (in the sense of uncompounded, elemental) concealed true being He became revealed in order to produce everything there is

שהם כל העולמות אשר מאחר העלמתו עד סוף האצילות,

– all of the worlds that emerge after His state of concealment, until the final aspect of Atzilut –

שנתגלה מציאותם ולא מהותם,

in all of these only their being is revealed but not their true nature,

וְהַמְהִיָּה אֶת הַכֹּל שֶׁהֵם הָעוֹלָמוֹת דְּבִי"ע.

and He is the one who brought everything into being – referring to the Worlds of BiY" A.

וְהוּא לְבַדּוֹ מְנַהִיג אֶת הַכֹּל תָּמִיד וְכִמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דְּבָרִים ד', לט) "כִּי יִהְיֶה הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים בְּשָׁמַיִם מִמַּעַל וְעַל הָאָרֶץ מִתַּחַת אֵין עוֹד";

And He alone guides all things always, as the verse states (Deuteronomy 4:39) "For Havaye is Elokim in the heavens above, and on the earth below; there is no other," and

"יִהְיֶה מֶלֶךְ יִהְיֶה מֶלֶךְ יִהְיֶה יְמֻלֵּךְ לְעֹלָם וָעֶד",

Havaye is King, Havaye was King, Havaye will be King,

וְתִמְסֹר אֵלָיו נַפְשְׁךָ עַל כָּל זֶה כַּעֲקֵדַת יִצְחָק בֶּן אַבְרָהָם

and devote your life to Him in all this to the point of martyrdom like the Isaac, the son of Abraham, was willing to do at the akeidah the binding of Isaac.

בְּרוּךְ שֵׁם כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד:

Blessed be the name of His glorious kingdom for ever!

Footnotes

1. None of the translations here should be taken literally. There is no actual 'space' in the spiritual worlds above. [↩](#)
2. See *Eitz Chaim* 42:1 – *Ein Sof* is called 'Nothingness' because it cannot be grasped at all and has no form or substance, and *Keter* is referred to as 'non-being.' [↩](#)
3. Known as *gulgalta*, *avira* and *mocha stima'a* of *Arich Anpin* in which *chesed*, *gevurah* and *tiferet* of *Atik* become clothed. See *Eitz Chaim* 13:2; *Sha'ar Ma'amarei Rashbi*, *Sifra d'Tzinuta* 1 (Makover). [↩](#)

4. I.e. *Ohr Ein Sof* [↩](#)
5. The four letter Name **יה-ו-ה** [↩](#)
6. See *Avot* 5:1 "בעשרה מאמרות נברא העולם" [↩](#)
7. See p. 36c where he explains that the name *Elokim* alludes to the World of *Beriah*. See also *Eitz Chaim, Sha'ar Mochin d'Katnut* ch. 3. (*Me'ir HaLeshem*). [↩](#)
8. Literally, is 'opposite' the Temple below. [↩](#)
9. Note that the original text references 28:5, a printing error. It should be 28:2. [↩](#)
10. *Matok miDevash, Intro. Tikunei Zohar* p. 17a. [↩](#)
11. Thus the name with the vowel points is: **י־ה־ו־ה־י** – see *Eitz Chaim* 44:1 that this name is associated with *da'at* of *ze'ir anpin*. [↩](#)
12. for a total of 86, the same *gematria* as 70=ע; 2=ב; 9=ט; 5=ה [↩](#).the name *Elokim*
13. This line is from one of the *piyutim* sung during *Kol Nidrei* on Yom Kippur. It compares God to a glass-blower who shapes the vessel at will. [↩](#)
14. As mentioned earlier, each of the *sefirot* of Atzilut has one of the Names in particular associated with it. [↩](#)
15. Each of these aspects represents a different aspect or level of Divine revelation in the World of Atzilut. [↩](#)
16. In the current form of the *Tikunim* this appears on p. 65a, 65b. [↩](#)
17. In the current form of the *Tikunim* this appears on p. 64b. [↩](#)

18. *Matok miDevash* compares this to the angelic teacher (the maggid) that Rabbi Yosef Caro merited due to his devotion to Torah. [↩](#)
19. Ramban, Intro. *Sefer Bereishit*. See also Zohar cited in the text below. [↩](#)
20. In current versions: chapter 11. [↩](#)
21. See Bartenura. [↩](#)
22. *Meir HaLeshem*. [↩](#)
23. Some translate הבל as 'vanity,' but this seems difficult to justify. Why would the Torah be called vanity simply because we forget it? On the other hand, 'fleeting as a breath' seems to be more contextually appropriate. This term may also be understood as nothing at all, ie. No possible way to compare the two since we are dealing with two totally different dimensions of consciousness. [↩](#)
24. *Makover*. [↩](#)

Chapter 6 — The division between the first three revelations and the final two.

Sha'ar 4 Chapter 6

More on Revelations from Will to Actualization

וְהִנֵּה אֲמַרְנוּ כִּי אֵלּוּ ב' הַגְּלוּיִים הֵד' וְהָה'

We stated in the previous chapter that these two revelations, the fourth i.e. the revelation in Atzilut and the fifth i.e. the revelation in BiY"A (out of five in total)

הֵנָּה הֵם גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בְּבַחֲיוֹ פְּעֻלָּה.

are His revelations that are manifested in action.

כִּי הֵג' גְּלוּיִם הָרֵאשׁוֹנִים הֵם בְּבַחֲיוֹ רָצוֹן וּמַחֲשָׁבָה וְהִרְהוּר כָּנ"ל פ"ג.

The first three revelations are the aspect of *ratzon*, *machshava* and *hirhur* as discussed in chapter 3 of this section.

אֲךָ הֵב' גְּלוּיִים הָאַחֲרוֹנִים שֶׁהֵם הֵד' וְהָה'

However, the latter two revelations, the fourth and the fifth,

הֵנָּה הֵם גְּלוּיָיו ית"ש בְּבַחֲיוֹ יִצְיָאָה מִהֶכֶח אֶל הַפְּעֻלָּה.

are His revelations in the sense of emerging from potential to actual –

וְהֵם הָאֲצִילוֹת וְהַבִּי"ע. כִּי בָּהֶם שְׁנֵיהֶם נִתְגַּלָּה בְּפִעֻלָּתוֹ.

i.e. Atzilut and BiY"A, because it is in these two that His actions are revealed.

וְלָכֵן כְּתִיב עַל שְׁנֵיהֶם לְשׁוֹן עֲשִׂיהָ

And this is why the term *asiyah* – action – applies to both of them,

וכמ"ש כי שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים עָשָׂה ה' אֶת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת הָאָרֶץ

as the verse (Exodus 20:11) states, "For six days God made – *asah* – the heavens and the earth."

וְאָמַר שֵׁשֶׁת וְלֹא בְּשֵׁשֶׁת כִּי קָאִי עַל הוּ"ק דְּאַצִּילוֹת וְהֵם הַשֵּׁשֶׁת יָמֵי בְּרָאשִׁית.

Now the verse states "six days" שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים and not "*in six days*" בְּשֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים because it refers to the six extremities of *Atzilut* the six *sefirot* comprising *ze'ir anpin: chesed, gevurah, tiferet, netzach, hod* and *yesod*. These are called 'extremities' because they will eventually come to define the parameters of space – up, down and four directions, right and left, front and back. **These are the six 'days' of Creation,**

וְכִמּוֹ שֶׁרָמַז הָרַמְבַּ"ן ז"ל שֶׁם וְכֵן הוּא בְּזוּה"ק בְּרָאשִׁית ל"א סע"א
וְעַ' בְּתַקוּנִים רִישׁ תַּקוּן י"א.

as Ramban hints to in his commentary *ad loc*, and so too in the Holy Zohar, Bereishit 31a. See also *Tikunim*, beginning of *Tikun 11*

וְהָרִי לָנוּ לְשׁוֹן מַעֲשֵׂה וּפְעֻלָּה גַם עַל הָאַצִּילוֹת.

So here we have an example of action and activity even in *Atzilut*.

כִּי בְּאַצִּילוֹת וּמִכָּל שְׂכֵן בְּבִי"ע הִנֵּה בָּהֶם נִתְגַּלָּה הַמַּאֲצִיל בְּבַחֲי
יְצִיאָה מִן הַכֹּחַ אֶל הַפֶּעַל וְכֵנָּה:

For in *Atzilut*, and all the more so in BiY" A, the Emanator is revealed in the aspect of emerging from potential to actual, as mentioned previously.

אִמָּנֵם הִנֵּה יֵשׁ חֲלוּק גָּדוֹל בֵּין בַּחֲי פְעֻלָּתוֹ שֶׁבְּאַצִּילוֹת שֶׁהוּא גָלוּי
הָרַבֵּיעִי

However, there is a tremendous difference between the aspects of His action in Atzilut, which is the fourth stage of His revelation

לפַעֲלָתוֹ שֶׁבִּי"ע שֶׁהוּא גִלּוּי הַחֲמִישִׁי.

and His action in BiY" A, which is the fifth stage of His revelation.

וְהוּא כִּי הָרִי כָּבֵד אָמְרָנוּ שֶׁכָּל הָאֲצִילוֹת הֵנָּה הוּא מְצִיאוֹת נִעְלָה
וּמְרוֹמָם כְּזוֹ

And this is the difference: we already noted that Atzilut is a type of lofty and elevated existence

אֲשֶׁר רְאוּהָ לְהִתְקַדֵּשׁ בְּאוֹר קִדְשָׁתוֹ ית"ש

that is worthy of being sanctified with the light of His holiness, may His Name be blessed,

וְהִתְיַחַד אוֹרוֹ בָּהּ עַד שֶׁנִּעְשִׂית חֵד עִמּוֹ וְהָיָה מַעֲתָה אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוּר.

and He united His light with it with Atzilut to the extent that it became one with Him, and from that point on it became complete Godliness.

כִּי מֵעַתָּה שֶׁהִתְיַחַד אוֹרוֹ בְּאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא מִמַּעֲשֵׂה בְּרָאשִׁית וְהִלָּאָה

For the moment that He merged His light with Atzilut, which was from the act of Creation and on,

הֵנָּה כָּל הָאֲצִילוֹת הָיָה וְהוּא כָּל חֵד וְנִתְגַּלָּה ע"י הָאֲצִילוֹת

all of Atzilut and He, became one. And this was revealed via Atzilut

לְהִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם שֶׁהוּא הַשֵּׁם הוּי"ה ב"ה.

in that it came to be called by the Name, the Name *Havaye*, blessed is He.

וא"כ נמצא שכל פעלת האצילות הוא כביכול בחי' פעלה
בעצמותו ית"ש,

Accordingly, it turns out that the entire procedure of activating Atzilut is, so to speak, an activity within His essence, blessed be His Name,

כי על ידה נעשה ונפעל הוא עצמו בהוראת ותאר קדשת השם
יהו"ה ב"ה

since this action effectuated that He Himself came to be expressed and described by the holiness of the Name *Havaya*,

ובכל תאר הוראת קדשת השמות כלם המסתעפים ממנו.

and by all of the descriptions and expressions of all the holy names that derive from it.

משא"כ פעלתו שבבי"ע שהוא גליו החמישי

This is not so with respect to His activities in BiY" A, the fifth revelation

הנה פעל אותם בבחי' פעלה כזו שיהיו חוץ ממנו.

which was effectuated in a manner that categorizes the activity involved as 'outside of Him'¹

כי המציא אותם כלם במציאות נבדל ונפרד מאלהות

since all such activities are produced as an existence separate and distinct from Godliness,

ואין מציאותם גופה שום אלהות כלל וכלל ח"ו.

and their existence itself is not Godly in any way,² heaven forfend.

ולכן נקראים כלם בשם עולמות הנפרדים,

For this reason all of them the Worlds of BiY"A are referred to as separated worlds

כִּי הֵם נִפְרָד וְנִבְדָּל מֵאֱלֹהוּת, וּבָהֶם הוּא כָּל הַפְּרֻד וְהָרְבוּיִם.

since they are separated and distinct from Godliness, and in them in separation and multiplicity.

וְעֲלֵיהֶם נֹאמַר לֹא יִהְיֶה לָךְ אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים עַל פְּנֵי ור"ל זוּלַת
הָאֲצִילוֹת כִּנ"ל פ"ד

Regarding them the verse (Exodus 20:3) states "You shall not recognize the gods of others in My presence" – meaning to exclude Atzilut, as noted above in chapter 4.

The Worlds of BiY"A are separated from His presence, whereas "My presence" is manifested in Atzilut, as just explained.

כִּי הֵם כָּלָם רַק נִבְרָאִים נוֹצְרִים נַעֲשִׂים.

Because all of them the Worlds of BiY"A are only created, formed and made, and are not unified with His presence.

וְאִסּוּר בְּכָל חֹמֶר אִסּוּר לְכַנּוֹת וּלְתַאֵר עַל שׁוּם דְּבָר מִהַמְצִיאוֹת
שֶׁבְּהַעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע

And therefore it is strictly forbidden to ascribe or assign to any aspect of the existence of the Worlds of BiY"A

שׁוּם תַּאֲר אֱלֹהוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ.

any description pertaining to His blessed Godliness.

וְלָכֵן נִקְרָא הוּא ית"ש עֲלֵיהֶם בְּשֵׁם אַדְנִי.

And therefore in relationship to them He is called by the name Ad'nai,

שֶׁהוּא כְּמוֹ אֲדוֹן עַל עֲבָדָיו כִּי הֵם אֵינָם מִיְחָדִים בְּעֲצָמוֹתוֹ

like a master (adon) to his servants, who are not one with Him,

להקרא באֱלהותו יתברך כָּל־וְכָל־ח"ו.

**that His Godliness could be attributed to them at all, heaven
forfend.**

משא"כ כָּל־הָאֲצִילוֹת כְּלוּ הֵנָּה הוּא ית"ש מְתִיחַד שֵׁם בְּיָחִיד עֲצוּם
מֵאֲד

**But this is not so as regards all of Atzilut, with which He is
united with an excessively powerful unity**

עַד שֶׁנַּעֲשִׂית חֵד עֲמוּ וְהִיא כְּכֹה אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוּר עַל יָדוֹ.

**to the extent that it Atzilut becomes one with Him, and in its
entirety it is completely Godly as a result.**

וְהָרִי יֵשׁ חֲלוּק גָּדוֹל בֵּין אֵלֹו ב' הַגְּלוּיִם ג"כ

**Thus there is a huge difference between these two revelations
as well,**

הַגֵּם שֶׁשְּׁנֵיהֶם הֵם בְּבַחֲי' פְּעֻלָּה וְכַנְז':

**even though both of them are in the category of activity as
opposed to *ratzon*, *machshava* and *hirhur* which are all 'inside' of
Him, so to speak.**

אֲמָנָם מָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁכָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע אֵינָם אֱלֹהוֹת כָּל־

**However, our statement that the Worlds of BiY"A are not
Godliness at all,**

וְהֵם עוֹלָמוֹת נִפְרָדִים הֵנָּה הוּא רַק מְצִיאוֹתָם גּוֹפָה.

**that they are separated worlds, this only applies to their
existence.**

אֲבָל בְּפִנִּימִית פְּנִימִיוֹתָם הֵנָּה הוּא ית"ש אֵינוֹ נִבְדָּל גַּם מֵהֶם כָּל־
וְכָל־ח"ו.

However, in their innermost being, He is not separated from them at all, heaven forfend,

כי מתפשט תמיד בהארתו בהם, וכמו שמתבאר לעיל שער ג'

since His radiance continuously spreads forth in them, as explained in Shaar 3,

כל הבחי' דאור אלהות המתפשט ועומד בהעולמות בי"ע ע"ש.

that all aspects of the Godly light spread forth and are manifested in the Worlds of BiY"A. See there in *Sha'ar* 3.***

והנה עומד בהם אורו ית"ש תמיד בבחי' נשמה לנשמה

Now manifested in them in the Worlds of BiY"A continuously is His light, as the aspect of *neshama of neshama* – the soul of their soul.

ועל ידו הוא כל קיומם וכן כל עקר מציאותם והתהוותם.

It is through this that they endure, and in fact their primary existence and coming into being is also by virtue of this *neshama* of *neshama*.

וכן על ידו הוא כל תהלוכותיהם בכל מקריהם שהוא כל המעשים בלם.

It is also through this that their entire development and all the events that occur with them unfold; including all of their actions.

אך אורו וקדשתו שבהם הוא בהעלם גדול מאד

However, His light and holiness in them is greatly concealed

ואינו נכר כלל אלא מצד תהלוכותיהם וכל מקריהם ומאורעותיהם

and is not recognized at all, other than in their development and all the events and occurrences that take place with them,

וכמ"ש בזוה"ק פ' וַיְרָא ק"ג ב' קב"ה אֲתִידַע וְלֹא אֲתִידַע

as the holy *Zohar* (vol. 1) states (*Vayera* 103b): **The Holy One, blessed is He, is known** as He manifests Himself in the lower Worlds **but is not known** in His essence,³

בְּגִין דְּאִיהוּ נִשְׁמַתָּא לְנִשְׁמַתָּא רוּחָא לְרוּחָא גָּנִיז וְטָמִיר מִכָּל כּו'
ע"ש.

since He is the *neshamah* of the *neshamah*, the *ruach* of *ruach*, hidden and concealed from all. See there,

וְכֵן בִּפ' בְּהַר ק"ט ב' דְּאֵנִתְּ הוּא נִשְׁמָה לְנִשְׁמוֹת כּו'

and also in (*Zohar* III) *parshat Behar* 109b: "You are the *neshamah* of *neshamas*...

אֵנִת לְבַר מִכָּל וּלְגוֹ מִכָּל וּלְכָל סְטָרָא וּלְעֵלָא מִכָּל וּלְתַתָּא
מִכָּל כּו'.

You are beyond all things and within all things, in all directions and above and below..."

וְכֵן בִּפ' פְּנִיחָס רכ"ה א' אִיהוּ סוּבְבַּ עַל כָּל עֲלָמִין כּו' אִיהוּ מִמַּלְא כָּל
עֲלָמִין כּו'.

Also in (*Zohar* III) *parshat Pinchas* 125a: "He transcends all worlds... and He fills all worlds..." the transcendent light is called *sovev kol almin*, and the immanent light filling the worlds is called *memalei kol almin*.

וְכֵן הוּא בְּהַקְדָּמַת תְּקוּנִים ז' א'

The Introduction to the Tikunim (*Tikunei Zohar*) p. 7a, also makes the same point.

וְנוֹדַע הוּא מָה שֶׁהָעֵמִיקוּ בְּזֶה אֵיזָה חֲכָמִים ז"ל

[It is known that there are some Sages who delved into this deeply,

אִמָּנָם הָאֲרִיז"ל אֲשֶׁר גָּלָה לָנוּ כָּל סוּד וְכָל סֵתֶר נֶעְלָם לֹא פָּרַשׁ כֵּן.

but the Arizal, who revealed to all of us all the secrets and all hidden matters, did not explain it that way.

וְדַעְתּוֹ הוּא בְּעֵינָיו מִמֶּלֶא וְסוֹבֵב רַק ע"פ מ"ש בע"ח שֶׁעַר עֵיגָלִים
וְיֹשֶׁר עָנָף ב' וְעָנָף ד'.

His view regarding *sovev kol almin* and *memalei kol almin* is only according to what it states in *Eitz Chaim, sha'ar Igulim v'Yosher, anaf 2* and 4

שְׁאוּרוֹ ית"ש מִתְלַבֵּשׁ בְּכֻלָּם בְּפָנִימִיּוּתָם וְכֵן הוּא מְקִיף אוֹתָם
מִבְחוּץ.

that His light is clothed within all of them in their innermost being (*memalei kol almin*), and He also envelops them from without (*sovev kol almin*),

וְכִמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר קֶצֶת סֵדֶר הַהִתְלַבְּשׁוּת לְקִמּוֹן שֶׁעַר ה'.

as will be explained somewhat – regarding the order of 'enclothing' – below, *Sha'ar 5*.

'Enclothing' is the process whereby higher spiritual forces and profiles (called *kochot* and *partzufim*) affect and influence lower ones from within, rather than at a distance.

וְכֵן אָמַר הָאֲרִיז"ל מִפָּרֶשׁ בְּסֵפֶר שֶׁעַר הַקְּדָמוֹת דָּר ו' ע"א

Indeed the Arizal stated this explicitly in the work *Sha'ar Hakdamot* p. 6a,

וְכֵן בְּמִבּוֹא שְׁעָרִים שֶׁעַר א' פ"ב וְכֵן בְּסֵפֶר מַאֲמָרֵי רִשְׁב"י פ' בְּהַר
ע"ש וְתִמְצָא מִפָּרֶשׁ].

and in *Mevo Sha'arim, Sha'ar 1* chapter 2, and in the work *Mamarei Rashbi, Behar* where you will find it stated explicitly.]

וְאוֹתוֹ הַהִתְלַבְּשׁוּת שֶׁהוּא מִתְלַבֵּשׁ גַּם בְּכָל הַבִּי"ע כָּלָם

This 'enclothing' – in which He is clothed throughout BiY"A as well –

הוא אור שְכִינָתוֹ ית"ש שהוא המְלָכוּת דְאֶצִּילוֹת

is the light of His *Shechinah*, which is *malchut* of Atzilut

הַשְּׂרָוִי וְשׁוֹכֵן בְּפָנִימִית דְּפָנִימִית דְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע כָּלָם.

that reposes and dwells in the innermost being of all the Worlds of BiY"A,

וּמִמֶּנּוּ הוּא עֶצֶם כַּח דְּכָל הַתְּהוּוֹתָם תְּמִיד וְכֵן כָּל מָה שֶׁנֶּעֱשֶׂה בָהֶם תְּמִיד.

and from it from the *Shechinah* is itself the very force that maintains their continued existence, and whatever transpires with them at all times.

כִּי הוּא הַנֶּשְׁמָה לְנֶשְׁמָה רוּחָא לְרוּחָא כְּנֻז'.

For He is the *neshamah* of the *neshamah*, and the *ruach* of the *ruach*, as mentioned.

In other words, the *sine qua non* of their existence is only Godliness, so that without Godliness at their innermost core, they would simply not exist.

אִמָּנָם הוּא בָּהֶם בְּהֶעָלָם גָּדוֹל, וְכָל גְּלוּיָו הוּא רַק בְּהַתּוֹרָה ע"י יִשְׂרָאֵל.

He is in them, however, in a deeply concealed manner, and all His revelations are only in the Torah and through Israel,

כִּי בְקִיּוּמָהּ וּשְׁמִירָתָהּ מִתְפַּשֵּׁט וּמִתְגַּלֶּה אִרְקֵדְשָׁתוֹ

because through observing it i.e. fulfilling the positive commandments, and guarding it guarding against transgressing the prohibitions, the light of His holiness expands and becomes revealed.

וַיִּכְיִרוּ וַיֵּדְעוּ כָּל יֹשְׁבֵי תֵבֶל כִּי הוּא לְבַדּוֹ עָשָׂה וְעוֹשֶׂה לְכָל הַמַּעֲשִׂים.

So that all the inhabitants of the earth will come to recognize and know that He alone did and does all actions,

וכמ"ש (ישעיה כט, כג-24) כִּי בְּרֹאֲתוֹ יִלְדּוּ מַעֲשֵׂה יְדֵי בְּקִרְבוֹ
יִקְדִּישׁוּ שְׁמִי כו' וַיֵּדְעוּ תַעֲי רוח בִּינָה כו'.

as the verse (Isaiah 29:23-24) states, "when he (Jacob) sees his children, My handiwork in their midst, who will sanctify My Name... Those of misguided spirit will attain understanding...

שִׁיכִירוּ הַכֹּל כִּי ה' הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים אֵין עוֹד מִלְבָּדוֹ.

All will come to recognize that *Havaye* God in His transcendence is *Elokim* God enclothing Himself in the world in an immanent manifestation – there is none other than Him as the verse (Deuteronomy 4:35) states.

וְהוּא אור אֱלֹהוּתוֹ ית"ש הָעוֹמֵד בְּבִי"ע שֶׁהוּא גְלוּיֹ הַחֲמִישִׁי וְכָנ"ל:

And this is the light of His blessed Godliness which inheres in BiY" A, which is His fifth revelation, as mentioned above.

וְהָרִי נִתְבָּאֵר לָנוּ עֲנִין גְלוּיֹ ית"ש בְּדֶרֶךְ כָּלִל

Thus we have clarified for ourselves, in general, the concept of His revelations, may His name be blessed,

כִּי הֵנָּה הֵם בְּה' מִדְּרֹגוֹת כָּלְלִים:

in which there are five general levels:

הַג' הָרֵאשׁוֹנִים הֵם בְּבִחִי' רָצוֹן וּמַחְשָׁבָה וְהִרְהוּר.

The first three are called *ratzon*, *machshava* and *hirhur*, as explained previously.

וְהֵם גְלוּיֹ אֲשֶׁר בְּבִחִי' א"ס שְׂקָדָם הַצִּמְצוּם וְלִמְעָלָה מִהַצִּמְצוּם.

These are: 1) His revelation as the aspect of *Ein Sof*,⁴ prior to, and above the *tzimtzum*;

וְהָעוֹלָם דְּקוֹ וְצִמְצוּם שֶׁנִּקְרָא אֲוִיר הַקַּדְמוֹן וְטְהִירוֹ עֲלֵאָה

2) The realm of the *kav* and the *tzimtzum*⁵ which is called *avir kadmon* and *t'hiru ila'a*;

וְהָעוֹלָם דְּאָדָם קַדְמוֹן הֵם הָעוֹלָמוֹת דָּא"ס.

3) The World of Adam Kadmon. These are the three infinite revelations, called 'the infinite worlds.'

וְשָׁנִים הָאַחֲרוֹנִים הֵם בְּבַח'י פְּעֻלָּה

The other two of the five revelations mentioned above are the aspect of 'action':

וְהוּא אֶחָד הָעוֹלָם דְּאֲצִילוֹת שֶׁהוּא כֻּלּוֹ אֱלֹהוֹת גָּמוּר

One of them is the World of Atzilut, which is all complete Godliness,

וְהַשְּׁנֵי הָעוֹלָמוֹת בִּי"ע שֶׁהֵם עוֹלָמוֹת הַנִּפְרָדִים:

and the second is the Worlds of BiY"A, which are the separated worlds.

וְהִנֵּה בָּמָה שֶׁאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁגָּלָה ית"ש בְּבַח'י פְּעֻלָּה הוּא רַק בְּאֲצִילוֹת
וּבְבִי"ע

Now when we said that He revealed Himself in the category of 'activity' only in Atzilut and BiY"A,

וְאֲמַרְנוּ שֶׁהֵם ב' פְּעֻלוֹת מְחַלְקוֹת וְכַנִּז'.

and we also noted that these are two separate activities i.e. emanating Atzilut and producing BiY"A constitute two different actions.

הנה יובן לנו בזה שרש הדברים אשר אמרנו לעיל שער ג' פ' ה' ו'

We can now understand this matter in its root discussed above *Sha'ar 3* chapters 5 and 6:

שהנבראים הם רק שנים שהם רוח ונפש,

We stated over there **that there are only two entities** in the category of 'created' – *ruach* and *nefesh*, whereas *neshama*, *chaya* and *yechida* are not in the category of *created*, as the author is about to state, since they are 'within' the Creator.

אבל הנשמה, ומכל שכן החיה והיחידה, הם למעלה מהבריאה.

But *neshama*, and all the more so, *chaya* and *yechida*, are above creation.

והוא כי הרי אמרנו לעיל פ"ג שהם גלויים הנז' הם השרשים להנרנח".

And as we stated above *Sha'ar 4* chapter 3 the five revelations mentioned there are the roots of *nrnch* "y,⁶

וכשם שהג' גלויים הראשונים הם בבחי' אור א"ס והם למעלה מהפעלה

and just as the first three revelations there are in the category of *Ohr Ein Sof*, transcending the category of action,

כן הוא היחידה חיה נשמה למעלה מהבריאה שהוא למעלה מהגוף.

so too, *yechida*, *chaya* and *neshama* transcend creation, corresponding to the body, which they transcend.

וכן הוא עוד כי כשם שאמרנו שפעלתו אשר בהבי"ע שהוא גלוי החמישי

Furthermore, just as we explained that His activity in BiY" A is the fifth revelation,

הנה פֿעל אותם שִׁיְהִיו חוץ מִמֶּנּוּ שֶׁהֵם אֵינָם אֱלֹהוֹת כָּלל וְכֵן"ל,

which He produced to exist 'outside' of Himself, in the sense that they are not Godliness at all,

כֵּן הוּא ג"כ בְּחִי' הַנֶּפֶשׁ שֶׁהִיא כְּנִגְדּוֹ כִּי הִיא הָעֶנֶף דִּהְגְּלוּי הַחֲמִישִׁי,

so too, as regarding the corresponding aspect of *nefesh* (which corresponds to BiY"A) – it is merely a branch of the fifth revelation,

שֶׁהְגְּלוּי הַחֲמִישִׁי הוּא שֶׁרָשָׁה וְכֵנָז'.

for the fifth revelation is its root, as mentioned.

הִנֵּה הִנֵּה הַנֶּפֶשׁ לְעוֹלָם בְּבִחִי' לְבַר מְגוּפָא שֶׁהִיא אֵינָהּ מַעֲקָר הָאָדָם.

Accordingly, the aspect of *nefesh* is always in the category of extrinsic since it is not part of the intrinsic aspects of man

כִּי עֲקָר הָאָדָם הוּא וְכִי הָרוּחַ חֲג"ת [חֶסֶד, גְּבוּרָה, תִּפְאַרֶת]

since the primary aspect of man is only *ruach*, corresponding to *chesed, gevurah, tiferet*,****

אֲבָל הַנֶּפֶשׁ נִהְיָ"ם [נֶצַח, הוֹד, יְסוֹד, מַלְכוּת]

whereas *nefesh* corresponding to *netzach, hod, yesod, malchut*

הִיא וְכִי הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ לְמָה שֶׁלִּמְטָה מִמַּדְרַגַּת הָאָדָם

is merely the root of what is below the level of man,

וְהִיא עוֹמֶדֶת בְּהָאָדָם וְכִי לְקֶשֶׁר אוֹתוֹ

and only exists in man in order to connect him

לְכָל מָה שֶׁלִּמְטָה מִמֶּנּוּ שֶׁהוּא לְקֶשֶׁר עִם הַגּוֹי וְהָעוֹלָם.

to whatever is below him – i.e. to connect him to the body and to the world.

וְלָכֵן נִקְרָא הַנֶּפֶשׁ לִבְרַמְּגוּפִיהָ

This is why the *nefesh* is referred to as extrinsic,

וכמ"ש בזוה"ק בְּרֵאשִׁית כ"א ע"ב. ופ' תולדות קמו א'. ופ' וישלח (קס"א. ופ' פקודי רנז ב'. ופ' נשא קמ"ג א')

(as stated in *Zohar* vol. I *Bereishit* 21b, *Toldot* 146a; vol. II *Vayishlach* 166a, *Pekudei* 257b; vol. III *Nasso* 143a)

כִּי הִיא כְּנֶגֶד גְּלוּי הַחֲמִישִׁי וְכֵן ז' וְהֵבִי:

**since it corresponds to His fifth revelation, as explained.
Understand this.**

וְדַע כִּי כָּל הָה' גְּלוּיִם שְׂאֵמֶרְנוּ הֵנָּה הָיָה שְׁעוֹר מְצִיאוֹת הַגְּלוּי דְּכָל
עֲלִיוֹן

**Know also that regarding all five revelations we mentioned –
the degree of disclosure of all higher revelations**

רַק לְפִי צֶרֶךְ הַגְּלוּי דְּהִתְחַתּוֹן שְׂיוֹצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ

**is commensurate with the need for revelation of the levels
below, that emerge from it from the higher level**

כִּי הֵם כֻּלָּם רַק לִהְיוֹת סִבָּה זֶה לָזֶה.

since they all constitute the cause one for the other.

וְלָכֵן כָּל הַבְּחִינֹת שֶׁיֵּשְׁנָם בָּזֶה יֵשְׁנָם בָּזֶה, וְהֵם כֻּלָּם בְּסֵדֶר אֶחָד,

**And therefore all the aspects that exist in one level, exist in the
other one as well, and all of them constitute a single
arrangement,**

אֵלֶּא שֶׁבִּכ"א הוּא לְפִי עֶרְכּוֹ

except that each of them is according to its spiritual status,

וְכָל עֲלִיּוֹן בְּכָל בְּחִינֹתָיו הוּא הַסִּבָּה לְהִתְחַתּוֹן וְלְכָל בְּחִינֹתָיו.

and every higher level in all of its aspects is the cause for the lower level in all of its aspects.

וְכֵן הוּא תְּכַלִּיתוֹ ג"כ כִּי הַסִּבָּה עֲצֻמוֹ הוּא הַתְּכַלִּית

And so too is it regarding its peak aspiration, because its cause is its peak aspiration,

שֶׁתְּכַלִּית כָּל דָּבָר שְׂחוֹזֵר לְסִבָּתוֹ וְלִסִּבַּת סִבָּתוֹ עַד הַסִּבָּה הָרִאשׁוֹנָה:

since the peak aspiration of every entity is to return to its cause, and to the cause of its cause, all the way up until the First Cause.

וְהִנֵּה סֵדֵר הַמַּאֲצִיל ית"ש אֵת כָּל אוֹתָן הַגְּלוּיִם כֻּלָּם

Now the blessed Emanator arranged all of those revelations in a manner that

שִׁיחָא כָּל עֲלִיּוֹן נֶאֱרָךְ לְהִתְחַתּוֹן (ר"ל שֶׁהִתְחַתּוֹן צָרִיךְ לְהַעֲלִיּוֹן) בְּהִכְרֵחַ וְחִיּוּב,

the higher level is needed by the lower level (i.e. the lower needs the higher⁷) of necessity and as a requisite

כִּי הָרִי רַק הוּא סִבָּתוֹ וְתְּכַלִּיתוֹ.

since the higher level is its only cause and its peak aspiration.

אַבֵּל כָּל תְּחַתּוֹן הוּא נֶאֱרָךְ לְהַעֲלִיּוֹן רַק בְּכֹנֶה וְרָצוֹן.

Conversely, every lower level is needed by the higher level only in terms of intention and desire ('desire' in the sense of will)

כִּי עֲלִיוֹ הָיָה כְּוִנָּתוֹ וְרָצוֹנוֹ, וְרַק לָזֶה נִתְּפָשֵׁט וְנִתְּגַלָּה,

since this the lower level was the intention and desire of the higher level, and it was only for this purpose that it spread forth and became revealed,

וְהָיָה כָּל גְּלוּיָו רַק מֵה שְׁנוּגֵעַ לְהַתְחַתֵּן לְהִיּוֹת סִבָּתוֹ.

so that its entire revelation is only that which is relevant becoming the cause of the lower level.

וּא"כ נִמְצָא שֶׁהֵם כֻּלָּם בְּאֶמֶת סִבּוֹת זֶה לָזֶה

Thus it turns out that they are all actually causes for one another,

וְכֵן הֵם כֻּלָּם תְּכִלִּיּוֹת זֶה לָזֶה,

and also the peak aspiration for each other.

כִּי הֵרִי כָּשֵׁם שֶׁכָּל עֲלִיּוֹן הוּא הַסִּבָּה וְהַתְּכִלִּית לְהַתְחַתֵּן בְּנִז',

Because just as every higher level is the cause and the peak aspiration of the lower level, as mentioned,

כֵּן הוּא ג"כ כָּל תְּחִתָּוֹן סִבָּה וְתְכִלִּית לְהַעֲלִיּוֹן,

so too is every lower level the cause and the peak aspiration of the higher level,

שֶׁהֵרִי סִבָּת וְתְכִלִּית הַגְּלוּי דָּכָל עֲלִיּוֹן

since the cause and purpose of the revelation of the higher level

הוּא כְּדִי לְהַבִּיא עַל יָדוֹ אֶת הַשְּׁנִי אֵלָיו עַל מְצִיאוֹתוֹ וְתְכִלִּיתוֹ.

is to thereby bring the second one the lower level up to it to the level of the cause existentially and in terms of what it ultimately aspires to

וּבְזֶה יִשְׁלַם תְּכִלִּיתוֹ דְּהַעֲלִיּוֹן ג"כ וְהֵבִן כָּל הַדְּבָרִים:

And in this way the ultimate purpose of the higher level is also fulfilled. Understand these matters well.

וְהָיָה בְּכָל אֱלוֹהֵי הָה' גְּלוּיִם כָּלֵם יֵשׁ רְשׁוּת לְהֵלֵב לְחַשֵּׁב וּלְהַשְׁכֵּל
לְהִתְבּוֹנֵן

Now regarding all these five revelations, the heart has permission to think, theorize and meditate

בְּכָל סְדְרֵי מְצִיאוֹתָם וּבְהִרְצוֹן שִׁבְהֵם.

on the entire order of their existence and the Divine will invested in them.

אֲבָל לְמַעַלְהָ מֵאלוֹהֵי הָה' גְּלוּיִם בָּלֵם פִּיךָ מִלְדַּבֵּר וּלְבָבְךָ מִלְהַרְהֵר,

But beyond these five revelations, "prevent your mouth from speaking, and your heart from ruminating" as the *Sefer Yetzirah* (1:8) states in connection with the *sefirot* of Atzilut.⁸

וְגַם הֵתְבּוֹנְנוֹת בָּאלוֹהֵי הָה' אֵינוֹ בְּכָלֵם שׁוּהָ.

And even as regards contemplating these five – not all are equal,

וְלֹא הֵתֵר אֶלָּא בְּכָל אֶחָד לְפִי עֶרְכּוֹ בְּכָל יוֹתֵר עֲלִיוֹן וְרַק בְּכָלְלוֹת וְרַק
בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה,

so that it is only permitted to contemplate each one according to its stature, and the more elevated it is the more general the idea must be, and only in thought,

וְגַם זֶה רַק בְּרִצּוֹא וְשׁוּב,

and even then, only in a manner of *ratzo v'shov*,⁹ literally, 'to and fro' i.e. not for extended periods of time. As soon as one's thoughts soar up to the highest levels one must immediately return to where one is grounded.

וּבְיוֹתֵר תַּחְתּוֹן גַּם בְּפִרְטוֹת וּבְדַבּוּר,

Whereas regarding lower levels it is permitted even in detail and in speech.

אָמנָם הָתֵר הַדְּבוּר שֶׁבּוֹ הוּא רַק לְפִי עֵרֶךְ הָעֲלִיוֹן שֶׁעָלִיו.

Nevertheless, permission to speak about these levels is only in comparison with what is above it,

אָבֵל לֹא בְּעֵרֶךְ הַתַּחְתּוֹן שֶׁלִּמַּטָּה מִמֶּנּוּ.

but not in comparison with what is below it. In other words, speaking about higher levels is comparatively restricted, and the lower the level, the more it is permitted to speak about it. Thus the degree to which one can discuss a lower level clearly does not transfer to the next level up.

כִּי בְּזֶה נִבְחַן הוּא לְעֲלִיוֹן וּבְכָל מִשְׁפָּטָיו וְחֻקּוֹתָיו.

Indeed, this is what distinguishes it as a higher level as regards all of its rational and super-rational laws.

וְגַם הַהִתְבּוֹנְנוֹת הַמֵּתֵר בְּכָל אֶחָד

Also, regarding the contemplation which is allowed at each level

צָרִיכִים לִזְהַר מְאֹד לְדַעַת שֶׁהוּא רַק לְפִי עֵרֶכּוֹ הַמִּתְיַחֵס אֵלָיו.

one must take exceptional care that it is only according to the spiritual stature thereof of that level.

וְהֵבִין גַּם כָּל זֶה (וְהַמְעִין בְּדִבְרֵינוּ בְּסֵפֶר הַכְּלָלִים וּבְסֵפֶר הַדַּע"ה וּבְחֻלְק הַבְּאוּרִים

Understand this too (and one who examines our words in *Sefer HaKlalim* and in *Sefer HaDe'ah*, and in the elucidations at the end of this work

יִמְצָא מִבְּאֵר כָּל אוֹתוֹ הַדְּבָרִים כְּפֹל וּמִשְׁלָשׁ כֶּמֶה פְּעָמִים):

will find these matters explained two and three times over.

אֲמָנָם כָּל אֱלֹהֵי הָהָא גְלוּיִם הֵנָּה הֵם נִמְשָׁכִים זֶה מִזֶּה

Nevertheless, all of these five revelations are drawn one from the other,

וּמִשְׁפָּעִים זֶה מִזֶּה וְקִשּׁוּרִים וּמִיחָדִים זֶב"ז,

and are affected by one another and are bound to each other and are united one with another –

כָּל תַּחְתּוֹן בְּהֶעֱלִיֹן שְׁעָלָיו עַד אֲמַתּוֹ הַפְּשׁוּטָה הַנֶּעֱלָמָה

each lower level with the one above it, all the way up to His true, simple in the sense of uncompounded hidden Being

אֲשֶׁר לְמַעַלָּה מִכָּל הַגְּלוּיִם כָּלָם.

that transcends all revelation.

כִּי הוּא אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בְּהִגְלֵי הָרִאשׁוֹן, וּמִמֶּנּוּ לְהִשְׁנִי וּמִמֶּנּוּ לְהִשְׁלִישִׁי וְכֵן כו' כו' בְּנ"ל ספ"ד.

For He is revealed in the very first revelation, and from there to the second, and then to the third etc. as explained above end of chapter 4,

אֲבָל בְּאֲמַתּוֹ הַנֶּעֱלָמָה עֲצָמוֹ אֲשֶׁר נִתְגַּלָּה בָּהֶם

But as regards His true hidden Being itself which is revealed within them within these levels

הֵנָּה אֲסוּר וְנִמְנָע וּמִשּׁוּלָּל מִכָּל לֵב לְחַשֵּׁב וּמִכָּל שֶׁכֶּל לְהִתְבּוֹנֵן,

– it is forbidden and permission is withheld and denied to any heart to think about, and all the more so to contemplate,

כִּי רַק הוּא לְבַדּוֹ יֵת"ש יוֹדֵעַ אֶת עֲצָמוֹ וּמַכִּיר אֶת אֲמַתּוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ
וְיִתְעַלָּה שְׁמוֹ לְעַד:

for He alone knows Himself and is aware of His true being, may His Name be blessed and exalted forever.

Footnotes

1. I have placed this phrase in quotes since in reality nothing is actually outside of His aegis, as will be explained below. [↩](#)
2. And therefore the name revealed in BiY"A is *Elokim*, as explained in the previous chapter (Makover). [↩](#)
3. Rabbi Avraham Galanti and other commentaries on the *Zohar*. [↩](#)
4. I.e. the *Ohr Ein Sof*. [↩](#)
5. As noted previously, the *kav* follows the *tzimtzum*, and not vice versa, despite their reverse order in this sentence. [↩](#)
6. These are the *Ohr Ein Sof*, the *tzimtzum* and *kav*, Adam Kadmon, Atzilut and BiY"A. [↩](#)
7. The Hebrew text here clarifies the intention. Since we have translated the text according to the intended meaning, this parenthetical statement may seem unnecessary. [↩](#)
8. *Meir haLeshem* notes an apparent contradiction here since the *Sefer Yetzirah* (ibid.) seemingly allows only contemplation of the *sefirot* of Atzilut, whereas the Ba'al haLeshem allows contemplation of many levels beyond Atzilut! He concludes that this seems to depend upon the depth of contemplation. [↩](#)
9. See Ezekiel 1:14. [↩](#)